

COURSE DETAIL (COURSE DESCRIPTION BY FACULTY)

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING (30000) - **ERRICO, MARCO>>**

CONTENT

This course provides an introduction to financial statements and the financial reporting process from a user's perspective. The focus of the course is on fundamental accounting concepts and principles. Students learn how the economic transactions of a firm are reported in the financial statements and related disclosures. The objective of the course is to provide students with basic skills necessary to read and analyze financial statements as well as to prepare students for more advanced financial statement analysis courses.

Classes combine interactive lectures and discussions about financial accounting concepts and practice. A number of cases involving corporate financial statements are used to illustrate accounting concepts and to explore disclosure strategies of companies. Students are expected to complete assigned problems, readings, and cases in preparation for each class.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30000 if BUSN 20100 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Textbook: The recommended (optional) text is "Financial Accounting for MBAs," by Easton, Wild, Halsey & McAnally, 9th edition, Cambridge Business Publishing, 2025.

You can buy the textbook at the following link <https://mybusinesscourse.com/book/famba9e>, and choosing one of the options.

See syllabus for additional information.

GRADES

Based on a mid-term, final examination, participation, and individual assignments. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-06
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-07
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 20 2025

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING (30000) - GRANJA, JOAO>>

CONTENT

This course is an introduction to financial statements and the financial reporting process from a user's perspective. The focus of the course is on understanding the basic accounting principles and rules that mediate the communication of economic transactions between firms and the users of financial information. The objective of the course is to provide students with a long-lasting ability to read, interpret, and use corporate financial information and to prepare students for more advanced financial statement analysis courses.

Classes consist of interactive lectures and discussions about financial accounting standards and practices. Short case studies will be used to reinforce the main accounting concepts and foster class discussion about topical issues in accounting. Students are expected to complete assigned problems, readings, and cases in preparation for each class.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-04
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-05
F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll in BUSN 30000 if BUSN 20100 taken previously.

GRADES

Based on a mid-term, final examination, and individual assignments. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING (30000) - HANNA, J.>>

CONTENT

This course is an introduction to financial statements and the financial reporting process. Students learn to read and interpret common components of financial statements through a combination of textbook problems and cases taken from corporate financial reports. This course provides an understanding of how the financial reporting system operates and how financial statements are prepared. With an understanding of these concepts, students should be able to extract meaningful information from the summarized transactions presented in firms' financial statements. Attention is paid to the strengths and weaknesses inherent in the financial reporting process, and to the implications of these strengths and weaknesses for the users of financial information. This course does not prepare students to be accountants but rather prepares them to become informed users of financial statements. Classes include lectures and discussions, supplemented by short cases taken from actual corporate disclosures.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30000 if BUSN 20100 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Hanlon, Magee and Pfeiffer, *Financial Accounting*, (7th ed.), Cambridge Business Publishers. Also, access to the publisher's myBusinessCourse site related to this text is required. An access code is included with the purchase of a new textbook or an eBook. If you purchase a used textbook, access to the myBusinessCourse site can be purchased separately.

GRADES

Based on mid-term, final examination, and individual assignments. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 21 2025

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 30000-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING (30000) - [HELTZER, WENDY>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides an introduction to financial statements and the financial reporting process from a user's perspective. The focus of the course is on

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 30000-01

fundamental accounting concepts and principles. Students learn how the economic transactions of a firm are reported in the financial statements and related disclosures. The objective of the course is to provide students with basic skills necessary to read and analyze financial statements as well as to prepare students for more advanced financial statement analysis courses.

Classes combine interactive lectures and discussions about financial accounting concepts and practice. Short cases involving corporate financial statements are used to illustrate accounting concepts and to explore disclosure strategies of companies. Students are expected to complete assigned problems and readings in preparation for each class.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30000 if BUSN 20100 taken previously. No non-Booth grad students. Undergrads welcome to poll to enroll via Non-Booth registration process.

MATERIALS

Suggested: Hanlon, Magee, Pfeiffer & Dyckman. *Financial Accounting* (7th Edition) and related solution manual. There will also be weekly outlines. Course materials are used to supplement the text.

GRADES

Based on a mid-term and final examination, individual assignments and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 28 2025

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING (30000) - KLEYMENOVA, ANYA>>

CONTENT

This course provides an introduction to the financial reporting process and the use of financial statements from a user's perspective. Students learn fundamental accounting concepts and principles, and how firms report transactions in financial statements and related disclosures. Upon completion, students will be able to read and analyze financial statements. This course provides a foundation for more advanced courses in financial statement analysis.

Classes consist of interactive lectures and discussions about financial

T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 30000-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 30000-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 30000-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
404

accounting concepts and practice. Short case studies involving corporate financial statements are used to illustrate accounting concepts and to explore disclosure strategies of firms. We also consider international differences in accounting standards and how these differences may influence the content of financial statements. I also address the reporting practices for financial institutions as opposed to other types of firms.

In-Person Only

Students are expected to complete assigned problems, readings, and cases in preparation for each class.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30000 if BUSN 20100 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Required course materials: You are required to purchase a textbook for this course. The textbook can be purchased directly from McGraw-Hill or at the bookstore. There are two options:

(1) **Hardcopy:** The hardcopy of the textbook can be purchased [through this link](#) or at the bookstore. The hardcopy package includes physical and electronic (eBook) versions of the 12th Edition of Financial Accounting by Libby, Libby, and Hodge published by McGraw-Hill, ISBN9781265388225 (loose-leaf) or ISBN9781264608751 (bound copy)); and access to the McGraw-Hill Connect Assignment System ("Connect").

(2) **Electronic:** Includes an eBook copy of the textbook as well as access to Connect (ISBN9781265386986). You can purchase the eBook directly from the Connect website accessed through Canvas.

GRADES

Grades are based on a mid-term exam, final exam, class participation, and individual and group assignments. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[**SYLLABUS>>**](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 15 2026

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING (30000) - [**LE, ANTHONY>>**](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 30000-81

This course provides an introduction to financial statements and the financial reporting process from a user's perspective. The focus of the course is on fundamental accounting concepts and principles. Students learn how the economic transactions of a firm are reported in the financial statements and related disclosures. The objective of the course is to provide students with basic skills necessary to read and analyze financial statements as well as to prepare students for more advanced financial statement analysis courses.

Classes combine interactive lectures and discussions about financial accounting concepts and practice. A number of cases involving corporate financial statements are used to illustrate accounting concepts and to explore disclosure strategies of companies. Students are expected to complete assigned problems, readings, and cases in preparation for each class.

TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 30000-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30000 if BUSN 20100 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Textbook: The recommended (optional) text is "Financial Accounting for MBAs," by Easton, Wild, Halsey & McAnally, 9th edition, Cambridge Business Publishing, 2025.

You can buy the textbook at the following link <https://mybusinesscourse.com/book/famba9e>

See syllabus for additional information.

GRADES

Based on a mid-term, final examination, participation, and individual assignments. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 12 2026

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING (30000) - [NIKOLAEV, VALERI>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides an introduction to financial statements and the financial reporting process from a user's perspective. The focus of the course is on fundamental accounting concepts and principles. Students learn how the

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM

economic transactions of a firm are reported in the financial statements and related disclosures. The objective of the course is to provide students with basic skills necessary to read and analyze financial statements as well as to prepare students for more advanced financial statement analysis courses.

Classes combine interactive lectures and discussions about financial accounting concepts and practice. A number of cases involving corporate financial statements are used to illustrate accounting concepts and to explore disclosure strategies of companies. Students are expected to complete assigned problems, readings, and cases in preparation for each class.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30000 if BUSN 20100 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Textbook: You are required to use the 7th Edition of Financial Accounting by Hanlon, Magee, and Pfeiffer, published by Cambridge Business Publishers. The book and course access can be purchased by following the link: <https://mybusinesscourse.com/book/fa7e?purchase>, and choosing one of the options. You can also use the enrollment link below and get a 14-day temporary access to the textbook and MyBusinessCourse (you can update the access code once they receive it without losing your registration).

MyBusinessCourse Information: To access the course, you can choose the following options:

1. Enter the access code that comes with a printed textbook (locate your access code inside the textbook or if you purchased eBook check your email). If your book has not arrived yet, you can click on the course link below and get 14-day temporary access.
2. Purchase eBook with Course Access. Access to myBusinessCourse is free with the purchase of eBook. Note: Do NOT select "Course access only option in the bottom"

See syllabus for additional information.

GRADES

Based on a mid-term, final examination, participation, and individual assignments. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-02
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-03
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 18 2025

FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING (30000) - RIGGS-CRAGUN, AMORAY>>

CONTENT

This course is an introduction to corporate financial statements, as well as the accounting principles and procedures by which those statements are constructed. This course has two objectives that we will pursue concurrently. First, you will learn the mechanics of accounting from an *internal/preparer perspective*: you will learn how financial statements are constructed, how they relate to one another, and how they change in response to common business activities. Second, you will become a more sophisticated *external user* of financial statements by learning to infer certain transactions and events from the financial statements.

PREREQUISITES

Undergrads: None.

MBA STUDENTS: Pre-accounting MBA Canvas course is strongly recommended for those with little/no accounting background. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30000 if BUSN 20100 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Lecture notes, optional videos, self-study problems and other course materials are available on Canvas. Textbook is available for purchase but is not required.

GRADES

No pass/fail grades, no provisional grades, and no early final grades.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 05 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-08
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30000-09
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

INTERNAL INFORMATION FOR STRATEGIC DECISIONS (30005) - COSTELLO, ANNA>>

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

We develop your ability to analyze the economic costs of important decisions *within* a firm. These decisions include make vs. buy, abandon vs. continue, setting transfer prices, and evaluating employee performance, to name a few. When you leave the course, you will understand key costing concepts such as overhead allocation, activity-based costing, capacity costs, customer profitability, transfer pricing, performance evaluation, and internal controls. We apply a case-based approach to learning. Cases cover both the manufacturing and service sectors. The course is highly recommended for students intending to become management consultants, entrepreneurs, managers (e.g., CEOs, CFOs, product managers), and anyone with an interest in learning how firms make product and service decisions from a cost-analysis perspective

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, 33001, 41000 (or 41100) are helpful, but not required. Cannot enroll if BUSN 20101 or 30001 taken previously. Non-Booth students require faculty permission.

MATERIALS

Cases will be available in Canvas. There is no required textbook.

GRADES

The course is primarily case-based; therefore, class participation is a significant component of the final grade. The final grade is based on class participation, case write-ups, and a final project. The course cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. No provisional grades. No early final grades.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

Winter 2026
Section: 30005-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 30005-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 30005-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

INTERNAL INFORMATION FOR STRATEGIC DECISIONS (30005) - [HANNA, J.>>](#)

CONTENT

We develop your ability to analyze the economic costs of important decisions *within* a firm. These decisions include make vs. buy, abandon vs. continue, setting transfer prices, and evaluating employee performance, to name a few. When you leave the course, you will understand key costing concepts such as overhead allocation, activity-based costing, capacity costs, customer profitability, transfer pricing, performance evaluation, and internal controls. We apply a case-based approach to learning. Cases cover both the manufacturing and service sectors. The course is highly recommended for

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 30005-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD

students intending to become management consultants, entrepreneurs, managers (e.g., CEOs, CFOs, product managers), and anyone with an interest in learning how firms make product and service decisions from a cost-analysis perspective

Remote-Only

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, 33001, 41000 (or 41100). Cannot enroll if BUSN 20101 or 30001 taken previously. Non-Booth students require faculty permission.

MATERIALS

Cases will be available in Canvas. The textbook we will use is Fundamentals of Cost Accounting (2025 release) by Lanen, Anderson and Maher.

GRADES

The course is primarily case-based; therefore, class participation is important. The final grade is based on class participation, problem sets, case write-ups, and a final exam. The course cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Provisional grades (for joint degree and non-Booth students only). No early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 21 2025

INTERNAL INFORMATION FOR STRATEGIC DECISIONS (30005) - [STEWART, CHRISTOPHER>>](#)

CONTENT

We develop your ability to analyze the economic costs of important decisions *within* a firm. These decisions include make vs. buy, abandon vs. continue, setting transfer prices, and evaluating employee performance, to name a few. When you leave the course, you will understand key costing concepts such as overhead allocation, activity-based costing, capacity costs, customer profitability, transfer pricing, performance evaluation, and internal controls. We apply a case-based approach to learning. Cases cover both the manufacturing and service sectors. The course is highly recommended for

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 30005-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

Spring 2026

students intending to become management consultants, entrepreneurs, managers (e.g., CEOs, CFOs, product managers), and anyone with an interest in learning how firms make product and service decisions from a cost-analysis perspective.

Section: 30005-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, 33001, 41000 (or 41100). Cannot enroll if BUSN 20101 or 30001 taken previously. Non-Booth students require faculty permission.

Spring 2026
Section: 30005-03
M 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

Cases will be available in Canvas. There is no required textbook.

GRADES

The course is primarily case-based; therefore, class participation is a significant component of the final grade. The final grade is based on class participation, case write-ups, and a final project. The course cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Provisional grades (for joint degree and non-Booth students only). No early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 13 2026

ACCOUNTING AND FINANCIAL ANALYSIS (30116) - [CHRISTENSEN, HANS>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is designed to improve students' understanding of financial information beyond an introductory accounting class. It will provide the knowledge of financial statements necessary to conduct a reasonably sophisticated financial statement analysis. The focus is on the use of financial statements, although this requires some understanding of the process by which financial statements are produced. It will benefit students that want to become bankers, investors, analysts, or any other job that requires more than a superficial understanding of financial reporting. The course is also a good replacement for B30000 for MBA students that have already taken an

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30116-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30116-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM

introductory accounting class (the online pre-MBA accounting class is a great preparation for the class).

We will not limit our study to the financial statements per se. We will also work with supplemental disclosures, which help the user to interpret the financial statements and to understand better the economic transactions that gave rise to them. The techniques we will employ will be useful for variety of purposes including (but not limited to) equity, credit, and complex deals (such as MA) analysis. Although this course does not cover forecasting, valuation, or models of complex deals, a thorough understanding of financial reporting issues is critical to being able to use such techniques. As a result, this course will be especially useful as a prelude to Financial Statement Analysis (B30130), Advanced Financial Analysis and Valuation for Global Firms (B30131), and Deal Structuring and Financial Reporting Implications (B30122).

Topics covered typically include: pro forma financial statements; convertible instruments; EPS; stock-based compensation accounting; accounting for investments; accounting for income taxes; lease accounting; foreign currency translation. Where significant, differences between US GAAP and international standards (IFRS) will be highlighted.

Class discussions will draw from actual financial statements. Answers to five cases based on actual financial statements must be submitted. There will be two in-person exams (Weeks 5 and 10).

The course is also likely to prove useful to those preparing to take the CFA or CPA exams.

Harper Center
C08

In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30116-03
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
208

In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30116-04
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208

In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

-01 and -02: Booth pre-MBA online accounting class or Bus 30000 or equiv. recommended, not required. Can bid w/o securing a waiver. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30116 if BUSN 20140 taken previously. -03 and -04: Required class for MiF students. No prereqs.

MATERIALS

Textbook: Revsine, Collins, Johnson, Mittelstaedt & Soffer *Financial Reporting & Analysis*, latest edition (McGraw Hill Higher Education). Also additional readings, principally from the popular business press.

GRADES

Combination of exams and group case write-ups. Cannot be taken pass/fail. Auditors not permitted.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

TAXES AND BUSINESS STRATEGY (30118) - ERICKSON, MERLE>>**CONTENT**

This course provides students with a framework for thinking about tax planning. This framework has two principal advantages. First, it is designed to have value long after the recent and next tax law change. Second, the framework is portable, in that it can be applied to any set of tax laws - those of the United States or any other country. Although the course generally focuses on U.S. based transactions and planning examples, the underlying ideas are applicable in other jurisdictions. Once developed, the framework is applied to a variety of business settings. The applications integrate concepts from finance, economics, and accounting to achieve a more complete understanding of the role of taxes in business strategy. The course also includes periodic focus on the financial accounting ramifications of tax planning. Moreover, the course content has valuation related implications.

The following groups will profit from this course: financial executives (e.g. CFOs), entrepreneurs, private equity professionals, investment bankers, financial analysts, and consultants who want to have a competitive advantage by understanding how taxes impact the structure and value of various types of transactions.

Topics include the following: tax planning for mergers, acquisitions, and divestitures; taxation of structures for new businesses (e.g., C Corps, and LLCs); tax planning for financing transactions, including cross-border financing, executive compensation (e.g., incentive stock options); and others.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000. Business 35200 useful. No prior tax knowledge is needed for this course. Cannot enroll if BUSN 20170 previously taken.

MATERIALS

Textbook: Erickson, Hanlon, Maydew & Shevlin, *Taxes and Business Strategy*, 6th edition (Cambridge Publishers). Casebook: *Erickson, Cases in Tax Strategy*, 10th edition (available for purchase electronically from study.net). Weekly handouts.

GRADES

Based on short assignments, cases, and a final exam. No early final grades.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30118-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

TAXES AND BUSINESS STRATEGY (30118) - WEISS, IRA>>**CONTENT**

This course provides students with a framework for thinking about tax planning. This framework has two principal advantages. First, it is designed to have value long after the next tax act. Second, the framework is portable, in that it can be applied to any set of tax laws - those of the United States or any other country. Once developed, the framework is applied to a variety of business settings. The applications integrate concepts from finance, economics, and accounting to achieve a more complete understanding of the role of taxes in business strategy.

The following groups will profit from this course: financial executives, investment advisors, investment bankers, private equity investors and consultants who want to have a competitive advantage by understanding how taxes impact the structure and value of deals; and managers and analysts who need to understand how firms strategically respond to tax incentives.

Topics include the following: tax planning for investments; tax planning for executive compensation (e.g., executive stock options); tax planning for mergers, acquisitions, and divestitures; tax arbitrage strategies; taxation of competing legal entities (e.g., C Corps, S Corps, and LLCs).

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000 or equivalent (strict). Business 35200 useful. No prior tax knowledge is needed for this course. Cannot enroll if BUSN 20170 previously taken.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Textbook: Scholes, Wolfson, Erickson, Maydew and Shevlin, *Taxes and Business Strategy*, 6th edition. Readings and handouts will be posted in Chalk.

GRADES

Based on short assignments, cases, and a final exam.

Final exam will be given during class-time in week 10, with an optional exam given a week early during week 9 of the class.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 30118-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 30118-02
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 04 2025

TAXES AND BUSINESS STRATEGY (30118) - [WELSCH, ANTHONY>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides a foundational understanding of the role taxes play in strategic business decisions. We'll explore taxation not just as a compliance burden but as a critical element of business strategy, valuable across different industries, geographic locations, and taxpayer types. You will learn how to apply an "all taxes, all parties, all costs" framework to improve decision-making related to investment and retirement planning, compensation planning, choice of organizational form, mergers and acquisitions, operating in different states and countries, estate planning, and more. Through a mix of core principles and practical case studies, you will gain hands-on experience analyzing business tax strategies. A recurring theme will be linking concepts from corporate finance, financial accounting, business law, and economics to achieve a more complete understanding of the role of taxes in business strategy. We will also apply concepts to current events and to a constantly evolving tax landscape.

The following groups will benefit from this course: financial executives (e.g., CFOs), entrepreneurs, private equity professionals, investment bankers, financial analysts, and consultants who want to have a competitive advantage by understanding how taxes impact the structure and value of various types of transactions.

Topics include the following: taxation of different investment vehicles (including retirement vehicles such as IRAs, Roth IRAs, 401(k)s); taxation of executive compensation (e.g., incentive stock options and other equity-based pay); taxation of different businesses types (e.g., C Corps, S Corps, partnerships, and LLCs); taxation of mergers, acquisitions, and divestitures; multijurisdictional taxation (e.g., tax rules across states and across countries); estate tax planning; and others.

PREREQUISITES

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 30118-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Business 30000 required: strict. Business 35200 is useful. No prior tax knowledge is needed for this course. Cannot enroll if BUSN 20170 previously taken.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Textbook: Erickson, Hanlon, Maydew and Shevlin, *Taxes and Business Strategy*, 7th edition (Cambridge Publishers). Casebook: *Erickson, Cases in Tax Strategy*, 9th edition (available for purchase electronically from study.net). Weekly handouts.

GRADES

Based on problem sets, cases, participation, and a final exam. No early final grades.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 11 2026

ACCOUNTING FOR ENTREPRENEURSHIP: FROM START-UP THROUGH IPO (30121)
- [BERGER, PHILIP>>](#)

CONTENT

This course develops and illustrates a set of tools needed to provide accounting and related functions for private, entrepreneurial firms. The class follows the life-cycle of a business that originates as a start-up and will cover the accounting-related financial metrics, and the managerial, financial and tax accounting issues that are needed by an entrepreneur.

We will cover topics relevant at the earliest stages of a business, such as setting up the initial accounting infrastructure and tracking the company's Capitalization Table, move on to growth-stage issues such as how to most effectively scale up the firm (including discussion of how Generative AI can aid faster scaling with fewer employees), and end with discussion about the company's exit. The exit would typically be to a strategic buyer, a private equity firm, or via going public using an IPO, SPAC or direct listing.

PREREQUISITES

BUS 30000 Financial Accounting or equivalent. Cannot enroll if BUSN 20160 or 30835 taken previously.

SCHEDULE
Spring 2026 Section: 30121-01 W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM Harper Center C01 In-Person Only
Spring 2026 Section: 30121-02 TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM Harper Center C01 In-Person Only
Spring 2026 Section: 30121-81 W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM Booth 455 132

RESTRICTIONS

In-Person Only

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Readings, class slides and cases in Canvas, and textbook.

GRADES

Based on problem sets, cases, class participation and final exam. No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 12 2026

ACCOUNTING FOR ENTREPRENEURSHIP: FROM START-UP THROUGH IPO (30121) - [WEISS, IRA>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides the core set of tools and strategies that would be used by the Chief Financial Officer at a private, entrepreneurial company. The course follows the life-cycle of a company that begins life as a start-up, and covers the accounting-related financial metrics that are needed by an entrepreneur.

We will cover topics relevant at the earliest stages of a business, such as setting up the initial accounting infrastructure, through to the company's exit. The exit would typically be to a strategic buyer, a private equity firm or via an IPO/SPAC/Public listing.

PREREQUISITES

BUS 30000 Financial Accounting. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30121 if BUSN 20160 taken previously.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30121-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30121-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025

MATERIALS

Readings and cases in Canvas, handouts, and textbook.

GRADES

Grades based on problem sets, cases, class participation, and final exam. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

Section: 30121-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30121-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 07 2025

DEAL STRUCTURING AND FINANCIAL REPORTING IMPLICATIONS (30122) - [SAPRA, HARESH>>](#)

CONTENT

In previous accounting/financial analysis courses, you obtained skills important to understanding how a firm tracks its day-to-day operations, how its activities translate into periodic financial statements and how such financial statements may be used to assess the value of a firm. Outside of 'normal' business activities, firms periodically undergo dramatic transformations via acquisitions, divestitures, restructurings, or bankruptcy. This course builds on knowledge acquired from other Booth courses and equips you with tools to build financial models to better understand the financial reporting, tax, and legal implications of structuring complex deals.

This course is essential for investment bankers, consultants, restructuring and turnaround specialists, private equity professionals, corporate development/internal M&A professionals and entrepreneurs who want to have a competitive advantage by understanding how financial reporting, tax and legal considerations affect deal structures.

You will benefit greatly from this course if you wish to acquire tools to:

- understand the financial reporting, tax/legal implications of structuring complex deals.
- build merger and restructuring models to evaluate various deal structures;
- work for C-level roles (CEO, CFO, SVPs/GMs) and to serve on boards of major corporations as it provides an executive viewpoint on financial reporting and investor messaging implications for significant business investments.

Main topics to be covered include: (1) Financial Reporting and Tax implications of influence and control situations; (2) Financial reporting and Tax Implications of M&A deals; (3) Financial reporting and tax implications for restructuring via

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 30122-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

sales, spin-offs, and equity carve-outs; (4) Financial reporting implications and Tax implications for distressed firms operating in bankruptcy and emerging from bankruptcy (5) Building Merger Consequences and Restructuring models to evaluate the feasibility of deals. Here is a [video introduction](#) for the course.

1st Class Assignment is mandatory. It requires you to build a statement of cash flows. It is available [here](#). Note that it is your responsibility to submit the 1st class assignment even if you are *not* registered for the course by the 1st day of class but intend to do so. You may submit it via email to me or to the teaching assistant.

PREREQUISITES

Strict Prerequisites: BUS 30000 - Financial Accounting and at least *one* of the following:

- *BUS 30130 - Financial Statement Analysis, BUS 30116 - Accounting and Financial Analysis, BUS 30118 - Taxes & Business Strategy, BUS 30131 - Advanced Financial Analysis and Valuation for Global Firms. I may grant a waiver based on previous work/academic experience—please contact me at hsapra@chicagobooth.edu.*
- *[1st Class Assignment](#) is mandatory. It is meant to gauge your skills in financial reporting. If you find it difficult, you should not take the course.*
- Recommendations: Proficiency in Excel & Financial Modelling
- Time Commitment: This class is demanding and potentially overwhelming and stressful if you have a weak foundation in financial accounting and/or are not prepared to dedicate significant amounts of time and energy to keep up with the material. Students should expect 6-8 hours of work per week outside of class for pre-recorded videos, reading, preparation, and cases.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Course handouts and course readings posted on Canvas.

GRADES

The course grade will be determined by (1) an attendance policy, (2) In-class midterm and final exams (3) individual assignments, (4) an M&A modeling group project. Both the midterm exam and the final exam will be closed-book and note. Students may bring a one page double-sided (A4) notes sheet.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 17 2026

FINANCIAL STATEMENT ANALYSIS (30130) - HAND, JOHN>>

CONTENT

Hello! I'm delighted to teach you Financial Statement Analysis & Valuation (= FSAV) because I believe that strong FSAV skills will help you better understand firms' financial statements, disclosures, business strategies/decisions, and equity valuations. FSAV is especially designed for students who are seeking an internship or full-time career in finance or consulting. But I believe it's also very helpful and invaluable to anyone planning a career in business!

Using applied business cases, in-class mini-lectures, and optional pre-recorded videos and academic & real-world readings, my goals in FSAV are to do all I can to help you learn FSAV skills. We will:

[1] Motivate/Overview FSAV + Review Accrual/Deferral Accounting + Analyze Managed Financial Statements. Review the key elements of accrual/deferral accounting that make financial statements different from and on a net basis more informative and useful than pure cash accounting. Motivate + overview FSAV. Appreciate why, where, and how some managers may exploit the discretion in GAAP + IFRS to 'manage' their firm's financial statements, especially earnings/net income/EPS.

[2] Analyze Firm Financial Performance. Learn how to analyze a firm's financial performance in a multi-dimensional way by calculating + evaluating the SPP = size(s), source(s) and persistence(s) of conventional profitability, efficiency, liquidity, and leverage (PELL) ratios. Learn to decompose return on equity using the basic and advanced approaches and know how to measure and analyze the SSP of both normal and abnormal profitability.

[3] Analyze Revenues, Expenses & Assets. Discern key connections between revenues, expenses, and assets in firms' financial statements, business decisions, and past, present & future performance.

[4] Analyze the Economics, Accounting & Valuation of Intangibles + M&A. Gain insights into the unusual business characteristics, risks and returns of firms' intangible assets and M&A activities. Appreciate when, how and why financial statements capture vs. distort these big investments.

[5] Analyze Credit Risk & Financial Distress. Do FSAV wearing creditor shoes. Quantitatively & qualitatively measure and analyze a firm's credit riskiness and proximity to financial distress.

[6] Sensibly Forecast Full Sets of Financial Statements. Learn how to sensibly construct full sets of forecasted financial statements in order to arrive at economically well-founded quantitative answers to financing, investing or

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 30130-01
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 30130-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

valuation questions. Know how to avoid the errors and dubious judgments Wall Street analysts often make when they forecast financial statements.

[7] *Sensibly Value a Firm and Its Equity*. Learn how good FSAV can help you arrive at sensible DCF + multiples measures of enterprise and equity value. Recognize and avoid the errors and dubious economic judgments that managers & Wall Street analysts make when they do DCF valuations.

PREREQUISITES

To take BUSN 30130, you must have taken BUSN 30000 (Financial Accounting) or received a waiver from me. I strongly recommend but do not mandate that you must have taken BUSN 35200 (Corporation Finance). Also, while you don't need to have taken BUSN 35000 (Investments), it can be helpful in FSAV. You may not enroll in BUSN 30130 if you have previously taken BUSN 20150.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

There is no textbook. Cases, case questions, lecture PDFs, Excel files and templates, and always-optional supplementary + harder-core readings will be available on my 30130-01 Canvas website. I use the Modules structure in Canvas, so the Modules will have everything you need.

GRADES

My pedagogy consists of required in-class business cases + topic-based mini-lectures, and optional topic-based out-of-class videos. All classes except the 1st and 6th are structured as follows:

- During the first 2 hours, we'll discuss in depth the case that you must have fully prepared since our last class. I may also spring on you entirely out of the blue new a question or two about the case!
- We'll take a 5-minute break halfway thru and at the end of our case discussion.
- During the last hour of class, I'll present a PPT-based mini-lecture on the key aspects of the next FSAV topic. After my mini-lecture, I'll post the PDFs of my mini-lecture onto Canvas for you.
- Optional materials – For some topics there on Canvas will be optional/supplementary readings and videos available for you to read/see/use. My videos are typically two or three Zoom recordings, each lasting one hour or so, in which I walk through in more detail the FSAV topic(s) at hand.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

FINANCIAL STATEMENT ANALYSIS (30130) - MINNIS, MICHAEL>>

CONTENT

This course teaches you how to analyze financial statements in order to develop financial statement models, diagnose performance issues, assess credit risk, and, ultimately, value a company. The course provides both a framework and the tools necessary to analyze financial statements. Its primary objective is to advance your understanding of how financial reporting can be used in a variety of decisions (e.g., consulting, lending, and investment decisions) and analyses (e.g., financial distress and bankruptcy prediction). It is applied in nature and stresses the use of actual financial statements. Throughout the course, I draw heavily on real business examples and use cases to illustrate the application of the techniques and tools. Topics include traditional ratio analysis techniques, accounting analysis (i.e., identifying earnings management and accounting quality issues), and financial risk assessment. The second part of the course focuses on equity valuation, e.g., the preparation of pro forma financial statements, and the use of various valuation models. While students with a multitude of interests will benefit from this course, students with an interest in investment banking, consulting, strategy, corporate finance, or management will find this course particularly relevant.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000 (or 30116) and Business 35000 (or 35001) are strongly recommended and ideally should be taken prior to taking my class. In essence, I expect students to have a solid foundation in financial accounting and an understanding of investments (including the CAPM) as provided by Business 30000 and 35000, respectively. Business 35200 is also strongly recommended. If you decide to take this class without these prerequisites, you will have to work much harder and may be at a disadvantage. Students can bid without securing a waiver. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30130 if BUSN 20150 taken previously. While the prerequisites are not technically required, students who do not have a solid understanding of financial accounting and corporate finance fundamentals struggle in this class.

MATERIALS

The textbook should be purchased prior to the first week of class. All other materials (including reading assignments for the first class) will be posted to Canvas.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30130-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30130-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

GRADES

Based on individual and group assignments, class participation, a group valuation project, a quiz, and a final exam. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No registered auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades No auditors Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 26 2025

FINANCIAL STATEMENT ANALYSIS (30130) - SMITH, ABBIE>>

CONTENT

This course examines the role of financial statement analysis in the evaluation of the firm and the prediction of its future condition. The course provides a framework and tools for analyzing financial statements in a variety of contexts (e.g. analysis of financial distress and bankruptcy risk, equity valuation and identification and evaluation of value creation opportunities.) We emphasize the connection between executives' priorities, corporate strategy and industry dynamics, and financial statement information. We illustrate the use of financial statement information in ratio analysis, statistical prediction models, pro-forma financial statements, and equity valuation. Students interested in management, corporate finance, strategy consulting, investment banking, private equity, and equity or credit analysis will find this course most relevant.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000 (or 30116) and Business 35000 (or 35001) are strongly recommended prior to taking this class to provide a foundation in financial accounting and the Capital Asset Pricing Model. Cannot enroll in BUSN 30130 if BUSN 20150 taken previously.

MATERIALS

There is no required textbook. All required course materials will be posted on Canvas. If you would like additional detail, an optional book you can use as a reference can be rented or purchased. The Syllabus for Winter 2026 will provide a link to e-book rental options.

GRADES

Grades are based on weekly team or individual case assignments, weekly multiple choice questions, a final team valuation project, class participation, and a quiz and final exam. One team from each section will be selected to lead

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 30130-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 30130-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 30130-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

the final project discussion in week 9's class. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. No early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 03 2025

FINANCIAL STATEMENT ANALYSIS (30130) - [URCAN, OKTAY>>](#)

CONTENT

This course teaches you how to analyze financial statements in order to develop financial statement models, diagnose performance issues, assess credit risk, and, ultimately, value a company. The course provides both a framework and the tools necessary to analyze financial statements. Its primary objective is to advance your understanding of how financial reporting can be used in a variety of decisions (e.g., consulting, lending, and investment decisions) and analyses (e.g., financial distress and bankruptcy prediction). It is applied in nature and stresses the use of actual financial statements.

Throughout the course, I draw heavily on real business examples and use cases to illustrate the application of the techniques and tools. Topics include traditional ratio analysis techniques, accounting analysis (i.e., identifying earnings management and accounting quality issues), and financial risk assessment. The second part of the course focuses on equity valuation, e.g., the preparation of pro forma financial statements, and the use of various valuation models. While students with a multitude of interests will benefit from this course, students with an interest in investment banking, consulting, strategy, corporate finance, or management will find this course particularly relevant.

PREREQUISITES

Both BUSN 30000 (Financial Accounting) and BUSN 35000 are strongly recommended and ideally should be taken prior to taking my class. I expect students to have a solid foundation in financial accounting and an understanding of investments (including the CAPM). Individuals with CPA (or equivalent) or CFA designations are ready to take my class without the prerequisites. If you take this class without these prerequisites, you will have to work much harder, will be at a significant disadvantage, and will likely not learn as much from this class.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 30130-02
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 30130-03
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

The textbook should be purchased prior to the first week of class. All other materials (including reading assignments for the first class) will be posted to Canvas.

GRADES

Based on group assignments, class participation, a group valuation project, a quiz, and a final exam. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No registered auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 11 2026

ADVANCED FINANCIAL ANALYSIS AND VALUATION FOR GLOBAL FIRMS (30131) - [LEUZ, CHRISTIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

The course covers advanced financial analysis and valuation for global firms. It is designed for students that already have a basic familiarity with corporate valuation and DCF analysis (e.g., from corporate finance class or a prior job) as well as solid accounting knowledge. We cover financial analysis of different business models and specific situations (e.g., cyclicals, young growth companies, closely-held firms) as well as the analysis and valuation of foreign companies (e.g., emerging markets, reporting under IFRS). Capital markets have become increasingly global, providing more opportunities for corporate investments and M&A abroad. Evaluating these global investments, however, poses unique challenges for financial analysis (e.g., regarding information, accounting and governance) as well as valuation problems.

This course is likely useful for students who aim for careers in consulting, investment banking, investment management, equity or credit analysis, transaction services, private equity and venture capital, as well as accounting and corporate finance, including M&A functions. It is a capstone class, drawing on several other classes at Booth.

PREREQUISITES

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 30131-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 30131-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

There are no strict prerequisites for this class, so each student decides. However, I highly recommend that you have a basic familiarity with corporate valuation and DCF analysis (e.g., from a prior job or a corporate finance class). I would also recommend that you have taken investments and corporate finance before taking my class. Additionally, you should have solid accounting knowledge, such as Business 30000 or equivalent. You are not required to take Business 30116 but deeper accounting knowledge clearly helps in analyzing financial statements and building valuation models.

You do not need to take Business 30130 first. In fact, there is (conceptual) overlap between Business 30130 and my class, though my class is more advanced and covers different topics and cases.

To help you decide whether you are prepared for my class, I have created a valuation tutorial with a test exercise. I highly recommend that you work through the tutorial and complete the exercise, especially if you are unsure whether you have enough prior knowledge. The tutorial might also be a good refresher prior to the first class. It covers ratio analysis and the DCF model. You can access the tool on Canvas: <https://canvas.uchicago.edu/enroll/C397XG>

This class is demanding and potentially overwhelming if you are not prepared to dedicate significant amounts of time and energy. Students should expect 8-10 hours of work per week outside of class for pre-class or post-class videos, reading, preparation, and cases.

You cannot enroll in BUSN 30131 if you have BUSN 20180 taken previously:
Strict

MATERIALS

1. Valuation: Measuring and Managing the Value of Companies, by Tim Koller, Marc Goedhart and David Wessels, Eighth Edition, 2025. (NB. Readings in syllabus will refer to the latest edition but if you have the seventh, you can make it work)
2. Readings and case materials posted on Canvas (see Modules and Library Reserves)

GRADES

Class participation (25%); homework assignments (40%); final project (35%). No pass/fail grades. No formal auditing (on transcript). Sitting in at the instructor's discretion. I do not provide provisional grades considering that much of the grade is determined late in the quarter.

There is an in-person final project discussion in Week 10. Attendance is required.

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 23 2026

ADVANCED FINANCIAL ANALYSIS AND VALUATION FOR GLOBAL FIRMS (30131) - MCCLURE, CHARLES>>

CONTENT

The course covers advanced financial analysis and valuation for global firms. It is designed for students that already have a basic familiarity with corporate valuation and DCF analysis (e.g., from corporate finance class or a prior job) as well as solid accounting knowledge. We cover financial analysis of different business models, specific situations (e.g., cyclicals, young growth companies, closely-held firms) as well as the analysis and valuation of foreign companies (e.g., emerging markets, reporting under IFRS). Capital markets have become increasingly global, providing more opportunities for corporate investments and M&A abroad. Evaluating these global investments, however, poses unique challenges for financial analysis (e.g., regarding information, accounting and governance) as well as valuation problems.

PREREQUISITES

There are no strict prerequisites for this class, so each student decides. However, I highly recommend that you have a basic familiarity with corporate valuation and DCF analysis (e.g., from a prior job or a corporate finance class). I would also recommend that you have taken investments and corporate finance before taking my class. Additionally, you should have solid accounting knowledge, such as Business 30000 or equivalent. You are not required to take Business 30116 but deeper accounting knowledge clearly helps in analyzing financial statements and building valuation models.

You do not need to take Business 30130 first. In fact, there is (conceptual) overlap between Business 30130 and my class, though my class is more advanced and covers different topics and cases.

To help you decide whether you are prepared for my class, my colleagues and I have created a valuation tutorial with a test exercise. I highly recommend that you work through the tutorial and complete the exercise, especially if you are unsure whether you have enough prior knowledge. The tutorial might also be a good refresher prior to the first class. It covers ratio analysis and the DCF model. You can access the [Canvas pre-enrollment tutorial](#).

This class is demanding and potentially overwhelming if you are not prepared to dedicate significant amounts of time and energy. Students should expect 8-10 hours of work per week outside of class for pre-class or post-class videos, reading, preparation, and cases.

Cannot enroll in BUSN 30131 if BUSN 20180 taken previously: strict.

MATERIALS

Textbook and Required Materials:

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30131-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30131-02
M 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 30131-03
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

- Valuation: Measuring and Managing the Value of Companies, by Tim Koller, Marc Goedhart and David Wessels, Eighth Ed., McKinsey and Co., 2025.
- Readings and case materials posted on Canvas (see Modules and Library Reserves)

GRADES

Class participation (15%); homework assignments (50%); final project (35%). No pass/fail grades. No formal auditing (on transcript). Sitting in at the instructor's discretion. For joint degree students, college students and other non-Booth students, I can provide provisional grades but no early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors No pass/fail grades Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 11 2025

AI AND FINANCIAL INFORMATION (30135) - LEVY, BRADFORD>>

CONTENT

Are you interested in building an AI-first company? Managing an AI product? Evaluating investments in AI ventures? If so, this course will provide a foundation for achieving those goals.

Today's agentic AI such as ChatGPT and Claude are a complex web of components: knowledge bases, language and multi-modal models, preference alignment mechanisms, retrieval augmented generation (RAG) pipelines, re-rankers, etc. As such, this course will cover a wide range of topics and how each one fits into the *big picture of "AI."* Hands-on experience with the topics will result from applying methods to *processing large volumes of financial information.* That said, most of these methods are general, and *even students interested in other domains will gain valuable experience.*

PREREQUISITES

1. I thought Python was a snake, should I take this course?

Yes. Half of each class will be discussion/lecture which you will find useful and the other half a lab where we apply the lecture to a practical problem. If you

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 30135-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 30135-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

genuinely have zero programming experience and/or have never programmed in Python then the lab will be challenging. That said, the labs will be team based so if you have team members who can help guide you, then that will help.

2. In my free time, I leverage QLORA to PEFT Llama 405B while using my 4090's waste heat to keep my pet python's terrarium at a balmy 29C, should I take this course?

Yes. If you are already familiar with advanced methods, the final project will be an opportunity for you to build something spectacular. Along these lines, I will make myself available to provide as much guidance as you like on the project. In addition, I believe the lectures will be sufficiently thought provoking to further cement your expertise and provide an opportunity for you to share with the class.

3. I might take (or already took) Booth course X on AI/ML. Should I take this course?

Yes. The Booth curriculum has been thoughtfully designed such that courses are compliments rather than substitutes. You must decide how much of your Booth education to dedicate to studying AI, but I believe that taking this course, along with any of my colleagues' courses, will only better prepare you for an AI-related career.

MATERIALS

Preparation for each class will involve concise pre-reading and a thought-provoking assignment. The first half of each class will be dedicated to discussion, lecture, and *current advancements*. The second half will be a lab. All materials will be provided via Canvas and labs will leverage cloud computing resources such as Google Colab.

GRADES

Throughout term, student teams will work on a final project of their choosing. For this reason, other assignments will be kept to the minimum sufficient to facilitate in-class discussion. The goal of the final project is to provide students with (i) experience to enhance their portfolio of work, (ii) the opportunity to study a problem of personal interest, and (iii) demonstrate what they have learnt. At the end of term, teams will present their projects to the class and a panel of industry experts. The following weights will be used for computing final grades: Final Project (60%), Pre-class Assignments (20%), Participation/Attendance (20%).

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 14 2025

WORKSHOP IN ACCOUNTING RESEARCH (30600) - STEWART, CHRISTOPHER>> ; TOMY, RIMMY>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30600-60
TH 1:20 PM-2:50 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 30600-60
TH 1:20 PM-2:50 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 30600-60
TH 1:20 PM-2:50 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS AND VALUATION OF FIRMS IN GLOBAL MARKETS (30831, 50 UNIT COURSE) - LEUZ, CHRISTIAN>>

CONTENT

The course covers advanced financial analysis and valuation for global firms. It is designed for students that already have a basic familiarity with corporate valuation and DCF analysis (e.g., from a corporate finance course or a prior job) as well as solid accounting knowledge. We cover financial analysis of different business models and specific situations (e.g., cyclicals, young growth companies) as well as the analysis and valuation of foreign companies (e.g., emerging markets, reporting under IFRS). Capital markets have become increasingly global, providing more opportunities for corporate investments and M&A abroad. Evaluating these global investments, however, poses unique challenges for financial analysis (e.g., regarding information, accounting and governance) as well as valuation problems.

This course is likely useful for executives in consulting, investment banking, investment management, equity or credit analysis, transaction services, private equity and venture capital, as well as corporate finance, including M&A functions. It is a capstone course, drawing on other classes at Booth.

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 30831-88
08/10, 08/11, 08/12, 08/14, 08/15
EMBA2 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

There are no strict prerequisites for this course, so each student decides. However, I highly recommend that you have a basic familiarity with corporate valuation and DCF analysis (e.g., from a prior job or a corporate finance course). Additionally, you should have solid accounting knowledge. See syllabus. You cannot enroll if 30131 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

1. *Valuation: Measuring and Managing the Value of Companies*, by Tim Koller, Marc Goedhart and David Wessels, **Eighth Ed.**, University Edition, McKinsey and Co., 2025.
2. Readings and case materials posted on Canvas (see Modules and Library Reserves)

GRADES

Class participation (25%); homework assignments (40%); final project (35%). No pass/fail grades. No formal auditing (on transcript).

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: May 12 2026

ACCOUNTING FOR ENTREPRENEURSHIP: FROM START-UP THROUGH IPO (30835, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [BERGER, PHILIP>>](#)

CONTENT

[View Video Course Description](#) for more details. The link to the video is at:

<https://uchicago.hosted.panopto.com/Panopto/Pages/Viewer.aspx?id=56fa8c00-49ac-4b5d-8e4c-b41f00eb791f>

This course provides the core set of tools and strategies related to the work of a Chief Financial Officer (CFO) at a private, entrepreneurial company as well as to the work of those who provide funding to the company, work for the

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 30835-88
08/10, 08/11, 08/13, 08/14,
08/15
EMBA2 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306

company, or are founders of the company. The course follows the life-cycle of a company that begins as a start-up, and covers the accounting-related financial metrics, and the managerial, financial and tax accounting issues that are centrally important for an entrepreneur in the private firm environment.

50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

We will cover topics relevant at the earliest stages of a business, such as setting up the initial accounting infrastructure, through to the growth stage (including the role of Generative AI in aiding rapid scaling with fewer employees), and finally to the company's exit. The exit would typically be to a strategic buyer, a private equity firm or via an IPO, Direct Listing, or SPAC. The course will be of particular interest to those who may become start-up founders or key employees as well as to those who may invest in early stage firms.

Selected topics:

- Setting up the **initial infrastructure** for the information system used by a start-up, including tracking the equity capitalization (i.e., the **capitalization table**).
- Structuring and accounting for **equity based employee compensation**, for founders and employees.
- Reporting **key performance indicators** to the company, the board of directors and investors such as venture capital and private equity funds.
- **Issues to consider during the growth phase, including the role of GenAI in aiding rapid scaling with fewer employees.**
- **Sale process**, working capital adjustment, and roll-over equity for a management team.
- Accounting and applying for **debt as a private company**, such as bank debt, venture debt, and account receivable lines of credit.
- Accounting information required for a **fundraising process**.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if 20161 or 30121 taken previously.

MATERIALS

1. Readings and Cases via on-line University of Chicago Canvas system
<https://canvas.uchicago.edu/>
2. Canvas paperless "handouts" each week.
3. Text-book: *[Entrepreneurial Finance and Accounting for High-Tech Companies](#)*, by Frank Fabozzi, MIT Press, November 2016.1st edition

GRADES

Your grade is based on your score out of a possible 290 points. The course cannot be taken pass/fail. The points are allocated as follows:

Final exam	146 (individual work)
Problem sets (best 1 of 2)	30 (group work)
Cases (best 2 of 3)	80 (group work)

Class Participation	34 (individual work)
Total Points	290

The final exam will be taken virtually via Canvas as a timed exam and will be “open book” and open notes, including open access to the old exams and old exams solutions from the Canvas course site. It will be a timed exam (you will likely be given 2.5 hours to take the exam). There will be a multiple week window during which the exam will be available for you to take it. The window will open in the latter part of August and will close in the second half of September.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 02 2026

DEAL STRUCTURING (30840, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [SAPRA, HARESH>>](#)

CONTENT

There are many forms of “structures” in a deal such as financial structure, tax structure, legal structure, and governance structure, all of which impact how deals should be structured. This course combines the knowledge acquired in your financial accounting and corporate finance courses and applies it to structuring complex deals. This course will highlight where to look for key points of deal structure when determining the accounting and financial reporting for the transaction, and the potential impact on investor messaging. More importantly, the course is designed to be practical because it allows students to put skills learned in the course to immediate use by building financial models to evaluate how deals should be structured.

Who should consider taking this course?

This course is useful for anyone who want to have a competitive advantage by understanding how financial reporting, tax and legal considerations affect deal structures. This course is also useful for C-level roles (CEO, CFO, SVPs/GMs) and for those who want to serve on boards of major corporations as it provides an executive viewpoint on financial reporting and investor messaging implications for significant business investments.

Main topics to be covered include: (1) Financial Reporting and Tax implications of influence and control situations; (2) Financial reporting and Tax Implications of M&A deals; (3) Financial reporting and tax implications for restructuring via sales, spin-offs, and equity carve-outs; (4) Financial reporting implications and

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 30840-88
08/03, 08/04, 08/05, 08/07, 08/08
EMBA1 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
200
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

Tax implications for distressed firms operating in bankruptcy and emerging from bankruptcy (5) Building Merger Consequences and Restructuring models to evaluate the feasibility of deals. Here is a [video introduction](#) for the course.

PREREQUISITES

Students should have a solid foundation in financial accounting. To gauge your financial accounting skills, you should work on the following [self-assessment assignment](#). A solution is provided. Cannot enroll if BUSN 30122 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

No textbook required. I will provide all the course materials.

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 06 2026

FOUNDATIONS OF ACCOUNTING RESEARCH (30900) - [COSTELLO, ANNA>>](#) ; [MINNIS, MICHAEL>>](#) ; [SKINNER, DOUGLAS>>](#)

CONTENT

The goal of this course is to provide you with the foundations of accounting research, with a primary focus on empirical research in financial accounting and disclosure. We will initially cover some foundational material in research methodology and design, but then move onto a selection of important applied papers in this area, beginning with Ball and Brown (1968). The goal is to consider and evaluate both substantive economic questions and the empirical methods employed in these papers. The ultimate goal is to prepare you to begin conducting your own research as well as being able to evaluate others' research (including as referees).

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30900-50
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

PhD Students Only: strict

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 31 2025

CONTRACTING ON ACCOUNTING INFORMATION (30906) - [NIKOLAEV, VALERI>>](#)

CONTENT

The course focuses on the role accounting information plays in facilitating the contracting process. Throughout the quarter, we will discuss contracting issues related to agency and information problems and the role accounting information plays to address these issues. Most classes will begin by discussing a foundational theory paper and will proceed with presentations and discussions of related empirical work. We will begin by covering main ideas from the Positive Accounting Theory. Subsequently, we will spend several weeks on compensation contracts. We will then move to debt contracting issues and will discuss the design of loan contracts with the focus on the use of control rights. We will consider contract design from both the classic agency and the incomplete contracting perspective. Throughout the class will be covering both classic papers and more recent topics. Towards the end of the course, you will present a research project idea in front of the class.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 30906-50
T 1:00 PM-4:00 PM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

DISCLOSURE, REPORTING AND TRANSPARENCY: ANALYSIS OF MARKETS AND REGULATION (30907) - [LEUZ, CHRISTIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

The course is designed for Ph.D. students in accounting, finance, and related fields. Its primary objective is to advance your understanding of how to conduct and evaluate empirical research. The course is heavily focused on research design and design-based identification. The assigned studies and topics serve primarily to illustrate broader challenges of empirical research, e.g., our ability to draw causal inferences.

In terms of topics, much of the course covers the empirical analysis and evaluation of regulation, primarily of disclosure, reporting and transparency in different settings. We discuss a wide array of economic consequences, including capital-market, spillover, reallocation and real effects. Specifically, the course covers the link between disclosure, information asymmetry and the cost of capital, voluntary disclosure incentives, the economic consequences of disclosure and securities regulation and its enforcement, the role of standards, and more. We also discuss transparency regulation for ESG issues and the role of accounting in bank regulation. For each topic, we will discuss the underlying theory, research design, econometric techniques, and data issues. We also discuss ideas for future research in various areas.

Spring 2026
Section: 30907-50
W 3:00 PM-6:30 PM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

For Booth PhD Students: No strict prereqs. Talk to instructor if unsure. For other Booth populations and Non-Booth students (including UChicago grad students): instructor permission required.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Below is a list of readings for the class. Please obtain published articles from the library via their e-journals website. Working papers are generally available on www.ssrn.com. Some working papers as well as other materials will be posted on Canvas. Please let me know if you have trouble finding a required readings or assigned materials. For working papers make sure you read the latest version.

GRADES

Your grade will be based on the following components:

Class participation (Presentation of papers and comments in class): 30%

Assignments (Referee reports and weekly write-ups): 40%

Research project: 30%

You cannot officially audit this class but interested students from areas other than accounting are welcome to sit in on the class if they do not need or want to take it for grade. Accounting Ph.D. students have to take the class for grade (unless they have taken it for grade before).

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 21 2026

ACCOUNTING FOR PRIVATE ENTITIES & NON-INVESTOR STAKEHOLDERS (30908) - [COSTELLO, ANNA>>](#) ; [MINNIS, MICHAEL>>](#)

CONTENT

The goal of this course is to provide an overview of accounting research in the area of unregulated entities and transactions. Specifically, the first half of the course will cover accounting choices and consequences by privately held firms. The second half of the course will cover the usefulness of accounting information for stakeholders of the firm that are not equity investors or lenders (non-investor stakeholders), with a focus on suppliers and customers as well as employees. The focus of the course will be to expose students to the existing literature in each of these areas, but we will also discuss the challenges of exploring unregulated transactions and entities, notably accessing data and settings. The course will also contrast the findings in the private-firm space to much larger body of work that uses public firms and investor transactions as a setting. Lastly, we will also discuss the appropriateness of different research designs and statistical methods in this space.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only: strict

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

One student will be asked to lead the discussion of each paper, providing a one-page summary to the class. Grades will be determined based on the quality of the student's contribution to class discussion, a referee report, and a final project (research proposal).

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 30908-50
TH 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

RESEARCH SEMINAR IN ACCOUNTING (30930, 50 UNIT COURSE) - MCCLURE, CHARLES>> ; STEWART, CHRISTOPHER>>

CONTENT

The main goal of the research-seminar class is to help Ph.D. students transition from course work to research. The seminar is intended to support this transition by developing students' research questions and papers. The course is meant to provide students feedback from multiple faculty so they can further develop research ideas into a high-quality dissertation. In the process, Ph.D. students also learn how to present ideas and give feedback to classmates.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 30930-50
W 10:00 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
50-Units: All Weeks
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 25 2025

RESEARCH SEMINAR IN ACCOUNTING (30931, 50 UNIT COURSE) - MCCLURE, CHARLES>> ; STEWART, CHRISTOPHER>>

CONTENT

The main goal of the research-seminar class is to help Ph.D. students transition from course work to research. The seminar is intended to support this transition by developing students' research questions and papers. The course is meant to provide students feedback from multiple faculty so they can further develop research ideas into a high-quality dissertation. In the process, Ph.D. students also learn how to present ideas and give feedback to classmates.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 30931-50
W 10:00 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
50-Units: All Weeks
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 30930: strict

RESTRICTIONS

SYLLABUS>>*Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025***INTERPERSONAL DYNAMICS (31401) - CARPENTER, CHRISTINE>>****CONTENT****31401-04 and 05 – Interpersonal Dynamics***Spring 2026* - Carpenter

In Interpersonal Dynamics, you will embark on a learning journey different from any you are likely to have experienced before. The class uses the well-established T-Group (or training group) method as originally developed at the National Training Lab over 70 years ago. Participating in a T-Group is not like attending a class in statistical methods or finance. Here you will engage in a form of experiential learning or learning by doing. While each class will begin with a brief lecture and one or two short exercises, the primary learning takes place in the T-Group. T-Group is an interactive, small group with no set agenda. The group dynamic and interactions between members dictate the agenda. The T-Group is composed of 12 students, the instructor and a co-facilitator, and will comprise the majority of each class period. In addition, there will be small-group meetings outside of the regular class time, including an intensive weekend experience.

The focus of this course is on enhancing interpersonal communication skills to foster more effective relationships. This leadership learning laboratory offers ample opportunity to test out assumptions, determine if you are having the impact you intend, and to practice giving/receiving feedback in a productive way. In the process of becoming the most effective communicator you can be, the course calls you to engage in deep and sometimes uncomfortable self-exploration. You may experience strong emotions which you are encouraged to express. You may want to consider current life stressors and struggles when deciding when or whether to apply. The extended goals of this course are:

- To use interpersonal communication skills to build more open, effective, and rewarding relationships, even with people whom you may initially experience as difficult or who are different from you.
- To identify and pursue personal learning goals aimed at improving interpersonal communications.
- To learn how you are perceived by your colleagues and how you can shift in order to present yourself such that others' perceptions more accurately reflect what you intend.
- To identify your emotions and how to utilize them as an important source of information and guide to your interpersonal choices.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 31401-04
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
225
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 31401-05
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
225
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 31401-04
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
225
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 31401-05
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
225
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 31401-04
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
225
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 31401-05
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
225

- To navigate the emotions of others and learn how to be more aware of and sensitive to them.

In-Person Only

- To identify the widely varied and equally valuable leadership roles that emerge in the life of a group.

Improving personal knowledge and abilities in these areas is crucial to becoming a more effective manager in today's increasingly complex, diverse, international and exceedingly inter-dependent business climate.

Commitment

Because of the highly interactive nature of this course, it is essential that all students make a commitment to the course from the beginning and attend all sessions. *Course shopping is actively discouraged. If you attend the first class and decide not to return, you have robbed another student of the opportunity to take the course, as we cannot backfill a spot after the first class meeting. Failure to attend the first class will result in an automatic drop.*

Scheduling Details

Attendance at each 3-hour class, as well as at a residential weekend intensive retreat (off-site), is required. Attendance at this retreat, in its entirety, is mandatory and non-negotiable. Several meetings with a small group of fellow students outside of class will also be required throughout the quarter.

Enrollment in the course is by application

[Apply online.](#) The application period opens on **Monday February 2, 2026 at 9:00am**. Applications are due by Sunday **February 8, 2026 at 11:59 pm**. You will be notified of your enrollment status no later than Monday **February 16, 2026 at 5:00 pm**. The more sections you indicate you can commit to, the better your chances of landing a spot. *But please do not include sections that you cannot completely commit to or that you would prefer not to attend. An invitation to a section is for that section only. There is no section swapping once you are offered a spot.*

Format and Course Materials

The format of the class will include discussion, experiential exercises, small-group support meetings outside of class, short lectures, T-Group and the retreat weekend. There is one required text for this class (see "Materials"), and links to all other course readings will be included in the syllabus.

Autumn 2023 Information Session

An in-person information session for this class may be offered but has yet to be scheduled. In the meantime, please use this link to view a previous session: [View recording of Spring 2020 Info Session.](#)

Spring Section Specifics

Weekly class:

- **Section 04:** Wednesdays 8:30 am - 11:30 am. All classes take place at Harper.
- **Section 05:** Wednesdays 1:30 am - 4:30 am. All classes take place at Harper.

Weekend Intensive Retreat: This is a mandatory, off-site retreat.

Transportation, meals and lodging are all provided. The Friday session begins at 6:45 pm (allow for travel time and dinner); Sunday session ends at 12:30 pm.

- **Section 04:** Friday, May 8 through Sunday, May 10.
- **Section 05:** Friday, May 15 through Sunday, May 17.

Small Group Meetings: Students will meet in small subgroups up to four times throughout the quarter. These meetings are to be scheduled at mutually agreeable times by the students.

PREREQUISITES

No non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students Application-based course

MATERIALS

[Connect: Building Exceptional Relationships with Family, Friends, and Colleagues](#)

by David Bradford, Carole Robin, et al.

GRADES

Grades will be based on weekly preparation, class participation, short written assignments, weekly journal submissions and a final paper. Interpersonal Dynamics cannot be taken pass/fail and the class cannot be audited.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades No auditors Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 10 2026

INTERPERSONAL DYNAMICS (31401) - [COLE, HUGH>>](#)

CONTENT

Interpersonal Dynamics 31401, Section 82 Spring Quarter 2026

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 31401-82

Professor Hugh Cole

Course Description

Content

In this class, you will embark on a learning journey different from any you are likely to have experienced before. The class uses the well-established T-Group (or training group) method as originally developed at the National Training Lab over 70 years ago. Participating in a T-Group is not like attending a class in statistical methods or finance. Here you will engage in a form of experiential learning or learning by doing. While each class will begin with a brief lecture and one or two short exercises, the primary learning takes place in the T-Group. T-Group is an interactive, small group with no set agenda. The group dynamic and interactions between members come together as a sort of co-created agenda. The T-Group is composed of 12 students, the instructor and a co-facilitator, and will comprise the majority of each class period. In addition, there will be T-group meetings outside of the regular class time, including an intensive weekend experience.

The main focus of this course is on enhancing interpersonal communication skills to foster more effective relationships. This leadership learning laboratory offers ample opportunity to test out assumptions, determine if you are having the impact you intend, and to practice giving/receiving feedback in a productive way. In the process of becoming the most effective communicator you can be, the course calls you to engage in deep and sometimes uncomfortable self-exploration. The extended goals of this course are:

- To use interpersonal communication skills to build more open, effective, and rewarding relationships, even with people whom you may initially experience as difficult or who are different from you.
- To identify and pursue personal learning goals aimed at improving interpersonal communications.
- To learn how you are perceived by your colleagues and how you can shift in order to present yourself such that others' perceptions more accurately reflect what you intend.
- To identify your emotions and how to utilize them as an important source of information and guide to your interpersonal choices.
- To navigate the emotions of others and learn how to be more aware of and sensitive to them.
- To identify the widely varied and equally valuable leadership roles that emerge in the life of a group.

Improving personal knowledge and abilities in these areas is crucial to becoming a more effective manager in today's increasingly complex, diverse, international and exceedingly inter-dependent business climate.

A Note About Connecting Via Zoom

Connecting virtually is something just about every single company on this planet is needing to do right now. For many international companies, virtual team meetings have been long practiced/required. Learning how to build and sustain relationships and giving/receiving productive feedback through a

T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
422
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 31401-82
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
422
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 31401-82
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
422
In-Person Only

virtual setting will increase the influence you can bring to the current or next company you are a part of. In this class, the virtual meeting option is reserved for reasons of medical necessity, and all class participants are required to attend all class sessions and all sections of the weekend retreat in person.

Commitment

Because of the highly interactive nature of this course, it is essential that all students make a commitment to the course from the beginning and attend all sessions. Course shopping is actively discouraged. Failure to attend the first class will result in an automatic drop.

Scheduling Details

Attendance at each 3-hour class and eighteen additional hours of T-Group (outside of the weekly class time) is required. Six to eight of these additional hours will take place in one-hour bi-weekly time blocks, usually on a different day of the week. These mandatory additional hours will be scheduled during lunch or dinner breaks so as not to conflict with other classes you may be committed to taking. Note, also, that an off-site weekend intensive consisting of 10-12 hours of T-Group will be held the weekend of May 8 - 10, 2026. Again, attendance at this intensive weekend is required. Details regarding the exact times for these additional T-Group meetings will be available to you prior to you applying to the course.

Enrollment in the course is by application

[Apply Online](#) The application period opens on Monday February 2 at 9am and will end on Monday February 9 at 9:00pm. To maximize your chances of enrolling in your preferred section, please make sure to submit your application by February 9 at 9:00pm. You will be notified with your enrollment status and potential offer by end of day on Wednesday February 16th and you will need to accept or decline that offer by 11:59pm on Sunday February 18. Please note: The more sections you indicate you could commit to, the better your chances in landing a spot.

Format and Course Materials

The format of the class will include short lectures, discussion, and experiential exercises in addition to T-Group. Links to all course readings will be included in the syllabus; there is one suggested textbook for this class: Bradford, David and Robin, Carole; Connect: Building Exceptional Relationships with Family, Friends, and Colleagues, First edition; Currency Publishing, New York, NY (2021).

Information Sessions

Please view the recording of the information session from Spring 2020 here:

[View recording of Spring 2020 Info Session.](#)

PREREQUISITES

No non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Application-based course

MATERIALS

One text:

Bradford, David and Robin, Carole; Connect: Building Exceptional Relationships with Family, Friends, and Colleagues,

First edition; Currency Publishing, New York, NY (2021).

Weekly articles and readings assigned via canvas throughout the quarter.

GRADES

Grades will be based on weekly preparation and class participation, short written assignments, weekly journal submissions and a final paper.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 06 2026

INTERPERSONAL DYNAMICS (31401) - [PURE, DARRYL>>](#)

CONTENT

In this class, you will embark on a learning journey different from any you are likely to have experienced before. The class uses the well-established T-Group (or training group) method as originally developed at the National Training Lab over 70 years ago. Participating in a T-Group is not like attending a class in statistical methods or finance. Here you will engage in a form of experiential learning or learning by doing. While each class will begin with a brief lecture and one or two short exercises, the primary learning takes place in the T-Group. T-Group is an interactive, small group with no set agenda. The group dynamic and interactions between members dictate the agenda. The T-Group is composed of 12 students, the instructor and a co-facilitator, and will comprise the majority of each class period. In addition, there will be T-group meetings outside of the regular class time, including an intensive weekend experience.

The main focus of this course is on enhancing interpersonal communication skills to foster more effective relationships. This leadership learning laboratory offers ample opportunity to test out assumptions, determine if you are having

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 31401-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
225
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 31401-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
219 - Meeting Room
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 31401-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center

the impact you intend, and to practice giving/receiving feedback in a productive way. In the process of becoming the most effective communicator you can be, the course calls you to engage in deep and sometimes uncomfortable self-exploration. The extended goals of this course are:

- To use interpersonal communication skills to build more open, effective, and rewarding relationships, even with people whom you may initially experience as difficult or who are different from you.
- To identify and pursue personal learning goals aimed at improving interpersonal communications.
- To learn how you are perceived by your colleagues and how you can shift in order to present yourself such that others' perceptions more accurately reflect what you intend.
- To identify your emotions and how to utilize them as an important source of information and guide to your interpersonal choices.
- To navigate the emotions of others and learn how to be more aware of and sensitive to them.
- To identify the widely varied and equally valuable leadership roles that emerge in the life of a group.

Improving personal knowledge and abilities in these areas is crucial to becoming a more effective manager in today's increasingly complex, diverse, international and exceedingly inter-dependent business climate.

Commitment

Because of the highly interactive nature of this course, it is essential that all students make a commitment to the course from the beginning and attend all sessions. Course shopping is actively discouraged. Failure to attend the first class will result in an automatic drop.

Scheduling Details

Attendance at each 3-hour class and eighteen additional hours of T-Group (outside of the weekly class time) is required. It is our hope that these additional hours will take place over an intensive weekend held in-residence at a conference center. If in person, the weekend intensive will be held on the weekend of **May 1-3 (Section 01) or May 8-10 (Section 02)** (depending on your section).

Again, attendance at this intensive weekend in its entirety is required. Details regarding the exact times for these additional T-Group meetings will be available to you prior to you applying to the course.

Enrollment in the course is by application

Apply Online Applications close on Monday, February 9 at 9:00pm. You will be notified of your enrollment status no later than EOD February 16. The more sections you indicate you could commit to, the better your chances in landing a spot. When applying, please note that successful applications usually show a fair amount of self-reflection and vulnerability. It helps to show that you have already started an introspective process and feel ready to learn even more about yourself. While this course focuses on "soft" skills, it is definitely not an easy class and requires substantial personal and academic investment. You may want to take your current life stressors and struggles into consideration when deciding when or whether to apply.

225

In-Person Only

Winter 2026

Section: 31401-02

T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM

Harper Center

225

In-Person Only

Spring 2026

Section: 31401-01

T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM

Harper Center

225

In-Person Only

Spring 2026

Section: 31401-02

T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM

Harper Center

225

In-Person Only

Format and Course Materials

The format of the class will include discussion, experiential exercises, and short lectures, in addition to T-Group. Links to all course readings will be included in the syllabus; there is a recommend text you will find useful for this class [Connect: Building Exceptional Relationships with Family, Friends, and Colleagues](#). Bradford, D. and Robin, C. Currency Publishing 2021

Spring 2022 Information Session

[View recording of Spring 2022 Info Session](#)

Spring 2026 Section Specifics

All times are CT

Monday mornings 8:30-11:30. Section 01 May 1-3 Retreat Weekend

Monday afternoons 1:30-4:30 Section 02 May 8-10 Retreat Weekend

Sections are NOT interchangeable; you may only attend the section you are offered

PREREQUISITES

No non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Application-based course

MATERIALS

[Connect: Building Exceptional Relationships with Family, Friends, and Colleagues](#). Bradford, D. and Robin, C. Currency Publishing 2021

GRADES

Grades will be based on weekly preparation and class participation, short written assignments, weekly journal submissions and a final paper. Interpersonal Dynamics cannot be taken pass/fail, nor can the class be audited.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 09 2026

INTERPERSONAL DYNAMICS (31401) - RAPHLING, BRITT>>

CONTENT

Interpersonal Dynamics (31401-03) will be offered as an IN-PERSON class this Spring Quarter 2026, meeting at BL455, Room 140 (NBC Tower) Wednesdays 2-5 p.m.

Interpersonal Dynamics (31401-81) will be offered as a REMOTE class this Spring Quarter 2026 on Thursdays, 6 – 9 p.m. (selected classes 5:30-9:30 p.m.).

In this class, you will embark on a learning journey different from any you are likely to have experienced before. The class uses the well-established T-Group (or training group) method as originally developed at the National Training Lab over 70 years ago. Participating in a T-Group is not like attending a class in statistical methods or finance. Here you will engage in a form of experiential learning or learning by doing. While each class begins with a brief lecture and one or two short exercises, the primary learning takes place in the T-Group. T-Group is an interactive, small group with no set agenda beyond what the group dynamic, choices, and interactions between members dictate. The T-Group is composed of 12 students plus the instructor and a co-facilitator and will comprise most of each class period. In addition, there will be T-group meetings outside of the regular class time, including an intensive weekend experience.

If you are interested in Section 81 (Remote) you should know that Interpersonal Dynamics has been taught successfully using a virtual platform since 2020, as the era of remote meetings and learning has developed for academia and business. Even pre-pandemic, virtual meetings have been an increasingly important means of conducting business, especially internationally. Learning how to build and sustain relationships and how to give and receive feedback in a virtual setting will increase the influence you can bring to your current company and/or companies you will work for in the future.

The focus of this course is on enhancing interpersonal communication skills to foster more effective relationships. This leadership learning laboratory offers ample opportunity to test out assumptions, determine if you are having the impact you intend, and to practice giving and receiving feedback in a productive way. In the process of becoming the most effective communicator you can be, the course calls upon you to engage in deep and sometimes uncomfortable self-exploration. The extended goals of this course are:

- To learn to use interpersonal communication skills to build more open,

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 31401-03
W 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Booth 455
140
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 31401-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Winter 2026
Section: 31401-03
W 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Booth 455
140
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 31401-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Spring 2026
Section: 31401-03
W 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Booth 455
140
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 31401-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM

effective, and rewarding relationships, even with people whom you may initially experience as difficult or who are different from you.

Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

- To identify and pursue personal learning goals aimed at improving interpersonal communications.
- To learn how you are perceived by your colleagues and how you can shift in order to present yourself such that others' perceptions more accurately reflect what you intend.
- To identify your emotions and utilize them as an important source of information and guide to your interpersonal choices.
- To navigate the emotions of others and learn how to be more aware of and sensitive to them.
- To be aware of the varied and valuable leadership roles that emerge in the life of a group, and to articulate your own personal leadership style within the context of a group.

Improving personal knowledge and abilities in these areas is crucial to becoming a more effective leader in today's increasingly complex, diverse, international and exceedingly interdependent business climate.

Commitment

Because of the highly interactive nature of this course, it is essential that all students make a commitment to the course from the beginning and attend all sessions. While this class focuses on "soft" skills, it is not an easy class and requires personal and academic rigor. Please take current life stressors and struggles into consideration as you decide when or whether to apply. You're welcome to reach out to me if you'd like to discuss this or have questions about whether it is good for you to apply at this time.

Course shopping is actively discouraged. Failure to attend the first class will result in an automatic drop.

Scheduling Details

Section 03 IN-PERSON Schedule

Weekly class: Wednesdays 2:00-5:00 p.m. at BL455 (NBC Tower), Room 140. Attendance at each weekly class is required.

Weekend Intensive Retreat off site at the Q Center in St. Charles IL, May 1-3. Friday session begins at 6:45 pm (allow for travel time, which means a Friday early-afternoon departure from Chicago); Sunday session ends at 12:30 pm. Attendance at this retreat, in its entirety, is mandatory and non-negotiable, including remaining at the retreat center for the weekend (*i.e.*, no commuting back and forth between T-group sessions or overnight).

Small group meetings with fellow students throughout the quarter (up to four), scheduled at mutually agreeable times by the students.

Section 81 REMOTE Schedule

Weekly class on Zoom: Thursdays 6:00 - 9:00 p.m., with extended hours of 5:30 - 9:30 p.m. on March 26; April 9 and 23; and May 14 and 21. Attendance at each weekly class is required.

Weekend Intensive Retreat on Zoom, May 8-10. Friday session runs 6:00 - 9:00 p.m.; Saturday sessions 9:00 a.m. - 12:00 p.m. and 2:00 p.m. - 5:00 p.m.;

Sunday session 9:00 a.m. – 12:00 p.m. Attendance at this retreat, in its entirety, is mandatory and non-negotiable.

Small group meetings with fellow students throughout the quarter (up to four), scheduled at mutually agreeable times by the students, including one meeting during the Weekend Retreat to be held between Saturday's morning and afternoon sessions.

Enrollment in the course is by application

Apply online. The application period opens on **Monday, February 2 at 9 a.m.** and closes **Monday February 9 at 9:00 p.m.** You will be notified of your enrollment status no later than **NOON Monday February 16.** The more sections you indicate you can commit to, the better your chances are at landing a spot. **Please only apply to sections you can commit to in terms of the required schedule.** While we have increased the number of sections of this course each year, the number of applicants for this class continues to far exceed the number of openings we have for students.

Format and Course Materials

The format of the class will include discussion, experiential exercises, small-group support meetings outside of class, and short lectures, in addition to T-Group and the weekend retreat. There is one recommended text for this class (see "Materials"), and links to all other course materials will be included in the syllabus.

Information Session

View recording of [2020 Info Session](#) for an overview of the Interpersonal Dynamics course.

PREREQUISITES

No Non-Booth Students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Application-based course

MATERIALS

Recommended text "Connect: Building Exceptional Relationships with Family, Friends, and Colleagues" by David Bradford, Ph.D. and Carole Robin, Ph.D.

GRADES

Grades will be based on weekly preparation and class participation, short written assignments, weekly journal submissions and a final paper. Interpersonal Dynamics cannot be taken pass/fail, nor can the class be audited.

RESTRICTIONS

SYLLABUS>>*Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 06 2026***INTERPERSONAL DYNAMICS (31401) - STEFANAC, LISA>>****CONTENT**

In this class, you will embark on a learning journey different from any you are likely to have experienced before. The class uses the well-established T-Group (or training group) method as originally developed at the National Training Lab over 70 years ago. Participating in a T-Group is not like attending a class in statistical methods or finance. Here you will engage in a form of experiential learning or learning by doing. While each class will begin with a brief lecture and one or two short exercises, the primary learning takes place in the T-Group. T-Group is an interactive, small group with no set agenda. The group dynamic and interactions between members dictate the agenda. The T-Group is composed of 12 students, the instructor and a co-facilitator, and will comprise the majority of each class period. In addition, there will be T-group meetings outside of the regular class time, including an intensive weekend experience.

The main focus of this course is on enhancing interpersonal communication skills to foster more effective relationships. This leadership learning laboratory offers ample opportunity to test out assumptions, determine if you are having the impact you intend, and to practice giving/receiving feedback in a productive way. In the process of becoming the most effective communicator you can be, the course calls you to engage in deep and sometimes uncomfortable self-exploration. The extended goals of this course are:

- To use interpersonal communication skills to build more open, effective, and rewarding relationships, even with people whom you may initially experience as difficult or who are different from you.
- To identify and pursue personal learning goals aimed at improving interpersonal communications.
- To learn how you are perceived by your colleagues and how you can shift in order to present yourself such that others' perceptions more accurately reflect what you intend.
- To identify your emotions and how to utilize them as an important source of information and guide to your interpersonal choices.
- To navigate the emotions of others and learn how to be more aware of and sensitive to them.
- To identify the widely varied and equally valuable leadership roles that emerge in the life of a group.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 31401-06
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
225
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 31401-06
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
225
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 31401-83
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
422
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 31401-06
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
225
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 31401-83
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
422
In-Person Only

- Improving personal knowledge and abilities in these areas is crucial to becoming a more effective manager in today's increasingly complex, diverse, international and exceedingly inter-dependent business climate.

A Note About Connecting Via Zoom

31401-06 will be in person this quarter. If this is not possible due to unforeseen reason, we will shift to virtual using Zoom. Connecting virtually is something just about every company is needing to do right now. For many international companies, virtual team meetings have been long practiced/required. Learning how to build and sustain relationships and giving/receiving productive feedback through a virtual setting will increase the influence you can bring to the current or next company you are a part of.

Commitment

Because of the highly interactive nature of this course, it is essential that all students make a commitment to the course from the beginning and attend all sessions. Course shopping is actively discouraged. Failure to attend the first class will result in an automatic drop.

Scheduling Details

Attendance at each 3-hour class and up to eighteen additional hours of T-Group (outside of the weekly class time, during a T-Group Intensive Weekend - see further below) is required.

Enrollment in the course is by application

[Apply online.](#) You will be notified of your enrollment status on February 16th before bidding begins. The more sections you indicate you could commit to, the better your chances in landing a spot. When applying, please note that successful applications usually show a fair amount of self-reflection and vulnerability. It helps to show that you have already started an introspective process and feel ready to learn even more about yourself.

Please note: You may want to consider current life stressors and struggles when deciding when or whether to apply.

Format and Course Materials

The format of the class will include discussion, experiential exercises, and short lectures, in addition to T-Group. Links to all course readings will be included in the syllabus; there is no textbook for this class.

Spring 2021 Information Session

[View recording of Spring 2021 Info Session](#)

Spring 2026 Section Specifics

(All times are in CT)

31401-06: Monday afternoons in Harper Center (HC225): 1:30 - 4:30 PM

31401-83: Monday evenings in Gleacher (GL422): 6:00 - 9:00 PM

Interpersonal Dynamics sections are NOT interchangeable; you may only attend the section you are offered

In-person Weekend Intensive for 31401-06 section (Mondays 1:30 - 4:30 PM)

May 8: 6:45-9:30pm

May 9: 9:00am-12:00pm; 1:30-4:30pm; 7-9:30pm

May 10: 9:00am-12:30pm

In-person Weekend Intensive for 31401-83 section (Mondays 6:00 - 9:00 PM)

May 1: 6:45-9:30pm

May 2: 9:00am-12:00pm; 1:30-4:30pm; 7-9:30pm

May 3: 9:00am-12:30pm

PREREQUISITES

No non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

Grades will be based on weekly preparation and class participation, short written assignments, weekly journal submissions and a final paper. Interpersonal Dynamics cannot be taken pass/fail, nor can the class be audited.

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 11 2026

LEADERSHIP STUDIO (31403) - [DAVIS, HARRY>>](#) ; [TENNANT, NANCY>>](#)

CONTENT

The Leadership Studio is designed around four guiding principles that we ask those who enroll to embrace and make them their own. Simply stated:

1. ***I am agile.*** My current leadership abilities do not define or limit me. I can play very different roles as needed and display different leadership qualities at the right time with the right audience.
2. ***I am my best when I play my roles as my authentic-self.*** I can experiment and adopt new leadership qualities that are rooted in my personal values.
3. ***I am self-driven.*** I take personal responsibility for doing the work and expanding my leadership qualities.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 31403-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
219 - Meeting Room
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 31403-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Booth 455
140
In-Person Only

4. *I will continue work on my leadership behaviors into the future.* I put in place good habits for ongoing development/learning following the work started in The Leadership Studio.

During the Studio, each student builds upon their current leadership strengths and learns how to harness many more of their leadership qualities and abilities. They gain greater confidence in their ability to have the impact they desire and to continue growing and evolving as they face new demands as leaders. To this end, the Leadership Studio explores leadership from nine perspectives. These provide valuable inputs for a leadership journey that is truly actionable and lasting.

This work is accomplished through a learning environment built upon three interwoven tracks:

- Exposure to research and new knowledge in a Classroom track
- Applying knowledge and leadership goals in a Rehearsal Hall track
- Experiments with enhancing leadership skills in a Fieldwork track.

The class is not recorded to keep it as a safe place for experimenting and sharing. Students must attend in person: there is no Zoom participation allowance. Because of the high participation requirement of the class, students are required to put away laptops, tablets, and smart phones for all Rehearsal Hall sessions.

We have assembled a teaching ensemble drawn from different areas of expertise that will remain involved in supporting students throughout the quarter. This team consists of academics, practitioners from the worlds of business, music, theater and improv, as well as coaches who bring a disciplined, scientific methodology to ongoing practice.

Attention! This is not a class in which faculty and students play traditional, well-defined roles. They will instead be co-creating the experience. Students should sign up for the Studio if they are committed to their own personal development with learning tailored to each person.

Four comments from students who have completed the course may be instructive:

"The Studio will teach you two things, which can have a lasting impact in your life: a) A framework for self improvement based on trying new things, collecting data and reflecting; and b) The notion that you can be flexible on the personal qualities you will draw on for each situation."

"This is a class that goes beyond business. It impacts every aspect of life. It is an essential course to take to be an effective leader and learn how to become one."

"It is what you put into it. This can be a profound experience for some, and useless for others who do not take it seriously."

"Unlike any Booth class I've taken, you must be ready to be fully present and ready to make a real change in your behavior."

Given the experiential nature of the Leadership Studio, please view a [recording of the information session](#) held Friday, February 13 at 12:00pm CST to provide more insights into the Studio experience. You will hear from a former student along with three members of the teaching and coaching team.

Spring 2026
Section: 31403-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
219 - Meeting Room
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 31403-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Booth 455
140
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

LEAD (31001)

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Assigned articles, book chapters, and online tutorial, from diverse disciplines including Business, Government, Theater/Improv, Psychology, Leadership, and Science.

GRADES

Note: Class attendance is very important given the design of this learning experience. Attendance at the first class is mandatory. The Studio focuses on a student's behavior in translating conceptual knowledge into action. Given the experiential nature of the Studio, considerable weight will be placed on work in the rehearsal hall and in their personal field work. There are no exams. Students will prepare several written reflection papers based on their experiences in the Rehearsal Hall and in the field.

- Overall Class & Rehearsal Hall Engagement: 16%
- Fieldwork: 36%
- Written Assignments: 38%
- Final Performance: 10%

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades Mandatory attendance week 1 No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 18 2026

LEADERSHIP LAB (31404) - [COLLINS, CHRIS>>](#)

CONTENT

As a leader there are few things more vital to your success and fulfillment than the ability to grow as you encounter new challenges or become aware of outdated patterns of behaviors.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 31404-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
219 - Meeting Room

The principal goal of this course is to learn how to guide your own development and make personal change. This ability is a form of self-leadership and is one of the foundations of a rewarding career and a meaningful life. The benefits of this class are twofold.

The first benefit is that you will define and make progress on a personal development goal of your choosing.

Most of us harbor a list of things we would like to work on and change about ourselves. We often carry these desires for years without making much progress. This class creates a space in which you can finally realize your desires for growth and change. A sample of development goals Booth students' have identified includes:

- Leaning into disagreements and conflict with others rather than avoiding
- Developing a stronger, more self-assured interpersonal presence
- Reworking interpersonal habits that derail interactions with others
- Developing habits and skills that enable more easily and comfortably connecting with others
- Managing one's reactions and frustrations that get in the way of working effectively with others

The second benefit is that you will learn a set of ideas and tactics for guiding your development in the future.

As you work on your own development goal, you will apply approaches introduced in class. These approaches are designed to help you make progress on their current development goals; and, these same approaches are portable so that you can also apply them to future development goals, long after the course is over. Some of the approaches covered in class include:

- Taking stock of your most pressing development needs
- Engaging your thoughts, emotions, and behaviors to create actionable development goals
- Reworking ineffective patterns of behavior
- Dealing with your own resistance to making desired change
- Initiating and sustaining action over time to make progress

It is important to note that Leadership Lab requires a deeper level of engagement than many classes.

Broadly speaking, the focus of the course concerns human development and introduces a valuable set of ideas on this topic. Yet, the heart of the class concerns the ways in which you apply these ideas to yourself. The class consists of activities, assignments, and interactions that involve analyzing your desires for yourself, better understanding what others need from you, learning to work with your own thoughts and emotions, generating meaningful goals for yourself, on-going effort to make desired changes, and supporting your fellow classmates as they engage in the same kind of work. The personal nature of the work we do in this class relies on a willingness to try difficult things, to be vulnerable, and to take responsibility for your own development.

Curriculum Video

[View video](#) for more details about the course. Note: CNet credentials required to view.

Enrollment in the course is by application

[Apply online here](#). The application period open is now open. Please submit your application by end of day on Sunday, February 19. You will be notified of your enrollment status on Tuesday, February 21st.

In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 31404-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
219 - Meeting Room
In-Person Only

Format

The format of the class will include in-class discussion, experiential exercises, and short lectures. One of the most important parts of class are the assignments in between classes which involve experimenting with new behaviors in ways that may feel unfamiliar and/or challenging. Both are considered essential parts of the class experience.

PREREQUISITES

No undergraduates. Cannot enroll in 31404 if 31407 taken previously: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

GRADES

Grades will be based on weekly preparation, class participation, performance on weekly assignments, and two papers. No pass/fail allowed and the class cannot be audited.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 06 2026

LEADING WITH AUTHENTICITY (31405) - [COLEMAN, SAMANTHA>>](#)

CONTENT

Today's most effective leaders are not just competent—they are **congruent**.

Leading with Authenticity is an applied leadership development course for students who want to align who they are with how they lead—without sacrificing credibility, coherence, or performance. Designed for complex, high-stakes environments, the course integrates personal values, social identity, and behavioral data into a disciplined and strategic leadership decision framework.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 31405-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
219 - Meeting Room
In-Person Only

Drawing on behavioral science, values-based assessments (**Hogan MVPI**), and experiential learning, students learn to **ALIGN** before they lead:

New Course

- **A — Assess:** Examine values, motives, identity data, and behavioral drivers.
- **L — Locate:** Identify the structural dynamics, incentives, risks, and performance expectations shaping the moment.
- **I — Interrogate::** Surface mental models, defaults, blind spots, and assumptions.
- **G — Generate Signal:** Determine what leadership stance to take, what to disclose or withhold, and how to act in alignment with both identity and context.
- **N — Navigate:** Make a deliberate leadership choice informed by both identity and context.

Through **professionally led table coaching, structured feedback, and narrative-based reflection (including podcast-based assignments)**, students translate self-insight into disciplined action—emphasizing decision-making and execution in environments shaped by competing expectations and real-world constraint.

By the end of the course, students produce an ALIGN Strategy Portfolio—a cohesive body of work integrating leadership identity, peer feedback, contextual analysis, and a structured 90-day implementation plan designed for immediate application in their workplace, internships, entrepreneurial ventures, or professional transitions.

PREREQUISITES

No undergraduates allowed. Graduate students from other divisions can enroll during Non-Booth registration period.

GRADES

Final grades are based on demonstrated engagement, applied learning, and the quality of cumulative work rather than on frequent low-stakes submissions.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 20 2026

LEADERSHIP LAB: BUILDING YOUR INFLUENCE SKILLS (31407) - **COLLINS, CHRIS>>**

CONTENT

The principal goal of this course is to build new abilities for more effectively influencing people, situations, and outcomes.

Students finish class (a) having completed a portfolio of work for building new abilities for exercising influence, (b) with an agenda for the development goals they will take up going forward, and (c) with a toolkit for managing their own learning and development in the future.

Leadership concerns creating meaningful change. The work of this class concerns self-leadership, or the practice of creating meaningful change in yourself and your abilities.

We begin the course by clarifying the meaning of leadership and the core capabilities for exercising influence. Students then explore and practice a set of these abilities over the duration of the class.

Developing skill and finesse with new abilities requires time and dedication. To facilitate more focused skill development work, students are invited to focus on three abilities, one of which students themselves create. A sample of past student projects includes:

- Leaning in to disagreements rather than avoiding them
- Advocating more effectively for one's point of view and needs
- Reworking interpersonal habits that derail interactions with others
- Building interpersonal practices to generate greater informal authority
- Establishing and maintaining boundaries necessary for productive work relationships
- More effectively using one's voice in a variety of situations

Throughout the course, students also learn a set of tactics for developing new abilities. These tactics are a toolkit that can be used long after the class has ended. Some of the approaches covered in class include:

- Taking stock of your most pressing development needs
- Engaging thoughts, emotions, and behaviors to create development goals
- Focusing and narrowing development goals so that they are actionable
- Reworking ineffective patterns of behavior
- Dealing with your own resistance to making desired change
- Initiating and sustaining action over time to make progress

It is important to note this class requires a more personal form of engagement than many classes.

The class requires students to take themselves as an object of study as they apply concepts and practices to their own conduct. The class consists of activities, assignments, and interactions that involve analyzing your core drivers, better understanding what others need from you, learning to work with your own thoughts and emotions, generating meaningful goals for yourself, on-going effort to make desired changes, and supporting your fellow classmates as they engage in the same kind of work. The personal nature of the work we do in this class relies on a willingness to try difficult things, to be vulnerable, and to take responsibility for your own development.

Format

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 31407-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only
New Course

The format of the class will include in-class discussion, experiential exercises, and short lectures. One of the most important parts of class are the assignments in between classes which involve experimenting with new behaviors in ways that may feel unfamiliar and/or challenging. Both are considered essential parts of the class experience.

PREREQUISITES

No undergraduates. Cannot enroll in 31407 if 31404 was previously taken: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

Grades will be based on weekly preparation, class participation, and performance on weekly assignments. No pass/fail allowed and the class cannot be audited.

- Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)
- Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 21 2026

REAL ESTATE AND EQUITY: LEVELING THE PLAYING FIELD (31425) - VALERY, ERNST>>

CONTENT

Real estate development and the title “developer” have long been contentious terms, synonymous with networks of wealth and influence. Developers have no required course of study, no exam to enter the field, no oath to uphold and no continuing education. Our built environment is reflective of those who developed it: racially monolithic, affluent, and male-dominated. This fosters a lack of equity and the widening wealth gap in America's most vulnerable neighborhoods.

Aided by current social, political and economic constructs, developers contribute to gentrification through large investments that build structures,

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 31425-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

not opportunity. The result is generations of residents being displaced rapidly - the same residents that contributed to the culture and economic success that makes development in a location so appealing.

This course involves an in-depth exploration and analyses of the above conditions and how we can work to develop a new reality in real estate development, one that does not displace people and values diversity and inclusion in order to create healthy communities. To start, to develop without displacement sufficient housing must be available for existing residents. One possible solution, and the one that is the focus of this class, is to assemble adjacent parcels so that new taller and denser development can be constructed. Admittedly not without its own controversies, this scenario envisions new residential units designed to meet the needs of existing residents and owners, as well as providing additional workforce housing and adding market-rate renters. Existing landowners can enter their properties into long-term leases with the developer ensuring a continual income stream while retaining ownership of the property. In addition to housing options, these developments offer ground floor retail that provide amenities for residents and contribute to neighborhood vibrancy and diversity. An influx of population can support new retail and increase available jobs. In this way development can be a catalyst that benefits all members of the neighborhood.

Inner-city neighborhoods have become increasingly desirable to developers and to a range of new urban residents. In order to make the resulting development work for everyone, creative strategies must be developed that minimize displacement and that share benefits. Inner city revitalization is challenging, but through intentional strategic development and planning, members of marginalized communities can gain access to resources to join the ranks of start-up developers and take leadership roles in the process.

MATERIALS

Required books:

1. *The Solution Revolution*, William D. Eggers and Paul Macmillan, Harvard Business Review Press, 2013.
2. *The Designing for Growth Field Book: A Step-by-Step Project Guide*, Columbia Business School Press, 2014.

Recommended book:

1. *The Well-Tempered City: What Modern Science, Ancient Civilizations, and Nature Teach Us About the Future of Urban Life*, Jonathan F.P. Rose, Harper Wave, 2016.

(This book can be used as a reference this quarter, providing background on challenges of cities. Required readings from the book are available on Canvas. Optional readings from the book are not on Canvas.)

Additional materials will be posted on Canvas.

GRADES

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-----|
| ■ Class Participation/ Book report | 20% |
| ■ Reconstructed Proforma | 10% |
| ■ Development Package/ Presentation | 40% |
| ■ Peer Evaluation | 10% |

■ Final Paper	20%
TOTAL100%	

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 15 2025

DATA ANALYSIS WITH PYTHON AND SQL (32120) - KATTAN, LARA>>

CONTENT

TL;DR:

- This course requires/expects no background in coding. However, those with a coding background are welcome and can scale up the difficulty of all assignments
- You'll learn to use ChatGPT and similar tools to write code
- You'll be writing code yourself every week, in class and on homework
- You can use ChatGPT on homework and on the exams
- Midterm exam will be take-home. Final exam will be a project with an in-class presentation in week 10 (finals week)

Let's get this out of the way: A lot of code today is written by ChatGPT. This isn't a bad thing per se, and it can be a useful adjunct. But ChatGPT is not error-free, so knowing something about coding is still important. In this course, you'll learn enough computer science, statistics, data analysis, and, yes, generative AI to do data analysis at your job.

We'll use two of the most popular programming languages today, Python and SQL. No prior experience in coding or data analytics is required. If you have any Python background, let me know and we'll work on finding more challenging practice problems.

You will be writing code every single week. If that scares you a little, that's ok, that's what the instructor and TAs are here to help with! We will carry out analytics, including data cleaning, computing summary statistics, basic visualizations and basic linear regression. No math or statistics background is required, we'll learn everything we need.

This course could be taken as a preparation for Business Statistics (41000), Applied Regression (41100), and Advanced Decision Models with Python (36109). Understanding how to work with data will also be helpful in other coursework even if programming is not required, such as Healthcare Data Analytics (40205).

Learning Outcomes:

1. Write basic code in Python and SQL to carry out fundamental data analysis tasks like data import, data cleaning, and data visualization
2. Prompt ChatGPT and similar genAI tools to optimize your coding workflow

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 32120-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 32120-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 32120-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 32120-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 32120-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 32120-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center

3. Define data analytics fundamentals to enable you to talk intelligently with programmers and analysts on your team

306
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

None.

MATERIALS

Required textbook:

- *The Data Science Design Manual* by Steven Skiena. You can buy a hardcopy if you'd prefer, but you can get a FREE PDF through the UChicago library ([link](#))

Other non-required resources (no guarantee that these will line up in any way with the material we cover in class, but can be useful for those interested in growing in their Python and SQL):

- [Python for Data Analysis](#) by William McKinney
- [Automate the Boring Stuff with Python](#) (2nd edition) by Al Sweigart
- [Learn Python the Hard Way](#) by Zed Shaw
- [W3 Schools SQL tutorials](#)
- [Four-hour video introduction to SQL from freeCodeCamp](#)

GRADES

- Homework - 10%
 - Homework will be assigned every week for total of 7 assignments
 - I'll automatically drop your lowest HW grade at the end of the quarter.
- Midterm (take-home, group work) - 20%
- Final (project with in-class presentation in week 10) - 50%
- Participation/attendance - 20%
 - Attendance will be self-reported through Poll Everywhere

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 16 2026

DATA VISUALIZATION FOR DECISION-MAKING (32130) - KATTAN, LARA>>

CONTENT

Hate reading?! [Watch this lil pitch video instead.](#)

TL;DR (updated 2/20/2026):

- Learn how to turn outputs of data analysis (boring) into compelling data stories (cool and shiny)
- Class will be a bit artsy, a bit technical
- Tools will be Tableau (80%), Figma and Inkscape for vector drawing (10%), and Python (10%), with optional SQL connection to Tableau
- No programming knowledge required, although you may need to work a little harder or review more material outside of class
- Data analysis experience (e.g. BUS 32120) is recommended, but there are no strict prereqs
- Grade will be mostly a project with an in-class final presentation (can be individual or group)
- You'll walk away with the skills to create publication-ready, professional dashboards in Tableau and static viz in Figma/Inkscape

The world has become obsessed with data, and for good reason. Effective data analysis can give you valuable insights and lead to improved business and policy decisions. You can, and should, study data analysis (and there's many courses for you to choose from right here at Booth!). But data analysis shouldn't end with the analysis. In this course, we'll learn how to take the tables of numbers that are often seen as the output of data analysis and transform them into tools of decision-making and communication. We'll learn how to extract stories from our data and to use those visualizations to aid decision-making and persuasion.

Our tools will be Tableau, Python, and a little bit of "fancy" Excel. We'll use GenAI tools like ChatGPT to explore our creativity. Beyond making one-off scatter plots and histograms, we'll learn what it means to tell a story through data. We'll also learn how to identify our target audience, peer into their eyes and brain to see how they process information, and how to use this insight to craft persuasive and compelling visual artifacts.

Think of this course as a blend of statistics, psychology, neurobiology, graphic design, and communication.

Data visualization is about more than picking pretty colors for your charts (though that's also important!), but it's about finding visual ways to represent information coded in your data that wouldn't be intelligible to your audience otherwise.

Consider the table of per capita incomes in the syllabus. Scrolling through dozens of rows of data can never give you the information that a map can code about the spatial distribution of incomes in a city. Adding spatial and/or temporal elements to your data, through the use of maps and dynamic dashboards in Tableau, can be the difference between data that sits on the page and data that moves your audience to action.

How are customers reacting to your ad spend, and can you make changes to

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 32130-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
200
In-Person Only

your allocations more quickly to take advantage of fluctuating trends in real time? What's driving customer churn, and what interventions are working right now? Is your bank being targeted by bad actors in a coordinated fraud scheme? How is your portfolio performing in real-time in relation to your risk metrics? Are your manufacturing processes on track, or are cost overruns and production delays imminent? Data visualization can improve your answers to all of these questions.

PREREQUISITES

There are no strict prerequisites, but there are recommendations. Anyone willing to practice and ask questions can be successful in the course.

Prior data analysis and coding experience, such as that obtained through BUS 32120 (Data Analysis with Python and SQL), will be extremely helpful. We'll cover the basics of data analysis and data cleaning in Excel and Tableau as a means to the end of data visualization, but prior exposure will be useful.

GRADES

- Homework and exercises (individual) - 20%
- Project proposal due in week 6 (group or individual) - 30%
- Final group project and presentation (group or individual) - 50%

There will be no midterm. You'll start working on a proposal for your final project in week 4. A proposal will be due in week 6. You'll have some in-class time to work on the project in week 8. Final presentations will be during the scheduled final exam time.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 20 2026

GENERATIVE THINKING (32210) - [MISRA, SANJOG>>](#)

CONTENT

Generative AI is a pivotal advancement in the realm of artificial intelligence that has the potential to transform various industries, from entertainment and

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 32210-01

advertising to healthcare and education. A thorough understanding of Generative technologies, potential uses cases and the implications are going to be necessary conditions of success. This new technology can automate content creation, optimize processes, and personalize experiences but more broadly it has the capacity to synthesize new data, simulate scenarios, generate ideas, and even design novel solutions to complex problems., making it a crucial technology for managers across all domains.

This course provides a comprehensive overview of Generative AI, covering its foundational technologies, practical applications, and broader societal implications. It aims to equip students with a solid understanding of Generative AI and its relevance to various fields, as well as cultivate critical thinking on the ethical, legal, and societal challenges related to its deployment.

Each class will have a lecture and discussion portion as well as some practicum/exercise/demo portion. In addition, there will be a course projects where you will work on the development of a Generative AI solution.

PREREQUISITES

No programming expertise will be required or assumed. Cannot take if 43100 or 43800 taken previously: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Readings for this course will be provided by the instructor and will be a combination of academic papers and online content. Where and when possible, the class will also have guest speakers.

GRADES

Evaluation will be based on class participation (20%), homework (40%) and the final project (40%).

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 15 2026

MICROECONOMICS (33001) - [CAMPOS, CHRISTOPHER>>](#)

CONTENT

This course teaches the core principles of modern microeconomics and illustrates their application to understanding business decisions and the

W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33001-01

broader world. The course covers the following topics: supply and demand; consumer choice; firm behavior, including pricing and production under different market structures; and the effects of uncertainty.

PREREQUISITES

Understanding of algebra and basic calculus (derivatives).

MATERIALS

Canvas site includes lecture slides and problem sets.

GRADES

Based on problem sets, a midterm, and a comprehensive final exam.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 14 2025

M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33001-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33001-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

MICROECONOMICS (33001) - [DIZON-ROSS, REBECCA>>](#)

CONTENT

This course teaches the basic principles of modern microeconomics and illustrates their application to business decisions. The course will cover the following topics: supply and demand; consumer choice; firm behavior, including pricing and production, under different market structures; and the effects of uncertainty and incomplete information on firm and consumer behavior.

PREREQUISITES

Students should have a solid understanding of algebra and basic calculus, including the ability to analyze and understand derivatives.

MATERIALS

Optional textbook: *Microeconomics* by Goolsbee, Levitt, and Syverson.

GRADES

Based on problem sets, a midterm exam, and a final exam.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-03
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-04
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-05
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

MICROECONOMICS (33001) - [FRANKEL, ALEXANDER>>](#)

CONTENT

This course introduces the principles of modern microeconomics and illustrates their application to business decisions. The course covers the following topics: supply and demand; the determinants of consumer choice; the pricing and output decisions of firms under different market structures; and the effects of incomplete information, uncertainty, and moral hazard on economic behavior.

PREREQUISITES

Understanding of algebra and basic calculus, including derivatives.

MATERIALS

Optional text: Goolsbee, Levitt, & Syverson, *Microeconomics*.

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 33001-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Summer 2026
Section: 33001-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Based on problem sets, a midterm exam, and a final exam.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

MICROECONOMICS (33001) - [GIBBS, MICHAEL>>](#)

CONTENT

This class will be offered in-person.

This course has three objectives. First, it studies how markets function. Second, it provides a rigorous understanding of basic microeconomic theory that is important in many core and advanced Booth courses. Third, it helps students develop analytical skills. Topics include consumer demand, firm supply and industry behavior, government regulation of markets, introductory game theory, pricing strategies, and network effects, time permitting.

PREREQUISITES

Students should have an understanding of basic calculus (derivatives).

MATERIALS

Textbook.

GRADES

Based on problem sets, midterm and final exam.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 14 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-06
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

MICROECONOMICS (33001) - [HORNBECK, RICHARD>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

This course teaches the core principles of modern microeconomics and illustrates their application to understanding business decisions and the broader world. The course covers the following topics: supply and demand; consumer choice; firm behavior, including pricing and production under different market structures; and the effects of uncertainty.

PREREQUISITES

Understanding of algebra and basic calculus (derivatives).

MATERIALS

Canvas site includes lecture slides and problem sets.

GRADES

Based on problem sets, a midterm, and a comprehensive final exam.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 25 2025

MICROECONOMICS (33001) - [MCCLELLAN, ANDREW>>](#)

CONTENT

This course teaches the basic principles of modern microeconomics and illustrates their application to business decisions. This course will cover the following topics: supply and demand; consumer choice; firm behavior, including pricing and production, under different market structures; and the effects of uncertainty, incomplete information and moral hazard on firm and consumer behavior.

PREREQUISITES

Students should have a solid understanding of algebra and calculus, including the ability to take derivatives.

MATERIALS

Optional Textbook: *Microeconomics* by Goolsbee, Levitt, and Syverson.

GRADES

The grades will be based on problem sets, a midterm and a final exam.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-07
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-08
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33001-09
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 15 2025

ACCELERATED MICROECONOMICS (33002) - [MOUNTJOY, JACK>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is an accelerated alternative to Microeconomics 33001, intended for students with some prior exposure to economics or simply the ambition to engage more intensely with the tools of economics in the spirit of Chicago price theory. We will cover the core topics of Microeconomics 33001 at a faster pace, with deeper exploration of the concepts and their applications to important real-world problems. The core topics include consumer behavior, supply and demand, production and pricing, and choice under uncertainty. Given the faster pace, we will have time to apply these tools to additional topics not typically covered in Microeconomics 33001, including labor markets, compensating differentials, discrimination, inequality, redistribution, education, signaling, human capital, and intergenerational mobility.

PREREQUISITES

Students should be comfortable with algebra and basic calculus.

MATERIALS

Textbook readings and lecture notes.

GRADES

Based on take-home problem sets, in-class quizzes, a midterm exam, and a final exam.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: September 18 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33002-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33002-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

MANAGING THE WORKPLACE (33032) - [KOLE, STACEY>>](#)

CONTENT

This course examines foundational topics in human resource management with a focus on coordinating human resource practices and business strategy. Topics covered include employee selection and retention, training and development, performance evaluation, compensation, job design and communications within the firm. Classes will combine case discussions with lectures, blending theory and application.

PREREQUISITES

Though not a strict prerequisite, students are strongly encouraged to have taken Business 33001 (or a higher level micro course) prior to enrolling in this course. Auditors must attend Week 1.

MATERIALS

Textbook; cases; selected readings.

GRADES

Based on participation in case discussions, team-based case write-ups and strike (union) analysis, an individual paper on a company policy in need of a refresh, and a final exam. Students should refer to the course syllabus for information about attendance.

Auditors with the permission of the professor. No provisional grades. No early final grades. Without exception, students taking the class for a Pass-Fail grade must earn at least half of all possible points on the final examination to pass the class.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: May 11 2026

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33032-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Summer 2026
Section: 33032-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

MANAGING THE WORKPLACE (33032) - [PRENDERGAST, CANICE>>](#)

CONTENT

This course analyzes the relationship between personnel practices and employee performance. An economic analysis of compensation policy is emphasized, though other topics covered include staffing, skill collection, and labor legislation.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33032-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Based on problem sets, a mid-term and final exam. No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

MACROECONOMICS AND THE BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT (33050) - [FABERMAN, JASON>>](#)

CONTENT

This MBA course will introduce students to macroeconomics with an analysis of the aggregate outcomes of the decisions made by households, firms and policymakers.

We will study both short-run business cycle fluctuations and longer-run secular trends in the aggregate economy. Topics covered will include the aggregate labor market, the behavior of consumption and investment, the determination of inflation and interest rates, and the implementation and effects of monetary and fiscal policy. The course will center the discussion of these topics around macroeconomic theories of the aggregate economy, and will frequently draw upon current economic and policy issues.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001 or equivalent is a strict prerequisite. Cannot enroll in BUSN 33050 if BUSN 33040 or 20200 taken previously: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Optional: Abel, Bernanke, and Croushore *Macroeconomics* (11th edition).
There will also be supplementary readings and occasional handouts from the

Spring 2026
Section: 33032-02
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33032-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33050-01
M 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33050-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

popular press. In addition, *The Economist* or an equivalent source of current economic news is highly recommended.

GRADES

Based on quizzes, a midterm, and final exam.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 01 2025

MACROECONOMICS AND THE BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT (33050) - HURST, ERIK>>

CONTENT

The goal of this course is to not only prepare you for your next job after completing your MBA but also prepare you for your last job when you are in upper levels of management. In particular, this course will give you the tools to answer questions like: How do tariffs affect the macroeconomy? How does rising inflation affect the demand for businesses' products or their ability to hire and retain workers? How much control does the government have over inflation and can politicians really create jobs? What does it mean for business and workers when the Fed starts raising interest rates? What effect will automation have on worker employment and wages? What are the benefits and costs of having an independent central bank?

To answer these questions, we develop a unified modeling framework, explore data that supports the model and discuss current research that allows MBA students to answer these sorts of questions and to develop an understanding of how the broad economic environment affects business outcomes. We will then apply this framework to understand historical episodes like the Great Recession as well as to evaluate the importance to businesses of current macroeconomic phenomena such as the introductions of tariffs, rising and falling inflation, tightening monetary policy, large pandemic recovery packages, and global supply chain issues. The applied focus of this course and its focus on providing a framework for business leaders makes it valuable even for those students who have taken previous macroeconomics courses as undergraduates.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001 or equivalent (recommended). No undergraduates. Cannot enroll in BUSN 33050 if BUSN 33040 or 20200 taken previously

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33050-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33050-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

Abel and Bernanke, *Macroeconomics* (recommended). A series of detailed lecture notes on a variety of applied topics will be available on the instructor's website. In addition, *The Economist* or an equivalent source of current economic news is highly recommended.

GRADES

Based on quizzes, midterm and final exam.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 17 2026

MACROECONOMICS AND THE BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT (33050) - [VAVRA, JOSEPH>>](#)

CONTENT

This course will give you the tools to answer questions like: How does rising inflation affect the demand for businesses' products or their ability to hire and retain workers? How much control does the government have over inflation and can politicians really create jobs? What does it mean for business and workers when the Fed starts raising interest rates?

We will build a unified framework, explore data and discuss current research that allows MBA students to answer these sorts of questions and to develop an understanding of how the broad economic environment affects business outcomes. We will then apply this framework to understand historical episodes like the Great Recession as well as to evaluate the importance to businesses of current macroeconomic phenomena such as rising inflation, tightening monetary policy, large pandemic recovery packages, and global supply chain issues arising from the pandemic and international conflict. The applied focus of this course makes it valuable even for those students who have taken previous macroeconomics courses as undergraduates.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001 or its equivalent recommended. Cannot enroll in BUSN 33050 if BUSN 33040 or 20200 taken previously: strict.

MATERIALS

Optional: Abel and Bernanke, *Macroeconomics*. There will also be supplementary readings and occasional handouts from the popular press. In addition, *The Economist* or an equivalent source of current economic news is highly recommended.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33050-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33050-02
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33050-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

GRADES

Based on quizzes/problem sets, a small group project and a final exam.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

BUSINESS IN HISTORICAL PERSPECTIVE (33112) - [HORNBECK, RICHARD>>](#)

CONTENT

This course develops an historical perspective on the modern business environment, with the goal of preparing for seemingly unprecedented business opportunities or challenges. The course explores how businesses have succeeded and failed in diverse contexts throughout history. Topics include: how firms have adapted to the absence of formal legal institutions; the causes and consequences of periods of technological revolution; similarities and differences between the Great Depression and more recent economic turmoil; and exploring determinants of income inequality and who benefits from productivity growth. This course fulfills the Business Environment "Economy" requirement.

PREREQUISITES

None

MATERIALS

Canvas site includes cases, lecture slides and supplementary optional readings.

GRADES

Based on written responses to case discussion questions and a final exam.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 05 2026

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33112-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33112-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33112-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

THE ECONOMICS OF COMPANIES (33230) - [SYVERSON, CHAD>>](#)

CONTENT

This course focuses on topics in industrial organization, the field of economics that studies companies and their behavior. Topics covered include production and productivity, pricing, demand estimation, oligopolies, equilibrium market structure, antitrust and regulation, vertical integration and contracting, strategic behavior, search and advertising, and two-sided markets. The course

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33230-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C05

is aimed at students who are comfortable with at least intermediate-level microeconomics, and ideally have already taken 33001 (Microeconomics) or equivalent. The course material combines both theoretical and empirical elements, and you should be prepared for both abstract and practical treatments of issues. The course can also serve as a complement to, but not replacement for, 42001 (Competitive Strategy).

In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33230-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Microeconomics background/33001 (or equivalent).

MATERIALS

Text: Cabral, Luís M. B. (2017). *Introduction to Industrial Organization*, 2nd Ed, MIT Press.

GRADES

Problem sets, exams, and a team presentation.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 19 2025

PERSPECTIVES ON CAPITALISM (33250) - [GERTNER, ROBERT>>](#)

CONTENT

The University of Chicago is home to scholars of diverse and nuanced perspectives on the accomplishments, limitations, and future of capitalism. The goal of this course is to take advantage of that diverse expertise to equip Chicago Booth students with tools and perspectives that help them engage thoughtfully in these debates and extend them into application in their own roles as corporate, non-profit, or entrepreneurial leaders. The course will provide students with an unbiased survey of the economic, social, and intellectual history of capitalism, sparking active discussion of the challenges and opportunities facing capitalist economies today and what "capitalism" can and should mean going forward.

Course format:

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33250-01
W 5:00 PM-6:30 PM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33250-81
W 5:00 PM-6:30 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD

The format of the course is atypical. The class will follow two parallel paths. First, a diverse group of University of Chicago faculty will be invited to share their research and views, supplemented by short readings; they will discuss their perspectives on capitalism and its future through the lens of their research and areas of expertise. The second path will be that of a seminar course, built around readings and discussion. The seminars of 10-15 students and a faculty member will be taught by Brian Barry, James Carmichael, Rob Gertner, Caroline Grossman, John Paul Rollert, and Susana Vasquez.

The course is 100-total units, but will be broken up into two course numbers/enrollments:

- 33250 Perspectives on Capitalism (0 units), meets 90 minutes per week on Wednesdays from 5:00-6:30pm in Harper Center C-25. Lecture format with speakers.
- 33251 Perspectives on Capitalism Seminar (100 units), meets 90 minutes per week. Small group discussion of readings at a variety of days and times at Harper, Gleacher, or remotely.

There will be a remote option for the seminar; students are required to attend lectures in person unless they are in a remote seminar section.

Past faculty speakers included:

- Marianne Bertrand, Chris P. Dyalynas Distinguished Service Professor of Economics, Chicago Booth
- Agnes Callard, Associate Professor in Philosophy, the College
- Michael Greenstone, Milton Friedman Distinguished Professor in Economics, the College and the Harris School
- Chang-tai Hsieh, Phyllis and Irwin Winkelried Professor of Economics, Chicago Booth
- Jonathan Levy, James Westfall Thompson Professor, History, John U. Nef Committee on Social Thought, and the Collegue
- Kevin Murphy, George J. Stigler Distinguished Service Professor of Economics, Chicago Booth, the College
- Kenneth Pomeranz, University Professor of Modern Chinese History, the College
- Raghuram Rajan, Katherine Dusak Miller Distinguished Service Professor of Finance, Chicago Booth
- Richard Thaler, Charles R. Walgreen Distinguished Service Professor of Behavioral Science and Economics, Chicago Booth
- Dali Yang, William Claude Reavis Professor, Political Science
- Luigi Zingales, Robert C. McCormack Distinguished Service Professor of Entrepreneurship and Finance, Chicago Booth

Information Session:

[View Info Session Recording](#) from 2/8/24 for more details about the course.

How to Enroll:

Perspectives on Capitalism was previously application-based. Effective Spring 2025, students will bid for the Seminar sections (33251). Students who bid successfully for 33251 will automatically be enrolled in 33250 by the Booth Registrar. If you are in a remote section of 33251, you will be enrolled in the remote section of 33250 and be expected to join the lectures remotely (live or asynchronously). If you are in an in-person section of 33251, you will be enrolled in the in-person section of 33250 and be required to attend the lectures in person. Students enrolled in an in-person seminar will not be able to attend lectures remotely or to watch recordings except by arrangement with their seminar instructor, which will only be made in cases of special

circumstances. For questions, contact email BoothRegistrar@lists.chicagobooth.edu.

PREREQUISITES

No Non-Booth students. MiM and MiF students can bid in phase 3.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 23 2026

PERSPECTIVES ON CAPITALISM SEMINAR (33251) - [BARRY, BRIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

The University of Chicago is home to scholars of diverse and nuanced perspectives on the accomplishments, limitations, and future of capitalism. The goal of this course is to take advantage of that diverse expertise to equip Chicago Booth students with tools and perspectives that help them engage thoughtfully in these debates and extend them into application in their own roles as corporate, non-profit, or entrepreneurial leaders. The course will provide students with an unbiased survey of the economic, social, and intellectual history of capitalism, sparking active discussion of the challenges and opportunities facing capitalist economies today and what "capitalism" can and should mean going forward.

Course format:

The format of the course is atypical. The class will follow two parallel paths. First, a diverse group of University of Chicago faculty will be invited to share their research and views, supplemented by short readings; they will discuss their perspectives on capitalism and its future through the lens of their research and areas of expertise. The second path will be that of a seminar

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-03
W 10:00 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
223 Conference Room
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-04
TH 10:00 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
223 Conference Room
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-05
TH 1:30 PM-3:00 PM

course, built around readings and discussion. The seminars of 10-15 students and a faculty member will be taught by Brian Barry, James Carmichael, Rob Gertner, Caroline Grossman, and Susana Vasquez.

Harper Center
223 Conference Room
In-Person Only

The course is 100-total units, but will be broken up into two course numbers/enrollments:

- 33250 Perspectives on Capitalism (0 units), meets 90 minutes per week on Wednesdays from 5:00-6:30pm in Harper Center C-25. Lecture format with speakers.
- 33251 Perspectives on Capitalism Seminar (100 units), meets 90 minutes per week. Small group discussion of readings at a variety of days and times at Harper, Gleacher, or remotely.

PREREQUISITES

No Non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 03 2026

PERSPECTIVES ON CAPITALISM SEMINAR (33251) - [CARMICHAEL, JAMES>>](#)

CONTENT

The University of Chicago is home to scholars of diverse and nuanced perspectives on the accomplishments, limitations, and future of capitalism. The goal of this course is to take advantage of that diverse expertise to equip Chicago Booth students with tools and perspectives that help them engage thoughtfully in these debates and extend them into application in their own roles as corporate, non-profit, or entrepreneurial leaders. The course will provide students with an unbiased survey of the economic, social, and

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-82
W 7:00 PM-8:30 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

intellectual history of capitalism, sparking active discussion of the challenges and opportunities facing capitalist economies today and what "capitalism" can and should mean going forward.

Course format:

The format of the course is atypical. The class will follow two parallel paths. First, a diverse group of University of Chicago faculty will be invited to share their research and views, supplemented by short readings; they will discuss their perspectives on capitalism and its future through the lens of their research and areas of expertise. The second path will be that of a seminar course, built around readings and discussion. The seminars of 10-15 students and a faculty member will be taught by Brian Barry, James Carmichael, Rob Gertner, Caroline Grossman, and Susana Vasquez.

The course is 100-total units, but will be broken up into two course numbers/enrollments:

- 33250 Perspectives on Capitalism (0 units), meets 90 minutes per week on Wednesdays from 5:00-6:30pm in Harper Center C-25. Lecture format with speakers.
- 33251 Perspectives on Capitalism Seminar (100 units), meets 90 minutes per week. Small group discussion of readings at a variety of days and times at Harper, Gleacher, or remotely.

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-83
F 6:00 PM-7:30 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-85
S 1:30 PM-3:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

PREREQUISITES

No Non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 03 2026

PERSPECTIVES ON CAPITALISM SEMINAR (33251) - [GERTNER, ROBERT>>](#)

CONTENT

The University of Chicago is home to scholars of diverse and nuanced perspectives on the accomplishments, limitations, and future of capitalism. The goal of this course is to take advantage of that diverse expertise to equip Chicago Booth students with tools and perspectives that help them engage thoughtfully in these debates and extend them into application in their own roles as corporate, non-profit, or entrepreneurial leaders. The course will provide students with an unbiased survey of the economic, social, and intellectual history of capitalism, sparking active discussion of the challenges and opportunities facing capitalist economies today and what "capitalism" can and should mean going forward.

Course format:

The format of the course is atypical. The class will follow two parallel paths. First, a diverse group of University of Chicago faculty will be invited to share their research and views, supplemented by short readings; they will discuss their perspectives on capitalism and its future through the lens of their research and areas of expertise. The second path will be that of a seminar course, built around readings and discussion. The seminars of 10-15 students and a faculty member will be taught by Brian Barry, James Carmichael, Rob Gertner, Caroline Grossman, John Paul Rollert, and Susana Vasquez.

The course is 100-total units, but will be broken up into two course numbers/enrollments:

- 33250 Perspectives on Capitalism (0 units), meets 90 minutes per week on Wednesdays from 5:00-6:30pm in Harper Center C-25. Lecture format with speakers.
- 33251 Perspectives on Capitalism Seminar (100 units), meets 90 minutes per week. Small group discussion of readings at a variety of days and times at Harper, Gleacher, or remotely.

PREREQUISITES

No Non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-01
TH 10:00 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-02
TH 1:30 PM-3:00 PM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PERSPECTIVES ON CAPITALISM SEMINAR (33251) - GROSSMAN, CAROLINE>>**CONTENT**

The University of Chicago is home to scholars of diverse and nuanced perspectives on the accomplishments, limitations, and future of capitalism. The goal of this course is to take advantage of that diverse expertise to equip Chicago Booth students with tools and perspectives that help them engage thoughtfully in these debates and extend them into application in their own roles as corporate, non-profit, or entrepreneurial leaders. The course will provide students with an unbiased survey of the economic, social, and intellectual history of capitalism, sparking active discussion of the challenges and opportunities facing capitalist economies today and what "capitalism" can and should mean going forward.

Course format:

The format of the course is atypical. The class will follow two parallel paths. First, a diverse group of University of Chicago faculty will be invited to share their research and views, supplemented by short readings; they will discuss their perspectives on capitalism and its future through the lens of their research and areas of expertise. The second path will be that of a seminar course, built around readings and discussion. The seminars of 10-15 students and a faculty member will be taught by Brian Barry, James Carmichael, Rob Gertner, Caroline Grossman, and Susana Vasquez.

The course is 100-total units, but will be broken up into two course numbers/enrollments:

- 33250 Perspectives on Capitalism (0 units), meets 90 minutes per week on Wednesdays from 5:00-6:30pm in Harper Center C-25. Lecture format with speakers.
- 33251 Perspectives on Capitalism Seminar (100 units), meets 90 minutes per week. Small group discussion of readings at a variety of days and times at Harper, Gleacher, or remotely.

PREREQUISITES

No Non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

No pass/fail grades.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-06
W 3:00 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
207 D - North
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-81
W 6:45 PM-8:15 PM
Harper Center
223 Conference Room
In-Person Only

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 03 2026

PERSPECTIVES ON CAPITALISM SEMINAR (33251) - **VASQUEZ, SUSANA>>**

CONTENT

The University of Chicago is home to scholars of diverse and nuanced perspectives on the accomplishments, limitations, and future of capitalism. The goal of this course is to take advantage of that diverse expertise to equip Chicago Booth students with tools and perspectives that help them engage thoughtfully in these debates and extend them into application in their own roles as corporate, non-profit, or entrepreneurial leaders. The course will provide students with an unbiased survey of the economic, social, and intellectual history of capitalism, sparking active discussion of the challenges and opportunities facing capitalist economies today and what "capitalism" can and should mean going forward.

Course format:

The format of the course is atypical. The class will follow two parallel paths. First, a diverse group of University of Chicago faculty will be invited to share their research and views, supplemented by short readings; they will discuss their perspectives on capitalism and its future through the lens of their research and areas of expertise. The second path will be that of a seminar course, built around readings and discussion. The seminars of 10-15 students and a faculty member will be taught by Brian Barry, James Carmichael, Rob Gertner, Caroline Grossman, and Susana Vasquez.

The course is 100-total units, but will be broken up into two course numbers/enrollments:

- 33250 Perspectives on Capitalism (0 units), meets 90 minutes per week on Wednesdays from 5:00-6:30pm in Harper Center C-25. Lecture format with speakers.
- 33251 Perspectives on Capitalism Seminar (100 units), meets 90 minutes per week. Small group discussion of readings at a variety of days and times at Harper, Gleacher, or remotely.

PREREQUISITES

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-07
T 1:30 PM-3:00 PM
Harper Center
223 Conference Room
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-08
T 3:30 PM-5:00 PM
Harper Center
223 Conference Room
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33251-09
W 3:00 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
223 Conference Room
In-Person Only

No Non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 03 2026

THE FIRM AND THE NON-MARKET ENVIRONMENT (33305) - BERTRAND, MARIANNE>>

CONTENT

The business environment has both a market and a non-market component. Most courses in the MBA curriculum focus on the market component: they study firms’ interactions with customers, suppliers, and alliance partners in the form of mutually beneficial exchanges transacted in markets. In contrast, this course focuses on the non-market component. For example, businesses need to cope with laws and regulations, lobby for favorable legislation, ensure access to foreign markets, and deal with media coverage and activist pressures, to name just a few. Successful managers need to formulate strategies for their firms that take into account not only the market but also the regulatory, legal, political and social (e.g. non-market) environments in which they operate.

Markets and the non-market environment have become increasingly interrelated: regulation, laws, media coverage and activist organization pressures directly affect firms’ market performance. Conversely, the profit-maximizing activities of firms often give rise to issues that involve governments and the public. For example, the market strategies of some e-commerce firms have sparked debates ranging from intellectual property protection to privacy; recent development in the fast-food industry and financial markets have triggered intense discussions about new information disclosure and consumer protection rules.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33305-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33305-02
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33305-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406

The main purpose of this course is to better understand the non-market environment, and discuss firms' strategies in light of regulatory, legal, political and social constraints that they face. We will discuss the rationales for economic regulation and describe the main tools of economic regulation (such as the industry conduct regulation of natural monopolies and industrial structure regulation imposed by antitrust laws). We also discuss firms' strategies in light of environmental, safety, or intellectual property concerns.

A common thread throughout this course is that we will recognize that firms can also shape their non-market environment. In particular, we will discuss firms' lobbying strategies and use tools from political science to guide our understanding of the lawmaking and rulemaking process. We will also discuss why and how firms may decide to self-regulate in response to activist or media pressures.

In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

None.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Lecture notes and selected additional readings. This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Based on class participation in case discussions, weekly write-ups and a final exam. Provisional grades will be issued for graduating students. No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 04 2026

FINANCING THE GRID: VALUING TRANSMISSION & STORAGE CAPACITY (33320) - [BIRGE, JOHN>>](#) ; [MORDECAI, DAVID K.A.>>](#)

CONTENT

This course will provide a general introductory overview to fundamental instruments, and to foundational concepts and practice principles from industrial economics, statistics and engineering applicable to financing and valuation of grid-scale electricity storage and transmission capacity.

We will survey key principles underlying the engineering and economics of the grid, and introduce fundamental themes from applicable financial derivatives and natural resource and environmental economics, which are foundational to the application of Cournot models and real options analysis, as well as statistical and econometric specification of spatial models from industrial economics (locational and agglomerative models, capacitated market models) for storage and transmission in the context of binding technical constraints. Beginning with foundational principles for fundamental pricing instruments applicable to electricity generation, consumption, storage and transmission, lecture and discussion will address corresponding established and prospective industry practice related to spatial organization and colocation of industrial electricity supply and demand with additional implications for environmental and infrastructure regulation and finance, electricity trading and asset pricing (e.g., metals and ancillary commodity derivatives markets), as well as broader implications and impacts for political economy, energy policy and applied management science.

Topics to be addressed include: (i) Contracts-for-Differences (CfDs) and relative-value pricing to comparable instruments; (ii) volatility estimation and spread elasticities; (iii) load estimation/forecasting; (iv) state estimation of peak-load price regimes and volatility shocks; (v) weather and weather volatility estimation/forecasting; (vi) thermodynamics of power and energy density; (vii) measuring temperature extremes in terms of cooling degree days (CDDs), heating degree days (HDDs) and precipitation days; (viii) estimating conditional supply-demand spread elasticities to CfDs and spot spreads.

PREREQUISITES

Although background in electrical engineering or power systems is not required, and there are no specific prerequisites for the course, prior coursework in statistical and economic analysis and the pricing financial and commodity derivatives is highly encouraged.

MATERIALS

See syllabus for required and recommend textbooks, articles, and recommended computing/software materials.

GRADES

Grades will be determined based on the following:

(A) Homework ([25%]), Class Participation ([25%]) and (B) Final Group Project (50%)

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33320-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

HEALTH ECONOMICS (33350) - NOTOWIDIGDO, MATTHEW>>**CONTENT**

This course applies theoretical and empirical tools of microeconomics to the study of health insurance and the healthcare sector. This course will cover a broad range of topics including the demand for healthcare, the design and financing of health insurance, the behavior of non-profit and for-profit hospitals, the role of competition in the healthcare market, the determinants of healthcare spending, the sources of technological change in the healthcare sector, and the effects of government regulations on the healthcare market. We will also study in depth the role of adverse selection and moral hazard in healthcare markets, both theoretically and empirically. The course will briefly discuss healthcare systems around the world and describe socioeconomic disparities in health outcomes in both the United States and around the world. The course will conclude with applications of all of these concepts to recent health care policy debates in the United States.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33350-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33350-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

The recommended prerequisites for this class are 33001 (Microeconomics) and 41000 (Business Statistics).

MATERIALS

There is one required textbook, my book "Better Health Economics" (available here:

<https://press.uchicago.edu/ucp/books/book/chicago/B/bo208556491.html>). If you are unfamiliar with the U.S. healthcare system, then I also encourage you to purchase the "Healthcare Handbook" e-book and read it prior to the start of class (<https://www.amazon.com/Health-Care-Handbook-Concise-United-ebook/dp/B0088CMAUU>). Any edition is fine. This book is a useful introduction to the U.S. healthcare system, and many of the examples we will discuss in class will be from the U.S. healthcare system. I will also assign *optional* readings most weeks from the "Health Economics" textbook by Jay Bhattacharya, Timothy Hyde, and Peter Tu (<https://www.amazon.com/Health-Economics-Jay-Bhattacharya/dp/113702996X>). Again, any edition is fine.

GRADES

Grades will be determined by one of two formulas. If one performs better on the Final Exam than on the Midterm Exam, the midterm will be weighted less.

The maximum grade point average for the class will be 3.3, where A=4, B=3, C=2, D=1, and F=0.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 04 2026

THE BUSINESS OF PHARMACEUTICALS (33351) - [QATO, REAM>>](#)

CONTENT

This course introduces key contemporary and emerging issues in the US healthcare and pharmaceutical industry. Part I provides (a) a grounding in the industry's institutional features, in particular the role played by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) in regulating the sector, (b) an overview of key stakeholders involved in drug launch and commercialization, and (c) each stakeholders economic incentives in this competitive market. Once students understand the landscape, stakeholders, and incentives, Part II will turn to (a) the interplay between the stakeholders, (b) the current and anticipated changes to this highly dynamic industry, and (c) focus on recent Policy updates, emerging product categories, and a critical consideration of the future of healthcare delivery and payment in the US.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33351-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

The main course textbook is Campbell, J. J. (2008) *Understanding Pharma: The Professionals Guide to how Pharmaceutical Companies really work*, Pharmaceutical Institute, Raleigh.

Additional weekly readings listed in syllabus.

GRADES

Case Write-Ups (60%)

Students will be required to respond to questions for 3 of 5 case prompts. Students may work individually or in teams of two to respond to the cases.

Discussion (20%)

Students will be offered opportunities to participate in discussion in each class. This will be graded on their level of preparation, the clarity of contributions and the attention to and engagement with the topic of discussion.

Final Essay (20%)

Students will be given three prompts related to a controversial topic impacting the industry. Essays should demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specifics of the case, its place in the wider healthcare landscape, and a thoughtful strategy on how they would approach posed prompt should they be executives at a leading stakeholder firm.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 07 2025

PHARMACEUTICAL LAUNCH & LIFECYCLE STRATEGY (33353) - PRASAD, SANGEETA>>

CONTENT

The course is for students who plan to work with or in the Bio-Pharma industry - as a manager, entrepreneur, investor, or consultant. It builds on concepts from introductory marketing and strategy courses and applies them to the unique challenges of pharmaceutical product commercialization and lifecycle management. We will discuss how commercialization decisions are influenced by factors like science, regulation, market dynamics, patient care and business strategy. **The focus of the class is on how to optimize revenue and profit and scale up effectively in this industry.**

Topics will be discussed using a combination of lectures, readings, cases covering the following areas. We will bring in a number of senior industry practitioners as guest speakers to share their knowledge with the class:

- **Regulatory Landscape:** An overview of the highly regulated nature of the life sciences industry. We will explore how these regulations affect strategy and decisions in product development and commercialization.
- **Product Development & Lifecycle models:** Understanding of the product development model in life sciences, including the risks, costs, timelines and the “attrition rate problem”. We will explore commercialization frameworks to evaluate product potential.
- **Stakeholder Ecosystem:** Manufacturers in the life sciences industry must navigate an extremely complex web of stakeholders and changing incentives throughout the product lifecycle. Understanding the roles, incentives, and decision-making power of these stakeholders is essential to managing risk, enabling market access, and unlocking opportunities to create value in market entry and expansion.
- **How to identify commercially viable products and successfully commercialize them:** How traditional concepts like segmentation, targeting, positioning, pricing, and go-to-market strategy apply in the life sciences context. We will explore how companies create and sustain competitive advantage in markets where customers include patients providers, payers, advocacy groups and regulators.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33353-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only
New Course

A detailed week by week syllabus is available below. As we go along additional readings may be provided and we may modify the class to optimize learning objectives.

PREREQUISITES

Introductory Marketing (Business 37000 or equivalent): strict. A strategy classes such as Business 42001 is very helpful to follow the discussion. This course assumes that students are familiar with the components and structures learnt in these introductory courses like 3Cs, 4Ps, Marketing Mix, Segmentation and positioning, Porter's 5 forces, BCG growth share matrix and PEST analysis. Our course will apply these concepts within the structural construct of the healthcare market. The focus will be how to maximize revenue and profits from the commercialization of Bio- Pharma products by both startups as well as mature companies at different stages of the lifecycle.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Please see detailed syllabus attachment

GRADES

Being a good manager requires superior skills in analysis, decision making and both verbal and written communication. The grade you receive will reflect your proficiency in the course material as well as your ability to communicate it. The grade will be a combination of your performance in

- **Class attendance and discussion (35%):**

1. Attendance: Your participation is integral to class discussions, so class attendance is expected. Since grades are dependent on class participation, absences, as well as arriving late or departing early, will adversely affect your grade.
2. Quality contributions in class: Students will be offered opportunities to participate in discussions in each class. Your contributions should be clear, concise, and offer ideas that will advance our topic of discussion. It requires that you are prepared for class, having read and thought about the material and the case in advance. It is the quality of your contributions, not their quantity, that will determine your class participation grade. Peer evaluations may be used to supplement instructor evaluations.

- **Homework Assignments (45%):** Students will be required to submit assignments based on readings prior to the class.

- **Final Assignment (see detailed syllabus): 20%**

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 02 2026

MONEY AND BANKING (33401) - HUBER, KILIAN>>

CONTENT

This course is about money, central banks, and financial institutions. We focus on how they affect businesses, how they help companies grow, and what can go wrong.

One focus of the course is monetary policy. We study how modern central banks affect the real economy and how they can be successful. We analyze how central banks use conventional and unconventional monetary policy in crises, using examples from the 2008 financial crisis and the recent inflationary period. We also consider how households and firms react to monetary policy.

A second focus is financial crises. We highlight why a well-functioning monetary and financial system is key to a successful economy, and how crises disrupt businesses. To evaluate whether and how the academic concepts matter in the real world, we read and discuss modern empirical research.

A third focus is how companies finance themselves and why they choose banks. Key questions are why banks exist and whether banks have a special role in the economy. We cover fundamental economic concepts, including asymmetric information on credit markets and banks' instability due to liquidity transformation.

A fourth focus is how central banks regulate the financial sector. We discuss topical questions, such as whether we should stop banks from becoming "too big to fail" and whether banks should receive government bailouts. The regulatory concepts that we discuss affect not only financial institutions, but also businesses and their customers.

PREREQUISITES

There are no essential prerequisites. Cannot enroll in 33401 if 20232 taken previously: strict.

MATERIALS

Online readings accessible through Canvas.

Lecture slides accessible through Canvas.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33401-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33401-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33401-03
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 33401-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

GRADES

Grades are based on a mid-term exam, final exam, homework assignments, and class participation. Will give provisional grades to non-Booth students, but not early final grades.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 08 2026

MONEY AND BANKING (33401) - [KROSZNER, RANDALL>>](#)

CONTENT

This course analyzes the operation and regulation of financial institutions and the impact of Central Bank actions on securities markets and the economy, with particular emphasis on the financial crisis and the response by the Federal Reserve. The first half of the course focuses on how financial innovation and regulatory reform is dramatically changing the role of banks and other intermediaries in the financial system and how the banking and financial system will likely adapt to these reforms in the future. We analyze whether various regulatory reform proposals are likely to enhance or reduce the stability and soundness of the financial markets and the economy, drawing on examples from the recent and historical crises worldwide.

The second half of the class builds on the understanding of the banking system from the first half to investigate the macroeconomic consequences of Central Bank activities. Topics include how the Federal Reserve and banks create money, how the Fed intervenes in securities markets and attempts to affect interest rates, the impact of Fed policy on inflation and the boom-and-bust cycle, and the causes and consequences of inflation and deflation. In particular, we study the response to the crisis by the Fed and central banks around the globe and the exit strategies from extraordinary monetary policy. We also evaluate what the Central Bank should or should not do and the political pressures it faces in its decision-making process.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33401-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33401-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33401-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001 and 33040, or their equivalents. NOTE: 33001 is STRICT. Cannot enroll in 33401 if 20232 taken previously: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

The most recent edition of Frederic Mishkin, *The Economics of Money, Banking, and Financial Markets*, Randall Kroszner and Robert Shiller, *Reforming*

US Financial Markets, and articles on Library Course Reserve. Since there will be a heavy emphasis in class discussion on current developments in financial markets and monetary policy both domestically and internationally, *The Wall Street Journal*, *The Economist*, and *The Financial Times* are highly recommended.

GRADES

Based primarily on a mid-term, a final exam, homework assignments, and class participation. No auditors. Can provide provisional grades as long as student has passed the midterm and has been submitting weekly homework and participating in class. No early final grades allowed.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 08 2026

REAL ESTATE INVESTMENTS I (33450) - **PAGLIARI, JOSEPH>>**

CONTENT

This course is designed to familiarize students with real estate equity investments - primarily from the perspective of institutional investors (*e.g.*, pension funds, investment advisors, private equity, REITs, life insurance companies, *etc.*) with allocations to "core" property types. Accordingly, much of the course's emphasis will be placed on various types of financial modeling used by these investors to evaluate their real estate investments. The course will also emphasize the multi-disciplinary setting (*e.g.*, accounting, business law, economics, finance, mathematics and statistics) in which real estate operates. Given the dynamic nature of the real estate markets, the course notes, the pace of the class, the nature of exams, *etc.* should be expected to be somewhat fluid.

PREREQUISITES

None. However, it is recommended that you have taken (or are taking) Business 33001 (Microeconomics) and/or 35000 (Investments). In any event, students are expected to have a working knowledge of Excel and a familiarity with finance, accounting and statistics. Students should not be averse to analytical thinking and quantitative analysis - most real estate practitioners are "numbers junkies."

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33450-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33450-02
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33450-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD

MATERIALS

Readings and handouts posted on Canvas site.

GRADES

Based on class participation, cases, midterm and final exam. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

REAL ESTATE INVESTMENTS II (33451) - [PAGLIARI, JOSEPH>>](#)

CONTENT

This class is intended to be an extension of Real Estate Investments I (Business 33450) and, therefore, is designed to examine more complex real estate issues and problems. More specifically, this course is intended to: a) provide you with a perspective on the "structuring" issues related to real estate equity investments, b) invoke the multi-disciplinary setting in which complex real estate transactions take place, and c) move beyond the "core" property types. Given the dynamic nature of the real estate markets, the course notes, the pace of the class, the nature of exams, etc. should be expected to be somewhat fluid.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33450: strict

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33451-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Readings and handouts posted on Canvas site.

GRADES

Based on class participation, cases, midterm and final exam. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 10 2026

BUSINESS, POLITICS, AND ETHICS (33471) - [BARRY, BRIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

The business environment creates ethical choices that can be hard to think through clearly. It can also subject companies to negative publicity or political pressure, which affects both how they are regulated and how well they attract employees, customers and partners. So business leaders are often called upon to make credible and persuasive arguments defending their products, their firms, their industries, or the capitalist system in which they operate.

Doing this effectively – in a variety of settings – is an essential aspect of business leadership, given the extensive influence of government rules, pressure groups and the media on modern business. This is especially true now, when so many people are raising questions about the role of capitalism itself.

Students in this course will gain experience forming and articulating coherent arguments about the ethics and role of business, by relating their own views to important ideas about business and capitalism and then working to ground them in clear thinking and informed ethical reasoning. We will use this approach to consider a broad range of tradeoffs and controversies that business leaders often confront.

Arriving at informed views that reflect your beliefs is essential to handling these tradeoffs and controversies effectively, and in ways you can feel good about. It is also only part of the challenge in modern business. Managers must also handle criticism from groups who might gain something by weakening a firm or industry's reputation, or by questioning the legitimacy of the marketplace in which businesses operate. Critics can include rival firms, politicians, workers, pressure groups, journalists, customers and suppliers.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33471-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33471-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33471-03
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 33471-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304

The quality and accuracy of these groups' arguments vary, but usually include assertions that a business or its leaders are behaving unethically or lack legitimacy. The ability to respond to these claims, and counter them effectively when the facts and arguments are on your side, is a crucial management skill. This is easier to do when you can think through how your assessments relate to broader ideas about business and capitalism.

PREREQUISITES

Students who have taken BUSN 20940 cannot take 33471: strict. At least 4 previous Booth MBA classes strongly recommended. Booth MBA students only: strict. No auditors: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

A selection of cases and readings which will be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Short written assignments, group projects/debates.

No pass/fail grades and no auditors: strict. Note: Students must attend section in which they are enrolled: strict. Booth MBA students only: strict.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 05 2026

INTERNATIONAL COMMERCIAL POLICY (33501) - [ADAQ, RODRIGO>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

International trade has always been economically controversial and politically contentious. This course demystifies some of the complex issues that surround discussions of globalization. It asks such questions as: Why do countries engage in trade? Are countries in competition with one another, making one a winner and another a loser, or is trade mutually beneficial? Who gains and who loses from international trade within any given country? How is the burden of import tariffs divided in the economy? What is the impact of a trade war on the global economy? This course examines these questions and much more.

Winter 2026
Section: 33501-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

There is no strict requirement, but I assume familiarity with the concepts taught in Microeconomics (Bus 33001). This course employs quantitative reasoning. Cannot enroll in BUSN 33501 if 20231 taken previously.

GRADES

Grades will be based on assignments, a midterm exam, and a final exam. No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 04 2025

INTERNATIONAL FINANCIAL POLICY (33502) - [NEIMAN, BRENT>>](#)

CONTENT

This is a course on open-economy macroeconomics and key topics in international financial policymaking. We will discuss the linkage of exchange rates and interest rates, how businesses react to exchange rate risk, the choice of exchange rate regime including monetary unions like the euro area, international borrowing/lending and current accounts, and financial crises. We will also touch on policy-relevant areas, such as how IMF programs and central bank swap lines work, cross-border payments, the global role of the dollar, trade policy, sanctions, and geoeconomics.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33502-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33502-02
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM

PREREQUISITES

Business 33050 or equivalent is recommended, but not required. Cannot enroll in BUSN 33502 if BUSN 20230 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Based on a combination of class lectures, textbook chapters, and newspaper and magazine articles.

GRADES

Based on a combination of quizzes, a mid-term, and a final exam. It is possible there will be a homework assignment. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 05 2026

THE WEALTH OF NATIONS (33520) - [HSIEH, CHANG-TAI>>](#)

CONTENT

Why is the United States the wealthiest country in the world? How can we understand the emergence of China and India in the last two decades? What explains growth disasters of countries such as Venezuela? This class will develop quantitative analytical frameworks and use case studies to examine the role of resource allocation and technological innovation in understanding the performance of firms in emerging markets vs wealthy countries. We will examine the elements of successful and disastrous growth strategies in selected emerging markets.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001 recommended, but not required.

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33520-01
Day/Time: TBD
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only
Global SMP

Spring 2026
Section: 33520-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 33520-85

No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

APPLIED ECONOMICS WORKSHOP (33610) - [BERTRAND, MARIANNE>>](#) ; [KAMENICA, EMIR>>](#)

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 33610=ECON 54300. PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33610-60
W 1:20 PM-2:50 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

APPLIED ECONOMICS WORKSHOP (33610) - [CONWAY, JACOB>>](#) ; [KAMENICA, EMIR>>](#)

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33610-60

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 33610=ECON 54300. PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

APPLIED ECONOMICS WORKSHOP (33610) - MINNI, VIRGINIA>> ; ZWICK, ERIC>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 33610=ECON 54300. PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33610-60
W 1:20 PM-2:50 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

WORKSHOP: MONEY AND BANKING (33630) - HANSEN, LARS>> ; ROSSI-HANSBERG, ESTEBAN ; STAFF

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33630-60
W 3:00 PM-5:30 PM
Building: TBD

Location: TBD
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 33630=ECON 53000

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 09 2026

WORKSHOP: MONEY AND BANKING (33630) - PATTERSON, CHRISTINA>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 33630=ECON 53000

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 18 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33630-60
W 3:00 PM-5:30 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only

WORKSHOP: MONEY AND BANKING (33630) - STAFF

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 33630=ECON 53000

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33630-60
W 3:00 PM-5:30 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

In-Person Only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

WORKSHOP IN MACRO AND INTERNATIONAL ECONOMICS (33650) - ADAQ, RODRIGO>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

Completion of 1st year of PhD Program. PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 33650=ECON 57000

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33650-60
M 12:00 PM-1:15 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

WORKSHOP IN MACRO AND INTERNATIONAL ECONOMICS (33650) - LORENZONI, GUIDO>> ; VAVRA, JOSEPH>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

Completion of 1st year of PhD Program. PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 33650=ECON 57000

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33650-60
M 12:00 PM-1:15 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

WORKSHOP IN MACRO AND INTERNATIONAL ECONOMICS (33650) - STAFF

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

Completion of 1st year of PhD Program. PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 33650=ECON 57000

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33650-60
M 12:00 PM-1:15 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

MICROECONOMICS READING AND RESEARCH SEMINAR (33903, 50 UNIT COURSE) - BUDISH, ERIC>> ; NOTOWIDIGDO, MATTHEW>>

CONTENT

Intensive year-long research and writing seminar for Booth Economics PhD students in the 3rd year and up.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only: strict

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33903-50
M 4:30 PM-6:00 PM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
50-Units: All Weeks
In-Person Only

PhD - students only

Strict Prerequisite

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

MICROECONOMICS READING AND RESEARCH SEMINAR (33904, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [BUDISH, ERIC>>](#) ; [NOTOWIDIGDO, MATTHEW>>](#)

CONTENT

Intensive year-long research and writing seminar for Booth Economics PhD students in the 3rd year and up.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only: strict; Non-Booth PhD students require instructor consent

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

PhD - students only

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33904-50
W 4:00 PM-5:30 PM
Harper Center
4SE - Faculty Conference Room
50-Units: All Weeks
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

MICROECONOMICS READING AND RESEARCH SEMINAR (33905, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [BUDISH, ERIC>>](#) ; [NOTOWIDIGDO, MATTHEW>>](#)

CONTENT

Intensive year-long research and writing seminar for Booth Economics PhD students in the 3rd year and up

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only: strict

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

PhD - students only

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33905-50
M 4:30 PM-6:00 PM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
50-Units: All Weeks
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

TOPICS IN INFORMATION ECONOMICS (33914) - [KAMENICA, EMIR>>](#)

CONTENT

The course will provide an overview of formal models of information and explore ways these models have been used to analyze topics in economics. Emphasis will be placed on recent developments in the field.

PREREQUISITES

First year PhD micro. PhD students only: strict. BUSN 33914=ECON 30680

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

Based on problem sets.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33914-50
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

TOPICS IN LABOR ECONOMICS (33918) - [HUMLUM, ANDERS>>](#) ; [MINNI, VIRGINIA>>](#) ; [NOTOWIDIGDO, MATTHEW>>](#)

CONTENT

This course studies topics in labor economics, surveying both recent theoretical and empirical work in the field. The topics will build on core topics in labor economics and will survey recent work on gender discrimination, racial discrimination, gender and racial gaps in labor market outcomes, applied econometric tools in the economics of education, inequality, organizational economics, and minimum wages.

PREREQUISITES

First-year micro theory, especially game theory and basic theory of consumer/producer demand. The problem sets will involve some statistical

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33918-50
W 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

programming (in the language of your choice), and we will try to make these assignments both useful and challenging. In our experience, the programming/statistical part is more challenging for students than the math. PhD students only: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

MATERIALS

There is no assigned textbook. All assigned readings will be recent papers.

GRADES

Grades will be determined by the following formula:

- Percent of Final Grade
- Referee Reports 25%
- Problem Sets 50%
- Final Exam 25%

GRADES

- Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)
- Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 04 2026

HEALTH ECONOMICS LITERATURE SEMINAR (33920, 50 UNIT COURSE) - SHAPIRO, BRADLEY>>

CONTENT

This is a literature seminar in which students present recent papers in health economics. The goal is for students to understand the literature at the frontier of the field, its limitations, and opportunities to improve it. Topics vary by year as the field progresses.

PREREQUISITES

Knowledge of PhD level microeconomics and econometrics will be needed. Bus 33001, 33101, 33002 or Econ 30000, 30100, or 30200 & Econometrics at PhD level: strict. Students are encouraged (though not required) to take ECON

SCHEDULE
Autumn 2025 Section: 33920-50 TH 1:30 PM-3:00 PM Harper Center 3A - Seminar Room 50-Units: All Weeks In-Person Only
Winter 2026 Section: 33920-50 M 1:30 PM-3:00 PM Harper Center

37710/PPHA 48050 ("Economics of Healthcare") concurrently with or prior to this course. BUSN 33920=ECON 37720

Booth MBA students are allowed to take the course with the understanding that it will be PhD level material and requires reading, interpreting and presenting academic research papers. This will require a general comfort level with econometrics, causal inference, calculus and microeconomic theory. If you are an MBA student interested in enrolling in the course, please get preclearance from Professor Shapiro prior to enrolling to verify that you are sufficiently prepared for the material.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 03 2025

ADVANCED INDUSTRIAL ORGANIZATION I (33921) - SYVERSON, CHAD>>

CONTENT

This is the first course in a Chicago Booth sequence with one or more IO topics courses in the Department of Economics. The class is for PhD students. The sequence covers recent theoretical and empirical approaches in several topics. This course focuses on productivity and industry evolution, advertising and search, product differentiation, vertical relationships, and strategic behavior.

PREREQUISITES

Solid background in microeconomics (e.g., Business 33001, 33002, 33101, or Economics 30000, 30100, or 30200) and preferably econometrics at the PhD level. PhD students only. BUSN 33921=ECON 40101

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

MATERIALS

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33921-50
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

Carlton and Perloff, *Modern Industrial Organization*; Tirole, *The Theory of Industrial Organization*; reading list to be distributed in class.

GRADES

Students should plan to take all three quarters of this course and hopefully any additional IO topics offered. No provisional grades.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

ADVANCED INDUSTRIAL ORGANIZATION II (33922) - HORTACSU, ALI

CONTENT

This two-quarter sequence is part of the Industrial Organization Specialized Field taught jointly at the Ph.D. level in the Department of Economics and the Booth School of Business. Topics include modeling consumer demand, production function estimation, static and dynamic models of imperfect competition, pricing strategies, theory of the firm, auctions and market design. Recent theoretical and empirical approaches are emphasized. PQ: Solid background in first year Ph.D. level microeconomics and econometrics, e.g., ECON 30100, 30200, or 30300 and ECON 31000, 31100, or 31200.

In Winter 2026 this class will meet in Saieh Hall for Economics.

PREREQUISITES

Bus 33921. BUSN 33922=ECON 40201. PhD students only.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 07 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33922-50
TTH 2:00 PM-3:20 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only

ADVANCED INDUSTRIAL ORGANIZATION III (33923) - RICHERT, ERIC

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33923-50

This course will complement the other courses in the Ph.D. sequence for industrial organization and will focus on topics closely related to antitrust economics and regulation.

In spring 2026, the course will be taught by [Eric Richert](#). Class will meet in Saieh Hall on T/Th from 9:30-10:50 am, and the discussion session will meet on W from 5:30-6:30 pm. The course will have an in-person exam.

TTH 9:30 AM-10:50 AM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Bus 33921 and 33922. BUSN 33923=ECON 40301.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 09 2026

ECONOMICS OF EDUCATION (33930) - [CAMPOS, CHRISTOPHER>>](#) ; [MOUNTJOY, JACK>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is designed for graduate students interested in conducting rigorous research in the economics of education and related fields, including labor economics, public economics, and industrial organization. We will cover foundations and recent innovations across a range of topics spanning early childhood to postsecondary education, including students, teachers, and schools in the educational production function; school choice, information, and competition; human capital versus signaling; college admissions; and the pecuniary and non-pecuniary returns to colleges and majors.

PREREQUISITES

Students should be comfortable with the core material from the first-year economics PhD sequence, especially econometrics, price theory, and basic game theory. Cannot enroll in BUSN 33930 if ECON 36700 taken previously.

GRADES

Grades will be based on class discussion, a problem set, a referee report, a written research proposal, and a presentation of the research proposal.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33930-50
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 27 2026

THE ECONOMICS OF CONTRACTS (33931) - [FRANKEL, ALEXANDER>>](#)

CONTENT

The objective of this course is to introduce students to the theory of optimal contracting in economics. This course will jump around to cover a variety of loosely connected topics, going through seminal results and then presenting a quick tour of more recent work. Possible topics include incentive contracts under moral hazard and adverse selection, the theory of the firm, relational contracts, robustness, delegation, price discrimination, and others to be determined.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 33931-50
TTH 3:30 PM-4:50 PM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 33931 = ECON 30540

Students are expected to be familiar with Price Theory I - III (ECON 30100, 30200, 30300).

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 15 2025

READINGS IN APPLIED THEORY AND MARKET DESIGN (33935, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [BUDISH, ERIC>>](#)

CONTENT

PhD-level discussion of applied theory and market design for Booth PhD students who do work related to applied theory.

PREREQUISITES

Non-Booth PhD students require instructor permission: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33935-50
F 1:00 PM-2:30 PM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

PhD - students only

Strict Prerequisite

APPLIED MACROECONOMICS: MICRO DATA FOR MACRO MODELS (33942) - [HSIEH, CHANG-TAI>>](#) ; [HURST, ERIK>>](#)

CONTENT

This course considers the use of data on households, workers and producers in research on consumption behavior, labor market fluctuations, business dynamics and other areas of macroeconomics. A key goal is to help students develop the ability to identify interesting research questions and devise promising research strategies. Topics include life cycle consumption behavior, home production and time use, housing market dynamics, wage rigidities and their consequences, unemployment fluctuations, employer behavior on the hiring margin, entrepreneurship, and business productivity dynamics. Lectures treat a mix of important, well-established research contributions and new, often rough, papers that seek to advance the frontier. Homework assignments aim to build proficiency in the use of micro data to address macroeconomic issues, expose students to a variety of useful data sources, and give them first-hand experience in identifying and evaluating research questions and strategies.

PREREQUISITES

PhD Students only. BUSN 33942=ECON 38001.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

MATERIALS

See syllabus posted to the instructors' websites by September 2.

GRADES

No pass/fail grades. No provisional grades.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 33942-50
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

INTERNATIONAL MACROECONOMICS AND TRADE (33946) - ADAO, RODRIGO>>

CONTENT

This is a graduate course in international trade. It introduces the fundamental concepts and tools of international trade and economic geography to prepare students to tackle research questions in these areas.

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 33946=ECON 35101. PhD-level course. Non-Booth PhD students may enroll. Undergraduates and master's students require faculty permission.

MATERIALS

Slides, readings, and assignments will be available via Canvas and GitHub.

GRADES

Grades will be based on assignments and a final exam.

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 31 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 33946-50
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

ENTREPRENEURIAL FINANCE AND PRIVATE EQUITY (34101) - BERLIN, LARRY>>

CONTENT

This course uses the case method to study entrepreneurial and private equity finance. Private equity in all its forms has become a meaningful and growing component of the global economy. On the supply side, the amount of private equity under management - by partnerships investing in venture capital, growth equity, leveraged buyouts, distressed companies, etc. - has increased substantially in the last two decades. On the demand side, a large number of MBAs and others are interested in becoming investors in various private equity funds as well as starting and managing their own businesses.

The primary objective of the course is to provide an understanding of the concepts and institutions involved in entrepreneurial finance and private equity markets. To do this, the course has been designed to be broad and comprehensive. We will explore private equity from a number of perspectives, beginning with the entrepreneur/issuer, moving to private equity - venture capital, growth equity and leveraged buyout - partnerships, and finishing with investors in private equity partnerships.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34101-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

For each class meeting, study questions will be assigned concerning a case study. We will discuss these questions and the material in the case for most of the class period. Before each case discussion, each student will be required to submit a memorandum (up to two pages) of analysis and recommendations. Group work is encouraged, but not required on these short memoranda. Memoranda with up to three names on them are acceptable. We will use journal articles and some lectures to supplement and enhance the case discussions. All required cases and supplementary readings will be posted online in Canvas.

Pre-assignment: Students are responsible for a memorandum for each case we discuss in the first class. The first class assignment is detailed in Canvas. All students (including those who are not registered, but are trying to add the course) must attend and prepare the first week. **Students who do not attend the first week cannot take the course.**

PREREQUISITES

At least one of Business 35200, 35201, 35902, 34106 or 30130: strict (or with permission of instructor). Instructor permission required for auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

Based on class participation (40%), the short memoranda (10%), and a final exam (50%). Cannot be taken pass/fail. No non-Booth students. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 16 2026

ENTREPRENEURIAL FINANCE AND PRIVATE EQUITY (34101) - **FASANO, JIM>>**

CONTENT

This course uses the case method to study entrepreneurial and private equity finance. Private equity in all its forms has become a meaningful and growing component of the global economy. On the supply side, the amount of private equity under management - by partnerships investing in venture capital, growth equity, leveraged buyouts, distressed companies, etc. - has increased substantially in the last two decades. On the demand side, a large number of

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34101-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

MBAs and others are interested in starting and managing their own businesses.

The primary objective of the course is to provide an understanding of the concepts and institutions involved in entrepreneurial finance and private equity markets. To do this, the course has been designed to be broad and comprehensive. We will explore private equity from a number of perspectives, beginning with the entrepreneur/issuer, moving to private equity - venture capital, growth equity and leveraged buyout - partnerships, and finishing with investors in private equity partnerships.

For each class meeting, study questions will be assigned concerning a case study. We will discuss these questions and the material in the case for most of the class period. Before each case discussion, each student will be required to submit a memorandum (up to two pages) of analysis and recommendations. Group work is encouraged, but not required on these short memoranda. Memoranda with up to three names on them are acceptable. We will use journal articles and some lectures to supplement and enhance the case discussions. All required cases and supplementary readings will be posted online in Canvas.

Pre-assignment: Students are responsible for a memorandum for each case we discuss in the first class. The first class assignment is detailed in Canvas. All students (including those who are not registered, but are trying to add the course) must attend and prepare the first week.

PREREQUISITES

At least one of Business 35200, 35201, 35902, or 30130: strict (or with permission of instructor). Instructor permission required for auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

Exact split to be confirmed, but will be based on a combination of class participation, the short memoranda, a final exam, and possibly a mid-term. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Spring 2026
Section: 34101-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Booth 455
132
In-Person Only

ENTREPRENEURIAL FINANCE AND PRIVATE EQUITY (34101) - KAPLAN, STEVEN>>>

CONTENT

This course uses the case method to study entrepreneurial and private equity finance. Private equity in all its forms has become a meaningful and growing component of the global economy. On the supply side, the amount of private equity under management - by partnerships investing in venture capital, growth equity, leveraged buyouts, distressed companies, etc. - has increased substantially in the last two decades. On the demand side, a large number of MBAs and others are interested in becoming investors in various private equity funds as well as starting and managing their own businesses.

The primary objective of the course is to provide an understanding of the concepts and institutions involved in entrepreneurial finance and private equity markets. To do this, the course has been designed to be broad and comprehensive. We will explore private equity from a number of perspectives, beginning with the entrepreneur/issuer, moving to private equity - venture capital, growth equity and leveraged buyout - partnerships, and finishing with investors in private equity partnerships.

For each class meeting, study questions will be assigned concerning a case study. We will discuss these questions and the material in the case for most of the class period. Before each case discussion, each student will be required to submit a memorandum (up to two pages) of analysis and recommendations. Group work is encouraged, but not required on these short memoranda. Memoranda with up to three names on them are acceptable. We will use journal articles and some lectures to supplement and enhance the case discussions. All required cases and supplementary readings will be posted online in Canvas.

Pre-assignment: Students are responsible for a memorandum for each case we discuss in the first class. The first class assignment is detailed in Canvas. All students (including those who are not registered, but are trying to add the course) must attend and prepare the first week. **Students who do not attend the first week cannot take the course.**

PREREQUISITES

At least one of Business 35200, 35201, 35902, 34106 or 30130: strict (or with permission of instructor). Instructor permission required for auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

Based on class participation (40%), the short memoranda (10%), and a final exam (50%). Cannot be taken pass/fail. No non-Booth students. No auditors.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34101-01
MW 10:10 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 34101-02
MW 1:30 PM-2:50 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 11 2025

ENTREPRENEURIAL FINANCE AND PRIVATE EQUITY (34101) - MEADOW, SCOTT>>

CONTENT

Using the case method and an array of guest lecturers to supplement the casework, this course is meant to aid those students who are considering being part of an entrepreneurial enterprise or evaluating such enterprises from the seat of the public or private financier.

The chief objective of the course is to provide an understanding of the criteria for a successful entrepreneurial endeavor and the methods of analysis to make the proper judgment. The casework will consider ventures representing broad sectors of the economy, including telecommunications, healthcare and consumer services. These sectors will be used to examine entrepreneurial activity and analysis. The impact of the Internet / social media as an enhancement to these sectors will be interwoven throughout.

The class analyzes the role of various functional areas e.g., finance, marketing, and strategy, toward achieving success in new ventures.

Daily discussions will cover issues of private equity finance from seed stage through growth equity to recapitalization. Deal structure, incentive design, risk-based valuation, financial management in private, rapidly growing enterprises will be included. Exit strategies will be covered, including initial public offerings, mergers and strategic partnerships. Restructuring poorly performing projects will also be a component.

Attention is also given to analyzing the suppliers of capital, individual investors, venture capitalists, commercial banks, asset-based lenders and investment banks.

Before each class, students will be required to submit an executive summary that includes analysis and recommendations. Group work is encouraged, but not required on these executive summaries. Memoranda with up to five team member names on them are acceptable. We will discuss the study questions and the material in each class period.

Preassignment: Students are responsible for a memorandum for each case we discuss in the first class. The first class assignment is detailed on the Canvas site.

Also, please note that attendance for all nine weeks of the course is very important for your success and for other students' success in this team-based

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34101-01
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 34101-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

Summer 2026
Section: 34101-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

course. If you are hoping to register for this course but have not yet secured a seat, you must attend class sessions as it is prohibitive to catch up. If you have not attended and register after the start of the quarter, you will be asked to drop the course.

PREREQUISITES

None. Business 33001 and 35200 recommended. Business 30130 would be helpful.

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Based on class participation (10%), the short memorandum (15%), midterm (30%) and final project (45%). The final project is a take home case analysis. Cannot be taken pass/fail. Auditors need to receive approval from the professor.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: May 07 2026

NEW VENTURE STRATEGY (34102) - **BACON, JEREMIE>>**

CONTENT

New Venture Strategy: *How to Judge Ideas and Build Great Companies*

This course is for students who want to become expert decision-makers in the uncertain, high-stakes world of entrepreneurship and growth-stage company building. Whether you plan to participate in Booth's New Venture Challenge, launch a startup, join and lead an early-stage company, become a venture capitalist, investment banker, or consultant, or just want to sharpen your strategic thinking skills, this course will change how you see new ideas—and yourself.

At the heart of the class are nine battle-tested and tried-and-true strategy models and the Four Basic Questions that help you quickly and confidently

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34102-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

assess whether any new venture is worth pursuing. You'll learn how to tell the difference between a business that sounds good and one that actually works, and how to go about building the latter.

We'll dive into historical and contemporary case studies, debate what went wrong (or brilliantly right), and apply our frameworks through written memos, in-class exercises, and a final venture proposal you'll build with a team of your peers. Along the way, we'll dissect startups, carve-outs, roll-ups, and venture-backed plays with the same critical lens.

This class isn't about evangelizing entrepreneurship. It's about mastering the judgment, discipline, and creative clarity that help great entrepreneurs succeed.

By the end of the course, you'll be able to:

- Evaluate any new venture idea with clear strategic insight
- Design a business with a defensible and compelling value proposition
- Assess the risk and return of a venture for founders and investors
- Present and defend your ideas like a strategist, not a salesperson

MATERIALS

Course cases and readings in Canvas, along with current articles from the *Wall Street Journal* and other contemporary sources.

GRADES

Based on quality of class participation; weekly written work completed individually and/or in groups; and a group presentation of an original business venture.

Provisional grades will be available for those graduating. No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 07 2025

NEW VENTURE STRATEGY (34102) - **BUNCH, GREGORY>>**

CONTENT

"The world needs more entrepreneurs!" This course is a rigorous, decision-making simulator for aspiring entrepreneurs and early-stage investors. We move beyond tactical iteration to focus on the foundational strategic choices that determine whether a pre-revenue, pre-product startup is built to win. The class is explicitly designed to prepare students for launching a new venture (including the Polsky New Venture Challenge, NVC) and for competitive internships and full-time roles in venture capital.

Our methodology is built on a dual-track approach. In every session, we will spend half our time in the Founder's Playbook, learning to build a defensible venture, and the other half in the Investor's Playbook, learning to analyze and make bets on those ventures.

By synthesizing reality-tested frameworks (examples, POP!, 8 Strategy Models, Aulet's 24 Steps) with the realities of the 2025 new venture landscape, you will develop a repeatable process for assessing opportunities, crafting strategy, and communicating it with the clarity and conviction required to raise capital and build a high-growth business.

PREREQUISITES

No-Non Booth Students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Course readings in Canvas, and current articles from the *Wall Street Journal* and other sources.

Bill Aulet, Disciplined Entrepreneurship

GRADES

Based on quality of class participation; weekly written work completed individually; and group presentation of original business start-up ideas.

Auditors permitted only in their last quarter of Chicago Booth residency, limited to room capacity, and must have written approval from the instructor to attend.

Provisional grades will be available for those graduating. No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34102-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 34102-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34102-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: September 03 2025

NEW VENTURE STRATEGY (34102) - SCHRAGER, JAMES>>

CONTENT

This course builds non-mathematical models of success in the world of entrepreneurial business through intensive analyses of both archival and current cases. Students are required to analyze assigned cases carefully, develop and discuss current cases, and present a well-developed new business proposal to the class.

Emphasis is placed on creating a framework to analyze business opportunities of all sizes. The centerpiece is a set of models abstracted from the cases prepared during the course. These models allow students to categorize ideas quickly, discuss benefits, note problems, and ideally, predict performance.

The class is not a series of "nuts and bolts" lectures about running small businesses, nor is it a guest lecture series. Participants must be willing to become involved with the material and approach the topic with analytic rigor. From that effort, an organized way of thinking should evolve that will allow students to make better decisions on potential new venture proposals.

Please note that rescheduled class sessions will be required to allow for presentation of group projects to the class. See the Curriculum web page on the Chicago Booth Portal for details which vary by quarter regarding when these special sessions will be held.

PREREQUISITES

Non-Booth students are welcome, but require instructor consent.

MATERIALS

Electronic case materials posted on Canvas and current articles from the *Wall Street Journal*.

GRADES

Based on quality of in-class participation; weekly written case work completed in study groups (each paper limited to two pages); an individual case about a real entrepreneur (also limited to two pages); and study group presentations of original business start-up ideas.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34102-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Winter 2026
Section: 34102-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Summer 2026
Section: 34102-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Provisional grades will be available for those graduating.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: May 06 2026

BUILDING THE NEW VENTURE (34103) - [BREUER, ALE>>](#)

CONTENT

Course Description

This course is intended for students who are interested in learning about what it takes to start a new entrepreneurial business in an AI-native world. It is a tactical and hands-on class that covers the nuts and bolts of starting a company. Course material is organized around the milestones and phases that entrepreneurs must complete in pursuit of building their business. Students will learn how to raise capital, compensate for limited human and financial resources, secure a strong niche position, determine appropriate sourcing and sales channels, and develop execution plans in sales, marketing, and product development. The course also covers the human side of startups including, cofounder dynamics, how to think about equity splits, entrepreneurial resilience, and the entrepreneurial mindset. The emphasis is managerial and entrepreneurial, essentially a working model for starting a business.

Paralleling the course content is the YourCo assignment in which teams of four to five students simulate building a new venture through the first 18 months of the life of a startup. The majority of the course content focuses on the execution of building a new venture: the early launch, proof-of-concept, and traction phases of a new venture. Please note that this course does not focus on the ideation stage as students are expected to come to Class 1 with a startup idea or join a team with an idea. At the beginning of the class and as part of the YourCo exercise, teams describe a product or service they would like to bring to market and throughout the quarter, students explore the critical activities required to engage customers, build their product or service, and grow teams. Each week, teams have specific written deliverables for their "company" based on the course material. The course content and structure is applicable to all types of businesses, whether B2B, B2C or deep technology based on fundamental scientific research. YourCo projects range from software and digital solutions, to consumer products, to services, to industrial applications and beyond.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34103-01
W 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

AI is fundamentally changing how ventures are built, enabling founders and teams to move faster, test ideas more efficiently, and build products with fewer resources. As such, the use of AI tools is encouraged throughout this course. As part of the YourCo assignment and class discussions, students will explore how AI can be used to accelerate customer discovery, refine positioning and messaging, develop investor pitch materials, and support decision-making. Please note that students are expected to use AI responsibly and thoughtfully, applying their own judgment, critical thinking, and domain insight when evaluating and refining AI-generated outputs.

Students will have the unique opportunity to engage with distinguished guest entrepreneurs and investors who will share their firsthand experiences in building and scaling businesses. These guest speakers bring real-world insights, offering perspectives that complement and enrich the course material. By interacting with successful founders and industry leaders, students will gain a deeper understanding of the challenges, opportunities, and decision-making processes that shape entrepreneurial ventures. These sessions provide a rare chance to ask questions, seek mentorship, and build connections with seasoned professionals. Historically, students have found this component of the course to be immensely valuable, as it brings theoretical concepts to life in a way that no textbook or lecture alone can.

Students will also have the opportunity to practice the art of fundraising in a supportive environment designed for learning and growth. Students will refine their storytelling, articulate their value proposition, and present their venture to investors and experienced entrepreneurs, receiving direct feedback on both their business model and their pitch delivery.

Through class lectures, YourCo assignments, real-world cases, and guest fireside chats, the course covers the multidimensional aspects of entrepreneurship as both a mindset and a process that can be practiced and improved.

NOTE: WEEK 1 CLASS ATTENDANCE IS MANDATORY. IF YOU ARE CONSIDERING ADDING THE COURSE BUT DO NOT YET HAVE A SEAT, YOU MUST ATTEND THE FIRST CLASS IN ORDER TO REGISTER DURING DROP/ADD. PLEASE EMAIL ME IF YOU AREN'T YET REGISTERED BUT WANT TO ATTEND CLASS 1.

PREREQUISITES

Students must attend Class 1. Cannot enroll in BUSN 34103 if BUSN 20330 taken previously.

GRADES

40% YourCo. Assignments, Class Presentation, Pitch (group work)

30% Class Participation

15% Case Reflection Submissions (2 submissions done individually)

5% Resume of Failure (done individually)

10% Final (done individually, due week 10)

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 18 2026

BUILDING THE NEW VENTURE (34103) - CASEY, BOB>> ; ELNICK, THOMAS>>

CONTENT

This course is intended for students who are interested in starting new entrepreneurial businesses. It is a tactical and hands-on class that covers the nuts and bolts of starting a company, with a lesser emphasis on investing in entrepreneurial ventures. Course material is organized around the milestones and phases that entrepreneurs must complete in pursuit of building their business. Students will learn how to identify worthy problems to solve, how to go about testing and validating business hypotheses, getting to a minimal viable product, learning the viability of businesses, raising seed funding, when to bootstrap, hiring early employees, importance of culture, selling your first customers and standing up a predictable GTM motion, and the "secret truths" of building and scaling large, successful businesses. The emphasis is managerial and entrepreneurial, essentially a working model for starting an enterprise.

Paralleling the course content is the YourCo project in which teams of four to five students simulate building a new venture. Although this course touches on topics relevant to a venture in the growth/scaling phase, the majority of course content focuses on the early launch, proof-of-concept, and traction phases of a new venture. At the beginning of the class, teams describe a product or service they would like to bring to market, determine the necessary seed funding amount, and outline current staffing and development status. Throughout the quarter, students explore the critical activities required to engage customers, build their product or service, scale operations and build teams. Each week, teams have specific written deliverables for their YourCo based on the course material. Assignments include customer discovery, product validation, choosing an initial target customer, building the unit economics of the business, selling to prospects, hiring employees, and creating a pitch deck. The culmination of YourCo comes in the last class where each team will pitch and present their semester's long work in front of world-class early stage investors who will give real feedback to each team. The course content and structure is applicable to all types of businesses, whether B2B or B2C. Class projects range from software and digital solutions, to consumer products, to services, to industrial applications.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34103-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Cases will be used to illustrate the challenges that entrepreneurs face when building their companies, and are written specifically for this class to illustrate and reinforce course content each week. Through these case discussions, students will put themselves in the shoes of the entrepreneur and analyze how to navigate difficult circumstances under extreme resource constraints. You will be expected to come prepared each class having read the case materials

Guest entrepreneurs will also be used frequently to reinforce course and case materials in in-depth, real world examples. Guest entrepreneurs will talk about their journeys, take questions from students, and be available to teams and individuals at the end of class to be a resource. Please reference the syllabus for confirmed guest entrepreneurs this semester.

NOTE: WEEK 1 CLASS ATTENDANCE IS MANDATORY. IF YOU ARE CONSIDERING ADDING THE COURSE BUT DO NOT YET HAVE A SEAT, YOU MUST ATTEND THE FIRST CLASS IN ORDER TO REGISTER DURING DROP/ADD.

PREREQUISITES

Students from other divisions can enroll during Non-Booth registration period. STUDENTS MUST ATTEND WEEK 1 OF CLASS AND CANNOT ADD THE CLASS IF THEY HAVE NOT ATTENDED THE 1ST CLASS SESSION. Cannot enroll in BUSN 34103 if BUSN 20330 taken previously.

GRADES

30% YourCo. Assignments & Pitch (team work)

20% Class participation

10% Peer Review

10% Case write-up (1 done individually, your choice)

30% Final paper (done individually, due week 10)

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 13 2026

BUILDING THE NEW VENTURE (34103) - ELNICK, THOMAS>> ; MAYEKAR, SAMIR>>

CONTENT

This course is intended for students who are interested in starting new entrepreneurial businesses. It is a tactical and hands-on class that covers the nuts and bolts of starting a company, with a lesser emphasis on investing in entrepreneurial ventures. Course material is organized around the milestones and phases that entrepreneurs must complete in pursuit of building their business. Students will learn how to raise seed funding, compensate for limited human and financial resources, establish brand values and positioning, secure a strong niche position, determine appropriate sourcing and sales channels, and develop execution plans in sales, marketing, product development and operations. The emphasis is managerial and entrepreneurial, essentially a working model for starting an enterprise.

Paralleling the course content is the YourCo "game" in which teams of four to five students simulate building a new venture through the first 18 months of the life of a startup. At the beginning of the class, teams describe a product or service they would like to bring to market, determine the necessary seed funding amount, and outline current staffing and development status. Throughout the quarter, students explore the critical activities required to engage customers, build their product or service, scale operations and build teams. Each week, teams have specific written deliverables for their "company" based on the course material. Assignments include identifying key hires, choosing an initial target customer, executing a marketing campaign, executing a sales process to acquire customers, identifying important strategic partners, and determining next round funding requirements. "Game" points are awarded based on feasibility of actions, creativity of solutions, and adherence to seed budget constraints. The course content and structure is applicable to all types of businesses, whether B2B or B2C. Class projects range from software and digital solutions, to consumer products, to services, to industrial applications.

Cases are also used to illustrate the challenges that entrepreneurs face when building their companies, and are written specifically for this class to illustrate and reinforce course content each week. Through these case discussions, students will put themselves in the shoes of the entrepreneur and analyze how to navigate difficult circumstances under extreme resource constraints.

Through class lectures, "game" assignments, and real world cases, the course covers such topics as building a start-up management team; identifying target customers; inexpensive promotion/advertising techniques; professionalizing a sales process; hiring initial employees, and leveraging strategic partners. Emphasis is placed on marketing and sales for new enterprises, because this is a major area of entrepreneurial weakness.

NOTE: WEEK 1 CLASS ATTENDANCE IS MANDATORY. IF YOU ARE CONSIDERING ADDING THE COURSE BUT DO NOT YET HAVE A SEAT, YOU MUST ATTEND THE FIRST CLASS IN ORDER TO REGISTER DURING DROP/ADD.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34103-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Undergraduate and grad students from other divisions can enroll during Non-Booth registration period. STUDENTS MUST ATTEND WEEK 1 OF CLASS AND CANNOT ADD THE CLASS IF THEY HAVE NOT ATTENDED THE 1ST CLASS SESSION. Cannot enroll in BUSN 34103 if BUSN 20330 taken previously.

GRADES

Based on "game" assignments, case analysis and active class participation.

50% YourCo. Game (team work)

20% Case write-ups (individual work)

10% Final paper (individual work)

10% Team member evaluation

10% Class participation (modifications will be made for online students)

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 10 2025

BUILDING THE NEW VENTURE (34103) - FRIED, JENNIFER>>

CONTENT

This course is intended for students who are interested in starting new entrepreneurial businesses. It is a tactical and hands-on class that covers the nuts and bolts of starting a company, with a lesser emphasis on investing in entrepreneurial ventures. Course material is organized around the milestones and phases that entrepreneurs must complete in pursuit of building their business. Students will learn how to raise seed funding, compensate for limited human and financial resources, establish brand values and positioning, secure a strong niche position, determine appropriate sourcing and sales channels, and develop execution plans in sales, marketing, product development and operations. The emphasis is managerial and entrepreneurial, essentially a working model for starting an enterprise.

Paralleling the course content is the YourCo "game" in which teams of four to five students simulate building a new venture through the first 18 months of the life of a startup. At the beginning of the class, teams describe a product or service they would like to bring to market, determine the necessary seed funding amount, and outline current staffing and development status. Throughout the quarter, students explore the critical activities required to engage customers, build their product or service, scale operations and build teams. Each week, teams have specific written deliverables for their "company" based on the course material. Assignments include identifying key hires, choosing an initial target customer, executing a marketing campaign, executing a sales process to acquire customers, identifying important strategic partners, and determining next round funding requirements. "Game" points are awarded based on feasibility of actions, creativity of solutions, and adherence to seed budget constraints. The course content and structure is applicable to

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34103-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

all types of businesses, whether B2B or B2C. Class projects range from software and digital solutions, to consumer products, to services, to industrial applications.

Cases are also used to illustrate the challenges that entrepreneurs face when building their companies, and are written specifically for this class to illustrate and reinforce course content each week. Through these case discussions, students will put themselves in the shoes of the entrepreneur and analyze how to navigate difficult circumstances under extreme resource constraints.

Through class lectures, "game" assignments, and real world cases, the course covers such topics as building a start-up management team; identifying target customers; inexpensive promotion/advertising techniques; professionalizing a sales process; hiring initial employees, and leveraging strategic partners. Emphasis is placed on marketing and sales for new enterprises, because this is a major area of entrepreneurial weakness.

NOTE: WEEK 1 CLASS ATTENDANCE IS MANDATORY. IF YOU ARE CONSIDERING ADDING THE COURSE BUT DO NOT YET HAVE A SEAT, YOU MUST ATTEND THE FIRST CLASS IN ORDER TO REGISTER DURING DROP/ADD. PLEASE EMAIL ME FOR ZOOM LOGIN INFORMATION IF YOU AREN'T YET REGISTERED BUT WANT TO ATTEND CLASS 1.

PREREQUISITES

Grad students only. No undergrads. Grad students from other divisions can enroll during Non-Booth registration period. STUDENTS MUST ATTEND WEEK 1 OF CLASS AND CANNOT ADD THE CLASS IF THEY HAVE NOT ATTENDED THE 1ST CLASS SESSION. Cannot enroll in BUSN 34103 if BUSN 20330 taken previously.

GRADES

Based on "game" assignments, case analysis and active class participation.

50% YourCo. Game (team work)

20% Case write-ups (individual work)

10% Final paper (individual work)

10% Team member evaluation

10% Class participation (modifications will be made for online students)

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 01 2025

BUILDING THE NEW VENTURE (34103) - METCALF, SCOTT>>

CONTENT

This course is intended for students who are interested in starting new entrepreneurial businesses. It is tactical, hands-on, and covers the nuts and bolts of starting a company with a lesser emphasis on investing in entrepreneurial ventures. Students will learn how to identify a value proposition, compensate for limited human and financial resources, establish brand values and positioning, secure a strong niche position, determine appropriate sourcing and sales channels, and develop execution plans in sales, marketing, product development and operations. The emphasis is managerial and entrepreneurial, essentially a working model for starting an enterprise. Paralleling the course content is the YourCo "game" in which teams of four to five students simulate building a new venture through the first 18 months of the life of a startup.

Although this course touches on topics relevant to a venture in the growth/scaling phase, the majority of course content focuses on the early launch, proof-of-concept, and traction phases of a new venture. At the beginning of the class and as part of the YourCo exercise, teams describe a product or service they would like to bring to market, determine the necessary seed funding amount, and outline current staffing and development status.

Throughout the quarter, students explore the critical activities required to engage customers, build their product or service, scale operations and build teams. Each week, teams have specific written deliverables for their "company" based on the course material. Assignments include identifying key hires, choosing an initial target customer set, executing a marketing campaign, creating a sales pitch, completing a development or production plan, identifying important strategic partners, and determining next round funding requirements. Assignments are graded based on feasibility of actions, creativity of solutions, and adherence to seed budget constraints.

The course content and structure is applicable to all types of businesses, whether B2B, B2C or deep technology based on fundamental scientific research. Class YourCo projects range from software and digital solutions, to consumer products, to services, to industrial applications and beyond.

Through class lectures, discussion of assignments, guest speakers, and real-world cases, the course covers such topics as: building a startup management team; raising early-stage funding, identifying target customers; acquiring customers; professionalizing a sales process; hiring initial employees; and leveraging strategic partners. Emphasis is placed on marketing and sales for new enterprises as well as leadership skills because these are areas of entrepreneurial weakness.

The final assignment is a funding pitch to a group of judges with investing experience. The pitch and the Q&A with the judges is modeled on the funding pitch structure of the New Venture Challenge class.

Each class will include a group discussion of a funding pitch and investment potential of a startup currently pursuing seed or series A funding.

The focus of the class is from the perspective of startup founders. However students will have opportunities for business evaluation and discussion from the perspective of an investor and an advisor. The final paper for the class is a

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34103-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

reflection of the student's current interests in startups and entrepreneurship. The purpose is to think critically about one's personality, interests and other considerations when considering building a business.

NOTE: WEEK 1 CLASS ATTENDANCE IS MANDATORY. IF YOU ARE CONSIDERING ADDING THE COURSE BUT DO NOT YET HAVE A SEAT, YOU MUST ATTEND THE FIRST CLASS IN ORDER TO REGISTER DURING DROP/ADD. PLEASE EMAIL ME FOR ZOOM LOGIN INFORMATION IF YOU AREN'T YET REGISTERED BUT WANT TO ATTEND CLASS 1.

PREREQUISITES

Undergraduate and grad students from other divisions can enroll during Non-Booth registration period. STUDENTS MUST ATTEND WEEK 1 OF CLASS AND CANNOT ADD THE CLASS IF THEY HAVE NOT ATTENDED THE 1ST CLASS SESSION. Cannot enroll in BUSN 34103 if BUSN 20330 taken previously.

GRADES

Based on "game" assignments, case analysis and active class participation.

40% YourCo. assignments (team work)

20% Case write-ups (individual work)

20% Final paper (individual work)

5% Class assignments

5% Team member evaluation

10% Class participation

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 18 2025

SPECIAL TOPICS IN ENTREPRENEURSHIP: DEVELOPING A NEW VENTURE (NEW VENTURE CHALLENGE) (34104) - [KAPLAN, STEVEN>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

This course is designed to allow students who have advanced to the second round of the New Venture Challenge to develop their ideas into businesses. Student teams will work largely on their own to develop their businesses.

The class meetings consist primarily of business presentations. Venture capitalists, private investors, and entrepreneurs will help critique and improve the ideas and businesses during the presentations. The class meetings also will include sessions on presentation skills, financial modeling, and legal considerations in a new venture.

Spring 2026
Section: 34104-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Advancement to the second round of the New Venture Challenge or (in rare circumstances) consent of the instructor: strict. Students should contact the instructor before the course begins. Grad students from other divisions can enroll during Non-Booth registration period. Auditors require instructor permission.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite Application-based course

GRADES

Based 70% on the quality of the work that goes into the business plan and 30% on class participation. No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 02 2026

SPECIAL TOPICS IN ENTREPRENEURSHIP: DEVELOPING A NEW VENTURE (NEW VENTURE CHALLENGE) (34104) - [TEBBE, MARK>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is designed to allow students who have advanced to the second round of the New Venture Challenge to develop their ideas into full business plans. Student teams will work largely on their own to develop their business

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34104-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM

plans and are encouraged to meet individually with the class coaches and faculty.

The class meetings consist primarily of plan presentations. Venture capitalists, private investors, and entrepreneurs will also help critique and improve the plans during the presentations. The class sessions also will include workshops on the legal considerations of a new venture, developing marketing and sales plans, developing financial projections and presentation skills.

Preassignment: An orientation meeting for all teams that have advanced to the second round of the New Venture Challenge will be held during winter quarter. Students should come to this meeting ready to present an elevator pitch of their ideas. Students will also be required to present their business model during the first weeks of class.

Gleacher Center
200
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Advancement to the second round of the New Venture Challenge or (in rare circumstances) consent of the instructor: strict. Students should contact the instructor before the course begins.

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Grading will be based 80% on the progress of the business model during the quarter, the quality of the work on the business plan and the quality of the in-class presentations and 20% on class participation and meetings with coaches/faculty throughout the quarter. Cannot be taken pass/fail. For joint degree students, college students and other non-Booth students, can provide provisional and early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 23 2025

COMMERCIALIZING INNOVATION: TOOLS TO RESEARCH AND ANALYZE PRIVATE ENTERPRISES (34106) - [MEADOW, SCOTT>>](#)

CONTENT

Commercializing Innovation delivers useful “cross-training” to students interested in starting, leading or investing in entrepreneurial enterprises. Throughout the quarter, students learn how to effectively evaluate and communicate the fundamentals of novel business opportunities. More than a collection of tools and frameworks, this course teaches a comprehensive approach that can be efficiently applied across a broad range of businesses. This approach is built (and tested) incrementally over time using a mixture of case discussions, guest lectures, and hands-on assignments.

This course requires a high level of individual investment, group coordination, and professionalism. Students form teams at the beginning of the course and, each week, these teams evaluate new venture opportunities. These weekly group assignments require students to look beyond the modest case materials provided. Students are expected to use primary research (i.e. expert interviews) and secondary research (i.e. published sources) to study the industry and enterprise-level characteristics of the business. Early in the course, students will learn how to distill a new business concept down to its economic drivers, and how to model those economics effectively. In addition, each week two teams are assigned to deliver a presentation on the new ventures under evaluation, and to respond to class questions simulating how entrepreneurs would respond to prospective investors in a professional setting. Through their presentations, teams solidify their mastery of the topic and strengthen their communication skills, while the rest of the class hones critical listening skills and diplomacy.

The case studies used in this course are real investment opportunities, many of which the professor has been involved with as an investor or advisor. The cases cover a broad range of industries including retail, healthcare, energy, hospitality, consumer products, and consumer services. New cases and regular guest speakers from the venture community keep the course material relevant.

Class discussions will cover foundational analysis, as well as the use of market research in the entrepreneurial environment, "how to" build management, utilization of analogs to develop the economic profile of emerging companies, staging and structure of financing over the life of the enterprise, and modification through analysis of the tactics and strategy of functional disciplines when projected outcomes are not achieved and the resulting ramifications on cash usage.

For further information on the course outline, course expectations, and other useful information, please refer to the course syllabus.

Also, please note that attendance for all nine weeks of the course is very important for your success and for other students' success in this team-based course. If you are hoping to register for this course but have not yet secured a seat, you must attend class sessions as it is prohibitive to catch up. If you have not attended and register after the start of the quarter, you will be asked to drop the course.

PREREQUISITES

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34106-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 34106-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34106-01
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34106-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

None. Business 30130, 33001, 34101, 34102, 35200 might be helpful, but are not necessary or required. No MiM/MiF

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Copyrighted items and supplementary materials distributed on the Canvas course site.

GRADES

Based on class participation, including a team presentation (30%), weekly assignments/memorandum (10%), class participation (20%) and final project (40%). The final project is a take-home case analysis, also done in teams. Cannot be taken pass/fail. Auditors need to receive approval from the professor.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 20 2026

INNOVATION LEADERSHIP (34108) - [JANEGA, JAMES>>](#)

CONTENT

Course Introduction

Business leaders must contend with the rise of AI, geopolitical turbulence, and fast-shifting buyer expectations that require them to create new offerings and adapt faster than traditional business frameworks can adjust.

To develop a competitive edge in their industry and career, business leaders also must understand innovation fundamentals. They must develop the ability to anticipate customer needs as they emerge and evolve, and to develop those insights into new products, services, and processes at a new or existing venture before their competitors -- and with fewer missteps.

Traditional approaches to leadership and problem-solving struggle to keep pace in the current environment, leaving organizations stuck in reactive cycles. Internal innovation efforts often get derailed by risk aversion, siloed thinking, and a lack of practical frameworks for success. Outperformers have learned to develop a deeper understanding of what motivates (and irritates) end users, challenge biases in their organizations and themselves, and follow a repeatable and scalable path to new insights and reduced innovation risks.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34108-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34108-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

This course is designed to provide proven frameworks, practical applications, and an emphasis on helping each participant develop the innovative mindsets and skillsets required for innovative problem-solving in organizations big and small.

Through hands-on activities, case studies, and actionable strategies, this course will equip participants with the tools, mindsets, and frameworks to develop meaningfully unique ideas, systematically identify and mitigate the unique risks to each, and build the resulting innovative concepts into competitive advantage. Particular attention will include how to innovate with AI inside an enterprise setting.

You'll learn to:

- Foster a culture of experimentation, risk-taking, and collaboration.
- Empower teams to solve problems creatively and resourcefully.
- Implement practical methods to reduce risk and drive innovation quickly and inexpensively.
- Align innovation efforts with strategic goals to ensure measurable impact.

This course is for leaders and managers who want their core professional skillset to include how to identify and solve unique problems. Participants will learn to develop innovative concepts for products, services, and processes, de-risk them, and foster higher engagement in their teams, accelerate growth, and navigate complexity with confidence.

Course Design

This course explores four skillset themes that are crucial to leading innovation and change in an organization.

• *Theme 1: Discovery and Creation* – You will practice the skills that are required to see the world through a different lens, to identify opportunities and potential sources of disruption, and to create non-obvious solutions to problems. We will explore these skills and practice flexing these muscles through in-class exercises and group homework assignments. Creativity and structured problem-solving will be heavily emphasized throughout the entire class.

• *Theme 2: De-Risking and Execution* – Not knowing how to manage risk is a leading reason why companies kill breakthrough innovation. We will explore why this happens and learn tactical tools you can employ as a leader to manage risk and execute innovation despite the unknowns.

• *Theme 3: Communication and Influence* – Communicating new or complex ideas and bringing others along to support you is crucial to making innovation happen. In this portion of the class we will explore how to employ alternative strategies such as visual communication and storytelling in your pursuit of communicating your ideas and influencing others.

• *Theme 4: Innovation Infrastructure* – This portion of the class will explore operational topics surrounding innovation with a focus on how to develop a sustainable innovation strategy supported by the right capabilities, structure, and culture. We will discuss various organizational and strategic models for executing innovation, and the challenges of execution within established enterprises.

Readings and asynchronous lectures will be assigned prior to each class to introduce content. Classroom time will be spent applying the course concepts through case discussions, in-class activities, and guest speakers. Students will also work in teams on hands-on group assignments throughout the quarter that parallel course content and enable you to apply skills learned in class.

Learning Objectives

This class is designed to build on other business and course skills to make you a more creative and ambidextrous thinker. The objective is to arm you with a toolkit for leading innovation and growth in the context of *high risk, nebulous, and highly uncertain* innovation initiatives. We will cover the foundational principles of user-centered design and prototyping through the context of solving business problems broadly, however traditional product development tools and frameworks are not the focus of the class. Specific learning outcomes of this course include becoming:

- A stronger innovation *practitioner* (greater proficiency of using innovation skills and tools)
- A more effective *manager* of innovation (ability to manage the process and connect the right people/recourses/thinking to make things happen)
- A more inspirational *leader* of innovation (greater ability to think creatively, teach others, and inspire others)

PREREQUISITES

No prerequisites required. No undergraduates. Graduate students from other divisions can enroll during Non-Booth registration period.

1st Class Attendance is mandatory. If you are considering/trying to register for the course, please attend the 1st class even if you aren't yet registered. Only students who attend Class 1 will be allowed to register for the class.

MATERIALS

Assigned readings and materials will be posted to Canvas site prior to start of course. There is no required textbook for this class.

GRADES

50% Team Assignments (final adjusted grade based on peer reviews)

15% Weekly individual Point of View ('POV') submissions

15% Class Participation

10% Final Group Presentation

10% Final Reflection Paper (take home)

- Provisional grades are given subject to timely completion of assignments
- No auditors
- Cannot be taken pass/fail
- No early final grades

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 26 2026

ENTREPRENEURIAL SELLING (34111) - ALTER, MICHAEL>>

CONTENT

Overview

Selling is a life skill. At the core, this is a course in persuasion which is just a fancier word for selling. Persuasion is a skill you need to be good at in anything you do in life....which is why many students without near term plans to start a business have found the course to be immediately useful and impactful in their careers, recruiting, and in all aspects of life.

This course is designed as an adventure of discovery. You will be tested, taught and transformed through a series of interactive discussions, video lectures, and exercises that are designed to push you up and out of your comfort zone.

The biggest challenge to growing a successful entrepreneurial venture is selling. Entrepreneurs must build a strong sales pipeline to ensure profitable growth as they tackle other pressing issues like product development, staffing, infrastructure, and financing. In the Entrepreneurial Selling course, you will learn how to acquire and delight customers, use selling skills in different contexts, tell powerful stories, manage the entrepreneurial selling process, measure your success and use the key tools required for success in building a company. The course will combine the following elements to create a powerful learning experience for you:

•Frameworks that define and clarify the knowledge, skill and discipline to be successful in selling

•Toolkit: A list of key tactical sales tools, which we will build tool-by-tool throughout the course

•Guest Speakers: Real life examples of key class concepts

•Discussion: Based on readings, cases, and your experience, the class will be a dialogue that explores both B2B and B2C selling and entrepreneurship issues and concepts

•Role Plays: Experiential exhibitions to emphasize class concepts. •Assignments: These include a cold outreach, case write-ups, a barter exercise and Sales Toolkit for a start-up or early-stage company, as well as a Sales Meeting with a mock customer

All of these elements will be supported by research into both sales and entrepreneurship.

Overarching Goal

The goal of this course is to make you as efficient and effective in selling (persuasion) as possible, so that when you are spending time selling, not a

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34111-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 34111-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34111-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34111-02
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Summer 2026
Section: 34111-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

moment is wasted. Why? Because as an entrepreneur (and a human), the way you spend your time determines success and failure.

Learning Objectives

You will be able to:

- Understand the key phases of the entrepreneurial selling process, and identify the most common failure points in the process
- Construct a sales toolkit for your venture
- Build a set of sales skills and disciplines that will serve you in any career context (and in life...)

PREREQUISITES

None. Auditors and undergrads need instructor approval: strict. Cannot enroll if 20355 or 34887 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Canvas Site

GRADES

Grading will be based on several factors:

- 35% - Group work – Group project assignment and final “Mock” Sales Presentation/Meeting
- 30% - Individual work
- 35% - Class participation

Provisional grades are given for graduating students.

The course may be taken pass/fail, and also it may be audited with instructor approval.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 01 2026

IMPACT INVESTING (34113) - [PARRISH, PRIYA>>](#)

CONTENT

Impact investing plays an expanding role in deploying financial resources to address social problems through market-based interventions. Impact investing

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34113-01

includes both “non-concessionary” or “market-rate” investments that target risk-adjusted market-rate returns and “impact-first” or “catalytic” investments that anticipate lower than market returns.

Impact investing presents several intellectually interesting and practically important issues. Learning the strategies and mechanics of impact investing provide an opportunity to apply frameworks from corporate finance, microeconomics, and strategy to an interesting and rapidly evolving sector. There are rich questions about the market for impact investors -- who they are, how to market to them, and how to structure funds to attract them. We will study the “impact” of impact investing, as well as the financial returns and risks of such investments.

Students will work in teams of four to six to develop and pitch an impact investment fund. Group assignments will help each team identify opportunity drivers and a thesis, an investment strategy, an impact management and measurement framework, a pipeline of companies, and prospective investors. Each group’s final presentation will be in the form of a presentation to a group of potential investors.

The course also brings practitioners to the classroom, offering candid presentations from leading fund managers pursuing impact strategies within venture capital, real estate, private credit, and private equity. Individual assignments ask students to connect what they heard with the practice of finding deals and constructing appropriate impact metrics. Participation is a significant component of the course, with the expectation that students come prepared to ask questions and contribute insights.

This class complements the existing curriculum in corporate finance and private equity (Corporate Finance, Entrepreneurial Finance and Private Equity, Commercializing Innovation). Consistent with our curricular philosophy in other social enterprise courses, this is not a substitute “social” version of an existing course, but will focus on differences between the social and traditional institutions. Although no individual student needs to have a deep finance background, we will ensure that each team has at least one member with rich knowledge/experience. All students should have some working knowledge of finance and financial institutions.

MATERIALS

Case studies, articles and web sites of impact investing institutions. This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Class participation – 20%
Individual assignments - 25%
Group assignments - 30%
Group project - 25%

No pass/fail grades. For joint degree students, college students and other non-Booth students, can provide provisional and early final grades.

GRADES

TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34113-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 16 2026

NEW SOCIAL VENTURES (34115) - **GERTNER, ROBERT>>**

CONTENT

This course is for students participating in The John Edwardson '72 Social New Venture Challenge. Teams of students will develop an idea for an innovative, startup social organization. They will conduct research to create a detailed plan for its creation and growth and pitch the plan to faculty, social entrepreneurs, domain experts, foundation officers, and philanthropists.

The definition that we will use to determine if an idea belongs in the course is that social organizations are designed, managed and governed to sacrifice profit for mission or to seek funding from investors who are willing to sacrifice returns for mission. Compared to traditional for-profit organizations, such organizations rely in varying degrees on different funding institutions, different governance mechanisms, different ways to measure performance, different marketing, and different HR practices. These organizations may be structured as for-profit or non-profits. Because of these differences in management and the institutional structure supporting them, a distinct curriculum is appropriate, even if the definition excludes many organizations that create substantial social value.

The class will include multiple rounds of pitch presentations with detailed feedback. It will also include several short lectures/discussions, and classroom exercises. Topics will include; evaluating a new social enterprise, financing a social startup, managing a social organization, managing and financing growth and measuring performance and social impact.

We anticipate awarding over \$100,000 in prize money for the most promising social ventures.

Enrollment will be by application.

PREREQUISITES

Application and permission of instructor.

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34115-01
T 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Booth 455
130
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34115-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Booth 455
130
In-Person Only

Application-based course

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Based largely on new social venture plan and presentations. Class participation and constructive input into other groups' projects will also be incorporated. Cannot be taken pass/fail. For joint degree students, college students and other non-Booth students, can provide provisional and early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SOCIAL ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND INNOVATION (34117) - [CONNOR, TODD>>](#) ; [GERTNER, ROBERT>>](#)

CONTENT

The objective of this course is for students to develop and refine an idea for an innovative social venture that they plan to pursue.

Individuals or teams of students will apply for the course with an idea for a social venture or a narrow problem or issue that could lead to a social venture. In the course, students will conduct extensive customer-user-beneficiary (CUB) discovery. In addition, they will research the relevant academic literature, analyze the competitive landscape, validate and refine the product/service, develop a business model and financial model, articulate the venture's underlying theory of change, identify an impact measurement/management strategy, and develop a plan to execute on their venture model.

The purpose of the research process is to address the critical uncertainties of entrepreneurial ventures – namely, can the problem be validated by the target users, customers, beneficiaries, and, is the proposed venture the best solution to address this problem. Determining the best business model for a social venture can be very challenging. Social entrepreneurs must address the likely

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34117-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

source of funding, whether or how much to charge beneficiaries, other revenue streams, identify initial target beneficiaries, and often work within complex private, public, and nonprofit value networks.

Much of class time will be devoted to group exercises to implement frameworks to answer these questions for the students' venture ideas as well as a set of case study examples we will use throughout the course.

In addition, there will be occasional class discussions on the role of social entrepreneurship for developing and scaling innovative solutions to society's problems and alternative pathways for social innovation.

This class is a key component of the Rustandy Center for Social Sector Innovation's Social Venture Studio program. Promising ventures coming out of this class will be invited to participate in winter quarter programming at the Rustandy Center which will prepare student-led teams for the John Edwardson '72 Social New Venture Challenge in the upcoming spring quarter or in subsequent years. In the SNVC, teams have the opportunity to build out their ventures, develop and refine a pitch for potential investors/philanthropists, and present their ideas to successful social entrepreneurs and, and potentially receive seed funding to support the launch of the new venture.

Grading will be based on class participation and peer collaboration, a final presentation, and a final meeting with the instructors to review their venture project. There will be no exams.

Interested students should apply via the [online application](#). The initial application deadline for returning students is 5:00pm August 19. Students who apply by this deadline will be notified of application decisions on August 22 before bidding starts. We will continue to accept applications from all students (Booth and non-Booth) through September 19 and will make decisions on a rolling basis (within three business days from submission).

Non-Booth students are encouraged to apply for the course. We expect at least one team member from each venture to enroll in the course. Other team members are welcome to enroll or audit. For non-Booth teams, if degree requirements make it challenging for any student to enroll in the course, we will allow all team members to audit with the understanding that they will complete all work as if they were enrolled.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll if 20920 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

MATERIALS

Notes, articles, and several recommended books. This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Class participation and peer collaboration – 25%, final class presentations - 10%, venture project - 65% No pass/fail grades. For joint degree students,

college students and other non-Booth students, can provide provisional and early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 24 2025

WOMEN AS CEOS, ENTREPRENEURS, INVESTORS, EXECUTIVES & DIRECTORS (34206) - [RAPP, ALYSSA>>](#)

CONTENT

This course will examine the world of entrepreneurship, venture capital, and private equity from the fresh and contemporary lens and perspective of women. The goal of the course is to provide candid insight and purview into the personal and professional lives of leading women entrepreneurs, venture capitalists, and private equity executives, what has helped catapult or has hampered their ability to lead organizations worldwide.

Attention will also be paid to the legal, cultural (e.g. #MeToo) and regulatory dynamics that define the ecosystem of entrepreneurship, venture capital, private equity, and board service, discussing any unique benefits provided to women in this context (e.g. California's recent law mandating equal representative of female Corporate directors.)

Alyssa Rapp serves as the Chief Executive Officer and Director of [Healthwell Acquisition Corp. I](#). Ms. Rapp served as Chief Executive Officer of Surgical Solutions, a B2b healthcare services business providing non-clinical surgical services to hospitals, from 2018-2021. As CEO, Ms. Rapp led a successful turnaround of the enterprise, driving 21% sales growth with 90% customer retention. Ms. Rapp has also served as an independent director of Elevate Women's Health, a portfolio company of Shore Capital Partners, since October 2020. From 2015-2018, Ms. Rapp served as the founder & CEO of Bottlenotes, Inc., a leading interactive media company. Starting in 2015, Ms. Rapp served as the Managing Partner of A JR Ventures, a strategic advisory firm for family offices and private equity firms on market development, digital and e-commerce strategies for select portfolio companies. Ms. Rapp has served as a lecturer-in-management at Stanford University's Graduate School of Business since 2014 and Adjunct Professor of Entrepreneurship at the University of Chicago's Booth Business School since 2019. Ms. Rapp earned a B.A. in Political Science and the History of Art from Yale University in 2000 and an M.B.A. from

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34206-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

Stanford University's Graduate School of Business in 2005. She is the author of Amazon Bestseller, *Leadership and Life Hacks: Insights from a Mom, Wife, Entrepreneur & Executive* (ForbesBooks, October 2019).

PREREQUISITES

None. Undergraduates require instructor permission.

MATERIALS

Alyssa Rapp, *Leadership and Life Hacks*. 2019. ForbesBooks.

Valerie Jarrett, *Finding My Voice*. Viking 2019.

Articles and other materials will be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

- Class Participation (50%): In-class (35%); Written (15%) via class forum
- Mid-Term Paper and Final Projects (50%)

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

OUTPERFORM & OUTLAST: OPERATING AND INVESTING IN CLOSELY HELD BUSINESSES (34208, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [SHAH, JAMIE>>](#)

CONTENT

WHY IS THIS COURSE RELEVANT?

While sometimes overlooked in the broader business context, closely held firms are a dominant force for national (and global) employment, business activity and GDP. Moreover, recent studies have shown that these businesses tend to outperform and outlast their counterparts ([Harvard Business Review, 2012](#)). Admittedly amorphous, the course will begin by exploring the ambiguity of defining closely held businesses. Next, the course will focus on why and how closely held businesses can achieve these extraordinary results so that

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34208-01
MW 8:30 AM-9:50 AM
Harper Center
C08
1st Half: Week 1 - Week 5
50 Unit Course

students can apply these practices to their own careers and families, regardless of the type of business.

In-Person Only

AUDIENCE:

If you are interested or intrigued by the idea of having financial and operational independence in your business and your life, this course is for you. This class is aimed towards students who are interested in exploring alternate paths to independence and entrepreneurship afforded by closely held and family businesses. We will explore the benefits of stewarding a business to preserve and create generational wealth, while also maintaining maximum control over your business and, more importantly, your personal values and life. This course will introduce concepts relevant to investors, owners and operators who are interested in exploring or considering a long term or perpetual hold period perspective, with a focus on creating and maintaining profitability. This class will target students who are intending to manage a closely held business, either their own family's or someone else's, or those who will engage with closely held businesses through consulting, private wealth management, mergers and acquisitions, banking, etc. The course will also be relevant to students who are interested in acquiring a closely held business.

CLASS MODEL / PHILOSOPHY OF THE COURSE:

This course will provide a theoretical and practical understanding of closely held businesses and long term ownership (15+ years). It will draw on concepts gained from other courses (managerial decision making, behavioral / relationship dynamics, tax strategy, and organizational practices and structures) and analyze them within the context of the closely held business and long term ownership.

This course surveys many topics related to closely held businesses and long term ownership. It aims to establish a foundational knowledge that inspires connections to other business courses. The course will mix theory (through cases and assigned readings) with practice (through guest presentations and student participation). Through participation and in-class conversations, the course will provide a forum where students with previous exposure to closely held businesses can share their experiences and best practices. Through these open discussions on potentially difficult topics (sibling rivalry, compensation, corruption, power dynamics, ethical dilemmas, etc.) students will have the opportunity to learn as much from their peers as from their professors, guest speakers and readings.

PREREQUISITES

None, except for preliminary assignment found in Canvas.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

(1) Required reading via course materials (in Canvas)

(2) Lectures notes, templates, additional reading and other reference materials distributed via class website

(3) Notes and assignments handed out in class

GRADES

30% In Class Participation: As the course is meant to create a forum for students and guest practitioners to be able to learn from one another, active and engaged participation is expected and required. Participation will be determined by fellow classmates: At the end of each class, students are required to submit the three most valuable comments (and the speaker of the comment) throughout the day. A link will be available on canvas to submit this information and time at the end of class will be provided. Examples of good participation are making contributions based on the reading, making connections to previous weeks, making connections between students' ideas. I would love to hear from each student at least once per session.

~60% Assignments, comprised of:

~10% Case Assignment

~60% Other Reflection Assignments

~10% Final Project: Details to be announced in class.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: September 22 2025

ENTREPRENEURSHIP IN HEALTHCARE AND LIFE SCIENCES (34210) - [COE, BRIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

Course Description and Learning Objectives:

Entrepreneurship in Healthcare and Life Sciences is designed to teach students to weave together the hard science that underlies research-driven enterprises with the commercial, financial, and strategic elements into business plans required for new venture creation.

As the capstone project for the course, students from Booth, the Physical Sciences Division and the Biological Sciences Division will work collaboratively to create business plans and pitch decks based on intellectual property

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34210-01
M 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

available for license from universities. At the conclusion of the course, their learnings will provide a roadmap for their own entrepreneurial ambitions, and some may have business plans they choose to take forward.

Structurally, in the first three weeks of this course, students will learn and apply business and science frameworks to a challenging life-sciences case. Once the approach is solidified, students will identify intellectual property from universities across the country that they find compelling and then apply the structures they learned to create their own business plans and pitch decks based on the intellectual property they identified. In both the case study and the final project, business, medical and science students will work together in teams to leverage their individual expertise. Many students find this collaboration between business and science to be a highly valuable learning experience. During the course, guest lecturers including entrepreneurs, investors, IP and licensing attorneys will help students construct the roadmap to venture creation.

The specific learning objectives of this course are highlighted below:

- ? A framework to create and evaluate research programs
- ? A framework to create and evaluate research-driven business plans
- ? Business and science students will learn to collaborate across knowledge domains
- ? How to create and evaluate financial models for entrepreneurial, research-driven businesses
- ? The fundamentals of intellectual property and licensing
- ? The creative process and challenges at the earliest stages of research-driven entrepreneurship
- ? Solid foundation for students to begin their entrepreneurial journeys

Course Procedures

It is not necessary for Booth students to have a background in the sciences or for science students to have a background in business. However, the expectation is that each member is an active participant. Peer assessments make a substantial impact on individual grades. Please be sure you can regularly accommodate team meetings outside the classroom and devote the time necessary, roughly 6-8 hours per week. The course is also highly participatory, so attendance is expected. Please arrive before the class starts.

PREREQUISITES

Teams will work together, combining students with scientific/medical/technical backgrounds with those with more traditional business experience. It is not necessary for Booth students to have a background in the sciences or for science students to have a background in business. No undergrads. Non-Booth students must complete poll: strict.

The poll, https://chicagobooth.az1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_5ArxFkTW5Cdjc22, will open August 1st at 9am and will close August 20 at 11:59pm. Students will be notified of selection by August 22. After enrollment, students must obtain faculty permission to drop.

MATERIALS

The primary course materials include an instructor-developed case, publicly available company publications, analyst reports, scientific publications, Pitchbook, UpToDate, SEC filings, expert interviews and intellectual property from universities. Additional learning materials will be provided on Canvas.

GRADES

Grading

- Weekly assignments: 10%
- Class participation 10%
- Week 5 team assignment: 20%
- Peer evaluation: 20%
- Final presentation and business summary: 40%

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 27 2025

VALUE CREATION IN SMALL BUSINESSES (34211) - [CREMONS, DAN>>](#) ; [HODGKIN, ALEX>>](#)

CONTENT

Learn the art and science driving value creation in small businesses. This course equips future operators with battle-tested frameworks and practical tools for driving growth in companies with 10-250 employees. Through real-world case studies and hands-on projects, you'll learn how to pull the key traditional value creation levers: revenue growth, margin expansion, and multiple expansion. Beyond traditional value drivers, you'll learn how to build a winning team, cultivate a high-performance culture, and harness digital transformation to accelerate equity value creation. Perfect for students pursuing careers in private equity operations, entrepreneurship through acquisition (ETA), or growth-oriented management roles.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34211-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
200
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

The foundational text of the course will be **Winning Moves: 105 Proven Ways to Create Value in Private Equity-Backed Companies**, by Dan Cremons. Other supplemental readings are listed in the syllabus.

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 25 2026

USER EXPERIENCE DESIGN FOR INTELLIGENT PRODUCT-SERVICE SYSTEMS (34214, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [SUSANI, MARCO>>](#)

CONTENT

COURSE DESCRIPTION

User Experience Design for Intelligent Product-Service Systems analyses how modern consumer offerings increasingly integrate physical products and digital services to create unified, seamless user experiences across multiple touchpoints.

The course emphasizes the importance of multidisciplinary collaboration between business, technology, and design, and outlines tools and processes to integrate human-driven innovation in small or large organizations.

In class teamwork exercises, students familiarize themselves with tools and frameworks like user personas, experience modeling, trend analysis, system architecture, and scenario-making.

Anticipating how Agentic AI capabilities will become part of these systems, the course engages students in scenario-making exercises, to design innovative, intelligent product-service systems of the future, where AI technology enables effective, pleasurable user experiences, to provide tangible, ethical benefits to users/consumers.

In particular, the course will consider user experiences in 4 domains: health/fitness, urban mobility, self-expression, and entertainment.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34214-01
T 2:00 PM-3:30 PM
Booth 455
140
50-Units: All Weeks
In-Person Only
New Course

LEARNING OUTCOMES

The goal of the course is to envisage future, innovative, intelligent, integrated product-service offerings, and develop an interdisciplinary method to design satisfactory user experiences.

The course addresses competences that can be applied to product managers, tech leaders, and top management.

From this course, students will learn to:

- Understand product/service systems, integrating physical and digital experiences
- Assess the business value of positive, efficient, pleasurable user experiences
- Use tools and processes to develop human-driven innovation
- Integrate multi-disciplinary teams comprising business, engineering and design in small to large organizations
- Envisage future product/service systems based on agentic AI, to enable innovative user experiences

COURSE FORMAT

The course has a hands-on, interdisciplinary, creative format, combining the perspectives of Experience Design, Technology Innovation, and Business Disruption.

The course has a combination of lectures, teamwork in class, and individual homework.

TEAMWORK CLASS PROJECTS

Students will be graded by the faculty at a large percentage on their overall performance on the group projects.

Process and creativity will be balanced. Individual work and teamwork will be evaluated both in the use of tools and processes and in generating inspiring results.

The faculty cares about the quality of your work on the project itself, the way in which you work within a multi-disciplinary group, and the documentation and presentation of your team's work product.

The faculty's primary concern is that all team members have meaningful tasks, and that students deliver on these tasks for the team. First, teams have responsibility to assign tasks to all members, and to make sure everybody is engaged and actively participating. members and determine, on a weekly basis and as a team, whether these tasks were fulfilled, culminating with a brief weekly report submitted to the faculty. Failure to complete tasks appropriately will negatively impact grades. Second, each student will be asked to candidly evaluate your team members.

PREREQUISITES

RESTRICTIONS

GRADES

EVALUATION AND GRADING POLICY

The faculty will follow these percentages in the evaluation:

Individual homework assignments	20%
In-Class Team work participation	40%
Final essay	40%

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 14 2025

STRUCTURING INVESTMENTS AND INVESTING IN STRUCTURE (34215, 50 UNIT COURSE) - **SUSSMAN, JASON>>**

CONTENT

This course will cover key finance and tax topics relating to structured investments, from the transactional level to a portfolio perspective. A key premise of the class is that pattern recognition, fundamental understanding and insights about structuring require a combination of top down and bottom up perspectives across a wide scope of coverage.

Many of the same generic risk/return and tax considerations arise across asset classes, from traded derivatives to structured private equity investments. Similarly, many of these topics recur from the individual position level to fund level to ultimate investor portfolio. This course examines how the same finance concepts (e.g., the characteristics of an option) can be employed in varying contexts and structures, but are taxed differently notwithstanding economic similarities. For example, we trace and measure the interest component of returns through various instruments, and examine how that interest component is taxed differently depending on context and structuring choices.

The goal of the course is for students to develop perspective, intuitions and some technical facility in shaping risk/return through structuring, with awareness of tax considerations and implications for after-tax returns.

The course should be useful to investors, investment advisors, family office executives, investment bankers and finance executives.

Topic areas will include:

1. Use of structure to shape, allocate and underwrite risk/return (attach/detach levels, embedded options and convexity, etc).

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34215-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C08
1st Half: Week 1 - Week 5
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only
New Course

2. Tax considerations in structuring, including differing tax treatment of economically similar instruments, transactions and investment strategies.
3. Fund and portfolio level structuring, GP and LP (taxable and tax-exempt) investor perspectives, including blocker strategies.
4. Incorporating tax attributes and after-tax returns into underwriting and performance measurement, from direct investments to fund investments to portfolio construction.
5. Recent innovations in tax-aware investment strategies and investment products.

PREREQUISITES

No formal prerequisites. Basic knowledge of financial accounting and income tax is assumed.

MATERIALS

Readings and handouts will be posted.

GRADES

Final exam. Class participation taken into account.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 11 2025

INSTITUTIONAL PRIVATE CAPITAL INVESTING (34219) - [HEPP, STEFAN>>](#)

CONTENT

WHAT YOU LEARN

Explore the **evolution of private markets** and the forces shaping today's industry — from **venture capital in China and unicorns** to **GP-stake sales and SPACs**.

Gain a practical understanding of **fund structures, key terms, and transaction design**, and learn how to interpret **performance metrics, secondary deals, and access strategies**.

You'll engage with **real-world term sheets, due diligence reports, and financing examples** to see how investment decisions are made in practice.

HOW YOU LEARN

This course combines **academic rigor** with **practical efficiency**.

You'll complete **focused readings, short cases, and analytical exercises** before

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34219-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

each session.

In-class presentations help you connect the dots and build a clear conceptual framework.

Expect **6-7 hours of preparation per week** in addition to class attendance.

WHERE IT MATTERS

Relevant for careers in **asset management, private equity, infrastructure, real estate, private debt, consulting, and private banking.**

You'll learn to think like an investor — understanding how **capital providers evaluate, structure, and fund opportunities.**

The skills you gain will enhance your **professional confidence** and provide an **edge in interviews** for investment-related roles.

WHO SHOULD TAKE THIS COURSE

There are **no formal prerequisites**, but students who have taken private equity-focused classes or have prior **internship or industry experience** will find it easier to **navigate and absorb the substantial volume of material.**

The course is designed for those with a serious interest in private markets and a willingness to engage consistently throughout the quarter.

COURSE FORMAT & ASSESSMENT

This is a **lecture-based course** supported by ongoing analytical work.

Assessment is based on **class participation, short analytical assignments, two group projects, weekly graded quizzes, and a final exam.**

Continuous engagement is essential — this is **not** a class where students can “coast” early and catch up just before midterms or finals. Steady effort throughout the term is key to success.

INSTRUCTOR PERSPECTIVE

Private markets have evolved from niche strategies into a **core pillar of global capital formation.**

This course helps you understand **how institutional investors think, how funds are structured, and how value is created** — knowledge that remains relevant across economic cycles.

Students also gain insight into **the forces shaping the industry**, including how key players are driving **disintermediation within the financial sector.**

Exposure to some of the **most current industry practices and playbooks** has helped past students **secure internships and full-time roles** in leading private markets firms.

*** You can find additional information on the course webpage which will be available from Nov. 26 onwards***

PREREQUISITES

Who can attend?

- Open to Booth graduate students, qualified undergraduates (2nd year+), Harris School students, and approved Master's students from other programs.

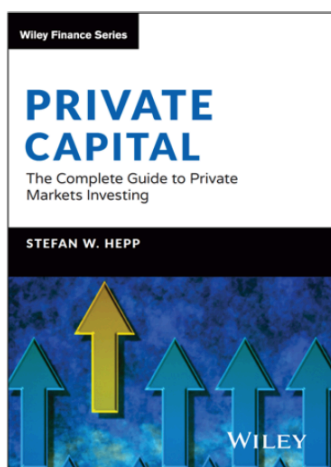
Attendance at the first class is mandatory for course enrollment. This also applies to wait-listed students or non-Booth students that only receive confirmation in week 2.

- No auditors allowed; the course cannot be taken pass/fail.
- **Section Switching:** Allowed until the end of week 2. Notify instructor or TA to ensure proper recording of attendance and quiz scores.

While the course covers a broad range of topics, it is taught at a professional level, reflecting the competitive nature of landing jobs in the private markets industry. This class is demanding and requires a high level of commitment and proficiency. Students who have previously worked in the financial industry or have taken courses related to private equity or investment have found the most benefit from this class. However, I go at great length to make the subject accessible to those who are not familiar with Private Markets but naturally for somebody who is not familiar with the subject the sheer volume of information is more daunting and may require extra time to digest. If you are looking for an easy-going high-level overview, you will find the detailed content of this course to be extremely challenging.

This course is designed to be complementary to Entrepreneurial Finance classes such as Entrepreneurial Finance and Private Equity (34101). But there is no prerequisite for attending my course. Cannot take BUSN 34219 if BUSN 34209 taken previously: strict.

MATERIALS



1. Hepp, S., Private Capital - A Complete Guide to Private Markets Investing, Wiley & Sons, 02/2024 ISBN 9781394217694 (Cloth), ISBN 9781394217700 (ePDF), ISBN 9781394217717 (ePUB)

You need to buy this book as a hardcopy or ebook before class starts - reading of several chapters is assigned before Week 1

2. Presentations, required reading, cases, or Excel spreadsheets for each session are posted on Canvas. You will work with cases, exercises, original documents covering real-life investment cases, and teaching notes

specifically developed or curated for this course.

Assigned reading prior to Week 1:

Chapters 1-4 (without 4.4 Limited Partnerships), Chapter 5 (without Chapter 5.4 Real Estate) and Chapters 6.5-6.9. and 10.5-10.6

!! The assigned reading prior to class start is about 240 pages, so please make sure you get the book early to be up to speed in Week 1. This assignment needs to be done even if you have no access to canvas prior to week 1.

Access to Canvas: In order to do your homework assignments you need to have access to canvas before Week 1. If you do not have access you must contact the TAs as you will be required to do weekly quizzes weekly (exams) the first of which will be due prior to class in Week 2 (see calendar in the Syllabus for deadlines).

GRADES

Assignment type	Group work or individual assignment	Max. score, time limits and deductions	Fail	Grading	Max. Points	Score in % of Final Grade
Classes Attendance:	Individual	Up to 1 Session can be excused. Score per week 3 points - 1 point deduction for being late (5 minutes +) missing more than 40 minutes - 2 points deduction). Time determination in the discretion of the TA	If 5 sessions are missed unexcused the course is failed.	Weekly point scores (9 Sessions - the zoom class is not attendance graded) are aggregated and rescaled.	27	30%
Class participation/ written assignments		Class participation max. score 10 points for the course: Responding to questions and engaging in in-class discussions as recorded by the TA.	No specific fail criteria. But no participation will result in zero points.	Max of 10 point overall. Overall participation (class and group work) is rescaled to 15%.	22	20%
	Pre-assigned groups	Due Diligence Group Work: Up to 4 points for the investment memorandum and Power Point submitted by each group. The group exercise (due diligence) will be presented by selected groups in each Section.	No specific fail criteria.	Max 4 points overall		
		Private Debt Mandate Group Work: Up to 4 points for Power Point submitted by each group. The group exercise (due diligence) will be presented by selected groups in each Section.	No specific fail criteria.	Max 4 points overall		
		Up to 4 points for a short paper where you address questions related to the City of London short case, which will be discussed in week 9.	No specific fail criteria. But no group work allowed.	Max 4 points overall		
Weekly quizzes:	Individual	Max. score per week 2-9 is the max. points per quiz per week, i.e., 20 points. The time limit is 60 minutes, one attempt and open books allowed. Late submission of a quiz will result in point deductions as set per default in Canvas.	Failure to hand in a quiz in time will result in zero points and late submission will result in point deduction as per default in Canvas.	Points received in each quiz submitted will be aggregated and rescaled to 30%.	160	25%
Final Exam		The final exam is done as a quiz during Week 10. The quiz has 100 multiple choice/multiple answer questions, a 150 minute time limit, one attempt, open books. Correct answers will not be released.	No specific fail criteria. But failure to participate in the final will result in zero points.	Points received for the quiz submitted will be aggregated and rescaled.	100	25%

This course cannot be taken as a pass/fail.

EARLY FINAL GRADES for joint-degree/non-booth graduating students

Students who require Early Final Grades can enroll, but if you do, you need to be aware that you may have to take the final (online quiz) exam earlier than the rest of the class during week 10, to meet the submission deadline for early final grades.

GRADES

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 19 2026

ADVANCED NEW VENTURE STRATEGY WORKSHOP (34220) - [SCHRAGER, JAMES>>](#)

CONTENT

Preliminary and Subject to Change

Business 34220-81 Spring 2024

Advanced New Venture Strategy Workshop

Thursday Evenings - Full Remote

Clinical Professor James E. Schrager

"Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication.

- Leonardo DaVinci

The New Venture Strategy course is all about selecting a good idea for a start-up business. The Advanced NVS Workshop investigates what happens after the initial operating period where significant growth remains paramount to reaching a liquidity event. Think WeWork as it expanded, Rivian, Uber, Carvana, Tovala, among many others. Each moved well beyond a single market, technology, or product, yet the entrepreneurs needed to make spot-on strategy decisions--in some cases as a matter of life or death for their enterprise.

The material we will cover is relevant to start-ups which do well in their initial operating period, Unicorns blessed with vast amounts of capital for rapid expansion yet in need of ideas and data on how to best spend it, private businesses looking for growth, and turnaround opportunities which can make good acquisition targets for buy-out entrepreneurs.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34220-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34220-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

As a workshop we will solve strategy puzzles in class together which means student groups presenting solutions in real time. This allows us to build the frameworks required to think strategically. Each student will be required to carefully analyze assigned cases, stay current in "The Wall Street Journal," together with a study group, present a well developed strategy proposal on how to solve real issues with an existing company, and write an individual term paper outlining strategy for a company or organization in trouble.

Because of the complexity of forever time, we do not build generic models of success as we do in New Venture Strategy. Instead we concentrate on taming the inherent challenges of operating without time limits. Cases used in New Venture Strategy will not be used in this course, nor will the NVS frameworks. The cognitive science underpinnings of New Venture Strategy will remain although we will look at the foundations of the Advanced NVS Workshop when possible with new examples to illustrate the central concepts.

By the end of the quarter, students should have an idea of how to formulate strategy for an existing business looking for growth, and how to realistically assess inherent risk in various options. We will practice how best to make all-important strategy presentations to board members of the enterprise or organization.

Our goal is to develop an unconscious common sense about strategy beyond a start-up's initial operating period.

PREREQUISITES

It is mandatory to attend the first class session. 34102 New Venture Strategy is not a prereq. All Non-Booth students require instructor consent.

MATERIALS

Required Reading:

- 1. Chicago Booth packet of cases and readings available on Canvas/Modules;
- 2. "The Wall Street Journal," Dow Jones, Inc., New York, NY. (See Canvas/Modules)

GRADES

Evaluation Procedure:

- 1. Group Portions:
 - a. Weekly case work is 20% of the final grade.
 - b. Strategy Presentations will count 35% of the final grade. Each group will have fifteen minutes to present their proposal to the class, including five minutes of Q&A
- 2. Individual Portions:
 - a. Class participation is 15% of the final grade.
 - b. An individual paper, "Grow This Business?" will count 15% and is due in the final class meeting

c. Peer Reviews: In the final class meeting each student will grade the others in their group based on the quality of contribution for 15% of the final grade.

Provisional Grades: Will be provided without additional arrangements.

Students are urged to communicate with me directly or anonymously on any class matters or improvement ideas while the course is in session.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 19 2026

ENTREPRENEURSHIP THROUGH ACQUISITION (34302) - [AGNEW, MARK>>](#) ; [O'CONNOR, BRIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

Entrepreneurship Through Acquisition ("ETA") will give students frameworks and real world solutions to use if they decide to pursue an acquisition of and lead a company. The class will walk through the life cycle of a typical path toward finding and running a business including information on fund formation, raising capital, searching for a company, buying a business, leading that business and then ultimately selling it. Approximately half of the course will go through critical points leading up to buying a business, while the other half will address some of the key issues executives face while running a company (identifying metrics, communicating with a team, interviewing, handling HR issues, etc). Although the main focus will be on buying and running a business, the class is designed to be applicable to many other career paths including private equity, venture capital and entrepreneurship.

The class will utilize cases, assignments and or/ readings in each lecture along with speakers who will give real life techniques that they use to excel in the particular area that the class is structured around.

We hope everyone comes fully prepared for lively discussion and debate. Attendance is mandatory and will be factored into the class participation grade. There will be cold calling to encourage a variety of perspectives and please be prepared for role playing, at any point in the class, as Professors Agnew and O'Connor strongly believe in trying to make some of the concepts as applicable as possible. Grading here will be based primarily on the quality of the ideas with which you bring to class. Most class meetings will have guest

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34302-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

speakers as “real life” entrepreneurs and investors are critical to the understanding of class material and frameworks. Active involvement and engagement with the guest speakers will be factored into the class participation grade.

PREREQUISITES

None.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

1. Required reading via course materials (in Canvas)
2. Lectures notes, templates, additional reading and other reference materials distributed via class website
3. Notes and assignments handed out in class

GRADES

Grading will be based on effort and comprehension of the principles of the class, as shown in your class participation, project work, and the final. Professors Agnew and O'Connor will select which homework assignment will be graded (starting with Class 2 assignment) at the end of the quarter. All homework assignments must be submitted prior to the start of class. Grades will be distributed as follows:

- Class Participation - 30%
- Homework Assignment - 20%
 - (3 assignments will be selected for grading at the end of the course, although work product will be handed in for classes 1-9. If coursework isn't handed in for any class, 5 out of the possible 30 points will be taken away from your final grade for each assignment missed up to 30 total points. It will not be disclosed in advance which write-ups will be graded).
- Final Project Presentation - 50%

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No Non-Booth students. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades No auditors

ENTREPRENEURSHIP THROUGH ACQUISITION (34302) - BURNS, KEITH>> ; CURRY, MICHAEL>>

CONTENT

Entrepreneurship Through Acquisition ("ETA") will give students frameworks and real world solutions to use if they decide to pursue an acquisition of and lead a company. The class will walk through the life cycle of a typical path toward finding and running a business including information on fund formation, raising capital, searching for a company, buying a business, leading that business and then ultimately selling it. Approximately half of the course will go through critical points leading up to buying a business, while the other half will address some of the key issues executives face while running a company (identifying metrics, communicating with a team, interviewing, handling HR issues, etc). Although the main focus will be on buying and running a business, the class is designed to be applicable to many other career paths including private equity, venture capital and entrepreneurship.

The class will utilize cases, assignments and or/ readings in each lecture along with speakers who will give real life techniques that they use to excel in the particular area that the class is structured around.

We hope everyone comes fully prepared for lively discussion and debate. Attendance is mandatory and will be factored into the class participation grade. There will be cold calling to encourage a variety of perspectives and please be prepared for role playing, at any point in the class, as Professors Burns and Curry strongly believe in trying to make some of the concepts as applicable as possible. Grading here will be based primarily on the quality of the ideas with which you bring to class. Most class meetings will have guest speakers as "real life" entrepreneurs and investors are critical to the understanding of class material and frameworks. Active involvement and engagement with the guest speakers will be factored into the class participation grade.

PREREQUISITES

None.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

1. Required reading via course materials (in Canvas)

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34302-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

2. Lectures notes, templates, additional reading and other reference materials distributed via class website

3. Notes and assignments handed out in class

GRADES

Grading will be based on effort and comprehension of the principles of the class, as shown in your class participation, project work, and the final. Professors Burns and Curry will select which homework assignment will be graded (starting with Class 2 assignment) at the end of the quarter. All homework assignments must be submitted prior to the start of class. Grades will be distributed as follows:

- Class Participation- 30%
- Homework Assignment- 20% (1 assignment will be selected for grading at the end of the course, although work product will be handed in for classes 2-9. For any two assignments turned in, you may write "DO NOT GRADE" on top of the assignment. If the assignment(s) that you picked have this designation, the Professors will pick another week's assignment to grade. If coursework isn't handed in for any class, 7.5 out of the possible 20 points will be taken away from your final grade for each assignment missed up to 20 total points).
- Final Project Hand In -20%
- Final Project Presentation-30%

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No Non-Booth students. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

ENTREPRENEURSHIP THROUGH ACQUISITION (34302) - [LITTELL, CATHERINE>>](#) ; [WALKER, ANTHONY>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Entrepreneurship Through Acquisition ("ETA") will give students frameworks and real world solutions to use if they decide to pursue an acquisition of and lead a company. The class will walk through the life cycle of a typical path toward finding and running a business including information on fund formation, raising capital, searching for a company, buying a business, leading that business and then ultimately selling it. Approximately half of the course will go through critical points leading up to buying a business, while the other half will address some of the key issues executives face while running a company (identifying metrics, communicating with a team, interviewing, handling HR issues, etc). Although the main focus will be on buying and running a business, the class is designed to be applicable to many other career paths including private equity, venture capital, entrepreneurship, and general management.

The class will utilize cases, assignments and or/ readings in each lecture along with speakers who will give real life techniques that they use to excel in the particular area that the class is structured around. Optional sessions before or after class offer excellent learning opportunities that complete assignments and in-class exercises.

We hope everyone comes fully prepared for lively discussion and debate. Attendance is mandatory and will be factored into the class participation grade. There will be cold calling to encourage a variety of perspectives and please be prepared for role playing, at any point in the class, as Professors Littell and Walker strongly believe in trying to make some of the concepts as applicable as possible. Grading here will be based primarily on the quality of the ideas with which you bring to class. Most class meetings will have guest speakers as "real life" entrepreneurs and investors are critical to the understanding of class material and frameworks. Active involvement and engagement with the guest speakers will be factored into the class participation grade.

PREREQUISITES

None.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

1. Required reading via course materials (in Canvas)
2. Lectures notes, templates, additional reading and other reference materials distributed via class website
3. Notes and assignments handed out in class

GRADES

Grading will be based on effort and comprehension of the principles of the class, as shown in your class participation, project work, and the final. All

Autumn 2025
Section: 34302-01
F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

homework assignments must be submitted prior to the start of class. Grades will be distributed as follows:

- Class Attendance & Participation - 40%
- Homework Assignments - 20%
- Final Project Presentation - 40%

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No Non-Booth students. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 07 2025

ENTREPRENEURSHIP THROUGH ACQUISITION (34302) - [WOLFE, BRIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

Entrepreneurship Through Acquisition ("ETA") will give students frameworks and real world solutions to use if they decide to pursue an acquisition of and lead a company. The class will walk through the life cycle of a typical path toward finding and running a business including information on fund formation, raising capital, searching for a company, buying a business, leading that business and then ultimately selling it. Approximately half of the course will go through critical points leading up to buying a business, while the other half will address some of the key issues executives face while running a company (identifying metrics, communicating with a team, interviewing, handling HR issues, etc). Although the main focus will be on buying and running a business, the class is designed to be applicable to many other career paths including private equity, venture capital and entrepreneurship.

The class will utilize cases, assignments and or/ readings in each lecture along with speakers who will give real life techniques that they use to excel in the particular area that the class is structured around.

We hope everyone comes fully prepared for lively discussion and debate. Attendance is mandatory and will be factored into the class participation grade. There will be cold calling to encourage a variety of perspectives and please be prepared for role playing, at any point in the class, as Professors Agnew and O'Connor strongly believe in trying to make some of the concepts as applicable as possible. Grading here will be based primarily on the quality of

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34302-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

the ideas with which you bring to class. Most class meetings will have guest speakers as “real life” entrepreneurs and investors are critical to the understanding of class material and frameworks. Active involvement and engagement with the guest speakers will be factored into the class participation grade.

PREREQUISITES

None.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

1. Required reading via course materials (in Canvas)
2. Lectures notes, templates, additional reading and other reference materials distributed via class website
3. Notes and assignments handed out in class

GRADES

Grading will be based on effort and comprehension of the principles of the class, as shown in your class participation, project work, and the final. Professors Agnew and O'Connor will select which homework assignment will be graded (starting with Class 2 assignment) at the end of the quarter. All homework assignments must be submitted prior to the start of class. Grades will be distributed as follows:

- Class Participation - 30%
- Homework Assignment - 20%
 - (3 assignments will be selected for grading at the end of the course, although work product will be handed in for classes 1-9. If coursework isn't handed in for any class, 5 out of the possible 30 points will be taken away from your final grade for each assignment missed up to 30 total points. It will not be disclosed in advance which write-ups will be graded).
- Final Project Presentation - 50%

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No Non-Booth students. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

PRIVATE EQUITY TRANSACTIONS (34305, 50 UNIT COURSE) - RITCHIE, STEPHEN>>

CONTENT

This course will examine a variety of business, legal, and practical issues that arise in negotiating and documenting a typical private equity leveraged buyout transaction. The course will follow a private equity transaction through its various stages, with a particular focus on the acquisition agreement, its interaction with the debt financing of the transaction, and the equity arrangements entered into among the transaction participants. The objective is to provide students with an understanding of the key contractual terms and important business and risk allocation issues that they will likely encounter in negotiating these transactions as deal professionals at private equity firms or other organizations active in the M&A market. In addition, the course is intended to provide students with insight as to how different stakeholders--including business founders, management team members, private equity sponsors, lenders, insurance providers and advisors--view and are involved in these transactions.

In advance of each class, students will be expected to read a selection of materials, including transaction documents, articles, and court opinions, that will be relevant to the in-class exercises and class discussion. Class sessions will generally include lectures, in-class exercises and discussion. Students will be expected to actively participate in the exercises and discussion, with their participation demonstrating their familiarity with the assigned materials. Following each class, students will be expected to complete an additional, brief homework assignment related to the materials discussed in class. In lieu of a final exam, the class will conclude with a mock negotiation exercise, which will take place during the two weeks following the final class and will end with an additional class session for debriefing. Prior to the first class session, students will form small teams, the members of which will work together throughout the term on the in-class exercises as well as the mock negotiation. All required reading materials will be posted to Canvas.

All students (including those trying to add the course) will be expected to prepare for and attend the first class.

PREREQUISITES

Prior private equity or investment banking experience, and Business 34101, are helpful but not required. No Non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34305-01
TH 3:00 PM-6:00 PM
Harper Center
C06
1st Half: Week 1 - Week 5
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

All required materials will be posted to Canvas.

GRADES

In lieu of a final exam, we will use the mock negotiation exercise described above, which is intended to tie together the various concepts discussed throughout the course. Grading will be based on written assignments, in-class exercises, class participation, and the mock negotiation exercise.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 19 2025

LEGAL FOUNDATIONS FOR ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND VC/PE INVESTMENTS (34308, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [GRAY, MICHAEL>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is designed for students who are interested in the legal issues that will be relevant to one's career as 1) an investment professional in a venture capital/growth equity/private equity firm or allocating money to funds; 2) a founder or member of the senior management of a venture/growth-backed or PE-backed company; or 3) a service provider to the venture/growth/private equity industry (i.e. consulting, banking, fundraising, executive search, and wealth management).

The class will focus mostly on founder/venture/growth issues, but will also be relevant to private equity firms (which frequently buy venture/growth backed companies). This class will supplement the business issues with the relevant legal frameworks of what you learn in New Venture Challenge, Private Equity and Venture Capital Lab and other entrepreneurial classes.

We will work through examples and work in groups to do mock discussions/negotiations of venture/growth deals with the perspective of a new investor, existing investors, founders and members of management. We will also discuss exits in this context and how they influence the way a deal is documented and liabilities allocated. This approach is designed to enable students to think about the different perspectives and interests of each key player in a deal.

We will focus on how the business issues and legal issues interface with each other, the economic and control significance of legal issues, and how these issues have monetary value to various stakeholders.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34308-81
01/07, 01/14, 01/21, 01/28,
02/11
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
1st Half: Week 1 - Week 5
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only
New Course

MATERIALS

Materials will be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Grading will be based on class participation (40%), weekly analysis/memoranda (30%) and a final examination (30%).

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 06 2025

PRIVATE EQUITY/VENTURE CAPITAL LAB (34702) - [HELTZER, JASON>>](#)

CONTENT

The private equity and venture capital lab is an experiential program intended for students who want to learn more about what it is like to work in private equity or venture capital industries. The program is comprised of (a) an internship and (b) an academic course. Internships are hosted by private equity firms, angel groups, venture capital firms, mezzanine lenders, growth equity firms, buyout firms and many other variations. The academic course is designed to equip students with timely practical tools and impart experience from industry veterans with the goal to accelerate the apprenticeship process of those aspiring to work in the private equity and venture capital industries. The course is split into two sections, one that emphasizes private equity and the other venture capital. Both sections are taught in the winter and spring quarters.

Internship assignments can range widely from evaluating new investment opportunities to working on specific projects for portfolio companies. The students are required to work 15-20 hours per week for their host firm during their internship. The class also includes assigned work in addition to the time commitment to the internship. Students are discouraged from registering for more than three courses during their internship quarter as a result of this workload.

The course is a mix of case discussions, guest speakers, investment committee meetings, simulated board of director negotiations, workshops and lectures. Course material is designed to be topical and immediately useful to the student's internship. Preparation for classes will involve group work and case preparation in addition to individual exercises. The class also employs self-directed videos and exercises which permits students of varying experience to adjust their learning in preparation for more in-depth class debate.

Grades are based on host firm evaluations, classroom participation, individual assignments, case write-ups and a final project. The course cannot be taken pass/fail and may not be audited.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34702-82
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34702-82
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

Students will be selected for the course through a competitive screening/interviewing process, which begins by submitting a resume and a questionnaire in a process conducted by the Polsky Center. The host firms choose interns. All students who secure an internship through the program are required to take the class due to federal laws relating to unpaid internships.

More information on the selection process can be found on the [Private Equity Lab website](#).

PREREQUISITES

Students are encouraged but not required to take corporate finance (35200), commercializing innovation (34106) and/or entrepreneurial finance (34101). In order to register for the course, the students must have an ongoing internship at a private equity or venture capital firm through the [Private Equity Venture Capital lab program](#) or through [Sterling Partners Investment Thesis Challenge](#).

No non-Booth students -- non-Booth grad students & undergraduates may not enroll.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students Application-based course

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

The VC section has a required text, *Venture Deals* by Brad Feld and Jason Mendelson.

GRADES

Grades are based on host firm evaluations, classroom participation, individual assignments, case write-ups and a final project. The course cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors are allowed.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors No pass/fail grades Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

PRIVATE EQUITY/VENTURE CAPITAL LAB (34702) - [MCGOWAN, CHRISTOPHER>>](#)

CONTENT

The private equity and venture capital lab is an experiential program intended for students who want to learn more about what it is like to work in private equity or venture capital industries. The program is comprised of (a) an internship and (b) an academic course. Internships are hosted by private equity firms, angel groups, venture capital firms, mezzanine lenders, growth equity firms, buyout firms and many other variations. The academic course is designed to equip students with timely practical tools and impart experience from industry veterans with the goal to accelerate the apprenticeship process of those aspiring to work in the private equity and venture capital industries. The course is split into two sections, offered in both winter and spring quarter, one that emphasizes private equity and the other venture capital.

Internship assignments can range widely from evaluating new investment opportunities to working on specific projects for portfolio companies. The students are expected to work 15-20 hours per week for their host firm during their internship. The class also includes assigned work in addition to the time commitment to the internship. Students are discouraged from registering for more than three courses during their internship quarter as a result of this workload. While the course is scheduled for the spring quarter, the internships will sometimes begin in the fall quarter, winter quarter and/or continue beyond the spring quarter.

The course is a mix of case discussions, guest speakers, investment committee meetings, simulated board of director negotiations, workshops and lectures. Course material is designed to be topical and immediately useful to the student's internship. Preparation for classes will involve group work and case preparation in addition to individual exercises. The class also employs self-directed videos and exercises which permits students of varying experience to adjust their learning in preparation for more in-depth class debate.

Grades are based on host firm evaluations, classroom participation, individual assignments, case write-ups and a final project. The course cannot be taken pass/fail and may not be audited.

Students will be selected for the course through a competitive screening/interviewing process, which begins by submitting a resume and a questionnaire in a process conducted by the Polsky Center. The host firms themselves choose which students to take on as interns. All students who secure an internship through the program are required to take the class due to federal laws relating to unpaid internships.

More information on the selection process can be found on the [Private Equity Lab website](#).

PREREQUISITES

Students are encouraged but not required to take corporate finance (35200), commercializing innovation (34106) and/or entrepreneurial finance (34101). In order to register for the course, the students must have an ongoing internship at a private equity or venture capital firm through the [Private Equity Venture Capital lab program](#) or through [Sterling Partners Investment Thesis Challenge](#).

No non-Booth students -- non-Booth grad students & undergraduates may not enroll.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34702-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
400
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 34702-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
400
In-Person Only

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Application-based course

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Grades are based on host firm evaluations, classroom participation, individual assignments, case write-ups and a final project. The course cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors are allowed.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

REAL ESTATE LAB: REAL ESTATE CHALLENGE (34704) - [PAGLIARI, JOSEPH>>](#)

CONTENT

For the autumn quarter, this class will only be offered in in-person mode.

Participating students will form up to three teams. Each team will select their own listed real estate company(ies) and/or strategy(ies) to endorse, research and (ultimately) present to a panel of external judges. The Real Estate Lab is designed as a capstone to your academic career and is intended to be an “applied” course – with the hope that participating students become subject-matter experts in their selected/particular aspect of real estate investing.

Participating students/teams will have wide latitude in the sort of real estate investment strategy (ies) they would like to pursue. For example, participating students/teams may pursue a traditional “bottoms-up” fundamental analysis of one or more companies – attempting to identify one or more under- or over-valued stocks and creating an appropriate investment strategy. Should students/ teams take this path, the environment is much like that of an investment manager specializing in listed real estate securities. Alternatively, participating students/teams may pursue a less-traditional investment strategy; the type that more likely might appeal to a hedge and/or opportunity fund in which the team looks to create an investment thesis which is more complex, potentially more narrow and seeks to creatively exploit a perceived mispricing.

The overarching goal of the Real Estate Lab is to provide participating students

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34704-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

with the latitude to examine/research investment strategies in which they are interested and to stimulate the investigation of companies and/or strategies that enables those students to “hit the ground running” with one or more investment ideas that they might hopefully deploy in the future. Accordingly, the Real Estate Lab attempts to place few constraints on the students’ creativity.

Please see syllabus link for additional details regarding this course.

PREREQUISITES

The class prerequisites are having successfully taken Real Estate Investments I (#33450) and Real Estate Investments II (#33451); strict. Participation in a previous RE Challenge does not bar students from participating in this year’s RE Lab. If you are interested in participating in this year’s RE Lab, please so indicate to Professor Pagliari, via an email note (to joseph.pagliari@chicagobooth.edu) should contain as attachments: 1) a resume and 2) a one paragraph statement as to why you would like to be involved in this year’s RE Lab and what you might offer to your teammates in terms of expertise, perspective, contacts, etc.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

Application-based course

MATERIALS

None.

GRADES

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 13 2025

ENTREPRENEURIAL DISCOVERY (34705) - [TEBBE, MARK>>](#)

CONTENT

Entrepreneurial success is built with passion, execution, and leadership; however, at the nucleus of a great company is a viable solution and business model that truly addresses customers' need or empowers an unmet desire. While business ideas are "a dime per dozen", building a viable business model on the right idea is invaluable but is very difficult. In both start-up entrepreneurship and corporate intrapreneurship, pursuing wrong ideas or models wastes precious time, resources, and energy.

Entrepreneurial Discovery is the class to help you experience a proven collection of approaches that will serve as the foundational approach to building a viable business. It is not expected that your class team will collectively build your dream startup in nine weeks (although it has happened before) but rather for you to actively encounter the needed processes which allows you to apply these methods to your first (or next) venture-backed company when you will have more calendar and focus on your business. This course provides impassioned innovators with the tools needed to identify and then iteratively refine the right business idea into a viable business model that is relevant, differentiated and sustainable.

Using customer-centric and evidence-based processes, class participants will work in class-oriented teams to actively explore a team-selected real-world foundational opportunity. Each class team will choose their problem space, conduct research, perform user-centered analysis and studies, as well as derive insights from customer interactions. Teams will then use stakeholders' feedback to conceptualize and refine multiple ways to address the needs in their respective problem area. Leveraging these insights, the team will rapidly refine the problem and iterate potential solutions. They will then commit to one solution upon which they will develop an initial business model on which they will build their business for this solution. They will then begin to identify the business' team, funding and timing needs and summarize such in some core messaging materials. The course's final deliverables allow each team to share a complete overview of their solution leveraging both internally and externally focused documents that expound their clarified and refined business solution (with related business model). However, this class does not assess the quality of your final business but the quality of your journey in getting to this final business foundation. The class goal is to build the foundation upon which a viable business can be launched.

Let's be clear: **This is not a passive class!** As entrepreneur turned educator and author Steve Blank states, "To turn hypotheses into facts, founders need to get out of the building and test them in front of customers." As such, our students will attend class sessions to share, explore and discuss important elements of this process including problem framing, "needs-finding" research techniques, opportunity identification, prototyping, and customer development. However, students are expected to spend time outside of the classroom conducting research, meeting with stakeholders and actively exploring alternatives while enhancing their business idea through active refinement. This class is a lab because it will require you to constructively identify problems or opportunities worth solving, frame your assumptions, refine your hypothesis with insights from your potential stakeholders and re-frame the opportunity as if you were in a science class. Just as successful entrepreneurs learn from the industry, customers and stakeholders while defining and running their business, you will do the same in this class!

This class will include a combination of lectures, team presentations, discussions, and in-class discussions. Class time will be highly interactive with

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34705-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 34705-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

students expected to actively participate by sharing insights and solutions. Students are only allowed to participate in their registered section. As members of a lab class, students will work in student-only teams to conduct interviews, perform observations, and work closely with industry experts and stakeholders as well as their other core team members. Group work is essential to the design process and will be extensive in this course. Participants should expect to meet with their assigned group multiple times outside of the classroom and should anticipate investing a minimum of seven hours per week.

By the end of the course, you will have acquired reusable business innovation skills and tools to:

1. discover problem areas worth exploring,
2. discriminate between strong and weak business ideas,
3. refine possible business ideas by iteratively exploring solutions,
4. enhance these ideas with customer and market feedback,
5. outline a viable business model on a Business Model Canvas,
6. rapidly test, iterate and execute on your defined business model, and
7. effectively communicate the needs for growing your business.

Due to the group nature of this course, you will only be able to drop the class before the first class begins.

As expressed by one of the Autumn 2024 students in last year's feedback forms, *"I am super glad that I took Entrepreneurial Discovery and would recommend it to first year students looking for an introduction to the entrepreneurial process. Leveraging Prof Tebbe's experience and proven insights, we gained a framework that gave me clarity on how to identify a real problem that's worth pursuing and then how to build the business core to make it happen."*

PREREQUISITES

This class is aimed at Booth's First-Years who are interested in entrepreneurship as a founder, employee, investor or advisor. While there are no class-related recommended prerequisites, prior career experience in business, technology, design, or product management is valued.

Please note that attendance for all nine weeks of the course is very important for your success and for other students' success in this team-based course.

For further information on the course outline, course expectations, and other useful information, please refer to the course syllabus. Cannot enroll if 20350 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

1. Required reading from course materials in Canvas.

2. Lectures notes, templates, additional reading and other reference materials distributed in Canvas

3. Notes and assignments handed out in class

GRADES

While 50% of your grade is individual performance, group work is extensive in this course. As such, 50% of your grade is based on a series of group projects that encompass from opportunity identification, concept development and an early feasibility summary for a new venture. Grading will be based on several factors:

- 50% on group work
 - 30% homework assignments
 - 20% final work products
- 50% on individual performance
 - 20% on attendance and participation in class
 - 30% on peer evaluation

No pass/fail grades. No auditors. No class drops.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 19 2026

LAB TO LAUNCH (34709) - BLUMBERG, JASON>> ; CRANDELL, KEITH>>

CONTENT

OVERVIEW:

Lab based innovations have contributed the most important advances to humanity, from energy that power our lives to medicine that cures disease. Billions of dollars are spent each year developing lab based innovations, with new discoveries happening every day. However, limited effort is place on commercializing these discoveries, which could create global scale impact and vast wealth creation. A major reason for this is that the toolset required to be successful in this arena is much different than digital/AI companies, which is currently the focus of most people or traditional corporate management. Therefore, we have created a class tailored to offer a very unique value proposition:

Teams composed of 3-4 students will build a new business, utilizing a lab technology that is sourced from a leading research lab (university or national lab)

- Technologies will be sourced and vetted by a PHD Science student from the

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34709-01
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

University of Chicago's [Molecular Engineering](#), [Physical Science](#), and [Biological Science](#) programs. These students participate as part of a team in the class, providing a unique technical capability.

- You may have the option to continue building the business after the class and potentially become an equity holder.
- You will be able to enter the business in the New Venture Challenge. A number of prior teams have been accepted.

Key milestones include:

- Determining the right technology to pursue from a large number of technologies, utilizing the analysis performed in the fall by the PHD team member.
- Analyzing multiple commercial market opportunities for the selected technology to determine the path forward (i.e. which approach has best financial benefits and lowest risk).
- Building a business plan, which sets the road map for commercializing the technology, and summarize this information in a VC pitch deck.
- Developing a robust set of skills, tools and experiences that you can utilize throughout your life.

Support & Guidance:

- Professors who will guide you through the class:
 - [Jason Blumberg](#): Head of a leading new energy VC fund + head of a leading energy focused Foundation + A sought out thought leader on Critical Industries, Energy & Cleantech issues
 - [Keith Crandell](#): Head of one the world's preeminent science focused VC's – 20+ IPO's and Billions of \$'s of value created
- Engage with preset external advisors from the professor's network, who will provide technical and/or business advice. These include leaders in industry, research and investments.
- Work with a leading lab or university to understand the technology and receive support from your U of C IME team member.
- Garner input from an array of referral sources and hear guest lectures from industry leaders.

Actual experience with a lab technology will be augmented with classroom instruction focused on:

- Issues faced by entrepreneurs as they work to commercialize a lab based technology.
- Core principals and technologies that are shaping the science landscaped, including the structure of various representative markets and overviews of major and minor technologies.
- Building a toolset to be able to effectively and efficiently develop commercialize plan, solve complex problems, and provide high impact advice.

The ultimate objective of the class is to provide students with a hands-on experience in commercializing lab based technologies. This type of immersion is insightful for students considering founding a company, working in a start-up, consulting, venture capital and/or working in the science based industries. Students who join this class in order to work with one particular technology will not obtain the full benefit of the course. Technologies that appear exciting in the course marketing materials may yield unexpected challenges.

For those interested in foundational knowledge in commercializing science or building a science based businesses' (i.e. anything besides digital & AI) we hope you'll find this one of your best classes.

APPLICATION:

Admittance into the class is by application only. Prospective class participants need to apply to participate. Since real-world problems often cut across multiple disciplines and interest groups, this course draws from a pool of students with a wide range of backgrounds, skills and perspectives with experience and across multiple schools in the university.

Please apply for the class using [this link](#). Applications may be submitted anytime and will be reviewed on a rolling basis until the class is filled. Please note this course is typically in very high demand, so we encourage you to apply early, as no additional seats will be available once capacity is reached.

ADDITIONAL DETAIL:

Students are expected to work 7– 10 hours out of class each week. This includes team and technology leads, independent and group research, interviews, presentation preparation and more. Individual team meetings are scheduled with the professor every 2 weeks or more if necessary.

Students who elect to register for this course should consider this a commitment. Dropping this class after the first week is strongly discouraged. Part-time students are welcome, but this class requires substantial schedule flexibility. Students must be able to schedule frequent meetings with the Lab Partner, often during business hours.

Project management is a key focus of the class. Many of the research partner leads may have not worked with MBA students before and consequently, students are expected to guide the process. Part of each class is devoted to discussing strategies and actual project issues in order to arrive at desired results.

PREREQUISITES

Please apply for the class using [this link](#). Applications may be submitted anytime and will be reviewed on a rolling basis until the class is filled. Cannot enroll in BUSN 34709 if 34706 taken previously: strict. No undergraduate students.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

MATERIALS

1. Required reading from course materials in Canvas.
2. Lectures notes, templates, additional reading and other reference materials distributed in Canvas.
3. Notes and assignments handed out in class

GRADES

- 20% Final project
- 10% Phase 2 Project
- 10% Phase 3 Project
- 20% Team evaluations (confidential)
- 10% Partner evaluation (confidential)

- 15% Class participation
- 15% Individual assignments

No pass/fail grades.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 14 2025

INNOVATION LAB (34712) - **STROMBERG, PER>>**

CONTENT

The "Innovation Lab" course is exclusively open for Specialized Masters students (Master in Management and Master in Finance) who are studying in London for Winter Quarter 2026. The purpose of the course is to:

- Learn about the private capital market: its economic role, institutional set-up, and future outlook and challenges.
- Learn how to address a real-world practical problem facing a European private capital investor working in a group of peers over a limited period of time.
- Practice group collaboration, project management, and presentation skills.

Even students who do not envision a career in private capital per se, they will likely interact with the private capital market in their future jobs: as consultants or advisors in connection with private capital deals, as managers of firms owned or financed by private capital, or as investors/limited partners in private capital funds. The course should therefore be broadly useful not only for students who are interested in working in private capital, but more broadly for those pursuing a career in finance, management, or consulting.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34712-01
Day/Time: TBD
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only
Global SMP

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 04 2025

HACKING FOR DEFENSE (34715) - **GOSSIN, WILL>> ; **HENDERSON, TODD>>****

CONTENT

Course Application

- Info Session:

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34715-01

- Thursday, Oct 30th, 5:15 - 6:00pm, ZOOM
- Registration Link: <https://forms.gle/1QpcoYuGbsatNV3q7>
- Course Application:
 - Apply here: <https://forms.gle/F4sfHpmayTklQgy7>

W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

Course Timeline:

- Oct 16th - Applications Open
- Oct 24th - Info Session (ZOOM)
- Oct 28th (Monday) - Applications Close
- Nov 1 (Friday) - Admitted Students Notified
- Nov 6 (Wednesday) - Students confirm admission; we submit list to Booth Registrar
- Nov 11 thr Jan 3 - Virtual Team Formation Process with Faculty & Project Onboarding
- Jan 6, 2025 - WTR Quarter Begins
- Jan 10 (Friday), 2025 - First Class Session

****NEW** for this year: Apply with an existing startup or idea to get matched with a government go-to-market sponsor. Submit ideas here and expect an email to debrief: <https://forms.gle/zNFUeGRV1p5fhya6>

Course Overview | Hacking for Defense is an application-based, entrepreneurship lab experience with a focus on government innovation. In this course, the faculty source fascinating technical and operational challenges from across the Department of Defense and Intelligence Agencies (DoD/IC) and match them with interdisciplinary student R&D teams from across campus. During the course, students will not only learn the innovation toolkit (customer discovery, human-centered design, prototyping, how to build an effective pitch deck, and leadership), but will get a chance to apply that toolkit to real-world problems facing one of the world's most complex and impactful bureaucracies. By the end of the course, students will gain professional experience systematically reducing organizational uncertainties, elevating their professional networks, and creating breakout solutions that can gain adoption within a huge organization and in new markets.

Students' career trajectories have been meaningfully transformed by this course. In the course's first six years at UChicago (with teams of students from across schools), we have had 7 teams successfully advance into the various NVC ("New Venture Challenge") programs, two finished in the top 4, one won \$80k in NVC, and another that was commercially acquired within 12 months of starting the class. Past Projects focused on projects ranging from: logistics, deep-tech, data-fusion, bio-tech, AI/ML, market creation, gender equity, digital manufacturing, distributed knowledge management, space management, and cyber security. (We expect future projects will be equally compelling). In the course evaluations, many students said the course was the most impactful learning experience they've had during their degree programs.

Opportunity and Experience | The innovation toolkit (lean startup, human-centered design, prototyping) was developed to create new value under conditions of extreme uncertainty. Our large institutions--both public and private--involve uncertainties at the cutting edge of technology and management with outsized implications. We believe such institutions should be more responsive to changing conditions and that they deserve commitment from the best and brightest when it comes to the application of innovation. All of the teams within the DoD/IC are large, complex, and as impactful on society as any that one can identify. These teams face intense pressure to adapt their missions to changing constituencies, evolving geopolitical demands, technology revolutions, wider social norms, and complex regulations. This

course aims to train teams of students in how to apply the innovation toolkit to such organizations and their challenges.

Students will apply to the class and be assigned to a project sponsored by a top government official. In the application, students will share their current skills, areas of desired development, and project preferences (posted mid-Autumn). The class projects center on the types of problems that few professionals get access to throughout their careers--working directly with high-level policy and operational experts who are asking your team to solve problems they've been unable to address. Each team's goal during the course is to develop a viable business ("mission") model for a dual-use new venture--serving customers both in government and the private sector. Students will be supported by both the faculty and between 8-12 expert coaches drawn from the national labs, relevant agencies, technology firms, and DoD affiliates.

Overall, the course is now organized into 3 Phases (Methods, Mindsets, and Landscape; Confirming Beneficiary Value; Completing the Mission Model Canvas). The final course output will remain a rigorous and defensible pitch to your team's client agency about how to address your challenge through a dual-use venture.

PREREQUISITES

There are no formal requirements for this class. Diverse combinations of personal and professional experiences are highly desired. Cannot enroll in BUSN 34715 and LAWS 53455, PPHA 33830 or INRE 32002 concurrently (or previously).

No project requires security clearance and therefore all are open to international students.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

MATERIALS

Required Texts:

- Phase 1 - Method, Mindsets, and Landscape
 - MisMatch, Kat Holmes (short book with a fantastic framing for thinking about innovation across sectors and contexts.)
 - Talking to Humans (PDF - free via internet/Canvas site)
 - Testing with Humans (PDF - free via internet/Canvas site)
- Phase 2 & 3 - Field Work and Venture Creation
 - Sprint, Jake Knapp
 - Business Model Generation, Osterwalder, et al (Highly visual reference and explainer for the Business Model Canvas that has been adapted to the Mission Model Canvas for Hacking for Defense.)
- + See Canvas Weekly for additional readings and videos

Recommended Texts:

? Slideology, Nancy Duarte (an excellent resource for designing presentations and storytelling in this class and across your career)

? (optional) The Startup Owner's Manual, Steve Blank & Bob Dorf (Desk reference for future innovation work, we'll sample across it.)

GRADES

- 15% Individual Innovation Checklist/Study Guide | submitted twice in the quarter. Will summarize key concepts of the innovation toolkit, their relationships, and their implications for your future professional use. (Graded on 10, 8, 0.)
- 45% PR/FAQ Memos + Website/Landing Page (Team) | Submitted throughout the course. Must demonstrate rigorous learning and synthesis from weekly interviews in your memo and provide other teams substantive feedback on theirs during in-class workshops.
- 30% Final Team Presentation (Team) | Team's final presentation summarizing your value proposition, proof of demand from beneficiaries/customers, and complete Mission Model Canvas learnings including buy-in and revenue model. Equivalent to a "Seed Stage" pitch.
- 10% Individual Participation | Weekly engagement in class discussions, coaching/client meetings, and group workshops.

All assignments must be turned in on time. Late assignment may incur an adjustment.

Attendance Requirements: Effectively learning in this course requires consistent attendance and feedback with active participation. I understand that absences are sometimes unavoidable (excused absences include work travel, illness, etc), however more than 1 unexcused absence will substantially impact your grade. Let me know prior to class if you must be absent due to an unavoidable circumstance. More than 3 absences for any reason will substantially impact your grade as the work and learning of the course requires all students to be engaged.

Peer Evaluation (adjustment to final grade): Twice during the quarter, students are required to evaluate the contributions of all team members. If an individual is rated negatively by 2 or more team members, their team grade may be adjusted downward up to 2 full letter grades. If an individual is rated very positively by 2 or more team members, their grade may be adjusted upward.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors Mandatory attendance week 1 No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 19 2026

BUILDING THE NEW VENTURE (34815, 50 UNIT COURSE) - MAYEKAR, SAMIR>>

CONTENT

Entrepreneurs must ask these five questions early and often:

1. How do I know if my idea is a good one?
2. How do I show up and stand out?
3. How do I win my first 100 customers?
4. How do I not get burned by investors? (And other important legal and financial questions.)
5. How do I hire great people and run my business with as little drama as possible?

My goal with this course: Help you answer these questions.

This course is intended for students who are interested in starting new entrepreneurial businesses. It is tactical, hands-on, and covers the nuts and bolts of starting a company with a lesser emphasis on investing in entrepreneurial ventures. Students will learn how to identify a value proposition, raise seed funding, compensate for limited human and financial resources, establish brand values and positioning, secure a strong niche position, determine appropriate sourcing and sales channels, and develop execution plans in sales, marketing, product development and operations. The emphasis is managerial and entrepreneurial, essentially a working model for starting an enterprise.

Although this course touches on topics relevant to a venture in the growth/scaling phase, the majority of course content focuses on the early launch, proof-of-concept, and traction phases of a new venture.

The course content and structure is applicable to all types of businesses, whether B2B, B2C or deep technology based on fundamental scientific research.

Through class lectures, "game" assignments, and real-world cases, the course covers such topics as: building a startup management team; raising early-stage funding, identifying target customers; acquiring customers; professionalizing a sales process; hiring initial employees; and leveraging strategic partners. Emphasis is placed on marketing and sales for new enterprises as well as leadership skills because these are areas of entrepreneurial weakness.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if 34103 or 20330 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Assigned out-of-class listening:

- Episodes of the How I Built This and Startup podcasts

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 34815-88
08/10, 08/11, 08/12, 08/14,
08/15
EMBA2 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

- Reid Hoffman: What Makes a Great Founder
- Brian Chesky: Designing a 10 Star Experience
- Dan Pink: The Puzzle of Motivation

Assigned out-of-class reading (~100 pages, should take less than 3 hours)

- Case studies: XFC, MoviePass, Dropbox, Netflix
- Paul Graham – What is a Startup
- HBR: What are Business Models & How Are They Built
- What is an MVP?
- Entrepreneurial Selling
- HBR: Raising Startup Capital
- HBR: The Founder's Dilemma

GRADES

30% YourCo. Assignment & Pitch (team work)

20% Class participation

10% Peer Review

10% Case write-up (1 done individually, your choice)

30% Final paper (done individually, due 2 weeks after end of elective)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 23 2026

INNOVATION STRATEGY AND MANAGEMENT (34816, 50 UNIT COURSE) - WOLCOTT, ROBERT>>

CONTENT

"Innovation distinguishes the leaders from the followers." --Steve Jobs

Please find a video introduction to our course, [here](#).

This course is about "Winning the Future." While everyone is transfixed on AI--and it is transformative--there are much larger forces at play. Leveraging better Vision (sensing, foresight, projection), understanding how organizations work, and solving the right challenges can provide meaningful competitive advantages. All leaders need far better Foresight to build optionality, both professionally and personally.

I'm a professor, author and active venture investor in nearly 50 companies and venture funds. I look forward to envisioning, exploring and creating the future

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 34816-88
08/10, 08/11, 08/13, 08/14,
08/15
EMBA2 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

with all of you.

Innovation must be a principal objective of senior management; unfortunately, few managers achieve the innovation competencies necessary to manage the innovation portfolio required by global firms to achieve growth and profitability objectives. This course will apply a theoretical and applied approach to understanding Innovation Strategy & Management from the perspective of **senior corporate leaders**.

The course will focus on innovation within business entities, from the typical technology and product innovation programs, to broader, process, marketing and other forms of innovation. The course will address innovation as a holistic strategic management imperative not limited to Research & Development or New Product Development. While the course will provide a theoretical foundation, **the focus will be on real world issues, products and systems**.

We will:

- Build foresight for where we're going across industries as a result of technology
- Examine Innovation from the perspective of corporate strategy
- Explore the impact of a range of emerging technologies on the future of business and society
- Relate Innovation to other factors such as Marketing, Risk, Structure, Processes and Project Management
- Discuss best practices from a number of leading firms, including Amazon, Netflix, AXON, BP, Disney, Dell, Zebra Technologies, Honeywell; category-creating companies like Haddy.life, AXON, Interstellar Lab, Unqork; and non-profit/government initiatives such as the Cambodian HIV/AIDS national response
- Consider what we're trying to accomplish in the world, and WHY, both professionally and personally.

MATERIALS

Materials: We'll have 2 books listed in the syllabus. All other readings will be provided via Canvas.

GRADES

Students will be evaluated on the following basis:

- Final Projects (CEO Presentation, team) - 50%
- ProximityParks Case Solution (team) - 10%
- Personal Mission Essay (Individual) - 20%
- Class & Team Contribution (Individual) - 20%

Class Contribution incorporates team participation, which will be determined by both self-evaluation and team member evaluation. The Instructor will determine in-class participation by the quality of a student's contribution to discussion. Each student will also evaluate the group work participation of each team member, reporting confidentially via email.

We'll discuss the case solution and "personal mission" assignment during the first day of class.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 17 2026

ASSET PRICING I (34901) - **[HANSEN, LARS>>](#) ; [NAGEL, STEFAN>>](#)**

CONTENT

PhD-level course in Asset Pricing that covers fundamental concepts in Asset Pricing. The first half will be taught by Stefan Nagel. The second half will be taught by Lars Hansen. Please see syllabus link for further details.

MATERIALS

See syllabus.

GRADES

The course grade is based on class participation, homework assignments, a midterm examination, and a final examination in class. Students are expected to read the assigned materials in advance, participate in the class discussion, and work on extensive problem sets.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 14 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34901-50
MW 8:30 AM-9:50 AM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

ASSET PRICING II (34902) - **[NAGEL, STEFAN>>](#) ; [XIU, DACHENG>>](#)**

CONTENT

This course builds on Asset Pricing I. The course focuses on empirical asset pricing. We cover reduced-form factor models, including equity factor models and term-structure models, as a parsimonious representation of the stochastic discount factor, and methods to estimate and test these models. We examine models of subjective belief formation of investors as explanations for the empirically observed risk premium variation, as well as asset demand system approaches to identify and estimate asset pricing models. We further explore machine-learning approaches to empirical asset pricing, leveraging them to enhance conventional prediction, estimation, and inference with respect to expected returns, risk premia, factor-mimicking portfolios, the stochastic discount factor and optimal portfolios, alphas, and models of the risk-return trade-off, while also addressing their limitations and criticisms by highlighting when, where, and why algorithms may fail.

PREREQUISITES

Business 34901 (or 35904): strict. Recommended, but not required: Econ 31000, 31100, 31200 or equivalent, and Econ 33000, 33100, 33200 or equivalent. BUSN 34902=ECON 35060

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 11 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34902-50
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

CORPORATE FINANCE I (34903) - [DIAMOND, DOUGLAS>>](#)

CONTENT

Corporate Finance I provides an introduction to the theory of corporate finance and financial intermediation. Some topics in corporate finance include capital structure, security design, security issuance, incomplete financial contracts and corporate control. Topics related to financial intermediation (banking) include financial crises, the role of liquidity creation and the choice of debt maturity for firms and financial intermediaries.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 34903-50
M 3:00 PM-6:00 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room

PREREQUISITES

Econ 30100, Econ 30200, & Econ 30300: strict. BUSN 34903=ECON 35070.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Journal articles.

GRADES

Grades will be based on problem sets, referee reports and a final examination.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 06 2025

CORPORATE FINANCE II (34904) - [SUFI, AMIR>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides an empirical treatment of major topics in corporate finance and financial intermediation, including: capital structure, investment, bankruptcy, internal capital markets, the real effects of bank lending, financial frictions, and corporate finance implications for macroeconomics.

PREREQUISITES

Business 34903 (or 35902): strict. A solid background in advanced microeconomics is highly recommended. MBA students must get instructor consent to enroll: strict. BUSN 34904=ECON 35080.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

Grades will be based on problem sets, referee reports and a final examination.
No provisional grades.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 34904-50
MW 10:10 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

CORPORATE FINANCE III (34906) - [COLONNELLI, EMANUELE>>](#) ; [RAJAN, RAGHURAM>>](#)

CONTENT

This course covers recent research on the role of financial intermediaries in the economy, macro-financial policies, as well as research on financial development and regulation of the financial system. Related topics include the links between financial intermediaries, central banks, regulators, financial markets and corporate finance. The course will cover both empirical and theoretical work.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 34906-50
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Business 34903 Corporate Finance I and Business 34904 Corporate Finance II: strict. A solid background in advanced microeconomics is highly recommended. BUSN 34906=ECON 35090

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

Homework, Final Exam and in class presentations.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 04 2026

INVESTMENTS (35000) - [BASTIANELLO, FRANCESCA>>](#)

CONTENT

This course offers the financial theory and quantitative analytical tools necessary for understanding how stock, bond, and option prices are determined, and provides the skills required to make sound investment decisions. The course combines a theoretical framework with applied analysis. Topics covered include: portfolio selection based on mean-variance analysis, models of risk and return (including the CAPM and multifactor models), performance evaluation of mutual funds and hedge funds, market efficiency

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35000-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

and the random walk hypothesis, asset pricing anomalies and behavioral finance, derivative security pricing (including options, futures, forwards, and swaps), and the term structure of interest rates.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000 and 33001 are recommended. Either 41000 or 41100 is required: strict. This is a quantitative course, meaning that students must be comfortable with statistics, linear algebra, calculus, and microeconomics at the level of the above courses. In addition, students must be familiar with a spreadsheet package such as Excel. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35000 if BUSN 20400 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

The main text used for the course is Bodie, Kane, and Marcus, *Investments*. The course Canvas site will contain supplemental readings, cases, and articles.

GRADES

Based on 5-6 homework assignments, a case write-up and discussion, a mid-term, and a final. Class participation will also play a role.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 24 2026

INVESTMENTS (35000) - [CASSIDY, WILLIAM>>](#)

CONTENT

This course offers the financial theory and quantitative analytical tools necessary for understanding how stock, bond, and option prices are determined, and provides the skills required to make sound investment decisions. The course combines a theoretical framework with applied analysis. Topics covered include: portfolio selection based on mean-variance analysis, models of risk and return (including the CAPM and multifactor models), performance evaluation of mutual and hedge funds, market efficiency and the random walk hypothesis, asset pricing anomalies and behavioral finance, derivative security pricing (including options, futures, forwards, and swaps), and the term structure of interest rates.

Spring 2026
Section: 35000-02
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35000-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35000-03
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35000-04
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM

PREREQUISITES

Bus 30000, 33001, & 41000 (or 41100). Comfortable w/ stats, linear & matrix algebra, calc, & micro @ the level of above courses. Familiarity w/ spreadsheet package such as Excel is vital. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35000 if BUSN 20400 taken previously.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35000-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 11 2025

INVESTMENTS (35000) - [DEW-BECKER, IAN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides an introduction to securities markets. It first provides a framework for portfolio choice, which then naturally shows how to evaluate the quality and performance of different securities, strategies, and fund managers. Specific topics covered include portfolio construction through mean-variance analysis, the risk-return trade-off in financial markets, performance evaluation of investment funds, behavioral finance, determinants of interest rates, and derivatives (options, futures, etc.).

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35000-03
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000 and 33001 are recommended. Either 41000 or 41100 is required: strict. This is a quantitative course, meaning that students must be comfortable with statistics and must be familiar with a spreadsheet package such as Excel. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35000 if BUSN 20400 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Bodie, Kane, and Marcus, *Investments*, is suggested as a good and relatively technical reference. Ang, *Asset Management*, is recommended for a better introduction to the actual economics underlying investing. Suggested readings from both are posted on Canvas, along with supplemental readings, cases, and articles.

GRADES

Grades are based on homework assignments, a midterm exam, a final exam, and class participation. No pass/fail grades. Auditing is not allowed, and undergrads may not sign up.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 15 2025

INVESTMENTS (35000) - GALA, VITO>>

CONTENT

This course provides the financial theory and quantitative analytical tools for making informed decisions on security valuation and portfolio strategies. The course combines a theoretical framework with applied analysis. Topics include valuation of equity, fixed income, and derivative securities; portfolio selection; models of risk and return including the CAPM and multifactor models; market efficiency, anomalies and fund performance.

PREREQUISITES

BUS 30000 and BUS 33001 are recommended. Either BUS 41000 or BUS 41100 is required. The course is quantitative in nature and students must be comfortable with probability, statistics, and regression analysis. In addition, students must be familiar with a spreadsheet package such as Excel. Cannot enroll in BUS 35000 if BUS 20400 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

The textbook for the course is *Investments* by Bodie, Kane, and Marcus, 13th Edition. Supplemental readings, cases, and articles will be posted on Canvas.

GRADES

Grades are based on midterm exam, final exam, assignments, and class participation.

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 35000-81
06/15, 06/17, 06/22, 06/24,
06/29, 07/01, 07/06, 07/08,
07/13, 07/15
MW 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
1st Half: Week 1 - Week 5
In-Person Only

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>*Description and/or course criteria last updated: May 11 2026***INVESTMENTS (35000) - VANDEWEYER, QUENTIN>>****CONTENT**

This course is designed to provide a sound foundation for the fundamental concepts in investments. Topics covered include models of risk and return (including the CAPM and multifactor models); stock market valuation; the term structure of interest rates; portfolio selection based on mean-variance analysis; performance evaluation; market efficiency and derivative security pricing (including options, futures, forwards, and swaps). Students who master the course material will acquire the analytical tools and financial theory necessary for making good investment decisions and understanding the paradigms by which financial securities are valued.

PREREQUISITES

This course is highly quantitative and relies heavily on analytical tools and economic theory developed throughout the course. Students should be comfortable with probability, statistics and regression analysis at the level of Business 41000. Use of a spreadsheet package such as Excel will be vital for the homework assignments, saving time and aiding in understanding the material. Some use of calculus and linear algebra will also be required. Cannot enroll if 20400 taken previously.

MATERIALS

- Textbook: Bodie, Zvi, Alex Kane, and Alan Marcus, Investments, Irwin, 12th Edition
- Additional articles: Additional readings and articles will be posted on canvas in advance of each class during the quarter.
- Lecture slides/handouts: Lecture slides will be posted in advance on canvas. The lecture slides provide an outline of the course discussion and some details on the topics covered.

GRADES

The course requirements are a Midterm exam, a Final exam, six graded homework assignments, and a case write-up. Class participation will also affect your grade. Your course grade will be determined by the maximum of Methods A and B below:

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35000-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 35000-02
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 35000-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35000-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35000-02
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35000-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306

Method A

Midterm 25%

Case Write-up 5%

Problem Sets 15%

Class participation 5%

Final 50%

Method B

Case Write-up 5%

Problem Sets 15%

Class participation 5%

Final 75%

In other words, the Midterm is optional and can only help your grade.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 13 2025

INVESTMENTS (35000) - ZHANG, ANTHONY>>**CONTENT**

This course offers the financial theory and quantitative analytical tools necessary for understanding how stock, bond, and option prices are determined, and provides the skills required to make sound investment decisions. The course combines a theoretical framework with applied analysis. Topics covered include: portfolio selection based on mean-variance analysis, models of risk and return (including the CAPM and multifactor models), performance evaluation of mutual and hedge funds, market efficiency and the random walk hypothesis, asset pricing anomalies and behavioral finance, derivative security pricing (including options, futures, forwards, and swaps), and the term structure of interest rates.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000 and 33001 are recommended. This is a quantitative course, meaning that students must be comfortable with statistics, linear algebra, calculus, and microeconomics at the level of the above courses. In addition, students must be familiar with a spreadsheet package such as Excel. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35000 if BUSN 20400 taken previously.

MATERIALS**SCHEDULE**

Autumn 2025
Section: 35000-04
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 35000-05
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

The main text used for the course is Bodie, Kane, and Marcus, *Investments*. Supplemental readings, cases, and articles will be posted on Canvas.

GRADES

Grades are based on homework assignments, a case write-up, a midterm exam, and a final exam.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 11 2025

INTRODUCTORY FINANCE (35001) - [CONSTANTINIDES, GEORGE>>](#)

CONTENT

The course introduces students to corporate finance, asset pricing, and investments. It is designed for students who have no background in finance and may or may not choose to concentrate in finance. I discuss sources of funds, capital budgeting, capital structure, dividend policy, cost of capital, portfolio theory, the capital asset pricing model, multifactor asset pricing models, valuation, and market efficiency. I provide the students with references to more advanced materials if they decide that they want to wade into the material further. The course is taught primarily with lectures but it relies heavily on numerical examples.

PREREQUISITES

It is recommended that students take Business 30000 prior to taking Business 35001. All Non-Booth students require instructor permission to enroll. Cannot enroll in 35001 if 35010 taken previously: strict.

MATERIALS

The main text used for the course is Berk and DeMarzo, *Corporate Finance*. The course Canvas site will contain supplemental readings and articles.

GRADES

Based on homework assignments, class participation, a mid-term, and a final. Provisional grades for non-Booth students provided, but no early final grades. I usually do not allow auditors in this course but you can email me if you have a special case.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35001-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35001-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 15 2025

MANAGERIAL FINANCE (35010) - [CONSTANTINIDES, GEORGE>>](#)

CONTENT

This course introduces students to corporate finance, asset pricing, and investments. It is designed for students who have no background in finance and may or may not choose to concentrate in finance. I discuss sources of funds, capital budgeting, capital structure, dividend policy, cost of capital, portfolio theory, the capital asset pricing model, multifactor asset pricing models, valuation, and market efficiency. I provide the students with references to more advanced materials if they decide that they want to wade into the material further. I teach the course primarily with lectures and I rely heavily on numerical examples.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35010-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, not enforced. MiM Only. All Non-Booth students require instructor permission to enroll. Cannot enroll in 35010 if 35001 taken previously: strict.

MATERIALS

Berk and De Marzo, Corporate Finance (Prentice Hall), sixth edition.
I recommend either the hard copy or the e-text of the sixth edition. The fifth edition is not very different and is cheaper.

GRADES

Participation, problem sets, midterm and final exam.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 15 2025

FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS (35100) - [BOONSTRA, BRIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course develops the basics of derivative security pricing. We cover both simple derivative contracts, such as forward, futures, and swaps, as well as more complex derivatives, such as put and call options and credit derivatives. The focus of the course is on the pricing and hedging of derivative securities through the principles of no-arbitrage and the law of one price. We apply these concepts to dynamic trading models, through the development of the binomial tree model, the Black-Scholes option-pricing model, and the risk neutral pricing methodology. We discuss several important applications of the pricing methodology, such as its implications for risk management, exotic options, the pricing of corporate securities (corporate bonds, callable bonds, equity, etc.), credit derivatives, and real options for investment decisions. We also discuss the role of arbitrageurs in ensuring no arbitrage, and use the 2007 – 2009 crisis also to highlight what happens to the law of one price if arbitrageurs are short in capital.

The course is analytical in nature, requiring some prior exposure to calculus, statistics, and probability theory.

Class materials such as problem sets, lecture slides, and other information will be posted on Canvas.

PREREQUISITES

Bus 35000: strict. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35100 if BUSN 20405 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Robert L. McDonald, 2006, *Derivatives Markets*, Pearson Education.

GRADES

Based on periodic problem sets, a mid-term and a final exam.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35100-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 19 2026

HEALTHCARE FINANCE (35118) - VERONESI, PIETRO>>

CONTENT

This course discusses the challenges to finance progress in healthcare in the 21st century, and the possible solutions, with a specific focus on drug discovery. The course reviews the current framework for drug approval, including the economics of clinical trials, and introduces the tools used for investment valuation, such as decision trees, financial and real options, Monte Carlo simulations, and portfolio theory applied to drug discovery and development. We review the venture capital and private debt markets as source of funding. We finally discuss the recent area of personalized medicine and targeted therapies, its current challenges, and the promises offered by new technologies, such as machine learning and artificial intelligence, and their impact on healthcare finance. Case studies are used to cement the concepts discussed in class.

PREREQUISITES

Prerequisites for this course are a course in Statistics such as 41000 (or equivalent), and either a course on Investments such as 35000 (or equivalent), or Corporate Finance such as 35200 (or equivalent): strict. Students are expected to use Excel spreadsheets or other similar tools to solve problem sets and case studies.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Lecture notes (on Canvas)

Case Studies (on Canvas)

Book: Healthcare Finance: Modern Financial Analysis for Accelerating Biomedical Innovation, by Andrew W. Lo and Shomesh E. Chaudhuri

GRADES

Based on class participation (10%), weekly homework (20%), in-class midterm (30%), and in-class final (40%).

SYLLABUS>>

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35118-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only
New Course

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 05 2026

PORTFOLIO MANAGEMENT (35120) - PASTOR, LUBOS>>

CONTENT

This course presents advanced material related to financial markets, focusing on topics most relevant to portfolio managers. The course is particularly well suited for students considering careers in the investment management industry, but it is designed for anyone who wants to build on the material covered in Bus 35000 (Investments), which is a strict prerequisite. Topics include active vs. passive management, mutual funds, hedge funds, index funds, ETFs, values-based investing, portfolio selection, liquidity, predictability of asset returns, market anomalies, and more. A substantial part of the course is devoted to case studies, academic research, and current events.

PREREQUISITES

Bus 35000: strict. No non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

Based on an exam, weekly group assignments, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 21 2026

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35120-01
F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35120-02
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35120-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

BEHAVIORAL FINANCE (35121) - YAN, HONGJUN>>

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Over the past four decades, Behavioral Finance has evolved significantly and is now an essential component of the modern finance toolkit—relevant across asset management, investment banking, corporate finance, and finance-related policy work.

While traditional financial theory assumes that market participants are fully rational, behavioral finance offers an alternative framework, grounded in empirical evidence, that explains many market phenomena as the result of systematic psychological biases and constraints on arbitrage.

This course begins with the foundational concepts of behavioral finance: limits to arbitrage and insights from psychology. We then apply these principles to a range of topics, including individual investor behavior, asset pricing, corporate decision-making, and public policy.

Autumn 2025
Section: 35121-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Business 35000 and Business 41100. This is a quantitative course and students are expected to be comfortable applying statistics and multivariate regression to data and interpreting the results. Knowledge of a regression package (such as Excel) is essential.

Prerequisite requirements (35000 and 41100) are not strict, so you do not need to request a waiver. If you feel confident taking the course without the prerequisites you are welcome to, but you are responsible for learning any material you might need to make up on your own.

This course can be taken before or after 35215 (Behavioral and Institutional Finance).

As long as you have completed all the coursework, provisional grades are given.

MATERIALS

Required readings: Lecture notes (will be provided).

GRADES

One final exam, group project, and class participation. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 30 2025

QUANTITATIVE PORTFOLIO MANAGEMENT (35126) - KOIJEN, RALPH>>

CONTENT

This course develops a framework to build and analyze quantitative investment strategies. We will take advantage of recent innovations in AI and extensively use large language models such as those developed by Anthropic, Google, and OpenAI (and related models). You will get an in-depth understanding and hands-on experience how these tools are incredibly useful in quantitative portfolio management (and in the asset management industry at large), and how they can transform the industry in the future.

We will use the AI models to develop code to analyze big data (such as stock prices and returns, firm fundamentals, text data, portfolio holdings and flows) for the purpose of predicting returns, measuring risk, estimating firm valuations, and ultimately building investment strategies. The final project requires you to develop and pitch a new investment strategy using this framework. The course will use Python as a coding language, but no prior knowledge of Python is required for this course.

The course starts with a brief review of the traditional portfolio choice framework introduced in the Investments course and then covers much of the recent research on quantitative methods to build and critically analyze investment strategies.

Key topics covered in the course are:

- An overview of recent developments in the asset management industry related to active vs passive investing, institutional vs retail investors (including high net worth individuals and family offices), and sustainable investing.
- Recent innovations in quantitative investing, such as factor investing, and industry applications via fundamental indexing and smart-beta products. We will also discuss how macroeconomic conditions (e.g., inflation and monetary policy) impact the success of these strategies.
- Market frictions and the capacity of investment strategies, incentives of asset managers, and evaluating the performance of actively-managed strategies, with applications to ETFs, hedge funds, and mutual funds.
- AI/ML methods and big data in the asset management industry: Applications and insights from big data (including text, holdings, flows, and alternative data sources).
- Using quantitative methods for firm valuation, and how to connect and integrate different approaches to investing, such as fundamental/value investing and quantitative investing.

The lecture material is built around recent academic research, problem sets, case studies, and significant time is spent on current events.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, 33001, and 35000 are non-strict (non-enforced) prerequisites. Business 41000 (or 41100) is a strict (enforced) prerequisite. Students must be comfortable with statistics, regression analysis, microeconomics, and investments at the level of the above courses. No prior knowledge of Python is required.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35126-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35126-02
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35126-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

There is no required textbook and all lecture notes will be made available on Canvas. In addition, problem sets and supplementary materials (such as academic papers and Python code templates for the investment strategies / portfolio analytics) will be made available on Canvas as well.

GRADES

The assignments for the course consist of 3 problem sets, 2 cases, a midterm, and a final project. **There will be no final exam.** Problem sets and case questions will be available on Canvas and should be submitted via Canvas. No auditors.

GRADES

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 02 2026

FIXED INCOME ASSET PRICING (35130) - [HEATON, JOHN>>](#)

CONTENT

The universe of fixed income instruments is large and ever more complex. Besides standard fixed-coupon bonds, several other types of securities are available for investment and trade, from inflation indexed securities (TIPS) to floating-rate notes, from mortgage backed securities to debt instruments issued by government agencies, such as Fannie Mae, Freddie Mac, and Ginnie Mae. In addition, a large market of exchange traded and over-the-counter derivative securities is available for trade in order to undertake sophisticated hedging strategies or to adjust the risk/return characteristics of an investment portfolio.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35130-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35130-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206

This course covers models and techniques that are used to analyze fixed income securities their (often embedded) derivatives. By the end of the course, students will learn (i) the basic concepts of fixed income instruments, such as yield curve, forward curve, yield-to-maturity, duration, convexity; (ii) the modern empirical methodologies to describe Treasury bond data, such as "curve fitting" and factor analysis; (iii) effective hedging strategies for fixed income portfolios, such as duration matching, asset-liability management and factor neutrality; (iv) the advanced properties of bonds, such as their risk/return characteristics, and the best predictors of their future returns; (v) modeling techniques used by market participants, such as the models of Vasicek, Cox Ingersoll and Ross, Ho and Lee, Hull and White, Black-Derman-Toy, and Heath-Jarrow-Morton; and, importantly, (vi) how to use these methodologies *in practice* to value and hedge fixed income products and derivatives, from the traditional securities, such as Bonds, Swaps, Options, Caps and Floors, to the more recent products, such as Inverse Floaters, Range Notes, Mortgage Backed Securities.

The key feature of this course is that it strongly emphasizes the *applications* of these methodologies to value real world fixed income products, and their derivatives, by focusing both on the practical difficulties of applying models to the data, as well as on the necessity to use computers to compute prices. The course, which is analytical in nature, includes many real world *Case Studies* and *Data Analysis* to allow students to apply these models to a wide range of fixed income securities as well as to understand their risk and return characteristics.

PREREQUISITES

Business 35000: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 16 2026

BLOCKCHAINS AND DECENTRALIZED FINANCE (35136) - **ZHANG, ANTHONY>>**

CONTENT

This course provides an information to blockchains and "decentralized finance". We will cover the basics of blockchain consensus, and smart contracts. We will then discuss finance applications built on blockchains, including automated market makers, lending platforms, stablecoins, and "tokenomics", as well as blockchain-related financial institutions such as cryptocurrency exchanges. We will cover a few other applications on blockchains, such as NFTs and DAOs.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if BUSN 35135 taken previously: strict.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 11 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35136-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

MACHINE LEARNING IN FINANCE (35137) - [BYBEE, LELAND>>](#)

CONTENT

Machine Learning in Finance focuses on the use of machine learning and AI methods and their applications in finance with a particular focus on problems in asset pricing. This course aims to provide students with the knowledge necessary to best use recent machine learning methods but also to understand their limitations. We will cover such topics as penalized estimation and its use in forecasting, clustering, factor models and unsupervised learning, neural networks and non-linear prediction, text data and large language models.

It is expected that students will have some exposure to programming in Python. Students will work with real financial datasets to help gain a better understanding of the methods covered.

PREREQUISITES

Business 41000 (or 41100 or 41210) is a prerequisite. Students must be comfortable with statistics, regression analysis, linear algebra, and Python programming.

MATERIALS

There is no required textbook. Several supplementary texts will be recommended and recent academic papers will be provided on Canvas.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35137-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35137-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

GRADES

Based on several homework problem sets, a final project, quizzes, and class participation.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

THE ECONOMICS OF DIGITAL ASSET PRODUCTS AND MARKETS (35139) - [VAN DER MERWE, ANDRIA>>](#)

CONTENT

Since the launch of Bitcoin in 2009 by the pseudonymous Satoshi Nakamoto, digital assets have developed into a distinct asset class with growing influence over global financial markets. The increasing institutional participation and increase in applications for cryptocurrencies and blockchain-based systems are challenging conventional notions and regulatory frameworks.

This course provides an introduction to the economic foundations and financial innovations driving the digital asset ecosystem, with a focus on cryptocurrencies, blockchain technologies, and decentralized finance (DeFi). Through real-world examples and recent regulatory investigations, students will analyze the underlying economics of both the successes and failures in cryptocurrency markets. Topics include centralized versus decentralized exchanges (CEX vs. DEX), crypto derivatives such as perpetual futures, and institutional investment products such as exchange-traded funds (ETFs).

PREREQUISITES

Introductory Economics or Finance (recommended).

MATERIALS

We will use suggested readings from books, published academic articles, and regulatory commentary.

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35139-01
F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only
New Course

Grades will be based on class participation, problem sets, and a final project.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 01 2025

ADVANCED MODELS OF SECURITY PRICING AND CREDIT RISK (35141) - [BOONSTRA, BRIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course will analyze complex derivative securities and arbitrage strategies, via mathematical and computational analysis, with a goal of making students familiar with the broad landscape of derivative securities and associated pricing theory.

The first two weeks will review classical Black Scholes option pricing, and place it in a broader context of risk neutral pricing theory. We will then cover some of the computational and numerical methods for applying that theory, such as Monte Carlo path techniques, iterative formulae, trees, and finite difference schemes. These will be put in the context of:

- American and Bermudan exercise options
- Multi-asset options, such as on baskets or ETFs
- Credit default swaps (CDS) and collateralized debt (CDO) tranche pricing
- Bonds, embedded bond options, swaps and swaptions
- Convertibles

PREREQUISITES

Students are expected to possess decent calculus skills, and have some understanding what a partial differential equation is. Students should also possess familiarity with Black-Scholes, either via prerequisites or by instructor approval of prior study experiences.

GRADES

Homework assignments will be not-quite weekly, consisting of work done in spreadsheets and/or Python coding. The homework problems will generally involve expanding on a framework provided by the instructor to get started. One assignment may be dropped. This course will have a midterm and a final.

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35141-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only
New Course

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 01 2025

ARBITRAGE AND CORPORATE SECURITIES (35144, 50 UNIT COURSE) - MITCHELL, MARK>>

CONTENT

This 50-unit course focuses on arbitrage in corporate securities. It will focus on real-world examples in the context of academic theory and empirical research. The class sessions will include HBS case studies and lectures with required class participation. In addition, the required readings include several academic articles. The course will explore various corporate arbitrage strategies, including merger arbitrage, convertible arbitrage, closed-end fund arbitrage, dual-listed and dual-class arbitrage, and SPAC arbitrage. Given the limited number of classes available for a 50-unit course, we will approach these topics at a high level.

We will not have enough time to delve deeply into the more technical aspects of the literature. It is essential to understand the basic concepts to prepare you for studying the more technical material independently. My goal is for you to learn key ideas that will benefit you throughout your career, regardless of whether you choose to become an arbitrageur. My aim is not to train you as an arbitrageur; that requires years of experience on an arbitrage trading desk. Likewise, it is not intended to teach you the art of arbitrage investing. Rather, the objective of the course is to broaden your understanding of asset pricing and corporate finance, as arbitrage plays an integral role in maintaining market efficiency and in facilitating corporate transactions and liquidity demands of other investors.

Note: Other than the slight title change, 35144 is the same course as 35124 ("Arbitrage Investing") taught Spring 2025.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if BUSN 35124 taken previously.

MATERIALS

There is no required textbook for the course as there are no adequate Arbitrage textbooks in print. I have prepared five detailed lecture notes of nearly 200 pages which you can treat as the textbook. In addition, there are

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35144-01
MW 10:10 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C01
1st Half: Week 1 - Week 5
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

several academic readings which I have assigned. If you are not comfortable with reading academic articles, this course is not for you.

GRADES

The primary course requirements include (1) four graded assignments, (2) class participation, and (3) a final exam.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 04 2026

THE FAMILY OFFICE (35146) - [HEATON, JOHN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is meant for current and future leaders of family offices: members of a family and/or part of a professional management team. Students in the course will develop insights into the different roles that family offices play, effective leadership, structure of these offices, defining goals for investment and distribution and other important topics.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll in BUSN 35146 if 35145 taken previously.

MATERIALS

There will be some lecture materials each week, but our discussions will be based predominantly around a sequence of cases. Students will work in groups of up to 4 people and will be required to submit written case evaluations each week. There will also be a final project to be done in groups. Details to be added.

We will also welcome periodically visitors from the industry to enrich our discussions.

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35146-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 02 2026

ADVANCED INVESTMENTS (35150) - NAGEL, STEFAN>>

CONTENT

This course examines advanced analytical methods and topics in investments from a macro asset allocation perspective. We adopt the viewpoint of a long-term institutional investor--such as a university endowment, pension fund, or family office--seeking to dynamically allocate capital across broad asset classes, including equities, corporate and sovereign bonds, and private equity. Asset allocation focuses on the allocation across asset classes rather than security selection within them.

Developing an asset allocation strategy requires a deep understanding of the dynamics of risk and return across these markets. We will apply empirical methods, including return forecasting regressions, shrinkage techniques, and techniques for out-of-sample evaluation, to form and assess expectations about risk and return. We will also examine how information from investor surveys and fund flows can be used to gauge investor sentiment and to enhance these forecasts.

To translate these empirical inputs into portfolio decisions, we will extend the mean-variance framework introduced in your introductory investments course to analyze multi-period portfolio choice over long horizons. We will also evaluate practical rule-of-thumb approaches such as risk parity and naive diversification, and we will study the use of leverage, volatility derivatives, and tail-risk hedging strategies; macro risk factors linked to interest rates and monetary policy; inflation risk and inflation-protected securities; "bubbly" assets such as cryptocurrencies and gold. Finally, we will discuss the distinctive challenges of incorporating private equity and other illiquid assets into a coherent asset allocation framework.

PREREQUISITES

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35150-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35150-02
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Business 35000 and 41000 (or 41100, 41210) are strict prerequisites for this course. Students must be comfortable with statistics, regression analysis, basic microeconomics (expected utility and risk aversion), basic matrix algebra, and fundamental concepts of investments such as mean-variance analysis in portfolio choice, CAPM, bond valuation, option payoffs, and Black-Scholes.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

There is no required textbook. Detailed lecture notes and slides will be made available on Canvas. Readings and supplementary materials will be made available on Canvas as well.

GRADES

Based on several homework problem sets, quizzes, a midterm exam, a final project, and class participation.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 11 2026

THE PUBLIC AND PRIVATE LENDING MARKETS: INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITIES AND RISKS (35155) - [KALCHEVA, GALINA>>](#) ; [VERONESI, PIETRO>>](#)

CONTENT

COURSE OVERVIEW

The market for corporate and sovereign bonds, as well as private corporate loans, has been increasing rapidly in the past decade. Institutional investors, such as pension funds, insurance companies, as well as commercial banks, broker-dealers, and sovereign funds exhibit strong demand for these securities. We first discuss recent trends and the investment opportunities offered by corporate and sovereign bonds, including callable, convertible and other structured securities, their risks and their expected returns. We will then

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35155-01
W 3:00 PM-6:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

discuss the booming U.S. private credit market, including middle market corporate direct lending, real estate credit, asset-based lending, specialty finance and infrastructure debt; its market participants, and the risk and investment opportunities that it offers to both corporations (who borrow) and investors (who lend). Students will learn to apply factor models and optimization techniques to analyze and construct credit portfolios, as well as asset allocation methods that account for illiquid assets. The class aims to provide economic intuition as well as quantitative tools for managing credit portfolios.

The course will benefit students who are interested in asset management, banking, investment banking, financial consulting, as well as corporate Treasurers and risk managers.

PREREQUISITES

Stats/Regression: strict 41000 (or 41100) and Investments: 35000. Cannot take if taken BUSN 34214 previously: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 18 2025

CORPORATION FINANCE (35200) - [KASHYAP, ANIL>>](#)

CONTENT

This course analyzes the major decisions facing corporate financial managers. It examines investment decisions, capital structure choice, and mergers and acquisitions. My primary objective is to teach you how to value a corporation. A revised detailed week by week syllabus and answers to a set of frequently asked questions will be posted by November 1 on the canvas class web page. Note that my policy on case preparation differs from some others teaching this class - see the class web site for details. Importantly the reason why I require 35000 as a strict prerequisite is that we will use the capital asset pricing model within the first 2 weeks of class and we will use Black Scholes during the first half of class. So taking 35000 concurrently does not work. If you are requesting an exemption from the 35000 prerequisite because you are familiar with that material and are instead taking a more advanced class, note that in your request and indicate the more advanced class you will be taking instead of 35000.

Frequently asked questions about Kashyap's B35200 (Corporation Finance)

How does your course differ from other instructors?

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35200-03
W 8:15 AM-11:15 AM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35200-04
W 2:15 PM-5:15 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35200-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center

We all cover roughly the same material, so I think that many of the differences come down to style. I think that I probably put more emphasis on teaching you how to value companies than some of the other instructors. Most of the cases I use involve valuation. Some of the other instructors include cases on other topics too. I also suspect that more of my examples are international (because of my research interests related to Japan and Europe). I teach the case on the Lehman Brothers bankruptcy in the last week of the class because it is a good advertisement for several of the advanced corporate finance electives.

Can I take 35000 concurrently?

No that won't work. By the second week of the term we will be using the CAPM and in week 3 we cover real options. You need to have completed 35000 (or an equivalent course) to keep up with what we will be doing.

What have you changed since the last time you taught the course?

I am updating a number of the examples and revising the lecture on real options significantly. The basic material for this class is pretty timeless.

Why do you grade the cases?

Because I have experimented with both grading them and not grading them and when they are not graded people do not take them seriously. The course is organized so that the cases really reinforce concepts. If students do not work hard on the cases then they are not going to fully learn the material. The 21 percent weight in the overall grade is enough to penalize people who shirk but not hurt people who make a sincere effort.

Why can't all the case write-ups be done in groups?

I require some individual effort for the same reason that I grade them in the first place. Having a group where the members take turns doing the work undermines the learning. I encourage you to discuss the cases, but I want everyone to have made a serious attempt on their own before any discussions start.

Why don't you give out solutions to the cases?

I (and other instructors) want to be able to use these cases in the future. If the answers are distributed they will find their way into future students' hands and ruin the cases. The handouts that I provide include all the material that you need to match the computations that I show. The TA will go over the details of what I put up in class in the review sessions (or with you individually or in groups).

Do I have to go to the review sessions?

No. If you are following the lectures and understanding the homework, then do not bother with the reviews. If you have questions, particularly on the homework, these sessions are designed to help.

How should I study for the exams?

Start with the takeaway slides that are at the end of each lecture. You absolutely need to understand these points. You should then make sure you understand how we solved the major problems worked out in class. Finally, you should do the homework. If you can do all the homework problems too (including the case write-ups), then you will do well in the class. If you do not do this you are going to have trouble. The best way to check that you are ready is to take one of the exams from prior years that are posted on the course chalk web site.

I missed class what should I do?

Review the lecture notes carefully and then try to do the homework. If you can do the homework and follow the notes you should be fine. You should make a point of also looking over the notes of someone who was in the lecture to make sure you find out what I stressed. Similarly, be sure to see Alissa Aviles to pick up any handouts you might have missed. (If you can attend one of the other sections, please do that.)

I missed an exam, can I reschedule it?

No. It is very hard to write a fair exam and without large numbers of people taking an exam you cannot tell whether a makeup would be fair.

Can I take the final early or late?

No. I won't have the exam written until the night before so there is no time to give it early. Controlling information after the exams becomes hard and I don't think it is fair to permit people to take it later. If you cannot make it at the scheduled time find another section. (If you do miss the final you will be given an incomplete that you can make up by taking the final in Spring quarter.)

Where is your office?

Campus office is HPC 529. When teaching at Gleacher, I grab the first office that I can find in the suite of faculty offices on the 4th floor.

Where are the questions for the cases?

They are posted in Canvas.

Do I need to buy the book?

I realize it is expensive, but it is an excellent resource and you will be at a definite disadvantage if you cannot do the assigned reading. I assign very little reading with the presumption that you will actually do it.

Why should I take this class?

Knowledge of this material is essential for anyone who hopes to run a business. If you do not understand how to finance a company you are very likely to make poor management decisions. For the students who are going to concentrate in finance this is the foundations course to help you get ready.

PREREQUISITES

Sections 03 & 04 are MiF only. Business 30000, 33001, 35000 (strict), and 41000 or 41100. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35200 if BUSN 20410 taken previously. Undergraduates and any non-Booth students require instructor permission and you will have to take the Tuesday section.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Berk and DeMarzo, *Corporate Finance*.

GRADES

Based primarily on a midterm and a final exam. I will also have a modest portion of the grade determined by case write-ups. Half of the grade is determined by the final exam. I am totally inflexible about allowing people to take the final outside of the scheduled time; if you cannot sit for the final during the scheduled time in either your section or one of the others, find another section to take. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 05 2025

CORPORATION FINANCE (35200) - [MA, YUERAN>>](#)

CONTENT

The purpose of this course is to provide an understanding of major decisions made by companies and the tools used to make these decisions. The first part of the course covers methods used to value investment opportunities. Particular attention is given to discounted cash flows valuation, including the methods of weighted average cost of capital (WACC) and adjusted present value (APV). The second part focuses on capital structure. We will analyze the choice of financing through equity, debt, and other types of securities, and as well as payout policies. Specialized topics, such as mergers and acquisitions, bankruptcy, and corporate hedging will be covered as time permits.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, 33001, 35000 (strict), and 41000 or 41100. Waivers for 35000 potentially granted only to students with substantial previous course work in investments or CFA level 2 or above. Previous work experience related to investments and previous coursework in corporate finance do not satisfy the prerequisite for 35000. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35200 if BUSN 20410 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Berk and DeMarzo, Corporate Finance (only textbook, do not need the kit); electronic course materials will be posted in Canvas. The course description and class schedule will also be posted in Canvas.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35200-03
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35200-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

GRADES

Based on cases, a midterm examination (optional), a final examination, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. This course is not open to Non-Booth students. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 20 2025

CORPORATION FINANCE (35200) - [NOEL, PASCAL>>](#)

CONTENT

The purpose of this course is to provide you with an understanding of major decisions made by corporate financial managers and to familiarize you with the tools used to make these decisions. The first part of the course covers methods used to value investment opportunities. Particular attention is given to discounted cash flow valuation, including the methods of weighted average cost of capital (WACC) and adjusted present value (APV). The second part of the course focuses on issues of corporate financial structure. The focus will be on the choice of financing through equity, debt and other types of securities and on payout policies through dividends. Specialized topics, such as mergers and acquisitions, bankruptcy, and real options will be covered as time permits.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, 33001, 35000, and 41000 (or 41100) recommended. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35200 if BUSN 20410 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Berk and DeMarzo, *Corporate Finance* (only textbook, do not need the kit); electronic course materials will be posted in Canvas. The course description and class schedule will also be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Based on cases, a group valuation project, a midterm examination (optional), a final examination, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35200-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35200-02
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35200-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35200-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 20 2026

CORPORATION FINANCE (35200) - PIERCE, JOSHUA>>

CONTENT

The purpose of this course is to provide you with an understanding of major decisions made by corporate financial managers and to familiarize you with the tools used to make these decisions. The first part of the course covers methods used to value investment opportunities. Particular attention is given to discounted cash flow valuation, including the methods of weighted average cost of capital (WACC) and adjusted present value (APV). The second part of the course focuses on issues of corporate financial structure. The focus will be on the choice of financing through equity, debt and other types of securities and on payout policies through dividends. Specialized topics, such as mergers and acquisitions, bankruptcy, and/or real options will be covered as time permits.

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 35200-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, 33001, 35000 (strict), and 41000 (or 41100). Waivers for 35000 potentially granted only to students with substantial previous course work in investments or CFA level 2 or above. Previous work experience related to investments and previous coursework in corporate finance do not satisfy the prerequisite for 35000. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35200 if BUSN 20410 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Berk and DeMarzo, *Corporate Finance* (only textbook, do not need the kit); electronic course materials will be posted in Canvas. The course description and class schedule will also be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Based on cases, a midterm, a final examination, problem sets, and class participation.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

CORPORATION FINANCE (35200) - VASUDEVAN, KAUSHIK>>**CONTENT**

The purpose of this course is to provide you with an understanding of major decisions made by corporate financial managers and to familiarize you with the tools used to make these decisions. The first part of the course covers methods used to value investment opportunities. Particular attention is given to discounted cash flow valuation, including the methods of weighted average cost of capital (WACC) and adjusted present value (APV). The second part of the course focuses on issues of corporate financial structure. The focus will be on the choice of financing through equity, debt and other types of securities and on payout policies through dividends. Specialized topics, such as mergers and acquisitions, corporate hedging, bankruptcy, and real options will be covered as time permits.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, 33001, 35000 (strict), and 41000 (or 41100). Waivers for 35000 potentially granted only to students with substantial previous course work in investments or CFA level 2 or above. Previous work experience related to investments and previous coursework in corporate finance do not satisfy the prerequisite for 35000. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35200 if BUSN 20410 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Berk and DeMarzo, *Corporate Finance* (only textbook, do not need the kit); electronic course materials will be posted in Canvas. The course description and class schedule will also be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Based on cases, a group valuation project, a midterm examination (optional), a final examination, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35200-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 35200-02
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

CASES IN FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT (35201) - ANDRADE, GREGOR>>**CONTENT**

A case-based corporate finance course designed to apply and enhance concepts learned in introductory classes (35200 or 35010). The course is structured to provide practical examples and real-world business situations, making it ideal for students considering careers in investment banking and finance departments of corporations, or those for whom practical corporate finance tools and skills are relevant (e.g., strategy, corporate development).

Key strategic and financial choices will be examined, including asset sales, mergers and acquisitions, major capital structure changes, such as IPOs, debt restructurings, dividend policy and bankruptcy. We will focus on the tools for measuring value and value creation/destruction and the economics underlying the value creation process.

Each week involves preparing a case study, with a group write-up due, and subsequent class discussion requiring active participation, and attendance. Grading would be based on a combination of case write-ups, class participation, and a comprehensive final exam.

PREREQUISITES

Business (35000 + 35200), OR (35901 + 35902), OR 35010: strict. Some familiarity with Microsoft Excel will be assumed.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Cases and supporting notes/articles will be available in Canvas. Optional readings will be assigned from corporate finance textbooks used in introductory courses (35200 or 35010).

GRADES

The course requirements will include (a) weekly case writeups, (b) active class participation, and (c) a final examination.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35201-01
F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 18 2026

CASES IN FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT (35201) - **BORN, LAURA>>**

CONTENT

This course is designed for MBA students (as we build on their full-time work experience) and as such, the Registrar will not permit Undergraduates, Master's in Finance or Master's in Management candidates to enroll.

If you are an MBA student and would like me to consider a waiver for either 35000 and/or 35200, please send me a list of all accounting and finance classes you've taken to date at Booth, a list of those classes taken in your undergraduate studies or other master's programs and a copy of your resume. Then, I will review for a waiver.

This case course is designed to utilize, reinforce and enhance the concepts in corporate finance you accumulated in 35200 using the case method and some lecture material. In this course, students will practice various valuation techniques, evaluate three acquisition cases, complete an LBO model and evaluate the governance aspects of an LBO, discuss optimal capital structure, review capital markets including public equity, convertibles, bank and debt markets, including analyzing an Initial Public Offering ("IPO) and learn about shareholder activism and finally, evaluate a company break-up case.

There are 9 cases, one due each week, completed in groups. Week 1 and 2 cases will be a review of the basics of valuation methods. Then, the course will progress to more advanced topics. Because this is a case course, the student's active engagement, participation and attendance is critical to his/her own success in the course and is graded. The instructor employs "cold calling" during class time. There will be pre-recorded lectures that may be viewed at the student's convenience to supplement the understanding of the course material each week. Short multiple choice quizzes will be required each week as a check-point for understanding. In all, the final course grade will be based on class participation (including in-person attendance), case write ups, weekly quizzes, and an in-class final exam to be given during the regularly schedule exam period, no exceptions granted.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35201-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 35201-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 35201-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

There is no option to take the final exam remotely.

PREREQUISITES

Business 35000 (or 35901) and 35200 (or 35902) are required: strict. It is mandatory for all students to submit the case write up due in week 1.

For those students who wish to request a waiver of prerequisites for the course, please provide Professor Born your resume, a list of accounting and finance classes completed at Booth and a list of accounting and finance classes from undergrad or other graduate studies. With this, she can evaluate your background for a waiver.

Non-Booth students require instructor permission. No MiM/MiF, no undergraduates

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Cases and supporting reading materials (which are primarily optional) will be posted in Canvas, and either Berk and DeMarzo, Corporate Finance (Prentice Hall) or Brealy Myers and Allen, *Principles of Corporate Finance* (McGraw Hill) can be helpful background reading.

GRADES

For the Harper Section: the course grade will be based upon graded Case Write Ups, Short Weekly Quizzes, Class Participation, Class Attendance, **and an in-class Final Exam (Wednesday Dec 10th)**. No pass/fail grades. No auditors. No early final grades. There is no option to take the final exam remotely.

Case write ups are due each week; this includes the write up for Week 1's class even if course is added later.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 14 2025

CASES IN FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT (35201) - [PIERCE, JOSHUA>>](#)

CONTENT

This is a case-based course in corporate financial strategy that is intended to extend, integrate, and apply tools from BUS 35200. We will discuss investment decisions, financing decisions, risk management, corporate control, leveraged transactions, valuation methods, public offerings, mergers and acquisitions, restructurings, and incentive systems in a variety of different economic environments. There will be some lecture material, but much of the course will be taught using cases. Students will complete case assignments in groups.

PREREQUISITES

Business 35000 and 35200 (or 35901 and 35902): strict. Some familiarity with Microsoft Excel will be assumed.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Cases and class handouts will be available in Canvas.

GRADES

Several case assignments, class participation, and a final exam.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 07 2026

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35201-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

CONSUMER FINANCE (35207) - [NELSON, SCOTT>>](#)

CONTENT

Consumer finance is ubiquitous. The US, for example, carries more consumer debt than corporate debt. Consumer finance is also consequential. Consumers' balance sheets can drive the sales of an individual firm and can shape the trajectory of macroeconomic crises. This course studies the design of consumer financial products and how business leaders more broadly can respond to consumers' financing needs.

We begin with recent innovations in consumer finance, including FinTech

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35207-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

business models related to underwriting, ML/AI, and alt-data, as well as recent developments in more traditional financial services. We then ask what makes these innovations successful – or not. Three main themes emerge. The first is an understanding of consumers' finances: how do the risks, income, wealth, and decision-making of consumers affect their financial needs? The second is the role of the competitive and regulatory environment: market forces such as adverse selection are shaped by regulation and by competition, and these crucially affect what financial products are viable. The final theme is the benefits, and risks, of new technology, including ethical concerns that arise in the debate around financial inclusion.

Particular applications and markets studied in the course include credit scoring; ML/AI in underwriting; mortgages and rental housing; credit cards; student loans; regulators, banks, and non-banks in the US financial system; and high-risk products and consumer financial distress.

PREREQUISITES

No strict prerequisites. Either 33001 (Microeconomics) or 35200 (Corporation Finance) is recommended but not required.

MATERIALS

Readings and handouts posted on Canvas site.

GRADES

Grades will be based on class participation, homework assignments, an optional midterm exam, and a final exam.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 07 2025

INTERNATIONAL CORPORATE FINANCE (35210) - [RAJAN, RAGHURAM>>](#)

CONTENT

This course will explore the challenges of corporate finance and investment in an integrated (and possible de-globalizing) world economy. How should one

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35210-01

Winter 2026
Section: 35207-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

optimally organize the location of production, control, and financing? What kinds of new concerns emerge when the whole world, rather than just one's domestic economy, becomes the arena of decision making? How does corporate decision making depend on the environment one is doing business in? In a world that is changing fast, this course will focus on finance and economics, but also on geo-politics, climate change, automation, and other important issues confronting us today. We will also have optional guest lectures outside class.

TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35210-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Strict prerequisite (not to be taken concurrently): 35200 or any one of 35201, 30130, 34101, or 35902. An undergraduate equivalent, or a basic corporate finance course elsewhere could work. Email me for permission. CFA or work experience is no substitute. If you have done something equivalent elsewhere in a college/university (CPA/CFA courses not acceptable), send the instructor an email with (1) brief course description (2) book used (3) and which college/university you took the course in, and he will respond.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

The course will be based on a set of readings and cases.

GRADES

Grades will be based on class participation, case-write-ups, and an exam. I discourage auditors, not because I have anything against them, but because experience tells me that if anyone does not read and do some work on the cases before class, they will not learn much.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 03 2026

EMERGING MARKETS FINANCE AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP (35213) - COLONNELLI,

CONTENT

Emerging markets (EMs) have recently become major contributors to global economic growth, with the past decade witnessing an unprecedented boom in entrepreneurship and private capital flows around the world. This course offers an overview of the key issues faced by high-growth entrepreneurs and investors operating in EMs, using the case method to drive active discussion and analysis. Through debate and highly interactive class discussions, students will engage directly with real-world decisions faced by founders, venture capitalists, and private equity investors. The course is particularly relevant for students interested in entrepreneurship, venture capital (VC), or private equity (PE)—especially growth equity—in global markets. Weekly sessions feature high-profile guest speakers (both founders and investors), allowing students to connect classroom frameworks to current practice.

The “Emerging Markets Finance and Entrepreneurship” course (EMFE) is organized around the life cycle of firm growth and investment in emerging markets, progressing from the macro and institutional context to financing mechanisms, deal structuring, and value realization. We begin by examining why emerging markets remain “emerging,” then turn to the entrepreneurial finance ecosystem and the different sources of capital available to founders. The middle section focuses on financing growth, studying how investors structure and manage capital across stages, sectors, and risk profiles. The final weeks move to exits and fund dynamics, analyzing how investors create and capture value and how limited partners and general partners structure their relationships. We will conclude with a wrap-up session and discussion of recent trends relevant to entrepreneurs and investors.

The goal of the course is not to become experts on particular countries or regions but rather to train ourselves in the use of principles that can be applied to evaluate entrepreneurship and investment opportunities across many countries, markets, and sectors. Ultimately, the goal is to ensure you leave the course comfortable navigating and analyzing the rapidly expanding entrepreneurial finance ecosystems across emerging markets. Our case lineup spans a wide range of regions: four cases on Latin America, three on Asia, two on Africa, one on emerging Europe, and three at an international scale.

PREREQUISITES

There are no formal prerequisites for the class. However, students with a weaker background in corporate finance—and particularly in venture capital (VC) or private equity (PE)—should expect to spend time before each session reviewing the supplementary background materials that will be posted on Canvas. The class is primarily case- and discussion-based, emphasizing analytical reasoning and decision-making. While much of the learning comes through qualitative debate, several sessions incorporate quantitative analysis (for example, modeling a cap table). Students should be comfortable performing basic calculations on cap tables and following the standard terminology used in VC and PE settings.

This course can be taken before or after Entrepreneurial Finance and Private Equity (BUSN 34101) and other related offerings, and it serves as an excellent

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35213-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

complement for students interested in entrepreneurship, venture investing, or growth equity in emerging markets.

Students who are unsure whether the course might be “too introductory” or “too advanced” for their background are encouraged to email me before bidding begins to discuss fit.

Instructor permission required for auditors.

MATERIALS

Cases and required readings (articles, academic papers, book chapters) will be posted on Canvas. The course description and class schedule will also be posted on Canvas.

GRADES

Based on class participation (40%), weekly case write-ups and short assignments (20%), and a final take-home exam (40%). Cannot be taken pass/fail. Instructor permission required for auditors (auditors cannot participate in class discussion and need to submit satisfactory weekly assignments).

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 21 2025

DEBT, DISTRESS, AND RESTRUCTURING (35214) - [SUFİ, AMİR>>](#)

CONTENT

This is an advanced corporate finance class designed to help students develop expertise on the main topics of leveraged finance: credit origination, credit investing, capital structure, corporate debt, credit cycles, credit default swaps, and restructuring. The leveraged finance market constitutes over \$3 trillion of assets outstanding in the United States alone, and it is growing rapidly.

We will do a deep dive into the type of debt instruments issued by firms: syndicated (leveraged) loans, high yield bonds, revolving credit facilities, mezzanine debt, and convertible bonds. We will also cover the main institutions that originate such debt, including investment banks, private credit (direct lender) funds, and opportunistic credit funds. The middle part of the course focuses on drafting credit investment memos, where students investigate a company in detail to make a recommendation on originating a credit or investing in a credit in the secondary market. The last part of the course covers the rich strategic actions taken by investors in the leveraged

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35214-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 35214-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406

finance market, including liability management exercises (LMEs) and the details of out-of-court restructuring (distressed debt exchanges) and in-court restructuring (Chapter 11).

In-Person Only

This class is designed for students in all finance and consulting fields, but with a particular focus on those who want to work in financial management of firms, private credit, private equity, banking, corporate restructuring, turnaround advising, or fixed income investing. Many law students also take the class, given the heavy overlap of finance and legal considerations in this area.

PREREQUISITES

Business 30000, 33001, 41000 (or 41100), 35000, 35200 strongly recommended for success in this class. Non-Booth students need faculty permission. Cannot enroll in BUSN 35214 if BUSN 35824 or 35224 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

This class will be both lecture and case-based. The cases are mostly original to this course, and focus on realistic situations in originating or investing in leveraged finance situations and in restructuring situations. We will also focus on current events and cases to make the lessons learned in class relevant for those looking to work in leveraged finance.

GRADES

Grades will be determined by cases, class participation, a final quiz, and a group final project. No pass/fail grades. No provisional grades. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 23 2026

BEHAVIORAL AND INSTITUTIONAL FINANCE (35215) - [VISHNY, ROBERT>>](#)

CONTENT

This is an advanced course covering a variety of special topics. These topics should include: Understanding financial crises and the role of banks; Investor

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35215-01

sentiment, anomalies, and market efficiency; The money management business and the inherent limitations of professional arbitrage; The role of cross-country institutional differences in explaining differences in financial markets and access to finance; Finance and rent-seeking: Are financial people overpaid?; Implications of asset price volatility for corporate finance, including merger waves and financial innovation.

PREREQUISITES

Bus 35000 and 35200 or equivalent.

MATERIALS

Selected readings.

GRADES

Based on class participation, a short paper, and a longer final paper.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

FINANCIAL CRISES (35218) - [CHABOT, BEN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course focuses on financial crises. Students will learn 1) why financial crises occur, 2) how they impact the economy and 3) what institutions and regulations have evolved to mitigate them. Thankfully, serious financial crises are rare, but their consequences are often felt for centuries. Students will become familiar with the historical crises that gave rise to today's institutions and regulatory framework and the theoretical models developed to explain past crises that guide policymakers today. Examples include 1) the bank runs that gave rise to our current global regulatory framework and institutions such as the Federal Reserve, 2) sovereign debt and currency crises, 3) the Great Depression and 2008 Global Financial Crises, and 4) stablecoins and their risks.

PREREQUISITES

There are no essential prerequisites. Familiarity with Introductory econometrics, micro- and macroeconomics is helpful.

TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 35215-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35218-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only
New Course

MATERIALS

Readings: All Readings are available online free of charge.

GRADES

Grades: grades will be based on empirical homeworks (20%), in-class quizzes (30%) and a cumulative final exam (50%).

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 11 2025

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE AND ACTIVISM - BOARD AND DIRECTOR ROLES IN CRITICAL DECISIONS (35222) - [ADRIANOPOLI, CARLIN>>](#) ; [HESSLER, STEPHEN>>](#) ; [SCHRIESHEIM, ROBERT>>](#)

CONTENT

This class will provide a detailed and practical education on the functions of corporate boards—and fiduciary duties of directors—in those types of complex circumstances where decision-making process and judgments are critical and, sometimes, the difference between the success and failure of the enterprise. Drawing from the lessons of real-world case studies and taught from the firsthand experiences of principals and professionals who were involved, issues covered will meet at the intersection of business strategy, law, and corporate finance with stakeholder value and board governance being omnipresent considerations.

The content will include original case materials with guest speakers providing an “in-person” view to the board room as directors address high-stakes matters including, in some cases, situations in which the co-teachers were either principals as board members, officers, financial and legal advisors.

Select topics to be covered will include, among others:

1. Overview of Corporate Governance and the Board’s Oversight Functions;
2. Board Building and Evolution: How Boards are Built at IPO, How Boards Change Over Time as the Company Evolves;
3. Activism Investing and Governance: How Large Activist Funds Invest, Consider Proxy Fights, and Conduct Board Refreshment;
4. The Board and Change-in-Control M&A;
5. Distressed Company Boards and Distressed Investor Influence on Board Governance;
6. Boards in Crisis Management Situations Including Distressed Situations and Chapter 11; and
7. Governance in Controlled or Dual Stock Companies.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35222-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if BUSN 35220 taken previously: strict.

MATERIALS

This class will be lecture and case-based. Case materials will be provided to the class in advance. Supplemental reading material may also be recommended.

GRADES

Grades for the class will be based on individual performance assessed through:

- 20%: Class attendance and participation;
- 30%: Three two-page reaction papers due 24 hours prior to the scheduled class considering the reading materials and case study for the upcoming class; and
- 50%: a final paper between ten to fifteen pages considering a real world issue in corporate governance. Inspiration may be drawn from assigned readings, supplemental readings, or any other source related to the subject matter of the course.

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 05 2025

GLOBAL ENTREPRENEURSHIP, VENTURE CAPITAL AND PRIVATE EQUITY (35223) - COLONNELLI, EMANUELE>>

CONTENT

This course is exclusively open to Specialized Masters students (Master in Management and Master in Finance) who are studying in London during Winter Quarter 2026.

Emerging markets (EMs) have recently become major contributors to global economic growth, with the past decade witnessing an unprecedented boom in entrepreneurship and private capital flows around the world. This course offers an overview of the key issues faced by high-growth entrepreneurs and investors operating in EMs, using the case method to drive active discussion and analysis. Through debate and highly interactive class discussions, students will engage directly with real-world decisions faced by founders, venture capitalists, and private equity investors. The course is particularly relevant for students interested in entrepreneurship, venture capital (VC), or private equity (PE)—especially growth equity—in global markets. Weekly sessions feature high-profile guest speakers (both founders and investors), allowing students to connect classroom frameworks to current practice.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35223-01
Day/Time: TBD
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only
Global SMP

The “Emerging Markets Finance and Entrepreneurship” course (EMFE) is organized around the life cycle of firm growth and investment in emerging markets, progressing from the macro and institutional context to financing mechanisms, deal structuring, and value realization. We begin by examining why emerging markets remain “emerging,” then turn to the entrepreneurial finance ecosystem and the different sources of capital available to founders. The middle section focuses on financing growth, studying how investors structure and manage capital across stages, sectors, and risk profiles. The final weeks move to exits and fund dynamics, analyzing how investors create and capture value and how limited partners and general partners structure their relationships. We will conclude with a wrap-up session and discussion of recent trends relevant to entrepreneurs and investors.

The goal of the course is not to become experts on particular countries or regions but rather to train ourselves in the use of principles that can be applied to evaluate entrepreneurship and investment opportunities across many countries, markets, and sectors. Ultimately, the goal is to ensure you leave the course comfortable navigating and analyzing the rapidly expanding entrepreneurial finance ecosystems across emerging markets. Our case lineup spans a wide range of regions: four cases on Latin America, three on Asia, two on Africa, one on emerging Europe, and three at an international scale.

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 05 2025

DISTRESSED DEBT INVESTING (35224) - MEHTA, RAVI>>

CONTENT

This course focuses on the principles of distressed debt investing. The course covers fundamental credit analysis, an overview of the bankruptcy process, a description of the mechanics around the trading of distressed debt in the secondary marketplace, and the basics of modeling prospective returns of distressed debt opportunities from the perspective of an investor in these transactions. Students will come out of the course with an understanding of the capital structure of highly leveraged companies and an understanding of how to underwrite and assess their debt.

Students will approach distressed debt transactions from a variety of stakeholder perspectives – including creditors, debtors, judges, and restructuring advisors. The course will consist of a series of case studies covering a range of transaction types, including debt exchanges, liability management exercises (“LMEs”), bankruptcies, application of asset sale proceeds, and litigation-oriented credit investments. The seminar will feature leading lawyers, credit investors, and investment bankers as guest lecturers.

The course will benefit students who are interested in asset management, credit investing, private equity, and restructuring/turnarounds.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35224-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only
New Course

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll in BUSN 35224 if 35214 taken previously: strict. Law school students and other non-Booth students require instructor consent: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

The reading materials for this course will consist of a customized "case packet" created for each of the case studies we will do together over the course of the quarter. The materials will be actual legal briefs, judicial opinions, and other document types from each of the case studies.

GRADES

Grading will be based on in-class participation (40%), written submissions to weekly case packets (40%), and a final project (20%). The final project will be done in groups of five people and will consist of writing an investment memo describing a potential distressed debt investment opportunity. Written responses to weekly case packets will be assessed on clarity, depth of analysis, and a pragmatic approach.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 19 2026

SEMINAR: FINANCE (35600) - [BASTIANELLO, FRANCESCA>>](#) ; [NOEL, PASCAL>>](#)

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 35600=ECON 55600

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35600-60
T 1:20 PM-2:50 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SEMINAR: FINANCE (35600) - BYBEE, LELAND>> ; COLONNELLI, EMANUELE>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 35600=ECON 55600

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35600-60
T 1:20 PM-2:50 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SEMINAR: FINANCE (35600) - KOIJEN, RALPH>> ; SUFI, AMIR>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 35600=ECON 55600

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35600-60
T 1:20 PM-2:50 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

APPLIED THEORY WORKSHOP (35601) - [LESHNO, JACOB>>](#)

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. One year in PhD program, and consent of instructor.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 16 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35601-60
T 3:30 PM-5:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only

APPLIED THEORY WORKSHOP (35601) - [PERNOUD, AGATHE>>](#)

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. One year in PhD program, and consent of instructor.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 28 2026

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35601-60
T 3:30 PM-5:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only

HEALTHCARE FINANCE (35817, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [VERONESI, PIETRO>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

This course discusses the challenges to finance progress in healthcare in the 21st century, and the possible solutions, with a specific focus on drug discovery. The course reviews the current framework for drug approval, including the economics of clinical trials, and introduces the tools used for investment valuation, such as decision trees, financial and real options, Monte Carlo simulations, and portfolio theory applied to drug discovery and development. We review the venture capital and private debt markets as source of funding. We finally discuss the recent area of personalized medicine and targeted therapies, its current challenges, and the promises offered by new technologies, such as machine learning and artificial intelligence, and their impact on healthcare finance. Case studies are used to cement the concepts discussed in class.

Guest Speaker on day 4: [Keith Crandell](#), co-founder of ARCH Venture Partners.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if 35118 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 14 2026

THE FAMILY OFFICE (35830, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [HEATON, JOHN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is meant for current and future leaders of family offices: members of a family and/or part of a professional management team. Students in the course will develop insights into the different roles that family offices play, effective leadership, structure of these offices, defining goals for investment and distribution and other important topics.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if 35146 or 35145 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 35830-88
08/10, 08/11, 08/13, 08/14, 08/15
EMBA2 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
50 Unit Course

No non-Booth Students

In-Person Only

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 07 2026

RESEARCH PROJECTS: FINANCE (35908) - [FAMA, EUGENE>>](#)

CONTENT

This is a research course for Ph.D. students and research-oriented MBA students. The course requirement is a research paper, due at the end of the quarter. The prerequisites are (i) my approval of the research topic, (ii) my judgment that the student has sufficient background to complete the project, and (iii) the topic is in my area of interest and expertise, so I can be helpful in seeing the paper to completion. Empirical paper topics in finance and economics are most likely to meet these criteria. Projects can be carried out independently or in groups of up to three students. There is one class session per week, where verbal progress reports are given, and discussed by the rest of the class. There is a final one-hour presentation of each paper. Weekly attendance is expected. Participation by the instructor is via Zoom.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35908-50
W 1:30 PM-5:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

PREREQUISITES

Consent of instructor: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

The course grade is based primarily on the final paper, but class participation is also considered. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. No provisional grades.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

NEW DEVELOPMENTS IN PUBLIC FINANCE (35916) - GANONG, PETER ; NOEL, PASCAL>> ; ZWICK, ERIC>>

CONTENT

This course provides graduate-level discussion of topics and methods in public finance. This course has two objectives. The first is to teach current topics and methods in public finance. The second is to advance students' development as economists by providing training in the production of high-quality research. This training may help students read, contribute to, and draw from recent progress in this literature.

The course covers a wide variety of applied econometric and theoretical approaches. It also discusses applications of a wide variety of datasets and methods that are useful in many settings for public finance and applied economics research.

The course will cover the following topics:

1. Investment tax policy
2. Housing
3. Taxation and inequality
4. Social insurance
5. Consumption, household finance, and public policy
6. Debt, household finance, and public policy

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 35916=ECON 36330/PPHA 42540. PhD student: strict. MBA students require instructor permission: strict.

MATERIALS

Required readings.

GRADES

Students will complete a reading response each week (either a slide summary or a response paper) and write a 5-to-7 page research proposal. Grades will be determined as follows: 50% for the reading responses and class participation, and 50% for the research proposal. No provisional grades.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35916-50
M 1:20 PM-4:20 PM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

RESEARCH SEMINAR (35930) - NAGEL, STEFAN>> ; NOEL, PASCAL>> ; ZHANG, ANTHONY>>

CONTENT

PhD research seminar for third year students in both Finance and the joint Financial Economics PhD program.

The course will meet for 80 minutes each week, and at the end of the academic year students are expected to finish at least one research paper.

PREREQUISITES

3rd year PhD students only. BUSN 35930=ECON 49700

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

No provisional grades.

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35930-50
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

RESEARCH SEMINAR (35930) - PATTERSON, CHRISTINA>> ; ROSSI-HANSBERG, ESTEBAN

CONTENT

PhD research seminar for third year students in both Finance and the joint Financial Economics PhD program.

The course will meet for 80 minutes each week, and at the end of the academic year students are expected to finish at least one research paper.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 35930-02
M 10:30 AM-11:50 AM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD

In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

3rd year PhD students only. BUSN 35930=ECON 49700

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

No provisional grades.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: September 24 2025

RESEARCH SEMINAR (35931) - [NAGEL, STEFAN>>](#) ; [NOEL, PASCAL>>](#) ; [ZHANG, ANTHONY>>](#)

CONTENT

PhD research seminar for third year students in both Finance and the joint Financial Economics PhD program.

The course will meet for 80 minutes each week, and at the end of the academic year students are expected to finish at least one research paper.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35931-50
T 4:00 PM-5:30 PM
Harper Center
5SE - Faculty Conference Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

3rd year PhD students only. BUSN 35931=ECON 49800

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

No provisional grades.

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

RESEARCH SEMINAR (35931) - PATTERSON, CHRISTINA>> ; ROSSI-HANSBERG, ESTEBAN

CONTENT

PhD research seminar for third year students in both Finance and the joint Financial Economics PhD program.

The course will meet for 80 minutes each week, and at the end of the academic year students are expected to finish at least one research paper.

PREREQUISITES

3rd year PhD students only. BUSN 35931=ECON 49800

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

No provisional grades.

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 04 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 35931-02
M 3:00 PM-4:20 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only

RESEARCH SEMINAR (35932) - NAGEL, STEFAN>> ; NOEL, PASCAL>> ; ZHANG, ANTHONY>>

CONTENT

PhD research seminar for third year students in both Finance and the joint Financial Economics PhD program.

The course will meet for 80 minutes each week, and at the end of the academic year students are expected to finish at least one research paper.

PREREQUISITES

3rd year PhD students only. BUSN 35932=ECON 49900

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35932-50
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PhD - students only

GRADES

No provisional grades.

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

RESEARCH SEMINAR (35932) - PATTERSON, CHRISTINA>> ; ROSSI-HANSBERG, ESTEBAN

CONTENT

PhD research seminar for third year students in both Finance and the joint Financial Economics PhD program.

The course will meet for 80 minutes each week, and at the end of the academic year students are expected to finish at least one research paper.

This section will meet in Saieh Hall.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 35932-02
M 3:00 PM-4:30 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

3rd year PhD students only. BUSN 35932=ECON 49900

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

No provisional grades.

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 09 2026

MANAGERIAL DECISION MODELING (36106) - AFÈCHE, PHILIPP>>

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

[Note: If the above link to my faculty page is not working, please click on this link.](#)

PLEASE REFER TO THE COURSE SYLLABUS FOR MORE DETAILS; if you have any questions about this course, please do not hesitate to email me at philipp.afeche@chicagobooth.edu

OVERVIEW AND LEARNING OBJECTIVES

The modern business world presents managers with important and challenging decision problems that involve complex situations, uncertainty and many possible options. This course focuses on managerial decision problems that are amenable to quantitative analysis.

This course teaches how to systematically structure, model, analyze and ultimately solve such managerial decision problems using Excel spreadsheets. We consider problems from business areas including operations, marketing, finance, and strategy. For each business problem we discuss how to build an appropriate mathematical model to structure and formulate the problem; how to analyze and solve the model; and how to analyze and discuss the managerial interpretation of the solution.

This course takes a practical approach that focuses on modeling, analysis and interpretation, rather than on developing the underlying theory or algorithms. We develop and use Excel spreadsheets as a modeling platform, because spreadsheets have become an essential medium of business analysis. Using Excel commands, functions, and add-ins, you learn how to select, apply and interpret the solution of the appropriate analytical tool, including optimization, simulation, and decision trees. This practical approach has proven to be accessible and effective for managers, who find spreadsheets to be an intuitive and user-friendly platform for business analysis.

In sum, you will learn how to:

- *Structure a decision problem:* identifying the objective, decision alternatives, input parameters, and sources of uncertainty.
- *Build a mathematical model to formalize the decision problem:*
 - *Optimization models (linear, nonlinear)* - for resource allocation (how to utilize available resources optimally)
 - *Simulation models* - for risk analysis and incorporating uncertainty in problem parameters
 - *Decision tree models* - for multiperiod sequential decision making.
- *Analyze the model solution:* Is the decision fairly robust, or very sensitive to the input parameters of the model? What is the managerial interpretation of the model solution?
- *Use Microsoft Excel as a platform for model building, solution, and analysis:* Spreadsheets are a useful medium for learning the decision modeling concepts mentioned above without the large time investment of learning a general purpose programming language (like Python). In addition to standard Excel tools such as Goal Seek and Data Table, we will use add-ins such as Solver, SolverTable, Precision Tree, and @RISK. This is NOT a course for learning Excel, the students will be expected to go through a introductory tutorial of Excel before the first class.

The classes will comprise mini-lectures to introduce the modeling and analytical concepts, followed by an interactive discussion of a few (3-5) representative problems. We will develop the models for these problems and implement, solve and analyze them in Excel.

Spring 2026
Section: 36106-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 36106-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

There are NO strict prerequisites. However, the following preparation/background is helpful.

1. *Basic Statistics*: Any previous or concurrent exposure to statistics at the level of 41000 will be helpful. Basic statistical concepts such as random variables, probability distributions, variance, covariance will be used. We will briefly review the important concepts when necessary, but will not spend a lot of time trying to teach such concepts.
2. *Basic Finance/Accounting*: Although the example models discussed in this class cross many functions of business, very little prior background in those areas is sufficient. Basic financial concepts such as net present value, discounted cash flow analysis, stocks and options, and so on will often be used. We will briefly review the important concepts when necessary, but will not spend a lot of time to teach such concepts. Our emphasis will be on applying analytical modeling techniques to analyze the business problem on hand and demonstrate how such concepts can be used in our models.
3. *Basic Excel*: I will assume that students have some familiarity with Excel, but are not an Excel expert. For example, the following are expected:
 - knowing how to enter and copy simple formulas involving relative and absolute cell addresses (A1 and \$A\$1)
 - how to use general-purpose Excel functions (for example, the IF() function)
 - how to draw different types of graphs (bar/line) in Excel
4. *Computing*: This course heavily relies on hands-on, in-class learning. Therefore, it is absolutely essential to bring your laptop to each class, so that you can actively participate in developing and analyzing the example problems during class.

Cannot enroll in BUSN 36106 if BUSN 20510 taken previously.

GRADES

Based on exams, homework assignments, which include spreadsheet model building and case analyses, and class participation. Both the Midterm and Final exams are take home, open book/open notes, and mandatory. Computer will be needed.

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. No early grades. (Provisional grades permitted.)

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

MANAGERIAL DECISION MODELING (36106) - [ATA, BARIS>>](#)

CONTENT

BUS 36106 is designed to sharpen students' analytical skills and elucidate quantitative modeling as an aid in managerial decision-making. This new version of the course teaches various ways to frame, set up and solve managerial questions about resource allocation, revenue management, finance, marketing, operations, risk analysis, data analysis, and forecasting using Microsoft Excel, as well as various tools and add-ins. The course will introduce various modeling frameworks and analytical tools in optimization, simulation, and data analysis. Students in this course will become proficient in formulating relevant managerial questions in the language of optimization and simulation modeling, as well as in solving the resulting problems using the frameworks covered in the course and interpreting the results. The course involves hands-on active learning through in-class cases and examples, homework and term project which applies the tools and modeling frameworks learned in the course to a business problem.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 36106 if BUSN 20510 taken previously. No Non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

Based on individual and group homework, a take-home midterm, and a group project.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 31 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 36106-02
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 36106-03
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 36106-04
M 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Summer 2026
Section: 36106-81
06/16, 06/18, 06/23, 06/25,
06/30, 07/02, 07/07, 07/09,
07/14, 07/21
TTH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
1st Half: Week 1 - Week 5
In-Person Only

MANAGERIAL DECISION MODELING (36106) - [NIAZADEH, RAD>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Decision making plays a critical and catalytic role in the modern business world, as managers are often forced to prioritize among feasible actions in complex situations; In such scenarios, making an informed quantitative decision --versus an educated guess-- can drastically change the outcome and impact the business. However, successful quantitative decision making requires the ability to structure complex problems, to analyze available options in an uncertain world, and to finally make the best decision given the information available.

In this course, we learn basic frameworks, methodologies, and analytical tools required for quantitative managerial decision making in a wide range of business areas including operations, marketing, and finance. Our goal is learning the foundations and applying these tools to several managerial questions related to resource allocation, revenue management, market design, risk analysis, and data analysis. On our journey towards this goal, we learn how to "structure a decision problem" by identifying objectives, decision alternatives, input parameters, and sources of uncertainty. We then learn how to "build mathematical models to formalize decision problems" by applying analytical tools such as optimization, simulation, and decision trees. We then switch gears to "analyzing model solutions" by applying basic statistics, probability, and stochastic processes. If time permits, we will cover some basics in machine learning that can be helpful in quantitative decision making.

We mainly use Microsoft Excel as a platform for model building, solution, and analysis: In addition to standard Excel tools such as Goal Seek and Data Table, we will learn to use important Excel add ons such as Sensitivity Toolkit, Solver, SolverTable, Precision Tree, @RISK, and RiskOptimizer. These tools can also be used in other Booth classes. If time permits, we will also try to have a crash tutorial on simulation and modeling in Python, which will be helpful to prepare for more advanced decision modeling courses such as Bus 36109.

PREREQUISITES

Any previous or concurrent exposure to statistics at the level of 41000, financial accounting at the level of 30000, and microeconomics at the level of 33001 will be helpful, but not strictly required. Although the example models discussed in this class cross many functions of business, little or no prior background in those areas is required.

It is assumed that students have some familiarity with Excel. However, one does not have to be an Excel expert to benefit from the course. Knowing how to enter and copy simple formulas involving relative and absolute cell addresses, how to use general-purpose Excel functions (for example, the If() function) and how to draw different types of graphs in Excel should be sufficient. There will be an Excel review session during the first week to help set the expectations.

This course involves in-class software demonstrations and "hands-on" practices. Students will be expected to bring their laptop to class each week.

Cannot enroll in BUSN 36106 if BUSN 20510 taken previously.

GRADES

Based on exams, homework assignments, which include spreadsheet model building and case analyses, and class participation. We have an in-class

Autumn 2025
Section: 36106-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 36106-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

Midterm and a take home Final exam, both open book/open notes and mandatory. Computers will be needed. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 11 2025

MANAGERIAL DECISION MODELING (36106) - SANDIKCI, BURHANEDDIN>>

CONTENT

The modern business world regularly forces managers to make decisions of great importance in complex situations and in the face of much uncertainty that involve many possible options for action. Successful decision-making, therefore, requires the ability to structure complex problems, to analyze available options in an uncertain world, and to finally make the best decision given the information available. This course teaches you frameworks for how to formulate managerial decision models that represent real-world problems in a wide range of business areas including operations, marketing, finance, and strategy. You learn how to analyze and ultimately solve such decision models and to understand the managerial interpretations of your model solution. The skills you learn in this course will greatly enhance your analytical problem solving capabilities.

This course develops and uses Excel spreadsheets as a modeling platform, because spreadsheets have become an essential medium of business analysis. You learn how to apply analytical tools including optimization, simulation, and decision trees to examine managerial decision models using Excel commands, functions, and add-ins. You practice good spreadsheet design and presentation principles, and perform comprehensive sensitivity analyses using your spreadsheet models to check the robustness of the proposed decisions. Business applications include those of resource allocation (how to utilize available resources optimally), risk analysis (how to incorporate uncertainty in problem parameters), and sequential decision-making through time. In case discussions you explore the effectiveness of various spreadsheet model designs in informing managerial decision-making.

PREREQUISITES

Any previous or concurrent exposure to statistics at the level of 41000, financial accounting at the level of 30000, and microeconomics at the level of 33001 will be helpful, but not strictly required. Although the example models discussed in this class cross many functions of business, little or no prior background in those areas is required.

It is assumed that students have some familiarity with Excel. However, one does not have to be an Excel expert to benefit from the course. Knowing how

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 36106-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 36106-02
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 36106-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

to enter and copy simple formulas involving relative and absolute cell addresses, how to use general-purpose Excel functions (for example, the If() function) and how to draw different types of graphs in Excel should be sufficient.

This course involves in-class software demonstrations and "hands-on" practices. Students will be expected to have a computer that they can work with regularly.

Cannot enroll in BUSN 36106 if BUSN 20510 taken previously.

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Individual and group homework assignments, final exam, and peer evaluation. The assignments and exam include spreadsheet model building and case analyses. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. No provisional grades and early final grades.

RESTRICTIONS

- No auditors
- Mandatory attendance week 1
- No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

ADVANCED DECISION MODELS WITH PYTHON (36109) - [EISENSTEIN, DONALD>>](#)

CONTENT

This course focuses on modeling, analyzing and solving managerial decision problems using Python, the de facto programming language of business analytics.

We will address a variety of problem areas such as optimal assignment and routing, resource allocation, and sequential decision analysis. Our toolkit will involve optimization (deterministic and stochastic) and discrete event simulation.

In addition to modeling, we will learn what it means to use professional software tools. For example, one decision model we address is the assignment of Uber drivers to customers. There are various options for us to consider of how to model such a decision. And with our ability to utilize Google’s API to get travel time data we are able to build a decision tool that can be used in the enterprise.

SCHEDULE
Winter 2026 Section: 36109-01 T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM Harper Center C05 In-Person Only
Winter 2026 Section: 36109-02 W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM Harper Center C05 In-Person Only
Winter 2026

We will also learn how to build discrete event simulations with Python. This is a very powerful tool that can be used to simulate countless processes. For example, how items flow through a logistical system, customers through a restaurant or hospital, or a disease through a community.

The class is a mix of modern programming tools and decision modeling. As such, the class can be, depending on your background, challenging and time consuming. Bus 36106 (Managerial Decision Modeling) is a suggested prerequisite for this class. A student may skip Bus 36106 if they have a good background in Linear Programming and basic probability and statistics (an Industrial Engineering major for example). Students should also have exposure to a modern object oriented programming language (Bus 36110 or Bus 32100 is one way to gain such experience). For students with programming experience but new to Python, there is a series of tutorials available on Canvas to work through before our first class.

This class is a natural follow-on to Bus 36106, Managerial Decision Modeling. Bus 36106 is constrained by the tools available within Excel and its limited ability to interact with all the information available from the internet.

This class is also a natural companion to Bus 36110, Application Development. Whereas Bus 36110 covers the full-stack building of web applications, it does not delve into the decision making or algorithmic needs of the enterprise. A student who has already taken Bus 36110 will find it easy to utilize their knowledge of the internet and object oriented programming for this class, and be ready to focus on decision modeling.

Please note that the use of "Advanced" in the course title does not pertain to Python. We will not cover advanced concepts of the Python language. In fact, I will stick to the basics of the language so that the course is accessible to students with only an introduction to programming in any modern language. The "Advanced" better describes that using Python rather than Excel for decision modeling is more challenging and advanced in its capabilities. And "Advanced" describes the types of models we will be able to examine here vs. Bus 36106 (for example stochastic optimization and discrete event simulation).

Review the syllabus for more detailed information.

Section: 36109-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Bus 36106 is recommended. See advice given in Content section of course description.

Experience with an object-oriented programming language. See advice given in Content section of course description.

MATERIALS

Course materials will be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Homework assignments, in-class assignments, in-class midterm and in-class final exam. No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

APPLICATION DEVELOPMENT (36110) - [BETINA, RAGHU>>](#)

CONTENT

*Note: Due to the intensive support requirements and volume of requests, **we can't allow auditors for this course**. We have many more sections available this year, so please plan ahead and enroll as usual through your program (or Take 3 for alums). If you are on the waitlist, you are welcome to attend Day 1 so that you can keep up in case someone drops.*

The new reality is that every company is a software company. Even in traditionally brick-and-mortar industries, software is performing more and more of the work. And, of course, many companies (especially "lean startups") are purely software-based.

Lacking an understanding of *how applications work* and *how software gets built* while working in a software-based world puts you at a disadvantage.

In this course, we will demystify these things and dispel this disadvantage. We believe the best way to do that is for you to just write and ship an app idea yourself.

To do this, you will have to become a *full-stack developer* — someone who can take *an idea* all the way to *a live app on the internet*.

This involves learning much more than just one language. You'll learn multiple languages (*front-end* and *back-end* languages), so that you can write a *whole* application (not just one slice of it). We'll also see how to deploy it on industrial-grade cloud infrastructure, as well as how to instrument it with analytics so that you can gather feedback and iterate.

You will ultimately build a functional prototype of your own app idea. To do this, you will learn the Ruby on Rails web application framework. Our objective, though, is not to learn specific technologies. Instead, we want to:

1. Understand how most modern software — specifically, software-as-a-service — functions.
2. Communicate more credibly with developers on our teams.
3. Grow an eye for problems that can be solved with technology.
4. Prioritize features more prudently by developing a better feel for their costs.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 36110-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 36110-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Winter 2026
Section: 36110-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 36110-02
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 36110-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Spring 2026

5. Research and specify changes we want made to products more clearly.
6. Be empowered with a new, powerful, and just plain fun creative outlet.

Course Format

This course is entirely project-driven. We will build a series of applications together in class. We will start with a simple idea and learn just what we need about various technologies (HTML, CSS, Ruby, Rails) to make that idea real.

We will then build a slightly more complicated idea, and deepen our knowledge of each topic. And then an even more complicated idea. In this way, we will spiral across topics picking up essential, applicable knowledge; what we're not going to do are deep theoretical dives into each topic, one after the other, without ever getting to build real stuff.

In addition, you will build your own app idea. During the first few weeks, you will think of a few of your ideas and we'll then, together, select one that matches the scope of the course. This app will be your final project.

The process will generally consist of the instructor demonstrating a concept in a tutorial app and then giving the class a challenge to practice it and think up questions. You are strongly encouraged to team up and work together on the challenges.

Expectations

This course is designed for a beginner who has never programmed before. It is our goal to make programming accessible to as many people as possible, and dispel the mystique that surrounds it. It's really possible, with passion and persistence, for a beginner to become productive very quickly with today's tools.

Note: it's *possible*, but not always *easy*. If you have never seen a line of code before, you are going to be learning a lot of new things all at once, and so should plan to spend a significant amount of time. If you already have some programming experience, you may have to spend less time initially while we learn basics; but once we get into Rails, it will likely be all new to you too.

What you can expect from us in return is a lot of support. We know it's a lot, and we're here for you -- one-on-one appointments, review sessions, etc. We all will help each other on the class discussion board. There is no such thing as a dumb question; we're all beginners here, learning together.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 36110 if BUSN 20550 taken previously.

MATERIALS

You should bring your own Mac, Windows, or Linux computer. You will receive a detailed guide to setting up your development environment.

Most required software, tools, and content are available free of cost; although there are various things that you may choose to purchase (i.e. a domain name, API access, etc) for your project.

Section: 36110-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

GRADES

Participation - 40%
Homework - 40%
Final Project - 20%

No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

APPLICATION DEVELOPMENT II (36111) - [BETINA, RAGHU>>](#)

CONTENT

Application Development II (BUSN 36111) continues where Application Development (BUSN 36110) ends.

In 36110, we started from “I’ve never seen a line of code before” and ended at “I can come up with, write, and deploy a functional software-as-a-service application.”

36111 is intended for students who want to continue writing software after graduation, whether it’s to launch prototypes for entrepreneurial ventures, contribute to codebases as a technical team lead, or build side projects to stay current on tech trends.

To start with, we’ll learn ways to improve the beginner-focused code we wrote in 36110. Once you can write idiomatic, industry-standard code, you will be able to more easily read and use libraries, books, and blog posts written by professionals; and have your code understood by them. We’ll also dig deeper into the workflows that software engineering teams use for collaboration, deployment, and feedback.

With that, you will be well-positioned to join the community of professional developers, and continue learning whatever you need to ship your ideas on your own.

Specifically, we will:

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 36111-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

- Learn more advanced and concise ways to use the Ruby language and the Rails framework.
- Write automated tests, which are essential for the long-term performance and code quality of a project.
- Learn JavaScript, which will enable us to improve the responsiveness of our applications with real-time updates.
- Add robust APIs to our applications, to enable additional third-party or first-party clients.
- If time permits, add native iOS and Android apps using a hybrid framework.

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 36110 or BUSN 20550: Strict

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

You should bring your own Mac, Windows, or Linux computer. You will receive a detailed guide to setting up your development environment.

Most required software, tools, and content are available free of cost. However, you may choose to purchase e.g. a domain name, API access, etc, for your project; and there are optional lessons and books that I will recommend if you want more practice in certain areas.

GRADES

Participation - 40%

Homework - 40%

Final Project - 20%

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

WORKSHOP IN OPERATIONS/MANAGEMENT SCIENCE (36600) - CANDOGAN, OZAN>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 24 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 36600-60
T 12:10 PM-1:10 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

WORKSHOP IN OPERATIONS/MANAGEMENT SCIENCE (36600) - NIAZADEH, RAD>> ; TASKESEN, BAHAR>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 36600-60
T 12:10 PM-1:10 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 36600-60
T 12:10 PM-1:10 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

LINEAR PROGRAMMING (36900) - BIRGE, JOHN>>

CONTENT

This course provides a rigorous treatment of linear optimization. It is designed for students who want to build large-scale optimization models and need an understanding of the underlying theory. The course is theoretical in nature and the vast majority of the assignments (as well as the exams) are theorem-proof oriented. It is designed for Ph.D. students only. The course will cover polyhedral theory, theory of systems of linear inequalities, simplex method, network simplex algorithm, polynomial time solvability of linear optimization, conic programming, and interior point methods in linear and semidefinite optimization.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

Grades will be based on homework assignments and a final exam. No provisional grades. No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 18 2025

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 36900-50
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

DYNAMIC PROGRAMMING/MARKOV DECISION PROCESSES (36902) - CALDENTEY, RENE>>

CONTENT

Decisions are often made sequentially and in environments where their outcomes are subject to stochastic variability. Dynamic Programming (DP) provides a powerful tool for obtaining structural insight about, as well computing prescriptions for, such decisions. The method finds wide application in operations management, marketing, economics, and finance

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 36902-50
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room

among other fields. This course is intended to provide a rigorous introduction to the method with an emphasis on applications from these fields. When appropriate, finite or countable state Markovian settings will be used to obtain theoretical results with a minimum of technical fuss. Implementation and computational issues will be discussed.

In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Linear and/or nonlinear optimization, Markov chain theory. PhD students only.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

MATERIALS

The following textbook will be used extensively as the primary reading for the course: *Dynamic Programming and Optimal Control, Vols. 1 (3rd Edition) and 2 (4th Edition)* by Dimitri P. Bertsekas. In addition a few research papers will be distributed in class.

GRADES

No provisional grades.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 18 2026

CONVEX OPTIMIZATION (36903) - STAFF

CONTENT

The course will cover techniques in unconstrained and constrained convex optimization and a practical introduction to convex duality. The course will focus on (1) formulating and understanding convex optimization problems and studying their properties; (2) understanding and using the dual; and (3) presenting and understanding optimization approaches, including interior point methods and first order methods for non-smooth problems. Examples will be mostly from data fitting, statistics and machine learning.

This is a cross-listed course taught by Zhiyuan Li, an assistant professor at [Toyota Technological Institute at Chicago \(TTIC\)](#) and an affiliated faculty of [Computer Science](#). The course will not be held at Booth. It will be held in Toyota Technological Inst 530.

PREREQUISITES

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 36903-01
TTH 2:00 PM-3:20 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only

Linear Algebra, Multidimensional Calculus, Undergraduate Algorithms. STAT
30900/CMSC 37810 or consent of instructor. BUSN 36903=STAT 31015=CAAM
31015

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 09 2026

APPROXIMATE DYNAMIC PROGRAMMING (36905) - ADELMAN, DAN>>

CONTENT

While many real-world problems can be formulated as Markov Decision Processes, they have historically suffered in practice due to Bellman's curse of dimensionality making computation intractable. However, over the last decade or so, researchers have been making significant strides in the area of approximate dynamic programming. A wide range of practical applications have now been successfully explored, in areas ranging from supply chain and distribution management, dynamic pricing and revenue management, marketing/advertising, industrial organization, finance, and others.

In this course, students will learn the state-of-the-art theory and methods for approximate dynamic programming. We will cover the full range of approaches available, including simulation-based methods and exact methods in the following broad categories: neurodynamic programming/reinforcement learning, gradient estimation, discretization/interpolation, fixed point projection, and math programming. As such, the course is ideal preparation for students in any field of study who are interested in solving dynamic programs that capture real-world features, but are intractable using standard methods. Students will implement the various numerical methods learned on a problem of their choosing, ideally coming from their own research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 06 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 36905-50
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

STOCHASTIC PROCESSES (36906) - ATA, BARIS>>

CONTENT

This course covers basic concepts and methods in applied probability and stochastic modeling. The intended audience is master's and doctoral students in programs such as Computer Science, Statistics, Mathematics, and those in

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 36906-50
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM

the MS/OM Ph.D. in Booth School of Business. In terms of prerequisites, basic familiarity with probability theory and stochastic processes will be assumed. The exposition will be (mostly) rigorous, yet intentionally skirting some measure-theoretic details; for those interested in such details they can be found in measure theoretic textbooks and other courses (e.g. Measure Theoretic Probability sequence offered by the department of Statistics). A unifying theme in the course will be the use of asymptotic methods which constitute a powerful tool for the study of complex stochastic systems.

Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Basic familiarity with probability theory and stochastic processes will be assumed.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

No provisional grades.

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

QUEUEING THEORY (36914) - ZHONG, YUAN>>

CONTENT

This is an introductory course on the theory of queueing systems and networks, with applications to service systems, computer systems, and manufacturing. The course will expose students to both classical and modern application of queueing theory, and aims to equip students with the basic methodological tools for system performance analysis and policy design.

PREREQUISITES

Basic probability theory and stochastic processes. PhD students (Booth and Non-Booth) only. Non-Booth master's students require instructor permission: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 36914-50
F 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

MARKETING STRATEGY (37000) - [DHAR, SANJAY>>](#)

CONTENT

I use a framework-based approach to teach this course. The first half of the class is spent on building a structured approach using customer analysis (assessing how the firm could provide unique benefits to an attractive target market segment); company analysis (assessing strategic fit based on long-term strategy and core capabilities) and competitor analysis (ascertaining how to build sustainable competitive advantage against both "current" and "future" competitors). The second half of the class uses the strategic marketing analysis described above to identify issues and challenges the firm faces, and articulate marketing objectives that are used to develop the marketing plan (product development, positioning and product strategy; setting prices to capture value, determining potential channel or places of distribution and promotion & communication strategies to communicate benefits to the target market).

I also try to use multiple pedagogical tools to help students comprehend and assimilate the material. This includes lectures that introduce tools, concepts and frameworks on each topic in the framework followed by a rigorous case analysis to illustrate application. In addition, I will discuss current events, recent industry examples, and ask you to play a real-world data based pricing simulation. I have also been working with firms applying these frameworks for the last 25 years and hope that students will also share their experiences in class discussions. Finally, in order to expose you to different types of marketing careers where concepts taught in this class can be leveraged, I typically invite 1-2 guest speakers from a variety of industries.

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 37000-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Summer 2026
Section: 37000-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

I strive to enhance student problem-solving and decision-making abilities and use marketing case studies to provide an opportunity (both written and oral) to help a student develop, present, and defend their own recommendations, and to examine and discuss the recommendations of others critically. Given the rigorous and highly interactive nature of class discussion, as well as framework-based approach used, this class is helpful to students for case analysis preparation. Therefore, in addition to students pursuing marketing careers, this class is also helpful to students pursuing consulting careers, developing entrepreneurial businesses, or interested in understanding and analyzing growth and demand strategies of a corporation.

PREREQUISITES

None. Expectations for case discussion are set in the first class session so it is highly recommended that you attend the first class session and come adequately prepared. No non-Booth students. Cannot enroll in BUSN 37000 if BUSN 20600 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Course readings and cases will be posted on the class Canvas site.

GRADES

Grading is based on an individual final case exam, three group case write-ups and class participation. The expectation is that there will be an 80% minimum attendance rate. In class discussions, students are expected to be able to support their point of view and therefore it is recommended to prepare the case thoroughly with your group before class. It is best to form groups with 4-5 students (from the same section) with diverse backgrounds but compatible work schedules and similar learning objectives from the course. Your learning from this class will be commensurate with the amount you put into the class. In order to realize the benefits of the discussion format for the cases, class attendance is mandatory. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. It is highly recommended that students planning to add the course attend the first class session.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

MARKETING STRATEGY (37000) - [DIETVORST, BERKELEY>>](#)

CONTENT

IMPORTANT: Relative to other marketing strategy sections, this class will place particular emphasis on the consumer and understanding the role of consumer psychology in strategic decisions. Please consider whether or not this focus fits with your preferences before enrolling.

This course introduces the substantive and functional aspects of marketing management. Specific course goals are as follows: (1) to introduce students to marketing strategy and the elements of marketing analysis: customer analysis, competitor analysis, and company analysis; (2) to familiarize students with the elements of the marketing mix (product strategy, pricing, advertising and promotion, and distribution), and to enhance their problem-solving and decision-making abilities in these operational areas of marketing; and (3) to use marketing case studies to provide an opportunity to develop, present, and defend a student's own recommendations, and to examine and discuss the recommendations of others critically.

The course employs a balanced mix of case discussions and lectures/class discussions. Class lectures and discussions provide an exposition of key concepts, and wherever possible are supported by research on current marketing practices. The case studies provide an opportunity to apply the theories, concepts, and analytical devices developed in the lectures.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 37000 if BUSN 20600 taken previously.

GRADES

Based on a final exam, individual and group case write-ups, group project, and class attendance & participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 37000-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 37000-02
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 37000-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

MARKETING STRATEGY (37000) - HU, BEIDI>>

CONTENT

IMPORTANT: Relative to other marketing strategy sections, this class will place particular emphasis on the consumer and understanding the role of consumer psychology in strategic decisions. Please consider whether or not this focus fits with your preferences before enrolling.

This course introduces the substantive and functional aspects of marketing management. Specific course goals are as follows: (1) to introduce students to marketing strategy and the elements of marketing analysis: customer analysis, competitor analysis, and company analysis; (2) to familiarize students with the elements of the marketing mix (product strategy, pricing, advertising and promotion, and distribution), and to enhance their problem-solving and decision-making abilities in these operational areas of marketing; and (3) to use marketing case studies to provide an opportunity to develop, present, and defend a student's own recommendations, and to examine and discuss the recommendations of others critically.

The course employs a balanced mix of case discussions and lectures/class discussions. Class lectures and discussions provide an exposition of key concepts, and wherever possible are supported by research on current marketing practices. The case studies provide an opportunity to apply the theories, concepts, and analytical devices developed in the lectures.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll in BUSN 37000 if BUSN 20600 taken previously. Early and provisional grades for graduating Non-Booth students only.

First class attendance mandatory.

GRADES

Based on a final exam, individual and group case write-ups, group project, and class attendance & participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37000-02
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 37000-03
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 10 2025

MARKETING STRATEGY (37000) - KORGANBEKOVA, MALIKA>>

CONTENT

This course introduces modern marketing management techniques. Specific course goals include: 1) To introduce you to the fundamentals of modern marketing practice. Specifically, we will look at the four tactical P's — price, promotion, product, and place (distribution) — through the structural lens of the three C's — customer, competition, and company. 2) To provide a theoretical basis and data-driven techniques for analyzing the success or failure of marketing actions. 3) To familiarize you with practices that marketing consulting firms typically employ. This class aims to help you sort through jargon, allowing you to make well-informed decisions based on knowing which techniques are applicable given the situation.

This course differentiates itself from other marketing strategy sections by viewing marketing from the perspective of economics. While students are not required to have taken a course in microeconomics (33001 or a course from undergrad), it is highly recommended. We will use demand curves and profit maximization as a jumping off point to understand where and how marketing decisions influence economic calculations.

The course employs a balanced mix of case discussions and lectures/class discussions. Class lectures and discussions provide an exposition of key concepts, and wherever possible are supported by research on current marketing practices. The case studies provide an opportunity to apply the theories, concepts, and analytical devices developed in the lectures.

PREREQUISITES

Background in microeconomics (Bus 33001 or a course at the level of 33001 from undergrad) is helpful but not required. No undergrads. Cannot enroll in BUSN 37000 if BUSN 20600 taken previously.

Early and provisional grades for graduating Non-Booth students only. First class attendance mandatory.

GRADES

Based on a final exam, a final project & presentation, individual and group case write-ups, and class participation and attendance. Course cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Students must attend the first class session.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 37000-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 37000-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 21 2025

MARKETING STRATEGY (37000) - SHAPIRO, BRADLEY>>

CONTENT

This course introduces modern marketing management techniques. Specific course goals include: 1) To introduce you to the fundamentals of modern marketing practice. Specifically, we will develop a consumer-driven framework for marketing decisions, starting from consumer needs, to measuring preferences over and above next best alternatives to finally designing and delivering product offerings. 2) To provide a theoretical basis and data-driven techniques for analyzing the success or failure of marketing actions. 3) To familiarize you with practices that marketing consulting firms typically employ. This class aims to help you sort through jargon, allowing you to make well-informed decisions based on knowing which techniques are applicable given the situation.

This course differentiates itself from other marketing strategy sections by viewing marketing from the perspective of economics. While students are not required to have taken a course in microeconomics (33001 or a course from undergrad), it is highly recommended. We will use demand curves and profit maximization as a jumping off point to understand where and how marketing decisions influence economic calculations.

PREREQUISITES

Background in microeconomics (Bus 33001 or a course at the level of 33001 from undergrad) is helpful but not required. No undergrads. Cannot enroll in BUSN 37000 if BUSN 20600 taken previously.

Early and provisional grades for graduating Non-Booth students only. First class attendance mandatory.

GRADES

Based on a final exam, a final project & presentation, individual and group case write-ups, and class participation and attendance. Course cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. A few specific notes to highlight:

- Students **must** attend the first class session. If you need to be traveling during the first class session, DO NOT ENROLL.
- Attendance and participation will be both expected and graded.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 37000-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: September 08 2025

MARKETING STRATEGY (37000) - SMITH, STEPHANIE>>

CONTENT

IMPORTANT: Relative to other marketing strategy sections, this class will place particular emphasis on the consumer and understanding the role of consumer psychology in strategic decisions. Please consider whether or not this focus fits with your preferences before enrolling.

This course introduces the substantive and functional aspects of marketing management. Specific course goals are as follows: (1) to introduce students to marketing strategy and the elements of marketing analysis: customer analysis, competitor analysis, and company analysis; (2) to familiarize students with the elements of the marketing mix (product strategy, pricing, advertising and promotion, and distribution), and to enhance their problem-solving and decision-making abilities in these operational areas of marketing; and (3) to use marketing case studies to provide an opportunity to develop, present, and defend a student's own recommendations, and to examine and discuss the recommendations of others critically.

The course employs a balanced mix of case discussions and lectures/class discussions. Class lectures and discussions provide an exposition of key concepts, and wherever possible are supported by research on current marketing practices. The case studies provide an opportunity to apply the theories, concepts, and analytical devices developed in the lectures.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 37000 if BUSN 20600 taken previously.

GRADES

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37000-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 37000-04
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 37000-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 13 2025

MARKETING STRATEGY (37000) - STRULOV-SHLAIN, AVNER>>

CONTENT

Confused about which section to take? My sections are fitting for all, but best suitable for those with quantitative inclinations. However, as a behavioral economist, the class will be infused with psychological insights taken quantitatively into account. So if you have broad interests – join us!

Course Overview

Marketing is the field concerned with delivering your products and services to your consumers. What do your consumers need? What should you offer? And how to make your products actually sell? To answer these questions, the goals of this course are as follows:

1. To provide a **framework** to think and solve marketing problems. We will look at the four tactical P's — price, promotion, product, and place (distribution) — through the structural lens of the three C's — customer, competition, and company with particular focus on the customer.
2. To provide a theoretical basis and data-driven techniques for analyzing the success or failure of marketing actions, with a particular focus on making **causal inferences**.
3. To familiarize you with practices that marketing consulting firms typically employ. As a manager, you will be responsible for contracting with external firms who will promise you the world in jargon-filled Powerpoint decks. This class aims to help you sort through jargon, allowing you to make well-informed decisions based on knowing which techniques are applicable given the situation.
4. To incorporate, in a disciplined way, the **humanity of consumers into the firm's decision making** process.

You will leave this course **knowing what questions to ask**. Answers will depend on the details, but asking the right questions is the key to success.

Marketing differentiates itself from other fields you will study here at Booth in part because of its focus on consumer heterogeneity. We will take seriously the idea that one size does not fit all and that value creation involves understanding and catering to different consumer types. Thus, Marketing Strategy provides a natural complement to your microeconomics and competitive strategy courses.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 37000-03
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 37000-04
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 37000-05
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Because the goal of this class is to help you develop skills for analyzing problems rather than rote memorization of facts and cases, we will often use examples from rapidly evolving industries that present new and interesting challenges.

My class differs from other sections of Marketing Strategy in being more integrative between the standard and behavioral approaches to consumer, and firms, behavior. While the style of the framework we will use is very quantitative and econ-y, my view of consumers is rooted in psychology. When discussing the various topics, we will discuss if, when, and to what extent, behavioral biases and non-rational consumer behavior matters.

A second component that I try to emphasize is the relevance of the framework in “real” decisions. You will investigate and we will discuss together what marketing strategy actions real companies take. I aim to bring as many guest speakers from industry as possible (it will probably be just a few though).

PREREQUISITES

Background in microeconomics (Bus 33001 or a course at the level of 33001 from undergrad) is helpful but not required. Cannot enroll in BUSN 37000 if BUSN 20600 taken previously. No undergraduates.

MATERIALS

See Canvas site.

GRADES

Based on a final exam, individual and group case write-ups, attendance, and participation. Course cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

Students must attend the first class session.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 14 2025

CONSUMER BEHAVIOR (37101) - **BARTELS, DANIEL>>**

CONTENT

The purpose of this course is to inform future managers, analysts, consultants, and advisors of the psychological processes and biases underlying consumer behavior, with emphasis on how to incorporate such insights into marketing and business strategies. Contemporary approaches to business emphasize the

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 37101-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM

importance of adopting a customer focus. Marketing, in particular, begins and ends with the consumer—from determining consumer needs to providing post-purchase satisfaction.

Of course, successful marketing and business strategies depend on a thorough understanding of how people think, and thus the overarching goal of this course is to help you think differently (and better) about how consumers arrive at judgments and choices and how their choices ultimately affect their well-being. You might think that, because you're a consumer (we all are), your intuitions about the drivers of consumer behavior (including your own) are well-informed, but in fact, your intuitions about this stuff are often inaccurate. To remedy this problem, this course gives students a broad overview of important results from various behavioral sciences (e.g., psychology, marketing, economics) that clarifies how and why people perceive and process information, make decisions, and evaluate stuff the way they do.

The greater understanding of consumer psychology provided in this course will help students to develop strategic consumer insights aimed at better meeting people's needs. Moreover, because this course takes a broad psychological perspective, it highlights novel ideas for grabbing attention, shaping behavior, and changing people's minds within and outside of traditional marketing contexts. Also, notably, people everywhere (i.e., not only marketers, but almost everybody you know) are trying to influence you all the time. This means that the issues covered in this class are not only of concern to marketing managers, but to you personally, as gaining an understanding of these issues helps you better understand yourself as a target of influence. The premise of the course is that understanding consumer psychology has powerful business and personal implications.

Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Winter 2026
Section: 37101-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 37101-02
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 37101-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

BUS 37000 useful (before or concurrent), but not absolutely necessary.

MATERIALS

A selection of readings on Canvas. There will be no textbook.

GRADES

No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 14 2025

CONSUMER BEHAVIOR (37101) - DONNELLY, KRISTIN>>

CONTENT

The purpose of this course is to inform future managers, analysts, consultants, and advisors of the psychological processes and biases underlying consumer behavior, with emphasis on how to incorporate such insights into marketing and business strategies. Contemporary approaches to business emphasize the importance of adopting a customer focus. Marketing, in particular, begins and ends with the consumer—from determining consumer needs to providing post-purchase satisfaction.

Of course, successful marketing and business strategies depend on a thorough understanding of how people think, and thus the overarching goal of this course is to help you think differently (and better) about how consumers arrive at judgments and choices and how their choices ultimately affect their well-being. You might think that, because you're a consumer (we all are), your intuitions about the drivers of consumer behavior (including your own) are well-informed, but in fact, your intuitions about this stuff are often inaccurate. To remedy this problem, this course gives students a broad overview of important results from various behavioral sciences (e.g., psychology, marketing, economics) that clarifies how and why people perceive and process information, make decisions, and evaluate stuff the way they do.

The greater understanding of consumer psychology provided in this course will help students to develop strategic consumer insights aimed at better meeting people's needs. Moreover, because this course takes a broad psychological perspective, it highlights novel ideas for grabbing attention, shaping behavior, and changing people's minds within and outside of traditional marketing contexts. Also, notably, people everywhere (i.e., not only marketers, but almost everybody you know) are trying to influence you all the time. This means that the issues covered in this class are not only of concern to marketing managers, but to you personally, as gaining an understanding of these issues helps you better understand yourself as a target of influence. The premise of the course is that understanding consumer psychology has powerful business and personal implications.

PREREQUISITES

BUS 37000 useful (before or concurrent), but not absolutely necessary.

MATERIALS

No textbook.

GRADES

No pass/fail grades. No auditors. No early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SCHEDULE
Spring 2026 Section: 37101-01 W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM Harper Center C07 In-Person Only
Spring 2026 Section: 37101-02 TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM Harper Center C07 In-Person Only
Spring 2026 Section: 37101-03 W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM Gleacher Center 206 In-Person Only

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 23 2026

DATA-DRIVEN MARKETING (37103) - **HITSCH, GUENTER>>**

CONTENT

Rapid advances in information technology during the last decades have enabled firms to create and analyze large databases of customer interactions and transactions. Data-driven marketing is an approach to implement marketing decisions based on a statistical analysis of big data to improve the profitability of marketing using ROI metrics.

The class is designed to provide a broad overview of data-driven marketing techniques. In the first part of the class we study methods to measure store and market level demand using demand models. Applications include base-price optimization, data-driven price discrimination, and promotions management. We also study the measurement of short-run and long-run effects of advertising. In the second part of the class we cover customer relationship management (CRM) and database marketing. We introduce a general framework to implement customer-level targeting using predictive modeling based on customer lifetime value and return on investment (ROI) predictions. We apply this framework to customer development, retention, and acquisition decisions. The final part of the class focuses on digital marketing and how to predict the effectiveness and profitability of display and search advertising.

Throughout the class we make use of statistical tools, including regression analysis and logistic regression. In particular, all assignments and the take-home final involve practical applications of the concepts covered in class using data and methods implemented in the R statistical computing language.

PREREQUISITES

Business 37000 (or 37100) and 41000 (or 41100) recommended. Cannot enroll in 37103 if 37105 or 20620 taken previously: strict.

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37103-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Based on a final take-home exam/project, homework assignments, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Students **must** attend the first class session.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 09 2026

DATA SCIENCE FOR MARKETING DECISION MAKING (37105) - **COMPIANI, GIOVANNI>>**

CONTENT

Marketing decisions in the era of big data and artificial intelligence (AI) are based on a statistical analysis of large amounts of transaction and customer data. Using such an analysis we can predict the profitability or ROI of different marketing decisions, such as pricing, customer targeting, or digital advertising.

The goal of this class is to introduce modern data-driven marketing techniques and train the students as data scientists who can analyze data and make marketing decisions using state-of-the-art tools employed in the industry. We will cover a wide range of topics, including demand modeling, the analysis of household-level data, customer relationship management (CRM), and digital marketing.

The focus is on predicting the impact of marketing decisions, including pricing, advertising, and customer targeting, on customer profitability and the ROI from a customer interaction. The students will get immersed in a workflow that begins with the initial processing of the raw data and ends with the implementation of the marketing decision. First, we will learn how to manage and process large databases. The key tools used include some key packages in R that are designed for big data processing. Second, we will discuss and apply modern statistical tools building on regression analysis, including some key tools from the machine learning literature. Finally, we will learn how to implement key marketing decisions based on the statistical analysis of the data.

Note: The broad set of topics in this class overlaps with the topics covered in 37103 (Data-Driven Marketing). However, we will cover these topics at a faster pace and emphasize state-of-the-art techniques that are only briefly surveyed or not covered in 37103. Also, the main goal of the data assignments in 37103 is to make the students familiar with some key concepts in data-

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 37105-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

driven marketing. This class goes above and beyond this goal and introduces the students to a professional data scientist's workflow used for marketing decision-making.

PREREQUISITES

Business 41000 (or 41100): strict. Cannot enroll in 37105 if 37103 or 20620 taken previously; strict.

Throughout the class the students will write scripts in R, and correspondingly some programming experience (preferably in R) is necessary.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Lecture notes.

GRADES

Based on a final take-home exam/project, homework assignments, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 23 2025

LAB IN DEVELOPING NEW PRODUCTS AND SERVICES (37201) - MIDDLEBROOKS, ARTHUR>>

CONTENT

This course provides an in-depth understanding of state-of-the-art practices in new product/service innovation using Design Thinking methods. It offers extensive, hands-on, practical innovation experience.

Topics covered include: Design Thinking, agile innovation processes, opportunity identification, qualitative and quantitative agile user research, customer insights, idea generation and evaluation, new product prototyping/testing/optimization, forecasting, new product branding, and business cases.

SCHEDULE
Winter 2026 Section: 37201-01 TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM Harper Center 219 - Meeting Room In-Person Only
Winter 2026 Section: 37201-02 F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM

A series of group projects enables students to apply these tools on an actual client “Lab” project. Group projects are real-world innovation projects from leading company sponsors across a range of industries. Student teams work closely with their clients, guided by a faculty coach, to uncover unmet customer needs, generate ideas, develop new product/service concept prototypes, test those new product concepts quantitatively, and present recommendations to their clients.

This course covers tech, consumer, and B2B products and services. Class examples and cases include mobile apps, e-commerce, software, fintech, food and beverage, household products, healthcare, and more. I make every effort to invite one or more practicing innovation experts to guest lecture.

This course is particularly relevant for students interested in the following careers: Product Management (Tech), Management Consulting, Brand Management, Innovation, Product Marketing Management (Tech), and Corporate Strategy.

Winter 2026 Application Timeline:

- Tuesday, November 4 at noon-1pm: **Webinar** to give details about the class and application process.
- Wednesday, November 5 at midnight: **Applications** are due.
- Tuesday, November 11: **Acceptances** are announced. Students have 24 hours to drop. After that, no drops are allowed.

PREREQUISITES

Business 37000: recommended. Application and acceptance into course is required. Cannot be dropped once enrolled. Cannot take 37201 if 37200 “New Products and Services” or 37810 “New Product Development” has already been taken.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Application-based course

MATERIALS

This course includes a text, case studies, and readings from practitioners and academics.

Group projects use an online agile user research platform called UserTesting (no cost).

Each project team needs a subscription to Open AI's ChatGPT Plus service for 3 months (currently \$20/month). Within ChatGPT Plus, teams also use several custom GPTs created specifically for this course.

GRADES

100% of grades are based on the three group projects. **Group work is extensive in this course**, and **peer evaluations impact grades** for each group assignment. Students meet with their groups multiple times each week, and

Harper Center
219 - Meeting Room
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 37201-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
600AB
In-Person Only

Speak with their client and faculty coach every week. Expect to spend ~10 hours/week outside of class.

Class attendance is mandatory. In order to get the most out of the class, to participate actively during in-class activities with your project team, and to be evaluated appropriately, students need to attend class.

- You must attend the Week 1 class, or you will be dropped from the course.
- You can miss no more than ***one*** (1) class session. Otherwise, ***your final grade will be lowered by one (1) full letter grade.***
- If you miss more than ***two*** (2) class sessions, you may be withdrawn from the course.

Cannot be taken Pass/Fail. Provisional grades are given subject to timely completion of assignments.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 16 2025

LAB IN DEVELOPING NEW PRODUCTS AND SERVICES (37201) - **TERRILL, CRAIG>>**

CONTENT

The primary purpose of this course is to provide students with an in-depth understanding of state-of-the-art practices in new product/service innovation using Design Thinking methods. It offers extensive, hands-on, practical innovation experience.

Topics covered include: Design Thinking, problem space defining, innovation processes, inventive opportunity identification, customer journey mapping, qualitative and quantitative agile user research, customer insights, iterative idea generation and evaluation, idea screening model, new product concept prototyping/optimization/testing, forecasting methods (including innovation diffusion models), growth hacking for new channels, brand/promotion/customer acquisition of early adopters, and new product business cases.

A series of group projects enables students to apply these tools on an actual client "Lab" project. Group projects are real-world innovation projects from leading company sponsors across a range of industries. Student teams work closely with their clients, guided by a faculty coach, to uncover unmet

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 37201-01
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
30
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 37201-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

customer needs, generate ideas, develop new product/service concept prototypes, test those new product concepts quantitatively, and present recommendations to their clients.

This course covers tech, consumer, and B2B products and services (with an emphasis on tech and consumer products/services), including examples from web applications, mobile apps, e-commerce, fin tech, food and beverage, household consumer products, telecommunication services, software, services, healthcare, and financial services. I make every effort is made to invite one or more practicing innovation experts to guest lecture.

This course is particularly relevant for students interested in the following careers: Product Management (Tech), Management Consulting, Brand Management, Innovation, Product Marketing Management (Tech), and Corporate Strategy. It also is relevant for students with an interest to lead a startup someday as I leverage my background in tech startups to discuss how essential it is to create and launch a new product that produces product-market fit.

Spring 2026 Application Timeline:

Students do not bid on this course. Rather, interested students complete an online application for this Lab course. Key Dates:

1. Thursday, February 12 at 12-1 pm CST: **Webinar** to give details about the class and application process. An email is sent prior to the webinar to all Booth students that includes Zoom information. You do not need to attend webinar in order to apply.
 - Link to Zoom Webinar ; Meeting ID: 931 8826 6138; Passcode: 407269
 - <https://uchicago.zoom.us/j/93188266138?pwd=bERzU1hnbTdxVjdjakhvQm1iWmRkdz09>
2. Sunday, February 15 at midnight: **Applications are Due.**
 - 2026 Application: [Link to Application for 37201 New Products Lab](#)
3. Tuesday, February 17: **Acceptances** are announced. Students have 2 days to drop. After that, no drops are allowed.

PREREQUISITES

Business 37000 or 37100: recommended. Can be taken concurrently. Not strict. Application and acceptance into course required. Course cannot be dropped once enrolled. Cannot be taken if 37200 "New Products and Services" or 37810 "New Product Development" already has been completed.

Restrictions

- No non-Booth Students
- Application-based course

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Application-based course

MATERIALS

This course includes a recommended text, case studies, and readings from practitioners and academics.

Group projects use an online agile user research platform called UserTesting (no cost).

Each project team needs a subscription to Open AI's ChatGPT Plus service for 3 months (currently \$20/month). Within ChatGPT Plus, teams also use several custom GPTs created specifically for this course.

GRADES

90% of a student's grade is based on two group deliverables due at the end of each phase of the client group project. The quarter-long group project takes a new product from problem space through design research and concept prototyping and concludes with final new product recommendations. Group work is extensive in this course, and peer evaluations impact final grades. Students should expect to meet with their group, outside of class, multiple times each week and to speak with their client and faculty coach every week. Expect to spend ~10 hours/week outside of class. 10% of a student's grade is based on individual class participation so weekly attendance is expected. It is mandatory to attend the group's final, one-hour client presentation which usually occurs during finals week and held via Zoom. Accommodations will be made for internships that start before the quarter ends.

There are no exams including no final exam. This course cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Provisional grades are given subject to timely completion of assignments.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors No pass/fail grades Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 19 2026

PRICING STRATEGIES (37202) - [DUBÉ, JEAN-PIERRE>>](#)

CONTENT

The surge in access to detailed marketing data and analytic tools has elevated pricing to the forefront of corporate strategy and the driving force of strategic revenue growth. Emerging roles like the Chief Growth Officer (CGO) and Chief Revenue Officer (CRO) focus predominantly on pricing decisions. For most

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 37202-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center

companies, improving pricing strategy represents both a strategic goal and a strategic challenge. Most struggle with the same basic questions: *How do we formulate a pricing strategy? What should we charge? Which data and methods should we be using to make pricing decisions? Who should be in charge of pricing decision-making?*

In practice, most firms still use ad hoc rules-of-thumb. The simplicity of these rules comes at a substantial cost to a firm's potential profitability. Most rules fail to align pricing with consumers' perceived value and underlying willingness-to-pay. Many firms also struggle with the delegation of pricing responsibility within the organization, exacerbating the use of rules-of-thumb that fail to deliver effective pricing decisions and *monetize*. The fact your company makes money does NOT confirm the optimization of your prices: *you may be leaving substantial money on the table*.

This course blends marketing analytic frameworks, marketing strategy, microeconomic theory and customer data to formulate actionable, evidence-based pricing strategies. Students learn how to coordinate pricing decisions with the rest of the marketing value proposition. Numerous pricing structures are developed in the course, along with their microeconomic foundations. Students learn the underlying theory for each pricing structure, along with the practical considerations for implementation. In several modules, students will use statistics and AI to implement optimized pricing decisions.

The course combines cases and analytic assignments to teach students how to design and execute pricing strategies. Students work with different forms of data and corresponding analytic methods. The examples span a wide array of business contexts including services, B2B and international.

During the quarter, there are 4 group homework assignments, 3 group case write-ups and 1 individual case assignment. Week 1 attendance is mandatory. The individual assignment is due during week 3. If you register late for the course, you must still submit this first assignment in class during week 3. Failure to submit this assignment will result in a grade of zero and no exceptions will be made. Provisional grades can be assigned so long as students complete all the assignments during the quarter.

For some of the group homework assignments, you will need to run a regression and/or use optimization software. Two review sessions have been scheduled with one of the course TAs to assist those students who are unfamiliar with these techniques.

For the group assignments and group case write-ups, students need to form a group of 4-5 people. All group members must be registered for the same section. No exceptions will be made.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001 or 37000 (either may be concurrent): strict. Students with an understanding of marketing and microeconomic principles will benefit more from the course. Cannot enroll in BUSN 37202 if BUSN 20610 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

C04

In-Person Only

Spring 2026

Section: 37202-81

W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM

Gleacher Center

304

In-Person Only

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 11 2026

PRICING STRATEGIES (37202) - [ROSSI, FEDERICO>>](#)

CONTENT

The advent of rich marketing data and analytic tools has brought pricing into the forefront of strategic thinking. For most companies, the improvement of pricing strategy is one of the main strategic goals and also one of the main strategic challenges. Most companies struggle with the same basic questions. *How do we formulate a pricing strategy? Which data and methods should we be using to make pricing decisions? Who should be in charge of pricing decision-making?* In practice, most firms use ad hoc rules of thumb that often fail to generate pricing recommendations that are even close to optimal. The simplicity of these rules of thumb comes at a substantial cost to profitability. Most rules fail to align pricing with the perceived value of consumers and their underlying willingness-to-pay. Many firms also struggle with the delegation of pricing responsibility within the organization, exacerbating the use of simple rules of thumb that fail to deliver effective pricing decisions.

This course blends marketing analytic frameworks, marketing strategy microeconomic theory, and data to formulate actionable pricing strategies. Students will learn how to coordinate pricing decisions with the rest of the marketing value proposition. Numerous pricing structures are developed in the course, along with their microeconomic foundations. Students will learn the underlying theory for each pricing structure, along with the practical considerations for implementation.

The course combines cases and homework to teach students how to design and execute pricing strategies. Students will be expected to work with different forms of data and corresponding analytic methods. The course will cover pricing strategies across many contexts including services, B2B and international.

During the quarter, there are 4 group assignments, 1 individual case

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37202-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 37202-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

assignment, and 1 final group mini-project.

For the group assignments and group case write-ups, students need to form a group of 4-5 people. All group members must be registered for the same section. No exceptions will be made.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001 or 37000 (either may be concurrent). Students with an understanding of marketing and microeconomic principles will benefit more from the course. Cannot enroll in BUSN 37202 if BUSN 20610 taken previously.

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 14 2025

BRAND MANAGEMENT IN A DIGITAL AGE (37209) - [HAFEN, TOM>>](#)

CONTENT

This course introduces the principles of brand management as practiced by industry leaders today. Although the implementation of marketing programs has undergone a massive transformation from conventional to digital media, the underlying principles of consumer driven marketing remain essentially the same; we will discuss how great marketing, including digital programming, is driven by a sound understanding of consumer segmentation, brand positioning, distinct product benefits, and relevant in-market executions.

Upon completion of this course, you should understand essential marketing concepts and use them to develop marketing strategies. You will develop this understanding through core readings, basic frameworks, and case studies involving firms such as Procter & Gamble, Drunk Elephant, Coca-Cola, Unilever, Porsche, Nestle, Sephora, and Glossier.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37209-01
M 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 37209-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD

This course is relevant for students interested in driving consumer demand regardless of career path. There are no prerequisites.

PREREQUISITES

None

GRADES

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

BUSINESS WITH PURPOSE (37212) - [SUSSMAN, ABIGAIL>>](#)

CONTENT

Business with Purpose: Integrating Profit and Social Value

In recent years, the question of whether the goal of business should be to benefit its shareholders (i.e., profit) or broader society (i.e., purpose) has not only become prominent, but increasingly polarized. Debates now extend beyond whether purpose can support profitability to whether purpose-driven efforts are strategic, performative, or even unwelcome. In this class, we begin with the assessment that the traditional framing of “profit versus purpose” remains a false dichotomy. In many cases, purpose contributes to brand value, risk mitigation, stakeholder trust, and ultimately profitability. However, success on both fronts requires a disciplined, evidence-based strategic approach. This class aims to equip students with the tools to pursue both goals together.

Although many consumers, employees, and investors continue to prefer companies aligned with their values, others are openly skeptical of (or even hostile to) sustainability, ESG initiatives, and corporate engagement with social issues. These diverging expectations create both opportunities and risks for firms. This course provides tools and frameworks to analyze when and how purpose can create business value, and when it may generate pushback. We begin with a broad business perspective, examining stakeholders and how companies define goals that extend beyond profit maximization. We then turn to the consumer to understand what customers value, how companies can serve those needs while supporting social or environmental good, and how traditional marketing strategies can be adapted or restrained in light of purpose-driven aims. Throughout, we will analyze cases, hear from guest speakers, and draw on academic and industry research as well as recent events. The final deliverable will be a marketing plan that articulates a firm

Remote-Only

Spring 2026
Section: 37209-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37212-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 37212-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

strategy capable of increasing societal benefit while also creating shareholder value.

Course Objectives:

- Critically evaluate the business case for doing well by doing good, and the potential benefits and risks for businesses, shareholders, and other stakeholders
- Learn how to select priorities and focus areas when developing purpose-driven strategies in the context of profit-seeking firms
- Understand consumer preferences for purpose-driven brands, and how to leverage these preferences to create value
- Learn principles of behavior change and how businesses can help their customers directly
- Effectively brand and communicate a company’s values and the value that they create - understanding when it is advantageous to do so
- Develop business strategies that align with broader societal goals, ensuring long-term sustainability and value creation for all stakeholders

GRADES

GRADES

- Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)
- Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 14 2026

PRODUCT MANAGEMENT (37215) - [TANEJA, ANSHUMAN>>](#) ; [URMINSKY, OLEG>>](#)

CONTENT

Product Management has emerged over the past several decades as a central general management discipline, extending well beyond its roots in CPG and technology firms to become a critical capability across retail, financial services, healthcare, hospitality, and other digitally transforming industries. While traditional functional roles such as marketing, operations, and finance address discrete aspects of business decision-making, Product Management integrates these perspectives to define, build, and evolve technological products and platforms under conditions of uncertainty and change.

This course examines Product Management as a modern general management function, focusing on how product leaders translate customer and business insight into coherent product strategy, execution, and organizational alignment for technology-based products. We will trace the historical evolution of Product Management, examine alternative organizational designs, and develop a rigorous understanding of the product manager’s craft, competencies, growth journeys, tools, and strategies to overcome challenges. The focus of this course

SCHEDULE
Spring 2026 Section: 37215-01 M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM Harper Center C10 In-Person Only New Course
Spring 2026 Section: 37215-81 M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM Gleacher Center 408 In-Person Only

is specifically on digital product management and the modern Product manager tech stack, providing a practical integration of product, design, data, engineering, leading cross-functional teams and going to market.

New Course

The course emphasizes both analytical and managerial decision-making, including:

- Identifying and framing customer and business problems appropriate for product-led solutions.
- Designing product vision, strategy, and roadmaps under resource and organizational constraints.
- Prioritizing initiatives using data, experimentation, and financial reasoning.
- Managing product development, measurement, and iteration across the product lifecycle, including the emerging use of AI-enabled tools.
- Leading without authority through influence, storytelling, and cross-functional collaboration.

The course uses a combination of case discussions, frameworks, applied exercises, and a team project in which students plan a product from concept through launch and evaluation. Students will leave the course with practical tools and a structured perspective for leading product-driven organizations and initiatives in both established firms and entrepreneurial settings.

PREREQUISITES

Business 37000 (Marketing Strategy) or equivalent coursework is required but can be taken concurrently (strict). Students who are not enrolled in one of the Booth programs must obtain permission from the instructor to enroll in this class (strict).

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

This course covers rapidly evolving methods and practices, and synthesizes from a wide range of sources, including academic research, policy experiments and business practices.

GRADES

Class participation: 20%

Mini assignments + Cases: 40%

Final Capstone Project + Presentation: 40%

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 10 2026

DIGITAL MARKETING (37301) - MOHAN, LIL>>

CONTENT

Companies - both B2C and B2B – have shifted an increasing portion of their marketing budgets to digital and social media marketing to engage their increasingly digital consumers. Also, with the advent of Generative AI, digital marketing itself is transforming at a rapid pace. All of this has created a significant challenge for the digital marketer: How to keep pace with and stay ahead of the changing digital eco-system.

In DM, students will cultivate a way of thinking that will help them navigate this ever-shifting digital landscape. They will learn how to use various current digital marketing techniques, including: content marketing, search, digital & social media advertising, social advocacy & influencer marketing, mobile apps, personalization & digital loyalty programs, conversational marketing, location-based, and omni-channel marketing. As most of these techniques have been significantly influenced by AI over the last few years, I have updated this DM course to incorporate many of the most recent AI platforms and tools into these techniques.

By course end, students will have understood: (i) how digital consumers behave and what are the most effective ways to digitally engage with them, (ii) how one creates digital marketing strategies and programs, including how to incorporate AI-based tools and techniques (iii) what frameworks and metrics to apply & when, and (iv) how one seamlessly combines digital with traditional off-line marketing strategies and programs.

In DM we will cover a broad spectrum of very current topics. To fit this course into a 1-quarter syllabus, I have prioritized topics based on currency, relevance and practical utility. Note that we will not have the bandwidth to deep-dive into specific tactical marketing campaign implementations. *Students who already have extensive prior experience with DM and AI techniques in DM should consult with me before signing up for this class.*

PREREQUISITES

There are no prerequisites for this course. However, having a basic background in marketing (BUSN 37000) is a definite plus. Non-Booth students require instructor permission.

MATERIALS

In addition to my lecture notes, we will use a wide array of topical content including blogs, posts, articles, and some book excerpts. In class, we will follow a discussion-oriented format, to analyze and understand concepts, frameworks and strategies. Class participation by students is crucial for every student to get the most out of this class.

GRADES

Evaluation is based on: 1 group project (total 25%), group in-class presentations (15%), 4-5 individual assignments (total 40%), and in-class

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 37301-81
F 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

discussions & contributions (20%). There is no final exam. It is mandatory for students to attend Sessions 1 and 10. Cannot be taken pass/fail. Provisional grades will be given subject to timely completion of assignments.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 11 2025

MARKETING WORKSHOP (37601) - [COMPIANI, GIOVANNI>>](#) ; [DONNELLY, KRISTIN>>](#)

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

Booth PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 24 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37601-60
T 10:40 AM-12:00 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

MARKETING WORKSHOP (37601) - [DONNELLY, KRISTIN>>](#) ; [KRAFT, ANDREAS>>](#)

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 37601-60
T 10:40 AM-12:00 PM
Harper Center

PREREQUISITES

Booth PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 24 2025

C03

In-Person Only

MARKETING WORKSHOP (37601) - SHAPIRO, BRADLEY>> ; SUSSMAN, ABIGAIL>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

Booth PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 37601-60
T 10:40 AM-12:00 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

DIGITAL MARKETING LAB (37703) - MOHAN, LIL>>

CONTENT

Companies today expect their marketing professionals to understand what it takes to design, execute and manage digital marketing strategies and campaigns. Marketing professionals, in both B2B and B2C environments, are now expected to know how to select, deploy and use a variety of marketing software platforms & services, including the latest AI-based platforms & tools. As of last count, there are over 15,300 MarTech applications in 49 categories including advertising (AdTech), content marketing, marketing automation, sales

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 37703-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
306

automation, websites, social media, sales intelligence, and analytics. The best way to gain such expertise is for these professionals to actually build and execute specific digital marketing programs/strategies using various MarTech platforms in a lab environment.

In-Person Only

This lab course, DML, takes students through the process of designing and executing specific digital marketing program components, hands-on. They will work with several marketing platforms and tools including some newer AI tools such as ChatGPT, for creating and managing digital presence, content and SEO, paid search and social media advertising, marketing analytics, & other aspects of digital marketing.

By the end of the course, students will have learned how to utilize key MarTech platforms, AI tools, and several frameworks to build out digital marketing programs, and by so doing, they will develop a deep understanding of what it really takes to design and execute digital marketing strategies and campaigns on their own. This course is primarily targeted at students (i) that are interested in marketing, MarTech and AdTech, (ii) that are aiming to be product managers, and (iii) that wish to start or join entrepreneurial ventures.

Registering for this course is strictly by [application only](#). As this is a lab course where students will be executing real-life projects with real companies, there is a limit on the number of student slots. We will host a Webinar on Friday, Aug 15 at 12:00 Noon, Central Time. In this webinar we will provide details about this Lab, the various class assignments & projects that the students will execute, and the application process. At that time, the application form for this course will be made available here and via email. Details regarding the webinar will be made available to students a week to 10 days in advance via email. Once accepted into the course, students will have 72 hours to decide before they will be registered. Once registered, students may not drop the course.

PREREQUISITES

There are no prerequisites for this course. However, having a basic background in marketing (BUSN 37000) is a definite plus. No undergrads allowed. This course is by application only: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

MATERIALS

In the lab, we will work hands-on with a set of key MarTech platforms and tools. We will complement this with background reading materials that include papers on strategy and techniques, blogs, posts, articles, specific platform user-manuals, and other 'how-to' documents. In each session, we will spend time on concepts, tools and techniques, as well as working hands-on designing, building, measuring, optimizing, and evaluating various types of digital content and campaigns.

GRADES

Evaluation is based on a set of individual assignments, tool certifications, and group Lab Projects (80%), as well as on individual in-class contributions (20%). There is no final exam. Each group will present its final Lab Project in class.

Attendance in Sessions 01 and 10 is mandatory. Cannot be taken pass/fail. Provisional grades will be given subject to timely completion of the assignments and projects.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 04 2025

PROFIT THROUGH SOCIAL VALUE (37820, 50 UNIT COURSE) - **SUSSMAN, ABIGAIL>>**

CONTENT

Recently, the role of business in society has come under intense scrutiny. Once widely embraced, the idea that companies should prioritize social good alongside profit is now being challenged—from concerns about its effectiveness to debates over whether it serves shareholders, stakeholders, or neither. This course critically examines these tensions and moves beyond ideological debates to focus on the strategic realities. We begin with the premise that profit and purpose are not necessarily in conflict, but achieving both requires a thoughtful, disciplined approach. Through case studies and analytical frameworks, this class equips students with the tools to assess when and how businesses can successfully integrate financial and social objectives in a way that is both sustainable and value-enhancing.

PREREQUISITES

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 37820-88
08/03, 08/04, 08/05, 08/07,
08/08
EMBA1 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 07 2026

FOUNDATIONS OF ADVANCED QUANTITATIVE MARKETING (37902) - [CHINTAGUNTA, PRADEEP>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is meant for Ph.D. students with marketing as dissertation or minor area. The focus of the course is on understanding the methods currently available for analyzing panel data (household purchases, physician prescriptions, etc.). The course begins with an introduction to the various aspects of individual behavior and the econometric models currently available to study them. The remainder of the course focuses on specific advances in such analyses. These include, but are not limited to, the study of purchases across product categories, the analysis of dynamic purchase behavior and accounting for endogeneity in such models. Students will write code in R, Matlab or some similar software; no canned routines are allowed for PhD students.

PREREQUISITES

PhD Students. MBA students with permission: strict

GRADES

No provisional grades.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37902-50
M 4:45 PM-7:45 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

ADV MKTG THEORY: BEHAVIORAL SCIENCE APPROACH (37903) - [SUSSMAN, ABIGAIL>>](#)

CONTENT

This is a Ph.D. seminar. We will discuss various topics covering current and classic research in consumer behavior with underpinnings in social and cognitive psychology. The class is an advanced research seminar in which students are expected to read, assimilate, and discuss multiple papers on specific topic areas each week. Each student is expected to lead the discussion for an entire topic once or twice in the quarter. Responsibilities will include assigning discussion questions for the week, allocating readings to specific

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 37903-50
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room

classmates for detailed discussion, and synthesizing the discussion across readings to develop an integrative framework for research in the topic area at the end of that session. Students are also expected to generate research ideas and write a paper for the course.

In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Non-Booth PhD students require instructor permission.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

MATERIALS

Readings will be from articles to be handed out in class or posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Based on class participation and a research paper. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

ADVANCED QUANTITATIVE MARKETING (37904) - [DUBÉ, JEAN-PIERRE>>](#) ; [HITSCH, GUENTER>>](#)

CONTENT

This course covers some key topics at the research frontier in quantitative marketing. We formulate and estimate models of consumer decision-making, and then explore the normative and positive consequences of the inferred consumer behavior for optimal marketing decisions and market structure. Topics include: Foundations of demand modeling, measurement of consumer heterogeneity, the origin and evolution of preferences, state dependence in demand, dynamic discrete choice models, learning and memory models, storable goods demand, diffusion models and durable goods demand, stated choice models, advertising dynamics, and search and shopping behavior.

This course is geared towards 2nd-year Ph.D. students who have already taken at least one course in Ph.D.-level Price Theory and in Ph.D.-level Empirical Economics.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37904-50
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. BUSN 37904=ECON 40902

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

Class presentations and a course paper/project. No provisional grades.

[**SYLLABUS>>**](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

MARKETING LITERATURE SEMINAR (37905) - [**COMPIANI, GIOVANNI>>**](#) ; [**DIETVORST, BERKELEY>>**](#)

CONTENT

The goal of this seminar is to familiarize students with the marketing literature and develop the process of generating research ideas. Each class will involve student presentations of preassigned papers followed by a class discussion.

PREREQUISITES

PhD Students Only.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

Based on class participation and a final research proposal. No provisional grades.

[**SYLLABUS>>**](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: September 04 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37905-50
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

BEHAVIORAL SCIENCE RESEARCH METHODS IN MARKETING (37907) - URMINSKY, OLEG>>

CONTENT

This course will focus on both the philosophical and practical questions involved in conducting behavioral research for academic publication. We will discuss specific research methodologies, best practices and current controversies in research methods. The course assumes prior training in statistics, and the goal of the course is to bridge the gap between formal statistics and day-to-day research practice. The course will provide training in commonly used methods as well as develop your intuition for the logic underlying statistical practice, and when that logic is being violated.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Undergraduates require instructor consent. Non-Booth Masters & PhD students may enroll through the online request poll.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

GRADES

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 07 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37907-50
TH 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

MARKETING RESEARCH SEMINAR (WINTER) (37911, 50 UNIT COURSE) - SMITH, STEPHANIE>>

CONTENT

Intensive year-long research and writing seminar for Booth Marketing PhD behavioral students in the 3rd year and up.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37911-51
T 9:30 AM-11:00 AM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only: strict

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

Strict Prerequisite

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 02 2026

MARKETING RESEARCH SEMINAR (WINTER) (37911, 50 UNIT COURSE) - STRULOV-SHLAIN, AVNER>>

CONTENT

Intensive year-long research and writing seminar for Booth Marketing PhD quantitative students in the 3rd year and up.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only: strict

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 02 2026

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 37911-50
T 1:00 PM-2:30 PM
Harper Center
4SE - Faculty Conference Room
50-Units: All Weeks
In-Person Only

MARKETING RESEARCH SEMINAR (SPRING) (37912, 50 UNIT COURSE) - DONNELLY, KRISTIN>>

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026

Intensive year-long research and writing seminar for Booth Marketing PhD behavioral students in the 3rd year and up.

Section: 37912-51
T 9:30 AM-11:00 AM
Harper Center
C50A
50-Units: All Weeks
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only: strict

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

Strict Prerequisite

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 03 2026

MARKETING RESEARCH SEMINAR (SPRING) (37912, 50 UNIT COURSE) - **KRAFT, ANDREAS>>**

CONTENT

Intensive year-long research and writing seminar for Booth Marketing PhD quantitative students in the 3rd year and up.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only: strict

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

Strict Prerequisite

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 03 2026

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 37912-50
T 1:00 PM-2:30 PM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
50-Units: All Weeks
In-Person Only

MANAGERIAL PSYCHOLOGY (38000) - **GINZEL, LINDA>>**

CONTENT

Managerial psychology is designed to increase your understanding of individual, interpersonal and group behaviors as they relate to organizational performance using the lens of social psychology. We will work together to develop a more complex understanding of processes such as motivation, social perception, interpersonal influence, effective communication, interpersonal

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38000-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
204

problem solving, group decision making, commitment, and leadership. Using a combination of case discussions, demonstrations, role-plays, group activities, and lectures, our primary goal is to offer conceptual frameworks and principles that will help to improve your managerial and leadership effectiveness.

In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38000-02
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

MiM Only

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 16 2025

MANAGING IN ORGANIZATIONS (38001) - [FISHBACH, AYELET>>](#)

CONTENT

Success in management requires understanding the factors that shape individual and group behaviors and attitudes. This course deals with the people part of management; we will develop a complex view of organizational behavior at the individual, interpersonal, and group levels of analysis. We will examine topics such as motivation, evaluation, communication, teamwork, and organizational culture.

The goal is to provide you with the tools and concepts to explore why people do what they do and, thus, prepare you for management challenges. The course is theory-based but practice-oriented. It is firmly grounded in the discipline of social psychology and is designed to focus on the situational causes of behavior, including your own.

Classes consist of lectures, individual and group exercises, case discussions, and other activities that provide opportunities to apply analytical frameworks to concrete organizational problems.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 38001 if BUSN 20701 taken previously.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 38001-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38001-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38001-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306

GRADES

Based on several written assignments, a final exam and class participation.
Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 08 2025

MANAGING IN ORGANIZATIONS (38001) - [KOCH, ALEX>>](#)

CONTENT

Business transactions commonly take place among people. Understanding the factors that determine people's actions and interactions is therefore a critical prerequisite for being successful in the work environment. This course is about managing people - oneself and others.

Using a combination of lectures, discussions and group activities, the course offers an introduction to theory and research in the behavioral sciences. Its primary goal is to develop conceptual frameworks that help students to understand and manage effectively their own work settings.

The course is organized into two main themes: (1) the individual, and (2) the organization. The individual part of the course is concerned with issues related to individual behavior, such as how people's attitudes influence their behavior, how people form impressions of others, and how the choices people make are affected by characteristics of the decision maker and the decision-making process. The organization part of the course focuses on people's behavior within the context of an organization. It addresses how organizations can successfully coordinate the actions of their members. Topics of this section include effective group decision-making, persuading and motivating others, and the use of formal and informal power in interpersonal relations.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 38001 if BUSN 20701 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38001-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38001-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

Based on several written assignments, a final exam and class participation.
Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 14 2026

MANAGING IN ORGANIZATIONS (38001) - [MCGILL, ANN>>](#)

CONTENT

Successfully managing other people – be they competitors or co-workers – requires an understanding of their thoughts, feelings, attitudes, motivations, and determinants of behavior. Developing an accurate understanding of these factors, however, can be difficult to achieve because intuitions are often misguided and unstructured experience can be a poor teacher. This course is intended to address this development by providing the scientific knowledge of human thought and behavior that is critical for successfully managing others, and also for successfully managing ourselves.

Using a combination of lectures, discussions, and group activities, the course offers an introduction to theory and research in the behavioral sciences. Its primary goal is to develop conceptual frameworks that help students to understand and manage effectively their own complicated work settings.

The course is organized into two main sections: (1) the individual, and (2) the organization. The first half of the course is concerned with issues related to individual behavior, such as how people form impressions of others and attribute causes of behavior, how prior beliefs including stereotypes shape perceptions, what motivates individuals, and what factors foster and inhibit creativity and problem-solving. The second half of the course turns to people's behavior in the context of a larger enterprise. It addresses how organizations can successfully coordinate the actions of their members. Topics in this section include effective group decision-making, persuading others, and building an

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 38001-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38001-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38001-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

effective organizational culture.

PREREQUISITES

None. However, students must attend week 1. No non-Booth students. Cannot enroll in BUSN 38001 if BUSN 20701 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Information on course materials and other current updates are available on the 38001 [Canvas](#) course site.

GRADES

Based on a midterm exam, written assignments, a group project, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. No non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors Mandatory attendance week 1 No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 18 2025

MANAGING IN ORGANIZATIONS (38001) - O'BRIEN, ED>>

CONTENT

The workplace is designed, inhabited, and controlled by people, but people make mistakes. Executives make decisions today that lead to unforeseen problems tomorrow, competitors mispredict their rival's moves and motives, and coworkers misperceive each other's thoughts and feelings. This course highlights how the human mind comes to make such errors, and what to do about them—ultimately, to understand how to manage yourself and others just a bit more wisely, both in the work environment and in daily life.

To accomplish this goal we will draw upon experimental social psychology, the bedrock of the course. Through laboratory findings and basic science, each week you will learn well-tested, well-replicated insights about social life: you'll be armed with management wisdom that works as opposed to management wisdom that "sounds right." The first few weeks (Internal Thought) outline the psychological underpinnings of how people—you, me, colleagues, clients, all of us—process information in biased ways. The latter few weeks (External

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 38001-82
F 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38001-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD

Change) use these insights to understand real organizational issues like persuasion, giving feedback, building culture, working in groups, and work-life balance.

Remote-Only

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll in BUSN 38001 if BUSN 20701 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Information on course materials and other current updates will be made available on the 38001: [Canvas course site](#).

GRADES

Based on an exam(s), weekly written assignments, class participation, and a final paper. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

MANAGERIAL DECISION MAKING (38002) - [HASTIE, REID>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is designed to make you a better decision maker. Good decision makers know how to recognize decision situations, then how to represent the essential structure of the situations, and how to analyze them with the formal tools from decision theory. But, perhaps more important, they need to be able to think effectively about the inputs into a decision analysis, whether to trust the analysis, and how to use the outputs to guide actions by themselves and their firms. And, maybe most important of all, they need to know how to make effective, unaided intuitive decisions, and to recognize the limits on their intuitive skills. This course will move back and forth between formal, optimal models and behavioral, descriptive models to help you understand and improve your native decision making abilities.

PREREQUISITES

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38002-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38002-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

Business 41000 (or 41100) or another course that introduces multiple regression statistical models is strongly recommended. You cannot enroll in BUSN 38002 if BUSN 20702 was taken previously.

MATERIALS

J.E. Russo & P.J.H. Schoemaker, *Winning Decisions: Getting it Right the First Time*. (OPTIONAL: M.H. Bazerman & D.A. Moore, *Judgment in Managerial Decision Making*. J. S. Hammond, R. L. Keeney, & H. Raiffa, *Smart Choices: A Practical Guide to Making Better Decisions*. D. Heath & C. Heath, *Decisive: How to Make Better Decisions*)

Additional course materials will be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Four essays, final examination, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. Will give provisional grades to non-Booth students, but not early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 09 2025

MANAGERIAL DECISION MAKING (38002) - [TODOROV, ALEXANDER>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is designed to make you a better decision maker. The primary focus is on *descriptive* questions: how do we make judgments about the world and how do we make decisions based on these judgments. The short answer, to be developed much more completely in this course, is that although people form judgments and make decisions in a systematic fashion, their decisions are not always as optimal as possible. The emphasis on “errors” in decision making is deliberate, because all good decision makers need to know how to make effective intuitive decisions, while recognizing the limits on their intuitive skills.

Much of the class contrasts the “do” (or descriptive emphasis) with the “should” (or normative emphasis). *Normative* questions deal with how should we

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 38002-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38002-02
W 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center

behave if we wish to behave rationally. We will discuss and identify principles of rationality, or principles which most reasonable people would like to govern their behavior. The course will move back and forth between formal, optimal methods and psychological, descriptive models to help you understand and improve your decision-making abilities. Good decision makers need to know how to recognize decision problems, how to represent the essential structure of the decision situation, and how to analyze the problem with the formal tools based on decision theory.

PREREQUISITES

Business 41000 (or 41100) or another course that introduces multiple regression statistical models is strongly recommended. You cannot enroll in BUSN 38002 if BUSN 20702 was taken previously.

MATERIALS

D. Kahneman. Thinking Fast and Slow. Farrar, Straus and Giroux.

Additional course materials will be posted on Canvas.

GRADES

Short in-class quizzes, four assignments, participation, and a final exam. Cannot be taken pass/fail. Will give provisional grades to non-Booth students, but not early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 12 2026

C02
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38002-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

Summer 2026
Section: 38002-81
07/14, 07/16, 07/21, 07/23,
07/28, 07/30, 08/04, 08/06,
08/11, 08/13
TTH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
2nd Half: Week 5 - Week 9
In-Person Only

POWER AND INFLUENCE IN ORGANIZATIONS (38003) - [NUSSBAUM, A.>>](#)

CONTENT

Every effective manager needs to know how to wisely manage power and influence. Skill in doing so enables managers to win the cooperation of others,

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 38003-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM

to elicit the most value from diverse organizational resources, and to consistently achieve goals.

In this class, you will be introduced to conceptual models, tactical approaches, and self-assessment tools that can help you to manage workplace power dynamics more wisely and skillfully. You will learn about several different methods of influence, and start the process of understanding and shaping your own influence style. You will also explore specific, real-world examples to understand how power and influence might be effectively *and* ineffectively used at different stages of a person's career. As the nature of our focal topics will raise difficult ethical questions, the course will also challenge you to examine and define your views on what will constitute the ethical exercise of power and influence in your work life.

Readings in this class are extensive. Preparing thoroughly for class discussions and exercises with these weekly readings is essential for getting the most value from the class.

Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38003-02
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38003-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

None. All Non-Booth students require instructor consent.

GRADES

Based on class participation, assignments, and a group project. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

STRATEGIES AND PROCESSES OF NEGOTIATION (38103) - [BURROWS, JOHN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course will help you become a more effective negotiator by developing your "tool kit" of negotiation tactics and strategies. You will learn from an extensive set of negotiation experiences in class, practice your skills, and benefit from feedback. In the early class sessions, we introduce basic negotiation concepts and tactics. In the classes that follow, we focus on specific aspects of the negotiation process that are important to many negotiation situations, such as obstacles to effective communication at the bargaining

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38103-03
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

table, the maximization of multiple interests, and tactics for coalition building. In the final set of classes, we put it all together by exploring negotiations that contain elements of both cooperation and competition; that is, these sessions involve cases where the parties can “enlarge the pie” by creating joint gains. Because little in business (or life) gets done without negotiation, this course has the potential to deliver significant upside in your professional and personal outcomes.

PREREQUISITES

Bus 38001, 38002, or 38003.

GRADES

No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

STRATEGIES AND PROCESSES OF NEGOTIATION (38103) - KIRGIOS, ERIKA>>

CONTENT

Negotiation is ubiquitous: you may have already negotiated once or twice today, whether you knew it or not. You don't just negotiate salary, rent, and business deals—you also negotiate when deciding where to go to dinner with your partner and when planning a vacation with your friends. The ability to negotiate is critical to success in business and in life. This course will guide you through the science and art of negotiation. You will learn theories of negotiation during lectures and through assigned readings (the science), and you will learn the practice of negotiation through exercises and case analyses (the art). Throughout the course, you will develop an understanding of how negotiation situations might be structured and what kinds of biases can interfere with successful negotiation (as well as strategies for avoiding these biases). Ultimately, you should leave the course better equipped to identify and achieve your interests.

PREREQUISITES

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 38103-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38103-02
W 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38103-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM

Undergraduates require instructor permission.

Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

Articles, cases, and handouts will be available through Canvas.

GRADES

Based on weekly attendance (at your enrolled section), preparation, and class participation, analytical exercises, short written assignments, and a final project. Due to the nature of this course, all students considering and or enrolled must attend the first week of class. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Provisional grades provided.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors No pass/fail grades Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 06 2025

STRATEGIES AND PROCESSES OF NEGOTIATION (38103) - [KOCH, ALEX>>](#)

CONTENT

Negotiation is to attempt agreement between two or more parties on one or more issues. In this course, you will develop negotiation skill and experience, two essential components of getting ahead and along in business.

Skillful negotiators realize that achieving agreement is not just about competition (claiming value), but also cooperation (creating value before claiming it). Skillful negotiators represent every party's interests, issues, leverage, strategies/tactics, and biases, and respond with strategies/tactics that best materialize their interests while maintaining a good reputation and healthy relationship with every other party. You will improve your **negotiation skill** through research-based readings, lectures and an exam in class, and reporting in writing a real-world negotiation.

Analytical negotiation skill is necessary but not sufficient for success at the bargaining table. Thanks to preparation and practice, experienced negotiators use adequate strategies/tactics intuitively – that is, they negotiate effectively in an efficient way. In most weeks, you will prepare in writing for the practice of negotiating a case with one or a few classmates. Then, you will compare and discuss your strategies/tactics and agreement or impasse with all other classmates. In three weeks, you and your co-negotiator(s) will jointly write an

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 38103-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38103-05
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

essay on some lessons learned from the respective week's negotiation case. This practice and multi-source feedback will inspire your preparation and continuously improve your **negotiation experience** and intuition, especially if you experiment by systematically varying the strategies/tactics that you naturally tend to use.

In sum, your learning goal for this course is to develop towards an **analytically and intuitively savvy negotiator** who confidently achieves agreements that materialize their interests as much as reasonably possible under the circumstances of the current bargaining situation.

PREREQUISITES

38001 (Managing in Organizations), 38002 (Managerial Decision Making), or 38003 (Power and Influence in Organizations)

The pre-requisite to take a behavioral science class prior to taking Strategies and Processes of Negotiation is soft (i.e., not required), but very highly recommended. Our experience is that exposure to some understanding of psychology as taught in our behavioral science classes (e.g., social influence, biases in cognitive or social judgment, etc.) before you take the negotiation class not only solidifies your understanding of the psychology you learned in the previous behavioral science class, but also greatly improves your understanding of how to negotiate. Although your behavioral science faculty tie the psychological concepts in these classes to managerial examples, it is nevertheless often difficult for students to recognize these principles in real world situations. The negotiation class helps you recognize these concepts in actual social interactions. Your ability to recognize these concepts "real-time" is facilitated by the abundant feedback provided by your instructor as well as your classmates. In addition, coming to class with an understanding of the concepts also provides a foundation that expedites the process of negotiating effectively. Although your instructors will cover the psychology that is essential for being an effective negotiator, our experience is that seeing the concepts a second time will not feel as a review, but rather will be viewed as a way to expedite the difficult process of internalizing these ideas and making them part of your negotiation repertoire.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Everything will be available through Canvas or handed out in class.

GRADES

- Weekly attendance = 18p.
- Before-class preparation for negotiation cases #3, #5, and #8 = 12p.
- Exam documenting that your negotiation skill has developed = 20p.
- Post-negotiation reflections documenting that your experience has developed = 12p.
- Report of a real-world negotiation that you took part in = 18p.
- Option to improve your grade by 1-3p.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 23 2026

STRATEGIES AND PROCESSES OF NEGOTIATION (38103) - [LEVINE, EMMA>>](#)

CONTENT

Negotiation is the art and science of creating agreements between two or more parties. This course will help you understand and develop negotiation skills using various methods, with a particular focus on helping you negotiate ethically. First, you will learn theories of negotiation from class lectures and assigned readings (the science). We will challenge common myths that may be limiting your negotiation performance and learn successful, and ethical, negotiation strategies based on empirical research. Second, you will learn how to apply these theories and strategies by actually negotiating – both inside and outside the classroom (the art). You will have many opportunities to experiment with your negotiation style and learn from your successes and mistakes. The objectives of this course are to help you gain experience with the negotiation process, and to improve your ability to reach agreements that both create value for you and promote your values and reputation as a negotiator.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 38103-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38103-03
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Mandatory to attend first class.

MATERIALS

Articles, cases, and handouts will be available through Canvas. Additionally, required copyrighted handouts will be passed out in class.

GRADES

Based on weekly attendance (at your enrolled section), preparation, and class participation, analytical exercises, short written assignments, and a final exam. Due to the nature of this course, all students considering and or enrolled must attend the first week of class. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Provisional grades provided.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 09 2026

STRATEGIES AND PROCESSES OF NEGOTIATION (38103) - [WITTENBRINK, BERND>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides an introduction to behavioral science insights relevant to negotiation. It is structured around a series of weekly negotiations conducted with classmates, each designed to identify and emphasize specific factors that influence negotiations and their outcomes. Together with the assigned readings, the in-class negotiations aim to help you develop your ability to analyze negotiations, recognize psychological biases that may impede success, and apply strategies to mitigate these biases.

PREREQUISITES

Business 38001, 38002, or 38003.

MATERIALS

Information on course materials can be found on the [course website](#).

GRADES

Based on weekly preparation and class participation, analytical exercises, and a final paper. Due to the nature of the course, all students enrolled, or considering enrolling, must attend the first week of class. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Will give provisional grades to Booth and non-Booth students, but not early final grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38103-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38103-05
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38103-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 16 2025

STRATEGIES AND PROCESSES OF NEGOTIATION (38103) - [ZINCHENKO, ELENA>>](#)

CONTENT

Successful management relies on agreement and collaboration with other people. While managers need technical analytic skills to discover optimal solutions to problems, a broad array of interpersonal negotiation skills are necessary to implement these solutions. This course provides you with the opportunity to develop these skills experientially and to understand negotiation concepts in useful analytic frameworks.

You will hone your skills in every class with different partners and increasingly complex negotiation scenarios. You will learn about common mistakes people make, how to correct them, and be both systematic and flexible about your strategies. Because negotiation is ubiquitous, this course has the potential to make a significant difference in your professional and personal outcomes.

PREREQUISITES

Business 38001, 38002, or 38003. Undergraduates require instructor permission.

GRADES

Based on weekly preparation and class participation; analytical exercises; short written assignments; and a final paper. Due to the nature of this course, all students considering and/or enrolled must attend the first week of class. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 01 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38103-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38103-04
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38103-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

ADVANCED NEGOTIATIONS (38105) - [WU, GEORGE>>](#)

CONTENT

This course builds on 38103, Strategies and Processes of Negotiation, and is designed to increase your understanding of the theory and process of

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 38105-01

negotiation.

The course will include advanced topics that expand upon or were not covered in 38103. In particular, the course will improve your ability to deal with difficult negotiators and difficult negotiations. 38103 introduced the basic ideas of negotiations—BATNAs, effective tactics for distributive negotiations, processes and analytics behind the discovery of joint gains, and coalitional dynamics in multi-party settings. This course will discuss advanced concepts of negotiations by taking you through a set of negotiation exercises that are more complex and more authentic than the ones used in 38103. The exercises will include: integrative negotiations without scoring systems, dynamic negotiations, complex deal structuring negotiations, sustaining negotiated value, and negotiations that require coordination of internal and external parties.

The more advanced deal making and deal design skills developed in this course should be especially useful to students whose careers will involve investment banking; business development; venture capital, private equity investment, and entrepreneurial firms; and alliances and joint ventures, as well as students who anticipate conducting a substantial amount of intra-organizational negotiations.

The course will use a combination of role-playing simulations and case discussions that include topics such as strategic alliances; dysfunctional business relationships.

Note: All students must attend the first week of class.

PREREQUISITES

BUS 38103-Strategies and Processes of Negotiation: strict (cannot be taken concurrently). It is mandatory to attend the first class session.

Non-Booth students require faculty permission.

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Based on class participation; weekly web surveys; written assignments; and a final group project. Cannot be taken pass/fail. Auditors by permission of instructor.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades Mandatory attendance week 1

TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM Harper Center C08 In-Person Only
Spring 2026 Section: 38105-02 TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM Harper Center C08 In-Person Only
Spring 2026 Section: 38105-81 TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM Booth 455 132 In-Person Only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 02 2026

CRAFTING AND DELIVERING PERSUASIVE NARRATIVES (38107) - [WEITZMAN, HAL>>](#)

CONTENT

The ability to articulate your ideas and convey them in a compelling way is a skill that will make you more effective throughout your career. This new, highly practical 100-unit course offers a comprehensive approach to presenting your ideas effectively and using them to win over various professional audiences. We'll learn analytical tools and processes, and practice deploying them in a range of situations, from video and podcasts to conference calls, one-on-one meetings, in-person presentations and speeches. We'll critique each other's work, which should improve your ability to persuade, to analyze others' communication, as well as to handle and learn from criticism. You should emerge a better writer and presenter, comfortable communicating your narrative whatever the medium. This course combines for the first time the insights, techniques, and frameworks from two courses formerly offered as stand-alone 50-credit options: Persuasion: Effective Business Communication and Persuasion II: Influence Through Narrative. It is designed for students who have never taken either of these classes.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38107-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Booth 455
130
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 38107-01
T 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center
C02
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if BUSN 38101 or 38102 taken previously: strict

GRADES

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 17 2025

ETHICS OF BUSINESS (38115) - [ROLLERT, JOHN>>](#)

CONTENT

The primary aim of this class is to help students define for themselves a canon of business ethics that is tailored to their professional goals. We will build a vocabulary for talking about business ethics by examining the work of a wide variety of authors – from economists and entrepreneurs to philosophers, journalists, and revolutionaries – all of whom have written about the place of business (and the business professional) in the modern world. These authors include Benjamin Franklin, Andrew Carnegie, Karl Marx, George Orwell, Ayn Rand, and, most importantly, Adam Smith, whose work we will revisit throughout the course. Topics include:

- The Nature of Self-Interest
- The Role of Empathy in Commercial Relationships
- The Nature of Utility and Moral Status of Usefulness
- Philanthropy and the Responsibilities of Wealth
- The Free-Market as an Engine for Virtue and Vice
- The Ideals of Capitalism vs. Lived Experience

The questions we will take up are large, contentious, and open-ended. Through in-class and online discussion, the course will help students determine their own answers, defend them intelligently, and recognize the merits of answers that other students give.

Please note that this class takes a “great books” approach to the topic of business ethics. As such, while contemporary events will be used as illustrations in class discussion, the readings for the course are drawn from seminal works of history, literature, and political economy from the 18th, 19th, and 20th centuries rather than from traditional case studies. Please also note that this class requires students to complete weekly writing assignments as well as a two-part take-home final exam.

Because of the highly interactive nature of the course, attendance is required at all class meetings.

PREREQUISITES

None.

MATERIALS

All readings will be available in a coursepack sent directly to students by the professor a week before the class begins except for Michael Lewis's *Liar's Poker*, which students will be asked to purchase.

GRADES

50% of the grade will be determined by written contributions to the class blog. 30% will be determined by in-class participation; 20% will be determined by a take-home final exam. The course may not be taken pass/fail. No auditors allowed.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38115-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

GRADES

- Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)
- Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

- No pass/fail grades
- No auditors
- Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 23 2025

DESIGNING A GOOD LIFE (38119) - EPLEY, NICHOLAS>>

CONTENT

This class is based on the assumption that you want to live a “good life” in three senses of the term. First, “good” in the sense of being successful. Second, “good” in the sense of being ethical and honorable. Third, “good” in the sense of feeling good: living a life rich in happiness, meaning, purpose, and well-being. If you wanted to increase your odds of living a good life in all three senses, what would you do? If you wanted to lead an organization that was “good” in all three senses of this term, how would you lead it?

This is primarily an ethics course, but not a *typical* ethics course. We will not spend time discussing ethical dilemmas, or trying to decide what is right or wrong in ethical gray areas. Science simply does not offer clear moral authority on many of these issues. Instead, we will adopt a psychological approach that focuses on the fundamental psychological processes that lead people to behave ethically and unethically. These processes can lure anyone—including you and me—into ethical lapses. Understanding these processes gives insight into how to design your life, your teams, and your organization to be as ethical as they can be.

We will end this course by focusing on how ethical behavior is related to wellbeing, happiness, and meaning in life—the third sense of a “good life.” Ethics and hedonics are sometimes described as opposites; either you do good or you feel good, but you don’t do both. The existing empirical evidence on wellbeing demonstrates that this is simply untrue. You will learn about surprising research demonstrating how and why doing good can be aligned with feeling good. You will participate in a few class activities that might also leave you feeling good.

Course Format:

This course will involve a combination of lecture, class discussion, in-class and out-of-class exercises, and occasional case discussion. There will be a take-home (open-book) midterm exam that you will have two hours to complete

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38119-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38119-02
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38119-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

after the Week 5 class session, and a final group paper due at the scheduled time of the final exam.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll if 38870 taken previously.

MATERIALS

—**Course website:** <https://canvas.uchicago.edu/>

—**Readings, Movies, Podcasts:** All posted on the course website.

You will watch two documentaries: The Social Dilemma and Enron: The Smartest Guys in the Room.

You will also listen to a podcast episode of Radiolab.

—**Books:** There are two books assigned for the course:

1. Bazerman, M.H., & Tenbrunsel, A.E. (2011). *Blind spots: Why we fail to do what's right and what to do about it*. Princeton University Press: Princeton, NJ.

2. Haidt, J. (2012). *The righteous mind: Why good people are divided by politics and religion*. Vintage Books: New York, NY.

You will read most of Bazerman and Tenbrunsel's book, but only the opening chapters of Haidt's book. I ask you to buy the entire book because it is worth reading the entire book when you can, and because the entire book is less expensive than excerpting chapters.

—**Lecture notes:**

I will post .pdf versions of the lecture slides on the course website at the same time I post the lectures. I will post any lecture slides shared during recorded live class sessions *after* the recorded session is posted on the Canvas site.

GRADES

No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

THE STUDY OF BEHAVIORAL ECONOMICS (38120) - [DEAN, JOSHUA>>](#)

CONTENT

Behavioral economics applies psychological insights to economic markets and decision making. In this class, we will discuss the recent theoretical and empirical advances that have been made in this increasingly important field of economics. Being thoughtful about the role of psychology can lead to a greater understanding of how the economy works.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll in BUSN 38120 if BUSN 20710 taken previously.

GRADES

No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: September 03 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 38120-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38120-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

THE STUDY OF BEHAVIORAL ECONOMICS (38120) - [POPE, DEVIN>>](#)

CONTENT

Behavioral economics applies psychological insights to economic markets and decision making. In this class, we will discuss the recent theoretical and empirical advances that have been made in this increasingly important field of economics. Being thoughtful about the role of psychology can lead to a greater understanding of how the economy works.

PREREQUISITES

No non-Booth students. Cannot enroll in BUSN 38120 if BUSN 20710 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38120-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38120-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06

No non-Booth Students

In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38120-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
408
In-Person Only

GRADES

No pass/fail grades. Auditors allowed only with faculty approval.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

DIVERSITY IN ORGANIZATIONS (38122) - [RISEN, JANE>>](#)

CONTENT

The aim of this course is to use insights from behavioral science to promote organizational health as it relates to diversity, equity, and inclusion. Many organizations that are interested in promoting diversity, equity, and inclusion don't know how to achieve their goals. Thus, the course will not only focus on the question of why (Why should we care about diversity, equity, and inclusion?), but primarily on the question of how (How can we promote diversity, equity, and inclusion? How can we leverage differences effectively?).

We will identify why work environments often aren't equitable – why is it more complicated for certain employees, such as women and racial minorities, to succeed in organizations? We will consider person-centered sources of bias, such as implicit and explicit stereotypes, as well as more systemic/ institutional sources of bias. By diagnosing sources of inequity, we can identify strategies that might help reduce the inequity (of course, no single change can undo all sources of bias).

We will focus our attention on strategies that use behavioral design or “nudges,” which are often more powerful than tactics that raise awareness and less costly and onerous than quotas and rules. Moreover, we will think about using behavioral design for creating equal access at the “gateways” to an organization (things like getting hired for a job and getting admitted to a school) as well as ensuring equal opportunities for success along its “pathways” (things like getting heard, getting credit, and getting second chances).

We will also consider barriers to diversity efforts that must be overcome. For example, an organization cannot learn and improve without being willing to

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38122-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 38122-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

acknowledge that current practices may be problematic and being willing to experiment with something new. Indeed, even with a good idea, implementing it effectively requires buy-in, ally-ship, and rigorous evaluation.

All are welcome. I hope to encourage learning and dialogue among students with a variety of social identities and backgrounds and expect to hear different views on how firms can and should address diversity, equity, and inclusion. Although the class will foreground race and gender dynamics in the U.S. context, we will also consider other dimensions of difference (e.g., class background, nationality, LGBTQ identity, religion, disability, and more) and reflect on these topics in other countries and cultural contexts. It is vitally important for MBA students, who will become the leaders of domestic and global companies, to be informed about how to create the conditions that enable all people to achieve success. Students who take this course will be able to utilize the skills and knowledge taught when making their own career decisions, as well as when managing, being managed by, or collaborating with others of diverse backgrounds.

PREREQUISITES

None. Cannot enroll if 20715 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Readings will be posted in Canvas (including cases and articles), and a couple of books will also be used.

GRADES

Short individual weekly papers and a final group paper. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Students are required to attend the first class session.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 07 2025

CULTURE (AND WHY IT MATTERS) (38126) - [TALHELM, THOMAS>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Culture shapes our thought, our relationships, and even how much power money has over us. This class will equip you with the basics of how cultures differ and why they differ. You'll also learn about exciting recent discoveries, such as why modernization is actually pushing cultures farther apart rather than erasing cultural differences. You'll learn through case challenges, fieldwork, and measuring real-world cultural differences. With these tools, you will be able to better navigate life abroad, negotiate better, and build the culture of the teams you lead.

PREREQUISITES

None

MATERIALS

This course will use readings, cases, videos, and podcasts.

GRADES

Grades will be calculated based on a midterm, final paper, weekly assignments, and attendance.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: July 31 2025

WORKSHOP IN BEHAVIORAL SCIENCE (38601) - [CHAUDHRY, SHEREEN>>](#) ; [EPLEY, NICHOLAS>>](#)

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38126-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38126-02
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 38126-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 38601-60
M 10:10 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

WORKSHOP IN BEHAVIORAL SCIENCE (38601) - FISHBACH, AYELET>> ; TODOROV, ALEXANDER>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD Students Only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38601-60
M 10:10 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 20 2025

WORKSHOP IN BEHAVIORAL SCIENCE (38601) - KOCH, ALEX>> ; POPE, DEVIN>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD Students Only. Instructor permission required for MBA students.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 38601-60
M 10:10 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

LEADERSHIP CAPITAL (38820, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [GINZEL, LINDA>>](#)

CONTENT

Leadership Capital is a new approach to leadership development, defined as "the wisdom to decide when to manage and when to lead, together with the courage and capacity to act on your choices." This course builds on conceptual knowledge from the discipline of experimental social psychology, supplemented with the domain knowledge and experience you gain outside the classroom. You will use this knowledge to practice and develop your action and insight skills. This course will provide opportunities to reflect, draft, and test frameworks for managing and leading, allowing you to learn from the data of your experience.

This course is meant to serve as a point of departure. Your primary task as a student of leadership is to develop your own perspective on themes of leadership that matter most to you. You will also learn to appreciate how that point of view evolves with experience and increased self-understanding. One of the bigger lessons from this class may be your ability to have an impact by putting social psychology into practice. You will learn about the power of strong situations on people and this will allow you to make better choices for you and for others. The goal of the course is to provide this framework in class, and leave you with tools you can use to put leadership capital to work in your own life for many years to come.

PREREQUISITES

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 38820-88
08/03, 08/04, 08/06, 08/07,
08/08
EMBA1 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 01 2026

POWER AND INFLUENCE IN ORGANIZATIONS (38886, 50 UNIT COURSE) - MENON, TANYA

CONTENT

Your technical skills determine what you can do in theory. Power determines what you can actually do in organizational contexts. This course considers power, a topic that everyone in organizations thinks and talks about but few people navigate with ease. We will also consider your options in influencing others—changing people's minds and moving them to action, whether or not you have formal authority over them. The particular focus in this session will be on the challenging moments, often starring difficult colleagues and complex, ambiguous situations, that senior executives might face in their path to power.

Through cases and exercises this course will help you: 1) diagnose the distribution of power in organizations, 2) identify strategies to build your power base, 3) develop techniques for motivating, persuading, and influencing others to get your ideas implemented, and 4) understand the manager's role in building cooperation in an organization.

This course has three objectives:

1. Understanding power

- You will be able to clinically diagnose power relations within organizations, i.e., understand who has power, why they have power, and how to deal with them.
- You will understand how to achieve things even if you don't have formal authority.
- You will recognize the hidden sources of power that you have available to yourself that you may not have leveraged yet.

2. Building your power base

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 38886-88
08/10, 08/11, 08/12, 08/14,
08/15
EMBA2 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

- You will learn the basic tools to acquire power
- You will learn tactics of influence, persuasion, and motivation
- You will learn how to develop your network relationships more effectively

3. Applying power to some of the most challenging situations executives face in organizations

This course is taught by Tanya Menon, Visiting Professor of Management, from Fisher College of Business, Ohio State University.

PREREQUISITES

Prereq: Cannot enroll if 38003 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

Course Requirements

There are three aspects of this course: Class contribution, essays, and final exam.

Class Contribution (15%)

Learning is an interactive process. You are admitted based on the experiences you bring to the learning community and what you can add to class discussions. Therefore, attendance, preparation, and contribution are important aspects of studying here. I do not grade class contribution based on subjective impressions, which can be highly unreliable, or on quantity of verbal output, which is often uncorrelated with your knowledge and learning. If you contribute in a professional and prepared manner, you will receive full credit for class contribution. If you are not meeting these standards, I will inform you immediately so that you can address these issues. I am also sensitive to your many obligations as executives, and please inform me of any specific issues you may face so I can understand and accommodate you.

I also understand it's hard to make the points you want to make in the midst of a case discussion. In a large classroom where we need to begin and end on time, it's impossible to call on everyone. My rule is always to call on those who have spoken the least. If you feel that you did not get a chance to make a point in class or you have further insights about the points made in class, please feel free to email me your thoughts/questions to discuss further at any point, or to set up an appointment.

Exam (65%)

The final exam is online, open book/notes, multiple choice, and you can complete it at home over an 80 minute window between the end of class and September 20th. Once you open it, you'll have 80 minutes to submit. There are 60 questions and you will not experience time pressure unless you are looking

up most of the items. The questions will draw on course readings, and concepts and frameworks from class discussions. The purpose of this examination is not to trick you or stress you out, or test your writing skills or powers of management. It is simply a chance for me to gage your mastery of the concepts presented in class. People who have been in class, done the readings, and have participated in our discussions do well on the exam. The exam is multiple choice to ensure a fair, objective grading process.

Essays (20%)

The goal here is not to grade you on your writing skills or to stress you out, but to offer you a chance to integrate the concepts from our class more deeply so you may apply them to your work situations. The maximum word count here is 500 words, and you may write less if you are able to answer the questions succinctly.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 13 2026

CURRENT TOPICS IN BEHAVIORAL SCIENCE I (38901) - CHAUDHRY, SHEREEN>> ; TODOROV, ALEXANDER>>

CONTENT

This is a graduate seminar for Ph.D. students interested in behavioral science. The course will be divided into two parts.

The first part of the seminar, taught by Professor Chaudhry, will be guided by the question "How can we understand the psychology underlying interdependent social interactions, where each person's decision depends on what they think the other person will do or think?" Topics will include person perception (mental state and trait inference), conversation (incl. language and pragmatic inference), interdependence theory, close relationships, conflict management, impression management, and shared reality.

The second part of the seminar, taught by Professor Todorov, will be guided by the question "To what extent we can generalize from group level data to individual behavior?" Standard research practices, including computational modeling, typically aggregate across participants, implicitly assuming individual variation is unimportant. However, in many domains of the social sciences, this assumption is unwarranted. Starting with methodological and empirical critiques of this assumption, we will focus on one area of research, where it is possible to quantify the importance of individual differences. We will conclude with methodological implications for psychological research.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 38901-50
W 3:30 PM-6:30 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Admitted to the Ph.D. program or consent of instructor.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 12 2025

FOUNDATIONS OF SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY (38914) - [EPLEY, NICHOLAS>>](#)

CONTENT

Intended for Ph.D. students interested in getting an advanced understanding of social psychology. This seminar will focus on foundational topics such as attitude change, emotion, social influence, and social cognition, covering both classic as well as contemporary research. Each week we will try to gain some understanding of how judgment and behavior is influenced by the contexts in which people find themselves. Each week we will try to identify new research directions worth pursuing, in the hope that students will develop new research ideas of their own.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 38914-50
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

BEHAVIORAL ECONOMICS - DEVELOPMENT & OBSERVATIONAL DATA (38916) - [DEAN, JOSHUA>>](#) ; [POPE, DEVIN>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025

Behavioral economics applies psychological insights to economic markets and decision making. In this class, we will discuss the recent theoretical and empirical advances made in this increasingly important field of economics with a focus on behavioral development economics and observational data analysis. Being thoughtful about the role of psychology can lead to a greater understanding of how economic agents make decisions and how the economy works.

Section: 38916-50
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

This course will utilize lectures, discussion, and problem sets to provide an introduction to the topic of behavioral economics. The primary goal of the class is to provide a basic understanding of the field and think about how one can do original research as a PhD student in this field.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. MBA students require instructor permission: strict. BUSN 38916 = ECON 41175

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

TOPICS IN BEHAVIORAL ECONOMICS (38917) - BURSZTYN, LEO

CONTENT

This class covers recent work in behavioral economics. Topics include social influence and social pressure, the role of identity in economics, the psychology of poverty, and social preferences. Applications will cover a wide range of fields, including labor economics, finance, political economy, and development economics.

This course will be taught by [Leonardo Bursztyn](#) in Economics. The course will likely be held in Saieh Hall room 141.

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 38917=ECON 41120

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 23 2026

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 38917-50
M 5:30 PM-8:20 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
In-Person Only

STRATEGY AND STRUCTURE: MARKETS AND ORGANIZATIONS (39001) - LI, NINGZI>>

CONTENT

Success in management requires both the ability to formulate a winning strategy and the skills to guide employees in executing it. A manager's brilliant ideas about strategy are ultimately worth little if she or he is unable to translate them into actions that both deliver value to customers and enable the firm to capture a portion of the value created. Yet, managers often overemphasize strategy development while giving short shrift to execution.

In this course, we will examine the powerful and complex role of social organization – the firm's formal structure, its culture, and the characteristics of the people who work there – in strategy execution. This course provides students with an overarching framework for thinking about the relationship between strategy, the organization and the firm's environment.

Using this framework, students will identify and characterize the strategies and organizational structures of existing firms, assess alignment between strategy and organizational structure, and identify steps a firm could take to increase the likelihood of executing its strategy successfully. We will consider topics such as innovation, mergers/acquisitions, new ventures, and organizational change.

A large component of the class will involve case discussions, which provide an opportunity for students to gain critical-thinking skills and decision-making experience by putting themselves into the shoes of a specific manager operating at a given firm with a particular, often incomplete, set of information.

PREREQUISITES

There are no required classes for Business 39001. This course is suitable for first-year students. This course has a first-class assignment. Non-Booth students require faculty permission: strict.

GRADES

No auditors. No pass/fail grades. Provisional grades and early final grades for graduating students only.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 39001-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 39001-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 13 2026

TECHNOLOGY STRATEGY (39101) - KNEZ, MARC>>

CONTENT

This course focuses on business strategy in the context of technology change. In the past, the class focused on a short list of relatively technology intensive industries. But under the current digital/AI revolution, the concepts and frameworks covered in the class apply to almost all industries. The fundamental principle that underlies the class is that how every companies competes, from their business strategy and business model/operating model, and the structure of the industry they compete in, has been optimized within one or more technology paradigms. Hence, when a new technology paradigms emerges a re-optimization process must follow - their strategy must change or they risk being being disrupted by new entrants to their industry. Engaging in this type of strategy process requires a deeper set of concepts than those provided in a traditional strategy class.

While technological change is at the heart of the course, a background in technology is not required.

PREREQUISITES

Business 42001 or 39001. Non-Booth students must have prereq (BUS 42001 or 39001): strict

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

The course is taught using lectures, case analysis and readings. This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Based on class participation, case write-ups, a midterm, and a final. The midterm will be in-class. Due to Memorial Day, the final will be on-line. The class cannot be taken pass/fail.

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 39101-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 39101-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 39101-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 39101-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
In-Person Only

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 17 2026

OPERATIONS MANAGEMENT: BUSINESS PROCESS FUNDAMENTALS (40000) - [CANDOGAN, OZAN>>](#)

CONTENT

This core course focuses on the levers for structuring, managing, and improving a firm's recurring business processes to achieve competitive advantage in customer responsiveness, price, quality, and product or service variety. These levers are as relevant to banks, hospitals, and brokerage firms as they are to traditional manufacturers. The course explores processes both within firms and across firms (i.e., supply chains). Students will examine the fundamental principles underlying state-of-the-art practices, learning how to critically evaluate these and other operational improvement programs.

The course introduces the basics of managing a firm's operations and demonstrates how operational issues both influence and are influenced by business decisions that students will encounter in their careers. As such, it is essential for students aspiring to become consultants, entrepreneurs, or general managers. A working knowledge of operations is also invaluable for those pursuing careers in marketing, finance, or accounting, where effective collaboration with operations is critical. Moreover, understanding how firms achieve market leadership through operations is particularly important for investment professionals.

Most sessions feature in-depth case discussions integrated with theory. This structure makes the course excellent preparation for the types of cases often encountered in internship and full-time job interviews.

PREREQUISITES

No Non-Booth students. Any previous or concurrent exposure to basic statistics is helpful. It is mandatory to attend the first class session. Cannot enroll in BUSN 40000 if BUSN 20500 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 40000-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 40000-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 40000-03
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 40000-04
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

Selection of readings and lecture notes which will be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Based on a midterm and final exam, case analyses, homework, group work, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. No GSAL students. No non-Booth students. Graduating students can receive a provisional grade, but not an early final grade.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 10 2025

OPERATIONS MANAGEMENT: BUSINESS PROCESS FUNDAMENTALS (40000) - [CHAYET, SERGIO>>](#)

CONTENT

This core course focuses on understanding levers for structuring, managing, and improving a firm's recurring business processes to achieve competitive advantage in customer responsiveness, price, quality, and variety of products and services. These levers are as applicable to banks, hospitals, and brokerage firms, for example, as to traditional manufacturing. Processes within firms, as well as between firms, i.e. supply chains, are explored. The fundamental principles underlying state-of-the-art practices, such as Quick Response, Just-in-Time and Time-Based Competition, are explored so that students learn to critically evaluate these and other operational improvement programs.

Students learn the basics of how to manage the operations of a firm, and how operational issues effect and are effected by the many business decisions they will be called upon to make or recommend in their careers. As such, this course is essential to students aspiring to become consultants, entrepreneurs, or general managers. A working knowledge of operations is also indispensable to those interested in marketing, finance, and accounting, where the interface between these functions and operations is critical. Finally, an understanding of how firms become market leaders through operations is important in investment careers.

Most sessions consist of in-depth case discussion, integrated with theory. As such, the course is ideal preparation for many cases encountered during job

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 40000-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Building: TBD
Location: TBD
Remote-Only

Summer 2026
Section: 40000-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

interviews.

PREREQUISITES

Any previous or concurrent exposure to basic statistics is helpful. Cannot enroll in BUSN 40000 if BUSN 20500 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

The Goal by Goldratt and a Canvas site with readings, lecture notes, and handouts.

GRADES

Based on a mid-term and final exam, case analyses, homework, and class contribution. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors or non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: May 08 2026

OPERATIONS MANAGEMENT: BUSINESS PROCESS FUNDAMENTALS (40000) - [ZHONG, YUAN>>](#)

CONTENT

This core course focuses on understanding levers for structuring, managing, and improving a firm's recurring business processes to achieve competitive advantage in customer responsiveness, price, quality, and variety of products and services. These levers are as applicable to banks, hospitals, and brokerage firms, for example, as to traditional manufacturing. Processes within firms, as well as between firms, i.e. supply chains, are explored. The fundamental principles underlying state-of-the-art practices are explored so that students learn to critically evaluate these and other operational improvement programs.

Students learn the basics of how to manage the operations of a firm, and how operational issues affect and are affected by the many business decisions they will be called upon to make or recommend in their careers. As such, this course is essential to students aspiring to become consultants, entrepreneurs, or general managers. A working knowledge of operations is also indispensable to those interested in marketing, finance, and accounting, where the interface

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 40000-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 40000-02
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

between these functions and operations is critical. Finally, an understanding of how firms become market leaders through operations is important in investment careers.

Most weeks consist of in-depth case discussion, integrated with theory. As such, the course is ideal preparation for many cases encountered during interviews for internships and full-time positions.

Spring 2026
Section: 40000-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Any previous or concurrent exposure to basic statistics is helpful. Cannot enroll in BUSN 40000 if BUSN 20500 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

A selection of readings and lecture notes which will be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Based on a mid-term and final exam, case analyses, homework, group work, and class participation. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. No GSAL students or non-Booth students. Graduating students will be able to receive a provisional grade.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 17 2026

SUPPLY CHAIN STRATEGY AND PRACTICE (40101) - DEHORATIUS, NICOLE

CONTENT

The supply chain of a firm is critical to its performance. Supply chains are networks of organizations that supply and transform materials and distribute final products to consumers. If designed and managed properly, these networks can be a crucial source of competitive advantage for both manufacturing and service enterprises.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 40101-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center

Students will learn how to examine and improve the flow of materials and information through this network of suppliers, manufacturers, distributors, and retailers in order to match supply with demand (i.e., to get the right products to the right customers in the right amount and at the right time). Key topics include inter- and intra-firm coordination, incentive design, the impact of uncertainty, and the role of information technology. Special emphasis is given to understanding how the business context shapes managerial decisions regarding the strategic design and management of the supply chain.

C09
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 40101-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll in BUSN 40101 if BUSN 20520 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

Based on case analyses, group assignments (e.g., case submissions, simulation results), class participation, and a final project. No auditors. No pass/fail grades. No non-Booth students.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SUPPLY CHAIN STRATEGY AND PRACTICE (40101) - [DEVALVE, LEVI>>](#)

CONTENT

The supply chain of a firm is critical to its performance. Supply chains are networks of organizations that supply and transform materials and distribute final products to consumers. If designed and managed properly, these networks can be a crucial source of competitive advantage for both manufacturing and service enterprises.

Students will learn how to examine and improve the flow of materials and information through this network of suppliers, manufacturers, distributors,

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 40101-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

and retailers in order to match supply with demand (i.e., to get the right products to the right customers in the right amount and at the right time). Key topics include inter- and intra-firm coordination, incentive design, the impact of uncertainty, and the role of information technology. Special emphasis is given to understanding how the business context shapes managerial decisions regarding the strategic design and management of the supply chain.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll in BUSN 40101 if BUSN 20520 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

Based on case analyses, group assignments (e.g., case submissions, simulation results), class participation, and a final project. No auditors. No pass/fail grades. No non-Booth students.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

REVENUE MANAGEMENT (40108) - [CALDENTEY, RENE>>](#)

CONTENT

This course will focus on the identification, formulation, solution, and implementation of systems for pricing and revenue optimization. The course will develop fundamental understanding of the use of pricing and capacity concepts combined with optimization tools to achieve revenue improvement within the practical context of limited resources and information. Case examples from a variety of industries including airlines, hotels, car rental agencies, internet/media advertising, entertainment, retailing, energy, commodities, freight, and manufacturing will be used to develop skills in designing and implementing solutions in different environments.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 40108-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Students will learn how to recognize opportunities for revenue enhancement; how to differentiate among types of opportunities; how to segment markets while incorporating constrained capacity, opportunity costs, customer and competitor response, demand and supply uncertainty, and information infrastructure; how to formulate and solve for revenue management decisions using constrained optimization; and how to define overall implementation requirements.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001 and 41000 (or 41100). No non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

The course will use the text, *Pricing and Revenue Optimization*, by R. Phillips, Stanford, 2005, plus cases, readings, and lecture notes. The course will rely heavily on the use of the Solver in Microsoft Excel.

GRADES

Based on homework, case summaries, mid-term, final exam and participation. No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 18 2026

MANAGING SERVICE OPERATIONS (40110) - [WARD, AMY>>](#)

CONTENT

This class is concerned with the design, delivery, monitoring, and analysis of services. Lines of inquiry include: How to design and improve a service offering for sustained excellence, How to identify and overcome key challenges in service delivery, and How to monitor and analyze the performance of service entities. We consider a wide range of industries, from traditional services such

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 40110-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C05

as restaurants and hospitals to more modern internet-based services, and services taken from both the public and private sector.

We consider a service one in which the customer is involved, actively or passively, in the production process, and we strive to understand and leverage the role customers play in the process. This course draws on ideas from operations management (Bus 40000), but from a different perspective, that also includes a behavioral element. This course is a mix of softer more qualitative frameworks and more analytical pursuits.

Our Service Model has four parts: The Service Offering (what customer needs and expectations does the service emphasize and which ones will it sacrifice?), Firm Value (does the service provide value for the stakeholders), Employee Value (does the service provide value to the employees?), and Customer Value (does the service provide enough value to customers to encourage them to play their role effectively?).

Process Flows are used to understand the aggregated flow of customers through a process to address issues such as capacity utilization, throughput, and waiting time. We will cover the basics of process flow analysis that is also covered in Bus 40000, but with a focus on service processes. As such, there is **significant overlap with the content of Bus 40000** (roughly 50%), and so a typical student may likely choose to take either this course or Bus 40000. This class's focus on Services is for those students whose interests tend towards the end consumer; in comparison, Bus 40000 takes a broader view of Operations that include issues of production and supply chain management.

The course has both cases and lecture. Most cases are intended to provoke class discussion, with the purpose of exploring our Service Framework in a broad sense, and also delving into particular aspects in more detail.

In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 40110-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Previous or concurrent exposure to basic statistics is helpful. Mandatory to attend first class.

MATERIALS

All materials can be accessed through Canvas.

GRADES

Your grade is based on written case analyses, class participation, in-class concept check quizzes, and a final project. The class cannot be taken pass/fail.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

PROJECT MANAGEMENT (40111) - CHAYET, SERGIO>>**CONTENT**

Change management has become synonymous with project management, since organizations who want to change their focus or direction increasingly recognize that introducing new products, processes, or programs in a timely and cost effective manner requires professional project management. This course analyzes complex projects and discusses available tools for managing them, covering both the fundamental aspects of modern project management, as well as state-of-the-art knowledge and methodologies for managing real-world projects.

Some of the topics covered include critical project success and failure factors, effective project planning for cost and time, the critical path method, earned value analysis for project management and control, project planning with uncertainty (PERT, Monte Carlo simulation, and cycling in precedence networks), critical chain, project risk management, managing multiple stakeholders, project portfolio management, managing multiple projects, project contracts, and agile/scrum project management. The course provides exposure to commercial project management software and to how to overcome its limited functionality to address the needs of risky complex projects in practice. Students learn project management skills that will be useful throughout their careers. Therefore, this course is essential for any current or future managers (unless they are already highly experienced project managers), regardless of their career concentration.

Most sessions consist of in-depth case discussion, integrated with theory; making the course ideal preparation for many cases encountered during job interviews.

PREREQUISITES

Any previous or concurrent exposure to basic statistics is helpful.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Critical Chain by Goldratt and a Canvas site with readings, lecture notes, and handouts.

GRADES**SCHEDULE**

Summer 2026
Section: 40111-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Based on a mid-term and final exam, case analyses, homework, and class contribution. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors or non-Booth students.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: May 08 2026

HEALTHCARE BUSINESS ANALYTICS (40206) - [ADELMAN, DAN>>](#)

CONTENT

One of the today's most exciting and important applications of Business Analytics is Healthcare. Every day, more data on provider performance is becoming available to consumers to help them make better informed decisions about their healthcare. Hospital revenues are being driven more and more by clinical results through value-based incentive programs for improving hospital readmissions, patient safety, costs, and patient outcomes. At the same time, population health is improving as Big Data is being used to learn what treatments are most effective at an unprecedented pace and scale. Alternative payment models are developing that require providers to take on the full financial risk of patient care. These forces are transforming the healthcare industry and public health.

In this class, you will learn the *business of healthcare* through the lens of the data that drive it. For its framework, the course develops the underlying financial model of a health system, and teaches you how operational and clinical performance drive business success. You will learn how to conduct various analyses that are essential for consultants and business analysts who work in the industry, and thus the course intertwines management issues with data for decision-making. The course combines lecture and discussion with hands-on work with large, real-world healthcare datasets. You will learn the underlying logic and calculations of value-based hospital reimbursement, outcomes measurement, and benchmarking, working directly with patient-level claims datasets from CMS (Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services) and elsewhere. By the end of the course, students will be prepared to conduct and/or participate in a real-world data analysis project at a major healthcare consulting firm, provider, or insurance company. Students who end up working in firms whose ultimate customers are healthcare providers or insurers, such as IT start-ups or pharmaceutical/biotech/device manufacturers, will benefit by developing an understanding of how providers/payers can use their firms' products and services to improve business performance.

Students interested in the Healthcare Analytics Laboratory (Bus 40721) are encouraged to enroll in this class. While this course is designed to complement the Healthcare Analytics Lab, it is a standalone offering and can be taken independently. Students seeking exposure to healthcare business analytics

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 40206-01
TH 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Booth 455
132
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 40206-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Booth 455
132
In-Person Only

who are unable to make the commitments the Lab requires will find it useful preparation for future endeavors.

PREREQUISITES

Basic introductory statistics. Students will not be required to write code (R or python), but occasionally you will be required to run or slightly edit pieces of code provided by the instructor. Almost all numerical work will be conducted using state-of-the-art software tools. Thus, students should have a willingness and interest in learning powerful new software tools and working with real-world data to transform it into usable management insights.

All Non-Booth students require instructor approval: strict. Enrollment of non-Booth students in Bus 40206 Healthcare Data Analytics is by application.

Applications

(https://chicagoboath.az1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_cw2jbFqdrTPbUyO) will be reviewed on a rolling basis. Please note: this course is not open to alumni.

Cannot enroll in 40206 if you have taken 40205 or 40201: strict.

Students may take this course and Bus 40721 (Healthcare Analytics Laboratory) either concurrently or sequentially in any order. These courses are organized similarly to typical college-level science courses, with both a lecture component (Bus 40206) and a lab component (Bus 40721). Thus, students who take both receive the complete educational experience, but students may also choose to take only one. Students in Bus 40206 receive foundational learning in the healthcare industry through the lens of business analyses using data, as well as training in conducting business analyses in an interface that does not require prior coding or data analysis experience. Students in both courses use Data Science Studio (DSS) by Dataiku, while students who take Bus 40721 also use Tableau to create data visualizations.

Students who choose to take Bus 40721 without having had Bus 40206 will need to complete trainings in both DSS and Tableau. Typically, teams in Bus 40721 include at least some members who have taken Bus 40206, and thus they are able to share any material from that course that is directly relevant to the project with other team members. Students who choose to take Bus 40206 without taking Bus 40721 will not benefit from reinforcing and applying their learnings to a real-world project and sponsor. Students who take both courses will benefit from having a broad understanding of how business analyses are conducted in the healthcare industry, and how their lab project fits into the broader industry landscape. They will be fully prepared to conduct business analyses in the healthcare industry from day one of employment as a consultant, analyst, or manager.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Students will use state-of-the-art commercial software tools that permit data preparation and collaboration on datasets too large to work with efficiently using spreadsheets. Data manipulation and analyses will be done using a

combination of both point-and-click recipes and pre-prepared analysis scripts in the statistical software package R.

Students will work with real-world healthcare data that is protected by HIPAA, on a secure, private server housed at Chicago Booth. As such, students will receive training and certification in HIPAA as part of their first class assignment.

Required Textbook: [Risk Adjustment for Measuring Health Care Outcomes](#), by Lisa I. Iezzoni, 4th Edition, 2013.

Supplementary articles and reading materials.

Students will be required to bring their internet-ready laptop to every class session.

GRADES

Based on a series of mini-projects and class participation. Can be taken pass/fail.

No auditors. Provisional grades will be given to graduating students.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 12 2025

HEALTHCARE ANALYTICS LAB (40721) - [ADELMAN, DAN>>](#)

CONTENT

The healthcare industry is now undergoing a transformation as data analysis is being rapidly deployed to improve clinical, operational, and financial outcomes. The Healthcare Analytics Laboratory will focus on applying data-driven analytics and insights to identify and create healthcare delivery efficiencies. Student teams will work on real-world improvement projects with prominent healthcare institutions.

The Laboratory provides students with opportunities to:

1. Apply and reinforce tools and frameworks developed elsewhere in the Booth curriculum

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 40721-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Booth 455
132
In-Person Only

2. Develop leadership skills and build effectiveness in teams;
3. Learn a healthcare context deeply through an intensive project experience
4. Develop proficiency at presenting data analyses to executive audiences
5. Impact real-world healthcare delivery.

Thus, the course will help students develop the skills required to successfully deliver evidence-based management analytics in the real world. Projects will be carefully scoped, and most data will be acquired, before the course begins so that students can make steady progress towards clear, attainable goals. Students will present milestones every two weeks to the instructional team (which consists of the faculty instructor and graduate students who serve as project mentors) and, on occasion, to the entire class. Final presentations will be delivered to hospital executives and physician leaders.

The course is for students interested in leveraging the academic rigor of data and decision analysis to improve healthcare delivery. It is an excellent course for those interested in careers in or related to the healthcare industry, and business analytics more broadly. Students will be prepared for careers as consultants, analysts, or managers in the healthcare industry, or in any industry or career that relies on data for making important business decisions.

Application Timeline:

Applications for Winter 2026 are now closed.

PREREQUISITES

Students may take this course and Bus 40206 (Healthcare Business Analytics) either concurrently or sequentially in any order. These courses are organized similarly to typical college-level science courses, with both a lecture component (Bus 40206) and a lab component (Bus 40721). Thus, students who take both receive the complete educational experience, but students may also choose to take only one. Students in Bus 40206 receive foundational learning in the healthcare industry through the lens of business analyses using data, as well as training in conducting business analyses in an interface that does not require prior coding or data analysis experience. Students in both courses use Data Science Studio (DSS) by Dataiku, while students who take Bus 40721 also use Tableau to create data visualizations.

Students who choose to take Bus 40721 without having had Bus 40206 will need to complete trainings in both DSS and Tableau. Typically, teams include at least some members who have taken Bus 40206, and thus they are able to share any material from that course that is directly relevant to the project with other team members. Students who choose to take Bus 40206 without taking Bus 40721 will not benefit from reinforcing and applying their learnings to a real-world project and sponsor. Students who take both courses will benefit from having a broad understanding of how business analyses are conducted in the healthcare industry, and how their lab project fits into the broader industry landscape. They will be fully prepared to conduct business analyses in the healthcare industry from day one of employment as a consultant, analyst, or manager.

Depending on the project students are assigned to, other courses may be helpful. Some projects require only basic statistics, but others require more advanced statistics at the level of Bus 41201 (Big Data), Bus 41100 (Applied Regression Analysis), or Bus 41204 (Machine Learning). For some projects, it is helpful to have a background in operations management (Bus 40000) and/or cost accounting (Bus 30001). Occasionally, a project uses concepts covered in Bus 36106 (Managerial Decision Modeling). Programming experience at the level of Bus 32100 (Data Analysis in R and Python) is helpful but not required. Not every student is required to have all of these recommended pre/co-requisites. Teams will be comprised of members having a variety of complementary skills and backgrounds.

Students should also be prepared to work collaboratively within a highly energized, self-managed work team, and be interested in developing their personal skills around team and individual behavior.

Please note: this course is not open to alumni.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

MATERIALS

Students will work with real-world healthcare data that is protected by HIPAA and confidential to sponsors, on a secure, private server housed at Chicago Booth. As such, students will receive training and certification in HIPAA as part of their first class assignment.

GRADES

Evaluation Criteria: project deliverables, presentations, participation in project teams and engagement in the class sessions, written assignments. Students typically spend 8-12 hours per week on their projects

Cannot take pass/fail. No auditors. Provisional grades will be given to graduating students.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 23 2025

FRONTIERS IN AI FOR OPERATIONAL DECISION-MAKING (40915) - [CANDOGAN, OZAN>>](#)

CONTENT

This PhD course explores the integration of artificial intelligence, machine learning, and reinforcement learning into operational decision-making. With an emphasis on practical applications rather than exhaustive theoretical development, the course builds on recent advances in the operations management literature. Class sessions introduce core theoretical concepts from the classical literature to develop intuition, provide direction for deeper study, and frame discussion around contemporary research and applications.

Topics span agentic AI systems, generative AI and digital twins, modeling of customer choice, experimental design under interference, AI-driven experimentation, and optimization enhanced by AI tools. The course concludes with reinforcement learning and its growing role in operational decision-making. Sessions combine discussion of recent research, student and instructor presentations, and guest lectures from leading scholars in the field.

PREREQUISITES

N/A

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

MATERIALS

See the syllabus for optional textbooks. Papers that will be discussed in our sessions will be referenced on Canvas.

GRADES

No pass/fail grades

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 40915-50
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
3A - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 10 2025

BUSINESS STATISTICS (41000) - ARAGAM, BRYON>>

CONTENT

Data science. Machine learning. Statistics. Predictive Analytics. No matter what it's called, modern business runs on data. This course is an introduction to the fundamentals of probability and statistics with an aim towards building foundational skills in modern data science. Topics to be covered include 1) Exploratory data analysis and descriptive statistics, 2) Basic probability, common pitfalls and fallacies, 3) Statistical modeling, inference, p-values, and A/B testing, and 4) Prediction, regression, and classification. Emphasis will be placed on ethics and privacy in data analysis as well as real-world applications and case studies.

PREREQUISITES

No undergraduates. Other non-Booth students require faculty permission.
All registered students must take the pre-MBA quiz before the first day of class. Please see the course syllabus for details.

GRADES

No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

- No auditors
- No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: January 05 2026

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 41000-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 41000-02
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 41000-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

BUSINESS STATISTICS (41000) - DEB, NABARUN>>

CONTENT

This course is an introduction to the fundamentals of probability and statistics with an aim towards building foundational skills in modern data science. Topics to be covered include 1) Exploratory data analysis and descriptive statistics, 2) Basic probability, common pitfalls and fallacies, 3) Statistical modeling, inference, p-values, and A/B testing, and 4) Prediction, regression, and classification. Emphasis will be placed on ethics and privacy in data analysis as well as real-world applications and case studies.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41000-04
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025

PREREQUISITES

None.

Section: 41000-05
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

Although there is no official textbook for the class, we will use the following free online reference:

*** OpenIntro Statistics (free online resource
<https://www.openintro.org/book/os/>).

All lecture notes and course materials will be available in the class website. In addition, these references may help you as a complement to the class:

1. Statistics for Business: Decision Making and Analysis, by Robert Stine and Dean Foster
2. Introductory Statistics, by Robert Gould and Colleen N. Ryan
3. Naked Statistics, by Charles Wheelan

GRADES

No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

Course grades will be based on the following:

1. Homework - 20%
2. Midterms - 30%
3. Finals - 50%

The Midterm and Final exams will be in-person. It is expected and recommended that students complete all homeworks. There will be 4 homeworks (roughly 1 HW every 2 weeks).

Please do not make any travel plans on the specified dates of the final. No make up exams will be offered for any reason.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 11 2025

BUSINESS STATISTICS (41000) - [KAJI, TETSUYA>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Data science has altered decision making in many business scenes, from tech companies to financial institutions. This course provides fundamental statistical knowledge and practice, essential to data science in modern business enterprise. Examples are drawn from economics, finance, revenue management, pricing strategies, supply chain management, marketing, accounting, and more. Microsoft Excel (desktop version) will be used to aid calculation. The course is largely divided into three parts: (1) probability theory for decision making, (2) statistical tools to learn from data, and (3) linear regression for prediction.

PREREQUISITES

Non-Booth undergrads allowed. Non-Booth graduate students with instructor permission only.

MATERIALS

The course materials are posted on Canvas. They include lecture slides, Excel files, weekly review quizzes, and practice exams. There are **no required textbooks**. If you are looking for more exercises than the ones provided in the course, I recommend the optional textbook, R. Stine and D. Foster (2018) *Statistics for Business: Decision Making and Analysis*, 3rd ed., Pearson Education. The desktop version of Microsoft Excel is available to UChicago students, and the instruction for installation is given at <https://howto.cs.uchicago.edu/techstaff:msoffice>.

GRADES

Grades are determined based on the midterm exam and the final exam. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: September 02 2025

BUSINESS STATISTICS (41000) - [KANKANALA, SID>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides fundamental statistical knowledge and practice, essential to data science in modern business enterprise. Examples are drawn from economics, finance, revenue management, pricing strategies, supply chain management, marketing, accounting, and more. The course also serves as a quantitative foundation for Chicago Booth elective courses in marketing, finance, economics and more advanced courses in data science.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41000-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 41000-02
M 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 41000-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406

The course is largely divided into three parts: (1) probability theory for decision making, (2) statistical tools to learn from data, and (3) linear regression for prediction.

PREREQUISITES

If you have a weak math background, math review course prior to start of class is recommended.

Business Statistics or Applied Regression?

Please take the pre-MBA exam to figure out which class would be a better fit.

You can access the exam and related materials from the canvas site below:

<https://canvas.uchicago.edu/courses/36612>

MATERIALS

There are no required texts for the course.

GRADES

40% Homework, 60% Final.

The final exam will be in-class.

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 11 2026

BUSINESS STATISTICS (41000) - [LI, SHUANGNING>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides fundamental statistical knowledge and practice, essential to data science in modern business enterprise. Examples are drawn from economics, finance, revenue management, pricing strategies, supply chain management, marketing, accounting, and more. The course also serves as a quantitative foundation for Chicago Booth elective courses in marketing, finance, economics and more advanced courses in data science.

The course is largely divided into three parts: (1) probability theory for decision making, (2) statistical tools to learn from data, and (3) linear regression for prediction.

In-Person Only

Spring 2026

Section: 41000-85

S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM

Gleacher Center

406

In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026

Section: 41000-81

TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM

Gleacher Center

208

In-Person Only

Summer 2026

Section: 41000-85

S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM

Gleacher Center

PREREQUISITES

If your math background feels less strong, taking a math review course before the class begins may be helpful.

Business Statistics or Applied Regression?

Please take the pre-MBA exam to figure out which class would be a better fit.

You can access the exam and related materials from the Canvas website (TBA).

MATERIALS

There are no required texts for the course.

GRADES

Based on homework and a final exam. No pass/fail grades.

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 09 2026

BUSINESS STATISTICS (41000) - [LIANG, TENGYUAN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course covers fundamental statistical concepts and basic computational tools in data analysis. The goal is to learn how to perform descriptive and predictive data analysis based on real datasets. This course also serves as a quantitative foundation for Chicago Booth elective courses in marketing, finance, economics and more advanced courses in data science.

The topics to be covered are: (1) descriptive data analysis, and data visualization; (2) statistical modeling and inference, bootstrap; (3) regression analysis: linear, logistic regression, (4) model fitting and diagnostics; (5) basic predictive tools in machine learning.

PREREQUISITES

If you have a weak math background, math review course prior to start of class is recommended.

Business Statistics or Applied Regression?

Please take the pre-MBA exam to figure out which class would be a better fit.

208

In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 41000-03
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 41000-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

You can access the exam and related materials from the canvas site below:

<https://canvas.uchicago.edu/courses/36612>

MATERIALS

There are no required texts for the course.

GRADES

Based on homework, a mid-term, and final exam. No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

BUSINESS STATISTICS (41000) - [POLSON, NICHOLAS>>](#)

CONTENT

Bus41000 is a course on Data Analytics. Students will learn how to visualize and analyze data together with learning model building skills for analysis and prediction.

This course provides an introduction to key concepts and data analytic tools that are applicable in business environments. Both basic underlying concepts and practical computational skills are covered.

The techniques covered include (i) graphical data visualization; (ii) Bayes Probability; (iii) Statistical Modeling and Inference; (iv) A/B testing; (v) linear, logistic and multiple regression.

This class uses R which is widely used in data science. Students are encouraged to familiarize themselves with the links and code available on the course website.

PREREQUISITES

None.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41000-03
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 41000-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

There are no required texts. Detailed lecture notes are available on the Course Website.

GRADES

Based on a midterm and a final project.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 24 2026

BUSINESS STATISTICS (41000) - [RUSSELL, JEFFREY>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is designed to build a solid foundation in the analysis and interpretation of data. The tools and skills learned are not only very useful in preparing for future Booth courses, but also in understanding and using statistics encountered in business and everyday life.

The topics covered are: (i) graphical and visualization tools; (ii) modeling tools that are useful for understanding uncertainty, forecasting, and prediction (iii): methods for testing to see if a model is consistent with the real world data (iv) simple linear regression; and (v) multiple regression.

PREREQUISITES

Take pre-course quiz prior to first lecture.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

There are no required texts for the course.

GRADES

Based on pre-course quiz, homework, a mid-term, and final exam.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41000-06
09/08, 09/10, 09/12, 09/15,
09/17, 09/19, 09/22, 09/24,
09/26
MWF 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 41000-07
09/08, 09/10, 09/12, 09/15,
09/17, 09/19, 09/22, 09/24,
09/26
MWF 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

APPLIED REGRESSION ANALYSIS (41100) - [SMETANINA, EKATERINA \(KATJA\)>>](#)

CONTENT

This course is about regression, a powerful and widely used data analysis technique which is used to understand how different random quantities relate to one another. Students will learn how to use regression to analyze a variety of complex real-world problems, with the aim of gaining insights from the data and also to potentially predict future events. Focus is placed on the understanding of fundamental concepts and its implementation in a programming language (R, or alternative). Real-world examples are used throughout the course to illustrate the application of techniques. Topics covered include: (i) short review of simple linear regression; (ii) multiple regression and model checking and diagnostics; (iii) generalized linear models (e.g. logistic regression); (iv) time series models and forecasting. We will also discuss the use of machine learning in the context of regression.

PREREQUISITES

All Non-Booth students require instructor permission. Business 41000 or familiarity with the topics covered in Business 41000. This course is only for students with a basic background in statistics, and preferably some prior exposure to linear regression. Note: There is a homework due on the first day of class.

MATERIALS

All of the instructor's notes will be available on the course website.

GRADES

Based on homework assignments (groups allowed), class participation, midterm exam, and a final exam. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No auditors. Non-Booth students cannot enroll unless permission to enroll is granted by the instructor directly.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41100-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 41100-02
W 3:30 PM-6:30 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

APPLIED REGRESSION ANALYSIS (41100) - TOULIS (PANOS), PANAGIOTIS>>

CONTENT

To understand how advertising affects sales, a natural approach is to predict expected sales as a function of advertising and other relevant factors. This is an example of **regression**, a powerful and widely used data-analysis method—and the central topic of this course. Students will learn how to apply regression tools to complex, real-world problems with the dual goals of understanding data and predicting future outcomes. The emphasis is on building statistical intuition, mastering fundamental concepts and developing practical implementation skills in a programming language (R or Python), rather than memorizing mathematical formulas. Real examples are used throughout to demonstrate how these techniques operate in practice.

Topics include:

- linear regression;
- multiple regression;
- model checking and selection;
- generalized linear models (e.g., logistic regression);
- time-series models and forecasting;
- causal inference;
- resampling methods, including the bootstrap and cross-validation.

We will also discuss recent developments in AI, focusing on those that relate to the core ideas of the course.

PREREQUISITES

- You are strongly encouraged to take the Applied Regression Quiz to aid your decision. See <https://canvas.uchicago.edu/courses/36612>.
- Business 41000 or familiarity with the topics covered in Business 41000. This course is only for students with a basic background in statistics, and preferably some prior exposure to linear regression.
- All Non-Booth students require instructor permission.

MATERIALS

See Syllabus.

GRADES

Based on homework assignments (groups allowed), a midterm exam, and a final exam. Cannot be taken pass/fail.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 41100-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 41100-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

This year, students may work on a data analysis project of their choosing but this is optional.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 01 2025

FINANCIAL ECONOMETRICS (41203) - [RUSSELL, JEFFREY>>](#)

CONTENT

This course covers a variety of topics in financial econometrics. The topics covered are of real- world, practical interest and are closely linked to material covered in other advance finance courses. Topics covered include ARMA models, volatility models (GARCH), factor models, models for time varying correlations, analysis of panel data, cointegration models for long-run co-movement between prices and models for transactions data and the analysis of transactions cost.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 41203-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll in BUSN 41203 if BUSN 20820 taken previously.

MATERIALS

See Canvas site for additional information.

GRADES

Homework, midterm, and final exam. No provisional grades. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

MACHINE LEARNING (41204) - [HANSEN, CHRISTIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course aims to offer a broad, relatively non-technical introduction to key ideas from machine learning without digging too far into the mathematical minutiae. I intend the course to be accessible to students with an understanding of basic statistical concepts and mathematics but no deeper training beyond standard MBA-level statistics. Overall, my goal is that students leave the course able to have informed conversations about machine learning, understanding key conceptual ideas and practical challenges, and having a better idea of realistic opportunities for the use of machine learning in business.

The course will start by covering two basic learning paradigms: (i) supervised learning and (ii) unsupervised learning. In class, I will illustrate the paradigms through small-scale applications styled to match business problems. These applications will provide a vehicle for discussing important concepts and practical considerations. After covering the basic learning methods, we will explore additional topics such as deep neural networks, causal inference, policy learning, reinforcement learning, and generative AI models.

PREREQUISITES

BUSN 41000, 41100, or equivalent. Cannot enroll if 20810 taken previously.

GRADES

Class participation. Group homework assignments. Group project.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 24 2026

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 41204-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

CAUSAL INFERENCE FOR BUSINESS APPLICATIONS (41207) - [TOULIS \(PANOS\), PANAGIOTIS>>](#)

CONTENT

In recent years, causal inference has become essential for data-driven decision making, as these methods can protect against biases in traditional statistical modeling techniques. In this course, students will learn how to use various methods to draw causal inferences through practical experience and real-world data examples in areas such as policy, marketing and operations. Topics covered will include randomized A/B experiments, difference-in-differences, instrumental variables, and modern machine learning/AI tools.

PREREQUISITES

It is recommended that you have taken BUS 41100 (Applied Regression Analysis) or an equivalent class on basics of regression methods. This prerequisite is not strictly enforced but the lecture material may sometimes assume knowledge of standard regression analysis concepts (such as standard errors or model selection). Undergraduates require instructor permission.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 01 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 41207-01
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C25
In-Person Only

FINANCIAL ANALYTICS (41210) - [XIU, DACHENG>>](#)

CONTENT

Financial Analytics is an in-depth course designed to explore the analysis, exploration, and simplification of large and complex datasets. This course arms students with the essential skills to model and derive insights from data, enabling the development of robust predictive and classification models. The curriculum encompasses core concepts and methodologies, such as hypothesis testing, confidence intervals, linear and logistic regression, model selection, multinomial and binary regression, clustering, factor models, and decision trees. A strong emphasis is placed on practical computational skills and the fundamental principles underpinning these methods. Students will actively engage with actual financial datasets, applying their knowledge to develop tailored methodologies for specific applications.

PREREQUISITES

Prerequisites for this course include prior exposure to basic statistics, linear algebra, and proficiency in Python coding.

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41210-01
09/08, 09/10, 09/12, 09/15,
09/17, 09/19, 09/22, 09/24,
09/26
MWF 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Gleacher Center
206
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 41210-02
09/08, 09/10, 09/12, 09/15,
09/17, 09/19, 09/22, 09/24,
09/26
MWF 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
206

No non-Booth Students

In-Person Only

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

DATA INTELLIGENCE (41215) - [ROCKOVA, VERONIKA>>](#)

CONTENT

This course sits at the intersection of **Data Science** and **Artificial Intelligence**.

Its primary objectives are to:

- become fluent in the language of “data science and AI”,
- learn how to effectively communicate uncertainty,
- cultivate the ability to craft compelling narratives grounded in data,
- introduce students to data analytics for informed decision-making in uncertain environments,
- develop skills in analyzing and exploring large datasets,
- build and interpret (predictive) models with confidence.

Designed for students preparing for careers in data-driven environments, the course emphasizes practical concepts and tools commonly used by data scientists in business contexts. Rather than focusing on coding, the course prioritizes data storytelling—the ability to interpret, analyze, and communicate insights from data.

Each lecture features the analysis of two to three real-world datasets, demonstrated live in class. Examples include consumer database mining, internet and social media tracking, asset pricing, network analysis, sports analytics, and text mining.

The curriculum spans topics from classical statistics (e.g. hypothesis-driven decisions), data science (dimensionality reduction) to modern machine learning techniques (e.g deep learning). It also explores cutting-edge advancements in generative AI. The course puts a particular emphasis on the analysis of text data in the context of both small and Large Language Models (LLM) that form a basis of popular text-generating systems. Techniques covered include large-scale testing and false discovery rates, modern regression and model choice, machine-learning based classification, network analysis, language and topic models, principal components, clustering, Bayesian analysis, deep learning, transformers and attention.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41215-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 41215-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

By the end of the course, students will be equipped to perform machine-supported intelligent data analysis and communicate findings effectively.

PREREQUISITES

OPTIONAL PREREQUISITES

Students might benefit most from this course if they have had prior exposure to basic concepts in probability, such as random variables and normal distributions. That said, these foundational topics are reviewed/introduced during the course, so students without a formal background in statistics can still succeed—though they may experience a steeper learning curve early on.

This course might appeal to students who have already taken Business Statistics (BUS 41000) or Applied Regression (BUS 41100). Another possibly useful prerequisite is Data Analysis with R and Python (BUS 32100) and Artificial Intelligence (BUS 32200).

Cannot enroll in BUSN 41215 if 41201 taken previously.

This course is designed for those with a strong interest in hands-on data analysis using real-world datasets, rather than purely abstract conversations.

POSSIBLE POSTREQUISITES

This course includes the key concepts and tools that data scientists find valuable in business environments, and it is also designed to act as a primer for continued study.

The course may be a useful prerequisite into deep-dive courses and/or field-specific variants such as Machine Learning in Finance (BUS 35137), Machine Learning (BUS 41204), Generative Thinking (BUS 32210), Data Science for Marketing Decision Making (BUS 37105), Data-driven Marketing (BUS 37103), Causal Inference in Business Applications (BUS 41207).

GRADES

Grades will be determined by homework (20%), a take-home midterm exam (45%), and a final project (35%). Late assignments, exams, or projects, will not be accepted.

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 18 2025

ECONOMETRICS AND STATISTICS COLLOQUIUM (41600) - **DEB, NABARUN>> ; **SMETANINA, EKATERINA (KATJA)>>****

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. BUSN 41600=ECON 51400.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41600-60
TH 1:20 PM-2:30 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

ECONOMETRICS AND STATISTICS COLLOQUIUM (41600) - HANSEN, CHRISTIAN>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. No non-Booth students BUSN 41600=ECON 51400.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 41600-60
TH 1:20 PM-2:30 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

ECONOMETRICS AND STATISTICS COLLOQUIUM (41600) - KANKANALA, SID>> ; LI, SHUANGNING>>

CONTENT

Workshops in each academic area provide a forum for faculty, PhD students, and invited guests to present, discuss, and debate new research.

PREREQUISITES

PhD students only. Instructor permission required for MBA students. No non-Booth students BUSN 41600=ECON 51400.

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 41600-60
TH 1:20 PM-2:30 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PROBABILITY AND STATISTICS (41901) - KAJI, TETSUYA>>

CONTENT

This is a PhD course that introduces fundamental statistical concepts for academic research in business and economics. The topics include linear regression, maximum likelihood, logistic regression, randomized controlled experiments, propensity score matching, instrumental variables regression, regression discontinuity designs, difference-in-differences, and fixed effects regression.

PREREQUISITES

Undergraduate-level real analysis, linear algebra, and statistics (or econometrics). BUSN 41901=STAT 32400

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41901-50
F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

MATERIALS

There are no required textbooks.

GRADES

Grades are based on the midterm exam and the final exam.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: September 02 2025

STATISTICAL INFERENCE (41902) - [XIU, DACHENG>>](#)

CONTENT

This Ph.D.-level course is the second in a two-quarter sequence with Business 41901. The central topic is statistical inference using asymptotic approximations. We will cover linear regression models, generalized method of moments, time series. Time permitting; we will discuss factor models.

PREREQUISITES

Business 41901

MATERIALS

Three recommended texts are *Econometrics* by Hayashi, *Econometric Analysis of Cross Section and Panel Data* by Wooldridge, and *Time Series Analysis* by Hamilton. *Asymptotic Theory for Econometricians* (Revised Edition) by White provides a useful and concise reference on asymptotic results.

GRADES

Based on homework assignments and an in-class final exam. Cannot be taken pass/fail. No provisional grades.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 41902-50
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

APPLIED ECONOMETRICS (41903) - [HANSEN, CHRISTIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

In this Ph.D.-level course, we will discuss statistical methodology with a focus on methods used for causal inference. The course will review basic models commonly used in social science research (the linear regression model and linear IV model) and cover additional topics such as estimation of treatment effects when effects may be heterogeneous, workhorse panel data models, estimation using flexible/high-dimensional methods, and group-based inference for dependent data. It is assumed that students have a good understanding of linear regression and methods of performing classical inference using asymptotic approximations for linear and nonlinear models.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 41903-50
TTH 3:30 PM-5:00 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Business 41901 and 41902.

MATERIALS

Canvas. There is no required text for this course. Some recommended texts are *Econometrics* by Hayashi, *Econometric Analysis of Cross Section and Panel Data* by Wooldridge, *Mostly Harmless Econometrics* by Angrist and Pischke, *Causal Inference for Statistics, Social, and Biomedical Sciences: An Introduction* by Imbens and Rubin, and *An Introduction to Statistical Learning* by James, Witten, Hastie, and Tibshirani.

GRADES

Based on a project, final, and problem sets.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

TIME-SERIES ANALYSIS FOR FORECASTING AND MODEL BUILDING (41910) - RUSSELL, JEFFREY>>

CONTENT

Forecasting plays an important role in business planning and decision-making. This Ph.D.-level course discusses time series models that have been widely used in business and economic data analysis and forecasting. Both theory and methods of the models are discussed. Real examples are used throughout the course to illustrate applications.

The topics covered include: (1) stationary and unit-root non-stationary processes; (2) linear dynamic models, including Autoregressive Moving Average models; (3) model building and data analysis; (4) prediction and forecasting evaluation; (5) asymptotic theory for estimation including unit-root theory; (6) models for time varying volatility; (7) models for time varying correlation including Dynamic Conditional Correlation and time varying factor models.; (9) state-space models and Kalman filter; and (10) models for high frequency data.

PREREQUISITES

Business 41901 or instructor consent. BUSN 41910=STAT 33500

MATERIALS

Software: Eviews will be introduced to perform data analysis, but students can use other software.

GRADES

Homework assignments (15%), mid-term (35%), and final exam (50%). No provisional grades.

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 41910-50
F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

BAYES, AI AND DEEP LEARNING (41916) - POLSON, NICHOLAS>>

CONTENT

This course focuses on the applications of data analytic, machine learning and deep learning methods. We will start with a quick review of basic Bayesian models followed by tools and concepts from artificial intelligence. Students will learn how to use deep learning to analyze a variety of complex real world problems. Numerous empirical examples from finance, internet analytics, and sports are used to illustrate the material covered. Google's development of

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 41916-50
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C04

deep neural networks and applications will be discussed in detail.

In-Person Only

Emphasis will be placed on understanding concepts of Bayes, AI and Deep Learning. The three main topics covered are: (i) Bayesian methods including conditional probability, hierarchical models (ii) Artificial Intelligence including modern regression methods such as lasso and ridge regression. Dimensionality reduction techniques and sparsity are central to data analysis (ii) Deep Learning including Neural Nets, Architecture design, Stochastic Gradient Descent, speeding up convergence. Throughout business and internet applications including machine intelligence, reinforcement learning, image and speech recognition will be used to illustrate the wide range of applications.

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

CONTEMPORARY BAYESIAN INFERENCE (41919) - ROCKOVA, VERONIKA>>

CONTENT

This is a course on advanced Bayesian inference in the context of contemporary data applications.

It is designed to equip students with both deep theoretical foundations as well as practical tools for modern Bayesian analysis.

Its primary objectives are to:

- Build intuition and confidence in using priors with emphasis on prior calibration,
- Gain a solid understanding of the core principles underlying Bayesian decision theory,
- Explore the theoretical foundations connecting frequentist and Bayesian perspectives,
- Engage with, and develop mastery of, Bayesian nonparametric theory and methods,
- Learn to implement modern (generative) posterior inference techniques,
- Build proficiency in analyzing and interpreting large-scale datasets using Bayesian methods.

This course captures the essence of being Bayesian in the 21st century, tracing the evolution of Bayesian thought from its theoretical foundations to modern developments such as generative Bayes. The goal of this course is not to dwell on dry proofs written on a board, but to cultivate intuition and a deep appreciation for the Bayesian approach to thinking and decision making. It blends theory, methodology, computation and hands-on practice. Embracing the Bayesian perspective often demands thoughtful, and sometimes uncompromising, choices of priors and likelihoods.

Throughout the course, we will explore key principles that underpin or alleviate such choices towards meaningful and theoretically sound Bayesian data analysis.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 41919-50
F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

Lectures will emphasize methodology, computation and theory but will also feature several real datasets. The goal is not to provide a compendium of techniques but rather to create links between various approaches and to explore their applicability in real life.

The curriculum begins with traditional (parametric) Bayesian statistics and progressively advances through nonparametric priors, likelihood-free inference, and prediction-driven inference, culminating in some of the most cutting-edge research-driven creative developments in Bayes.

Topics include Bayesian decision theory, Bayesian sparsity, Bayesian machine learning and nonparametrics, likelihood-free inference, generative Bayesian models, or variational and predictive inference.

By the end of the course, students will be able to confidently apply Bayesian tools in realworld settings and will have developed the theoretical and methodological foundation necessary to pursue both applied and methods-oriented research.

PREREQUISITES

Open to PhD students only: strict. BUSN 41919=STAT 32419

RESTRICTIONS

PhD - students only

NO SYLLABUS AVAILABLE

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 22 2026

COMPETITIVE STRATEGY (42001) - ALMAGRO, MILENA>>

CONTENT

The course applies microeconomics—mainly the economics of industrial organization—to analyze decisions managers face in business environments. It focuses on strategic decisions that drive profits.

The class is interactive. Roughly one-half of each class is devoted to lecture, with the remaining time devoted to case discussion. Time permitting, we will dedicate one week of the term to host a guest speaker.

The first half of the course takes a price theory approach to managerial decision-making. The actions of rivals are mostly assumed fixed, so we can isolate key tradeoffs that they face. The second half takes a game theory approach, in which managers' actions directly affect their rivals' payoffs, and vice versa.

Topics include *pricing, positioning, patterns and determinants of cross-industry and within-industry profitability, entry and exit, commitment, cooperation, deterrence, network effects, and multisided platforms.*

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 42001-03
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C04
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 42001-04
T 5:00 PM-8:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Section 03 is MiM and MiF Only. Bus 33001 or equivalent is highly recommended. In short, the course requires an understanding of microeconomics; otherwise, you will not learn as much and struggle with the material.

One cannot enroll in BUSN 42001 if BUSN 20900 was taken previously.

MATERIALS

Required: Harvard Business Publishing cases, news articles, and academic research.

Example cases from the first half of course: "Moneyball," "The Cola Wars," "Walmart," "Aldi"

Example cases from the second half: "The Future of Ridesourcing: Uber and Lyft," "Dropbox: It Just Works," "Power Play (Nintendo)," "Ryanair: Dogfight over Europe", "American Airlines"

Optional but very strongly recommended textbooks:

1. Luís Cabral, *Introduction to Industrial Organization*, MIT Press. Either edition is fine.
2. Besanko, D., Dranove D., Shanley, M., Schaefer S., *Economics of Strategy*, Wiley, 7th edition.

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Grading will be based on class participation and case discussion (35%), the in-class midterm (25%) and the in-class exam (40%). Note that I may adjust these amounts up to five percentage points in either direction based on how aspects of the course play out.

Auditors are allowed with prior approval over email.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 24 2025

COMPETITIVE STRATEGY (42001) - [FITZGERALD, KATHLEEN>>](#)

CONTENT

The course applies microeconomics (including elements of price theory, game theory, and industrial organization) to analyze decisions firms face in business environments. There will be specific focus on strategic decisions and the factors that influence firms' competitive advantages. Class time will be devoted to lectures and case discussions. Topics covered include sources of competitive advantage, scope of the firm, efficient performance, pricing, entry and exit, vertical structure, and network externalities.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001. Cannot enroll in BUSN 42001 if BUSN 20900 taken previously.

MATERIALS

A selection of readings will be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Based on class participation, assignments, a final, and possibly a midterm. No auditors. No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 06 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 42001-03
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 42001-04
TH 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 42001-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

COMPETITIVE STRATEGY (42001) - [HUMLUM, ANDERS>>](#)

CONTENT

This course applies microeconomics, particularly the economics of industrial organization, to analyze decisions managers face in business environments. We focus on strategic decisions that impact profitability.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 42001-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C08

In the first half, we take a price-theory approach, assuming rivals' actions are fixed to isolate key tradeoffs that managers face. The second half uses a game-theory approach, where managers' actions directly affect their rivals' payoffs, and vice versa.

Topics include pricing, positioning, industry profitability, entry and exit, boundaries of the firm, commitment, cooperation, deterrence, network effects, and multisided platforms.

PREREQUISITES

Bus 33001 or equivalent is highly recommended. In short, the course requires an understanding of microeconomics; otherwise, you will not learn as much and struggle with the material.

One cannot enroll in BUSN 42001 if BUSN 20900 was taken previously.

MATERIALS

Required: Harvard Business Publishing cases, news articles, and academic research.

Example cases from the first half of course: "Moneyball," "The Cola Wars," "Airborne Express."

Example cases from the second half: "The Future of Ridesourcing: Uber and Lyft," "Dropbox: It Just Works," "Power Play (Nintendo)," "LinkedIn," "Ryanair: Dogfight over Europe."

Optional but strongly recommended textbooks:

- Cabral, Luís. *Introduction to Industrial Organization*, MIT Press, 2nd edition, 2017
- Besanko, D., Dranove D., Shanley, M., Schaefer S., *Economics of Strategy*, Wiley, 7th edition.

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Grading will be based on weekly memos (5%), class participation and case discussion (30%), an in-class midterm (25%), and an in-class final exam (40%). I reserve the right to adjust these components by +/- 5% based on the course progression.

No auditors are allowed.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors Mandatory attendance week 1 No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 42001-02
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C08
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 42001-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

COMPETITIVE STRATEGY (42001) - [LESHNO, JACOB>>](#)

CONTENT

The course applies tools from microeconomics and game theory to the analysis of strategic decision making by firms. Specific topics covered include the sources of industry and firm profitability, strategic positioning, sustainable competitive advantage, the boundaries of the firm, incomplete contracts, strategic commitment, dynamic pricing, entry and exit, network effects, and platform markets. My goal for the class to give students a set of economic tools, and develop a rigorous evaluation of firm strategy.

The course is designed for students who are proficient with microeconomics at the level of 33001. Classes will combine case analysis, discussion, and lecture.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001. Cannot enroll in BUSN 42001 if BUSN 20900 taken previously.

MATERIALS

Articles and case materials will be distributed via the course website. There are two required books. There will be additional optional readings posted each week to the course website.

GRADES

Based on class participation, assignments, a mid-term, and a final. Cannot be taken pass/fail. Mandatory participation.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 11 2026

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 42001-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 42001-02
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

COMPETITIVE STRATEGY (42001) - [SHIVAKUMAR, RAM>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026

The focal point of this course is you, the strategist. The objective is to enhance your abilities as a strategist along three dimensions: (1) Diagnosis: recognizing the obstacles and challenges that you face as well as your best opportunities (2) Transformation: developing a playbook for initiating and managing change (3) Persuasion: winning hearts and minds on the merits of your ideas.

The class meetings will engage you in case analyses, discussions, expert opinions, (my) lectures, and (your) strategy presentations. The course will expose you to the challenge of crafting and executing strategy in a wide variety of business circumstances including crises, transformations, disruptions, and hyper-growth.

PREREQUISITES

Business 33001: strict. Cannot enroll in BUSN 42001 if BUSN 20900 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Required reading includes cases and a text book.

GRADES

Course grades are based on case write-ups (groups), problem sets, a final exam, and a company report (groups). Cannot be taken pass/fail.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: May 18 2026

COMPETITIVE STRATEGY (42001) - WOLLMANN, THOMAS

CONTENT

The course applies microeconomics—mainly the economics of industrial organization—to analyze decisions managers face in business environments. It focuses on strategic decisions that drive profits.

The class is interactive. Roughly one-third to one-half of each class is devoted to lecture, with the remaining (majority of) time devoted to case discussion.

The first half of the course takes a price theory approach to managerial

Section: 42001-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
In-Person Only

Summer 2026
Section: 42001-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 42001-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

decision-making. The actions of rivals are mostly assumed fixed, so we can isolate key tradeoffs that they face. The second half takes a game theory approach, in which managers' actions directly affect their rivals' payoffs, and vice versa.

Topics include *pricing, positioning, patterns and determinants of cross-industry and within-industry profitability, entry and exit, vertical integration and boundaries of the firm (i.e., the "make or buy" decision), commitment, cooperation, deterrence, network effects, and multisided platforms.*

PREREQUISITES

Bus 33001 or equivalent is highly recommended. In short, the course requires an understanding of microeconomics; otherwise, you will not learn as much and struggle with the material.

One cannot enroll in BUSN 42001 if BUSN 20900 was taken previously.

MATERIALS

Required: Harvard Business Publishing cases, news articles, and academic research.

Example cases from the first half of course: "Moneyball," "The Cola Wars," "Airborne Express."

Example cases from the second half: "The Future of Ridesourcing: Uber and Lyft," "Dropbox: It Just Works," "Power Play (Nintendo)," "LinkedIn," "Ryanair: Dogfight over Europe."

Optional but very strongly recommended textbook: Luís Cabral, *Introduction to Industrial Organization*, MIT Press. Either edition is fine.

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Grading will be based on class participation and case discussion (30%), the in-class midterm (25%), the in-class final exam (40%), and completion of case memorandum (5%). Note that I may adjust these amounts up to three percentage points in either direction based on how aspects of the course play out.

No auditors are allowed.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Autumn 2025
Section: 42001-02
F 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 42001-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

LITERATURE AND LEADERSHIP (42005) - BARRY, BRIAN>>

CONTENT

Using timeless stories and characters as case studies can illuminate leadership challenges in powerful ways. Great stories offer characters with memorable traits and leadership styles, without losing sight of each character's complexity. And the settings in those stories provide us with rich contexts that allow us to explore environments and issues in our own society.

We can broaden our view of such issues by using stories from other times and places, thereby considering them in other contexts and looking for universal themes. These settings allow us to consider how leaders' world views shape the ways in which they frame and respond to their societies' challenges.

In this course, we especially examine an important overarching aspect of leadership, by considering leaders as *architects, or shapers, of environments in which other people must live, work or pursue their goals.*

We will apply this approach to a range of readings in which the characters are not just potential leadership *models* but can also be people *who are affected* by the ways in which others lead. This approach encourages us to explore different aspects of society by taking the perspective of many different actors in those settings, while respecting the context in which each is operating.

This allows MBA students to consider how different approaches relate to some of the values or virtues that they often aspire to incorporate into their own leadership styles, such as: leading with integrity, with courage, or with empathy for those affected by one's approach to leadership; dealing with doubt; thinking and communicating clearly while considering multiple perspectives; and combining hard skills with softer or more ambiguous considerations. *This approach enables students to inquire deeply, in discussion with each other, into how to lead with these considerations in mind in a society with multiple value-systems, interests and perspectives.*

Besides providing valuable perspectives that we can apply to our own environments, the stories that we read and discuss will present us with memorable characters, who have varied traits and bring distinct approaches to the challenges they face. We can use these characters to explore different ways in which leaders bring their individuality to bear on problems.

By considering these nuanced characters in context, we will also attempt to understand their virtues and flaws in richer and deeper ways than typical business case studies and modern media accounts allow for. Leadership problems, and those who take them on, are often multifaceted, and this complexity is not easily captured by modern media caricatures of business heroes and villains.

Among other themes, there will be a special emphasis on ways in which the social environment that businesses operate in can distort communication. We will use these readings to explore leadership strategies for delivering and interpreting messages in the modern social environment, and will examine the role of rhetoric, principles and thoughtful communication in dealing with it.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 42005-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Students must attend the section in which they are enrolled: strict.

No pass/fail grades.

No Auditors: strict.

Complete 4 Booth MBA courses before taking 42005: recommended.

Current Booth MBA students only: strict.

Cannot enroll in 42005 if 42003 and/or 42004 taken previously: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Some of the readings will be available through Canvas.

Some works of fiction will be purchased by students.

GRADES

Grades will be based on short written assignments and class discussion. Some class discussions will involve small breakout groups

Students must attend the section in which they are enrolled: strict.

No pass/fail grades.

No Auditors: strict. Booth MBA students only: strict.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 02 2026

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE (42108) - [CHOOKASZIAN, DENNIS>>](#)

CONTENT

The course will introduce students to the functions and duties of directors and boards, and to the topics boards in the United States most commonly face.

The content will be applicable to both public and private corporations and not for profit organizations. The differences in corporate governance in other countries, as well as current trends in corporate governance, will be discussed.

The topics covered include the role of Directors and the Board in:

- Board Development
- Board Member Selection & Evaluation
- Board Responsibilities & Legal and Compliance Duties
- Sarbanes Oxley
- Fiduciary Integrity
- CEO Selection, Evaluation, and Succession Planning
- Compensation Practices
- Corporate Strategy
- Shareholder Communications
- Crisis, Bankruptcy, and Dissidents
- Private Firms and Not For Profit Organizations
- International Governance
- Global Trends

Format

The course utilizes the case method and practical examples of real situations are discussed each week. For students to benefit from the course, they must prepare thoroughly for, and actively participate in each class. Students will be part of a 5 person group in the course. Each group will prepare a 2 page weekly paper on the case being discussed starting in week 2. Each group will also research and prepare one paper and a presentation on international governance in a specific country. Each group will present their presentation to the class. There will be no exams.

MATERIALS

A selection of readings and cases which will be posted in Canvas.

GRADES

Class participation and contribution will be an important part of the grade and each student has the responsibility of making a contribution in each class. Students will be asked to respond to governance related questions orally and

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 42108-01
F 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 42108-81
F 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
200
In-Person Only

via email with their opinion on the appropriate solution to issues. Students will organize study groups of five and their grade will be a group grade for the weekly papers and the international project. The group grades will be adjusted to reflect individual contribution of the team members at the end of the course.

The weighting of the three factors is as follows.

- Individual Class Participation - 25%
- Group Weekly Papers - 50%
- Group International Project - 25%

The course cannot be taken pass/fail.

Auditors will not be admitted to class.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 11 2025

GAME THEORY (42116) - [KAMENICA, EMIR>>](#)

CONTENT

In terminology of economics a *game* is any situation where the best course of actions depends on what others will do. Under this definition, most business environments are games. Game theory is a framework for analyzing games. The course will focus on two questions: (i) how to *design* games (i.e., how to structure the business environment), and (ii) how to *play* games (i.e., how to predict what others will do and respond appropriately).

PREREQUISITES

Non-Booth students require instructor consent: strict No auditors.

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 42116-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C06
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 42116-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
404
In-Person Only

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 13 2025

MERGER & ACQUISITION STRATEGY (42121) - [MORRISSETTE, STEPHEN>>](#)

CONTENT

This course provides an overview of mergers and acquisitions with a focus on the role MA plays in the development and implementation of a firm's strategy. Students will develop an analytical and theoretical framework to understand the MA process and will also use cases and real-world applications to develop skills necessary to prepare and evaluate the strategic rationale for a proposed transaction. This course uses a strategic corporate development perspective rather than an investment banking/transaction perspective. Topics include strategic rationale for MA transactions, value creation and destruction in MA, the MA process, interplay between strategy and valuation, and implementation/integration issues. The student will apply course learnings in a cumulative project typically by preparing a M&A Plan including the rationale for a proposed acquisition target.

Students should note that this is a strategy course, not a finance course.

PREREQUISITES

None. Students would benefit from completing 42001 Competitive Strategy and 35201 Cases in Financial Management.

MATERIALS

The course is taught using lectures, case analysis, readings and guest speakers. This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Student assessment based on class participation, case write-ups, a midterm case and a final group project preparing and presenting a business case for a proposed transaction.

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 12 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 42121-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
200
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 42121-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
200
In-Person Only

STORYTELLING AND NARRATIVES IN BUSINESS (42124) - [ROLNIK, GUY>>](#)

CONTENT

This course aims to help students excel in one of the business world's most important competencies: the ability to construct and to deliver a powerful, influential narrative.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 42124-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM

What differentiates those who are more successful interacting with bosses and colleagues inside an organization? How do managers create trust and change the attitudes and behaviors of their teams? What differentiates the entrepreneurs who succeed in raising money from those who fail? Why are some companies more successful in attracting and retaining both employees and customers? How do companies that are yet to turn a profit command the value of billions of dollars? What is the basis for effective lobbying and rule-shaping?

Whether advancing in your career, leading organizations, motivating people, creating strong brands, building and sustaining reputations, or working effectively with politicians, regulators, and the media – successful managers, entrepreneurs, and companies share a few common, potent skills: they appreciate the importance of stories, they develop and maintain coherent strategic narratives – and they know how to tell them.

In this course we will study the critical role of stories in driving success in many real-life situations. We will gain an understanding of how our reality is comprised of stories, we will establish a critical perspective on stories in the arenas of business, economics and politics, and we will study the characteristics of successful stories and storytellers. **All the while, we will practice and hone the telling of our own powerful, personal stories.**

Who should take this course?

MBA students who aspire to lead larger teams, earn promotions, and step into senior roles where influence matters as much as analysis. In 2026, technical competence is assumed. Analytical rigor is table stakes. What differentiates rising leaders is their ability to align people around direction and purpose. As responsibility expands, success depends less on having the right answer and more on persuading others to act on it.

This course is especially suited for:

- Students who aspire to become general managers or CEOs and will be responsible for shaping organizational direction and public perception
- Founders who must raise capital, recruit top talent, and sustain belief in a vision through uncertainty and setbacks
- Consultants and strategists who need to reframe complex problems and persuade clients to commit to difficult strategic decisions
- Professionals entering highly regulated or politically visible industries where narrative control influences valuation and legitimacy
- Managers seeking promotion who must demonstrate strategic clarity, executive presence, and the ability to influence senior stakeholders
- Technically strong students in finance, engineering, analytics, or operations who want to strengthen their influence and leadership impact
- Anyone who expects to lead through crisis, organizational change, or rapid technological disruption and needs tools to build alignment under pressure

Crucially, the course emphasizes storytelling as an executive capability - not simply the crafting of a corporate brand message. Corporate narratives can be delegated to marketing departments. Executive storytelling cannot. In moments of ambiguity or crisis, stakeholders look to leaders, not logos, for clarity. The way an executive explains change, articulates risk, frames opportunity, or defines failure often determines whether an organization gains alignment or fractures.

Harper Center

C09

In-Person Only

Spring 2026

Section: 42124-81

TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM

Gleacher Center

304

In-Person Only

Spring 2026

Section: 42124-85

S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM

Gleacher Center

304

In-Person Only

For MBA students scanning the 2026 course catalogue, the question is not whether storytelling is useful, but whether it is central to leadership. In an era defined by competing interpretations of reality -across markets, media, and internal organizations - leadership is as much about meaning as it is about metrics. Markets are contests over interpretation as much as over resources. Those who can construct and communicate powerful narratives will be better positioned to lead in uncertain, politically complex, and fast-moving environments.

This course will feature two guest lectures of leading figures from the industry. Students enrolled in this class will have the opportunity to learn and engage with guest lecturers who hold, or have held, prominent roles in large corporations where they effectively employed their unique storytelling skills.

Order of topics in class are subject to change, according to guest lecture.

MATERIALS

The syllabus, readings, cases, and all other information can be accessed via Canvas.

GRADES

Grades will be based on class participation, memorandums, and an individually submitted project. Provisional grading will be available for non-Booth and joint degree graduating students.

GRADING BREAKDOWN

This course demands a number of unique requirements – including a high level of open, active participation that entails sharing your story and emotions – that some students may find challenging. While taking this class is an opportunity to overcome those challenges, students unwilling to tell their story in class, sharing it in group meetings during the quarter and to receive open feedback from day one should feel free to drop out of the course. If you are unsure about whether this course is right for you, please reach out to the Head TA - nadiabelkind@uchicago.edu.

Participation – 50%

- Attendance during all nine sessions
- Participation - will be tracked in each class based on the quality of the response
- Responding to cold calling to share your story in class
- Sharing your story in one of the scheduled sessions. Choose either a one-on-one meeting with a Storytelling expert or join a group office hour led by Prof. Rolnik, which accommodates up to 5 students per session
- Participating in two internal 90-minute feedback sessions in groups of 4 students where each member will share their story
- Submitting two questions to guest speakers before class

Memos and story submissions – 25%

- First story draft due before the 1st class ~ 500 words (P/F)

- Midterm submission due before week 6 ~ 500-700 words, and a 5-minute video recording, including the “Arc Canvas” with the story components (P/F; receive feedback on the written version)
- Submitting five memos on stories and case studies (P/F)
- Submitting two progress reports with insights from the internal group session (P/F)

Final Project submitted individually – 25%

- Final written version of your personal business story ~ 500-700 words
- 5-minute video recording of your story
- Your story charted across the “Arc Canvas” template

Due: Saturday, May 23, 2026 (final letter grade)

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 23 2026

ARTS LEADERSHIP: EXEMPLARY IS NOT ENOUGH (42126, 50 UNIT COURSE) - ITTELSON, MARY>>

CONTENT

From museums to concert halls to theaters, successful strategies of the past are no longer sufficient. Even before health, political, and social crises of recent years, arts leaders were grappling with how to succeed amidst seismic external shifts (demographic, economic, technological) and changes in the very nature of art-making, art-sharing, and art appreciation. At the same time, many institutions were already burdened by unsustainable financial structures, outmoded managerial practices and the responsibility to serve larger, more demanding, and diverse audiences. As the essential link between artist and audience, organizations have had to adapt rapidly and emphatically in order to thrive, an imperative that has now become a matter of survival. In this class, we examine best current practices in the not-for profit arts sector and consider the kinds of radical approaches that might be necessary for the future.

Taking the perspective of the CEO, Chairman of the Board, and Artistic Director, students will learn about advancing artistic excellence and creative innovation while expanding audiences and achieving financial goals. We will survey settings in the not-for-profit performing and visual arts. Among the topics explored will be governance and management, serving multiple stakeholders,

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 42126-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
219 - Meeting Room
2nd Half: Week 5 - Week 9
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

managing fiscal and creative tradeoffs, standing out in real and virtual spaces, achieving growth amidst rising costs and diminishing revenues, and adapting to rapidly evolving cultural ecosystems. Students will develop their own perspectives on the ways in which commerce, creativity, and culture can align and collide in the leadership of arts organizations. Students will have the opportunity to grapple real-time with the unprecedented challenges facing arts leaders today.

PREREQUISITES

No College students. Non-Booth Masters and PhD allowed with instructor consent. 1st class attendance is mandatory. Auditors require instructor permission.

GRADES

Classwork, Homework, and Grading: Classes will include discussions, group and individual exercises, and guest speakers. Homework will consist of readings, case studies, three short essay and one final paper. Grades will be based on class participation and essays (50%) and an 8-10 page final paper (50%). Advance homework is required for the first class session. Auditors require instructor permission.

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 19 2025

THE POLITICAL ECONOMY OF CLIMATE CHANGE (42129) - [WHEAT, CHRIS>>](#)

CONTENT

The last several years have seen an accelerated focus on climate change, whether in the halls of government, the boardrooms of corporations, or the daily lives of individuals. These discussions not only aim to seek solutions to limit warming to levels necessary to mitigate the most disastrous effects, but also to explore how societies and governments balance the immediacy and magnitude of the issue against other needs and goals. Historically, these fights have been viewed as environmentalists versus energy producers. But today's world is far more complex, with a growing and diverse stakeholder community attempting to exert influence on these discussions, each with competing interests, priorities, and perspectives.

These debates are more complex than determining the feasibility and efficiency of a particular solution in lowering emissions. What are the costs, and who pays for them? What externalities are created by these solutions, and

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 42129-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

how are they distributed? And what happens to the industries and people impacted by the current fossil fuel economy, for better or worse? How individuals, firms, markets, and the government come together or grow apart in answering these questions requires an examination through both traditional Business School tools and the sausage-making of politics, involving the various parties with a stake in the game.

This course will attempt to address some of these issues. However, this course will not focus on the firm's perspective, which is the customary starting point for most Business School courses. Instead, the course will focus on various governmental entities, commonly referred to as "the state." The firm represents one of the actors that influences and is influenced by the State. However, we will also consider other stakeholders, including policymakers, politicians, financiers, lobbyists, workers, communities, and advocates. As politics is an exercise in coalition building, how these actors work with or against each other is critical to understanding the potential solution set while also considering the disproportionate way climate change impacts particular communities and people. To that end, the interests of a traditional profit-maximizing firm may conflict with those of others.

As many students will soon be entering firms, it will be essential to align the fundamentals of how a firm's agenda aligns and conflicts with the needs and goals of various stakeholders who also have a voice. The course aims to support students in this endeavor in the field of climate and energy, but the skills learned apply to any regulated industry.

PREREQUISITES

Basic principles of Competitive Strategy, Microeconomics, and Corporate Finance are assumed to be understood.

GRADES

Grades will be based on weekly writing assignments, class participation (including potential cold calling), and a final paper. Group participation will be a component of assignments. Students will not be successful in the course without robust and respectful engagement with other classmates.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 12 2025

STRATEGY AND DIGITAL DISRUPTION (42132, 50 UNIT COURSE) - **MANG, PAUL>>**

CONTENT

- Autumn 2025
- 50-unit: second half of the quarter
- Gleacher Center: Tuesday evenings, 6-9pm, Room 306

This course focuses on the dynamics of digital disruption. Innovation and new business models have always transformed industries; Schumpeter observed “the perennial gale of creative destruction” as a normal part of markets almost a century ago. Today, digital disruptions—driven by modern telecommunications, cloud computing, AI/ML, virtual reality, and other technologies—are major factors influencing how industries are evolving. In fact, advances in agentic AI are potentially impacting the very nature of work and almost all organizations in profound ways. We will examine these disruptions primarily from the perspective of the leadership teams of established incumbents, as well as high-growth enterprises. We will discuss how leaders can best address the following key questions:

1. How do we assess and respond to a potential disruption in our industry?
2. If we want to strategically innovate in our business, how can we embark on such a journey *and* get it done?
3. How can we create the conditions for disciplined innovation in our organization?

Each of these questions can be peeled back to reveal a complex set of decisions, actions, and implications.

This class will involve a combination of case discussions and lectures, with a final exam. This course will appeal to students who intend to:

- lead teams and organizations, in the context of digital disruption,
- advise firms on adapting to change, as management consultants, or
- drive investment decision processes within private equity or other funds.

PREREQUISITES

BUS 39001 or BUS 42001. All Non-Booth students require instructor permission. Contact instructor for prerequisite waiver.

GRADES

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 42132-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
306
2nd Half: Week 5 - Week 9
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 30 2025

MEDIA POWER: HOW MEDIA INFLUENCES BUSINESS, MARKETS AND REGULATIONS (42133) - ROLNIK, GUY>>

CONTENT

****Students can refer to bid point history and course evaluations under course number 42123/Reputation, Regulation and Communications - How Media Influences Business****

This course equips MBA students with the analytical and strategic tools needed to understand how media systems operate and how they shape business, political, and social realities. Media has never been a neutral mirror of the world; it has always constructed it, defining what we see, believe, and value in private and public life. The media does not merely report events; it sets agendas, frames narratives, and determines which issues, companies, and leaders are perceived as legitimate, successful, or controversial. It influences investor confidence, consumer trust, regulatory priorities, and the boundaries of markets.

Today, that power operates within a dense and rapidly evolving ecosystem. Traditional news organizations still continue to shape policy discourse, corporate reputation, and market sentiment, while digital platforms, social media and, increasingly, large language models and AI-driven tools filter and amplify information with extraordinary precision and reach. Together, these forces create a hybrid information environment in which journalism, news, and technology are inseparable. For business leaders, understanding this ecosystem is not a soft skill but a strategic necessity. Success increasingly depends on the ability to anticipate how narratives emerge and how crises are mediated. Developing the capacity to critically interpret, engage with, and ethically shape these media dynamics is therefore as vital to leadership as mastering marketing, finance, or operations.

Through case studies, guest lectures, and real-world analysis, students will gain a deep understanding of how the media economy functions. They will examine the shifting business models of traditional news organizations and explore how economic pressures and technological disruption affect the role of the press in democratic market economies. The course will analyze how news coverage influences key decision-makers: legislators, regulators, CEOs, boards of directors, and investors. Students will learn how media narratives affect corporate reputation, valuations, and legitimacy, and how companies seek to influence, collaborate with, or challenge them.

Who Should Take This Course?

- Consultants and strategists who advise organizations operating in complex, high-visibility markets where perception, policy, and media

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 42133-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 42133-81
TH 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 42133-85
S 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

framing directly influence outcomes.

- Entrepreneurs and startup founders who need to understand how media narratives, platform dynamics, changing regulation and public sentiment affect valuations, investor confidence, brand legitimacy, and growth.
- Students pursuing roles in technology — who must anticipate how algorithms, AI systems, and online discourse shape regulation, competition, and reputation.
- Finance professionals and investors who need to evaluate not only financial fundamentals but also the regulatory, media, and cultural environments in which companies are embedded—factors that increasingly determine valuation, risk, and long-term performance.
- Future leaders in highly regulated sectors such as energy, healthcare, or financial services, where public opinion, policy agendas, and media narratives define both constraints and opportunities.
- Students who want to understand the world more deeply and become sophisticated, critical consumers of all forms of media—from traditional journalism to social platforms, algorithms, and AI-powered chatbots—developing the discernment essential to modern leadership.

PREREQUISITES

Students who have already taken "42123 - Reputation, Regulation and Communications – How Media Influences Business" OR "42705 - Reputation, Regulation and Communications – How Media Influences Business - Lab" cannot register for this course: strict. Auditors require instructor permission.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

The syllabus, readings, cases, and all other information can be accessed on the Canvas site.

GRADES

This course has a strict no laptops and no electronic devices policy during class.

Grades will be based on class participation, memorandums (pass/fail), and a group project.

Active Class Participation: 50%

Individual Memos & Questions for Guests: 25%

Group Project: 25%

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 17 2025

STRATEGY IN THE ERA OF AI AND TECHNOLOGICAL DISRUPTION (42134, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [SILBERG, GARY>>](#)

CONTENT

Guest Speakers:

Ted Cannis, Former CEO of Ford Motor Company's - Ford Pro and Customer Service Division

Don Burnette Founder & CEO, Kodiak Robotics

Pat Peri, Head of Hardware Systems, Waymo

Jim Adler, General Partner and Board Member, Toyota Venture Capital

Tom Kichler, Partner , CVC Capital Partners

COURSE DESCRIPTION:

This course uses the case study method to analyze business strategies in the face of market disruption and uncertainty, with a particular focus on the convergence of the automotive/transportation and technology industries—two, trillion-dollar sectors that innovate at vastly different paces, or “clockspeeds”.

Not since the first automotive revolution over a hundred years ago has there been such a stunning transformation in the industry. Every facet of transportation—from product development, to manufacturing, to supply chains and the customer experience—is undergoing profound changes, driven by the powerful convergence of the automotive and technology sectors. A tsunami of new investments – some half trillion dollars and climbing – has hit the industry from start-ups, established OEM's and suppliers and tech companies. Massive investments are being made in AI, software defined vehicles, electric propulsion systems, semiconductors, self-driving cars and trucks and mobility on demand services. The industry is creating a dazzling array of new vehicles – supercomputers on wheels – and over the next decade a new multi-trillion industry will emerge with new (and existing) players and new business models.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025

Section: 42134-01

T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM

Harper Center

C02

1st Half: Week 1 - Week 5

50 Unit Course

In-Person Only

New Course

So, how might all this play out? If history is any guide, we can expect a shakeout among market players, resulting in clear winners and losers. With billions of dollars at stake, this course offers students a strategic framework—*The Clockspeed Dilemma*—providing fresh ideas and approaches to not only survive but thrive during periods of market disruption

MATERIALS

This course draws upon a combination of assigned readings, lectures, case analyses, and in-person participation of senior industry executives. Readings are posted on Canvas, and the course schedule delineates which readings are due before the start of the week's lecture. Presentations used in class will be published on *Canvas* following the lecture, but students are encouraged to write down key insights from the executive speakers' presentations and intricacies of the case studies that may or may not be included in the slides.

GRADES

METHODS OF EVALUATION

Marks for the class will be assessed based on class participation, case study reports, and a final group project:

1. Class Participation (40%)

40% of the course grade will be based on class participation. Behavior demonstrating participation include, but are not limited to attendance, on-time arrival, and professional behavior during the class, asking insightful questions that further our discussion, sharing relevant professional experience, and a general demonstration of positive engagement.

2. Case Study Questions (10%)

Throughout the course, we will explore four case studies focusing on different aspects of competitive strategy during market disruption. These will include historical examples showcasing varying degrees of success from diverse positions within the industry. Additionally, you will have unique, intimate access to senior industry leaders who were directly involved in these cases, providing invaluable insights. The lessons drawn from these case studies will form the foundation of our learning. Students are encouraged to collaborate on the questions in groups of 2-4.

3. Final Group Project (50%)

Using AI, the group project involves creating an industry video (no longer than 5 minutes) that presents a strategic idea, investment strategy, or new business model. This project should incorporate the concepts and strategic frameworks discussed in class.

- Students will role-play as stakeholders within the industry, similar to the guest lecturers. They may choose to represent roles such as OEM or supplier executives, tech players, startup founders, or outside investors.
- Groups will have creative license to pitch a new investment idea, business venture, M&A opportunity, partnership, or disruptive startup thesis.
- Creativity in the video-making process is highly encouraged, including interviewing market experts, luminaries, potential customers, or investors, etc.

- Groups must defend their business thesis using market data, trends, and compelling economic data/arguments.

The AI videos will be showcased during the final week of the course, followed by a brief Q&A session with each group. Additional project details will be discussed in class, with a separate project proposal due by Week 3.

Your final grade will be calculated with the following weights on assignments:

Category	Weight on Final Grade
Class Participation	40%
Case Study Reports	10%
Final Group Project	50%

This course does not permit Pass/Fail grading, and students must earn a quality grade to be awarded credits.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: August 18 2025

PLATFORMS AND MARKET DESIGN (42135) - [BUDISH, ERIC>>](#)

CONTENT

Textbook markets are an abstraction. Real-world markets are explicitly *designed*. Many of the world's most exciting and innovative companies have designed marketplaces as a central part of their business: Amazon, Apple, Google, AirBNB, Uber. Much of finance takes place through designed markets: stock exchanges, futures markets, over-the-counter markets, blockchains. Even dating apps involve market design.

This class will cover the key economic principles behind market design and will challenge students to invent ways to make markets work better.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 42135-01
M 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

Spring 2026
Section: 42135-81
M 6:00 PM-9:00 PM

Some of the specific topics we will cover include auction design, matching markets, platform economics, financial markets, cryptocurrencies, and reputation systems.

The class will feature a mix of lectures and case studies.

Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Microeconomics is a prerequisite (33001, or equivalent background).
Competitive strategy (42001) is recommended.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 26 2026

SOCIAL IMPACT STRATEGY (42136) - [HACHIKIAN, CHRISTINA>>](#)

CONTENT

Course Description

Social and environmental challenges are no longer addressed only by governments or charities. Today, nonprofits, startups, corporations, investors, and public agencies often work side by side — and sometimes inside the same organizations — to tackle problems like housing, health, climate, education, and economic opportunity.

This course is about how those organizations actually work.

You'll learn how social sector organizations (including nonprofits and mission-driven businesses) design strategies, choose business models, raise and manage money, measure results, and make trade-offs between impact and financial sustainability. We'll focus on the practical tools leaders use to decide what to do, how to do it, and how to grow what works.

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 42136-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

Many of the basic management ideas you may already know — like marketing, operations, and competitive strategy — still apply. But managing for impact adds real complexity. Goals are harder to define, success is harder to measure, funding doesn't always come from customers, and stakeholders often have very different priorities. These differences matter, and they shape almost every major decision leaders make.

This class is designed as a survey course. You won't become an expert in every topic, but you will build a solid working understanding of how social ventures are structured and managed, and where the hardest challenges tend to arise. Whether you plan to work in the nonprofit sector, in government, in impact investing, or in a mission-driven company, the goal is for you to leave with a practical framework for thinking about how impact actually gets delivered — not just how it gets talked about.

Class Structure

This is a discussion-based, case-driven course. Most weeks, you'll prepare cases and readings and then use class time to apply ideas, debate trade-offs, and practice making real-world decisions.

Across the quarter, we'll cover how social sector organizations:

- Choose legal and organizational structures
- Design business and funding models
- Define their intended impact and theory of change
- Measure results and learn from data
- Work with boards and governance structures
- Think about growth, scale, partnerships, and systems change

When helpful, we'll compare social ventures to traditional for-profit companies to highlight what's similar — and what's not. The goal is not just to understand the tools, but to understand when and why certain tools work better (or worse) in impact-driven settings.

By the end of the course, you should be able to look at a social sector organization and assess how well its strategy, funding, operations, and governance fit together — and whether those pieces are likely to support the impact the organization is trying to achieve.

PREREQUISITES

Undergraduates require instructor consent. Cannot enroll in BUSN 42136 if BUSN 42125 or 20930 taken previously: strict.

MATERIALS

Readings and cases posted on Canvas.

GRADES

The focus of the course is reflected in the grading. The grading is based on a possible 100 points allocated as follows:

- Group Case Write-ups – 30 points (group work; 4 cases with lowest grade dropped)
- Group Simulation Case Submission – 10 points total
- Weekly Reading Quizzes – 10 points (5 quizzes, 2 points each)
- Final Project – 35 points
- Class Participation – 15 points

Student Group for Case Write-Ups

Students will have one group for their case write-ups. Each group will be comprised of five students. Students will be able to form their own groups, though the professor and TA may ask groups to add a non-Booth student to their group. Therefore, students should plan to be flexible in forming their groups. No group will have more than one non-Booth student, and non-Booth students will be spread out among the groups.

Case Write-Ups

Case grades will be based on written answers to several questions associated with each case. The questions will be posted on Canvas **one week** in advance. Each case is worth 10 points, and the lowest case grade will be dropped at the end of the quarter. Students should turn in **1 case per group**. One member of the group should upload the completed cases into Canvas. **Cases must be turned in by the beginning of the earliest class session attended by any member of the group in that week.** (Case write ups will be due week 3, 4, 6 and 7.)

Quizzes

Most weeks there will be a short quiz, containing questions based on the readings assigned for the week. It will be on Canvas.

Final Project

To integrate the in-class learning, students will complete a final project. The project will be comprised of a set of frameworks that students will be asked to apply to a real organization. Students will choose their organization early in the quarter, and there will be interim milestones due over the course of the term. A short presentation will take place on the last day of class.

Class Participation

Participation grades will be based on student's quality engagement in class, including offering comments in class, the ability to answer basic questions about the material, in particular case questions, as well as attendance. Students are responsible for finding ways to engage with the class. Any students facing issues with engagement should reach out the professor early in the quarter.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

SYLLABUS>>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 19 2026

THE LEGAL INFRASTRUCTURE OF BUSINESS (42201) - [PICKER, RANDAL>>](#)

CONTENT

The point of this course is to introduce students to the legal system and legal reasoning with an emphasis on the way that law shapes the strategic environment for businesses. Said differently, this course is about the intersection of law and business strategy. There is no textbook for the course and I will post the readings in chunks throughout the quarter. You will be able to download the readings at the course website.

PREREQUISITES

None.

MATERIALS

There is a [public website](#) for the course and that is where you will find the syllabus. The syllabus evolves throughout the quarter but what you see at the link should be representative of what we will cover.

GRADES

Based on written assignments on a course blog and a final examination.
Auditors require instructor approval.

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: June 17 2025

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 42201-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

Autumn 2025
Section: 42201-85
S 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
304
In-Person Only

CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY (CSR) SOCIAL IMPACT PRACTICUM (42708) - [GROSSMAN, CAROLINE>>](#)

CONTENT

Course Overview

Applications are now closed. If you wish to be considered as a late addition to the wait list, please email: Caroline.Grossman@chicagobooth.edu

This lab course centers around several live consulting projects that allow students to consider the role of the firm in society by exploring the domains of Sustainability, corporate social responsibility (CSR), Environmental, Social and Governance (ESG), and more.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 42708-01
T 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
3B - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

The Winter 2026 course will include three projects, sponsored by [Owens Corning](#), [ThirdLove](#), and [WM \(Waste Management\)](#), all focused on elements of sustainability and circularity.

Class time will be about 50% project-based, complemented by cases, discussions, and guest speakers who extend learnings beyond the projects. There will be some attention to how students work as a team and what you learn from that experience.

By application only.

Class sessions are required and will be in-person only with no remote option. Final presentations will be held during Week 9 and exam week. There will be additional required meetings with your client outside of class, including a potential field trip to begin during the lunch hour prior to class and which may extend into the evening.

Attendance at the first class on Tuesday January 6th is mandatory.

Students will be divided into three assigned groups. Students will have an opportunity rank project preference.

Project descriptions will be updated as available.

Owens Corning:

Owens Corning's glass reinforcements (GR) business is a leading global provider of solutions matching the differentiated needs of the growing composites industry. The 2026 project will focus on identifying opportunities for Sustaina® Loop, a newly launched product made with recycled glass fiber in data center and rebar markets. -In addition to its recycled content, Sustaina® Loop has a 50% lower carbon footprint compared to similar products currently available in the U.S. Students will explore decarbonization goals and market opportunities, helping Owens Corning understand how to best leverage the product's sustainability advantages to create value in ~~its~~ the data center and rebar end markets.

Leveraging a powerful combination of material science, manufacturing excellence, and deep market and customer knowledge, the GR business provides sustainable, customer-centric solutions for the global wind, building and construction, thermoplastic compounding, and composites specialty markets. With annual revenues of approximately \$1.2 billion, the business employs 4,000 people at 18 operations in 12 countries.

WM (Waste Management):

Textile Recycling

ThirdLove:

Textile sustainability and circularity

PREREQUISITES

Application only: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

No pass/fail grades. No auditors. No undergrads. No Take Three alumni.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 17 2025

CONSULTING LAB (42709) - [DAVIS, HARRY>>](#) ; [TERRILL, CRAIG>>](#)

CONTENT

Consulting Lab is an experiential lab course designed to give students the experience of engaging with real clients on strategic issues as management consultants. This lab is conducted in partnership with Kearney, a global management consulting firm with offices in over 40 countries. Projects are sourced from real clients by Kearney consultants, who also serve as professional coaches for student teams.

Students have two objectives in this course: (1) address the complex, strategic business problems brought by clients and develop actionable, data-driven recommendations and (2) develop their own consulting, interpersonal and leadership skills in the context of a flat consulting team. Teams primarily will be created with Master in Management students as well as with a limited number of Master in Finance students totaling up to 28 for the class. Each project will center on an important strategic challenge and require students to apply a broad set of concepts and tools. Kearney will coordinate client participation and supplement faculty with consulting resources to coach and support the student teams. Previous clients have included 3M, Campbell Soup, Georgia Pacific, Nike, Walgreens, Feeding America, Siemens Energy, Black Hawks, Emerson, IDEX, Avendra, Innerworkings, Valkre, Accretive Health, Beam Suntory, Facebook, and Walmart. While students' primary focus is the client project, they also work on related individual skills needed for success in consulting (e.g., soft skills, such as leadership and interpersonal development, and hard skills, such as the hypothesis-driven approach, data analyses, and deliverable development/delivery).

Background:

SCHEDULE

Spring 2026
Section: 42709-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Gleacher Center
204
In-Person Only

Professor Harry L. Davis is one of the top professors at Booth and has taught this course over many years. Joe Raudabaugh (Booth MBA '17), a principle at Kearney, leads the effort for Kearney and is a strong supporter of experiential education at Booth. Adjunct Professor Craig Terrill has taught client-based lab classes at Booth during the last 11 years and was a senior partner in a management consulting firm early in his career.

Enrollment & Application:

Consulting Lab is offered only to students in the Master in Management program (MiM) or Master in Finance program (MiF). Enrollment in this course is **by application**.

1. A Zoom Informational **Webinar** will be held at 12-1 CST on Thursday, February 5, 2026. Course structure, expectations, and potential clients will be discussed. The webinar is optional, and students can apply without attending. An email will be sent to all MiM and MiF students the week prior with instructions for attending the webinar and a link for completing the application (link is also below).

2. **Application Deadline: Sunday, February 8, 2026.**

- [Click Here for the Application](#)

3. Students will be notified of **acceptance** by Tues, February 10.

Class Location:

This course will meet weekly at the Gleacher Center on Thursdays from 1:30 - 4:30 pm. Please see the Gleacher/Booth 455 electronic boards to confirm location. Note below that there are three additional required meetings.

Additional Meetings:

In addition to the regular Thursday afternoon class sessions, there are three additional required meetings. If you cannot commit to attending these additional meetings, you should not apply for the course. Please note that the first one is **before** the spring quarter.

- Thursday, March 5, 2026: 5 pm to 7 pm, Gleacher - Initial training with Kearney
- Friday, March 27, 2026: 8 am to 12 pm, Gleacher - Kickoff meetings with Clients
- Friday, May 22, 2026: 8 am to 12 pm, Gleacher - Final Presentations to Clients

PREREQUISITES

No prerequisites. The course will be by application only for Spring 2026.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

This course will have a Canvas site.

GRADES

Evaluation Criteria: project deliverables (document and presentation), reflection assignments, participation in project teams, and engagement in the Thursday class sessions. There is no final exam and no meeting during final's week. See Syllabus for more details. Other:

- Mandatory attendance on Thurs 3/5 and for class 1 during Week 1
- Allow Provisional Grades

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No pass/fail grades

No auditors

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: February 10 2026

SOCIAL IMPACT LAB (42710) - [CONNOR, TODD>>](#) ; [FOREMAN, GHIAN>>](#)

CONTENT

Course Overview

In this Social Impact Lab, students work in small groups on consulting projects that are curated to address various economic development needs and opportunities on the South Side. By exploring Chicago's rich and complex social, economic, and political history, we in turn work with leading institutions to shape their strategies for how to advance local economies particularly with a lens towards generating wealth in the black community.

The Social Impact Lab seeks to give students opportunities to work with clients in a strategy consulting context while leveraging the Southside as a context for understanding systemic inequalities and the need for multi-sector and community participation in generating impactful strategies. Each week, we bring in guest speakers who can contextualize and animate conversations about economic development in Chicago's Southside and provide real-world insights into the challenges and opportunities that they see and are addressing.

In addition, each week students are given time to work on their client projects culminating in the final capstone in which students will present their findings and recommendations for the clients during the final week. Given the vast and

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 42710-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only

complicated nature of addressing economic development and wealth creation, we bring guest speakers who bring various perspectives that are important: entrepreneurs, elected officials, venture capitalists, leaders at anchor institutions, artists, and philanthropists, among them. Clients for the Winter 2025 section will include:

- [The Obama Presidential Center](#), in partnership with other South Side cultural institutions, is looking to explore revitalizing a tourism and brand strategy to support Museum Campus South. As the Obama Presidential Center nears its public launch in 2026, students will develop a strategy to identify and amplify tourism opportunities for the broader network of cultural institutions that stand to benefit from significant new tourist activity in the broader South Side.
- [The Garfield Park Community Council](#) is working to address food insecurity in the broader community through a variety of strategies. Having successfully recruited an anchor retailer to occupy a grocery retail site formerly occupied by Aldi, students will develop a retail launch, pricing, and customer retention strategy to ensure the success and profitability of the new grocery retail partner.
- [The Chicagoland Workforce Funder Alliance](#) is a collaborative of over 30 funders who develop and fund workforce solutions to strengthen workforce development strategies in the region. This quarter, students will develop a strategy to support transportation access for people entering the workforce, in particular in the construction and trades where vehicle access is required to transit to work and job sites. Students will explore various potential strategies including a shared fleet model, vehicle financing programs, or third party partnership models.
- Other project(s) TBA

Applications for the [Social Impact Lab \(SIL\)](#) are now open, taught by [Ghian Foreman](#) and myself, [Todd Connor](#). The course will be offered winter quarter on Tuesday mornings from 8:30 – 11:30am at the Harper Center. This course is open by application only. **Applications are due on 11/19/2025 at 5:00pm, and decisions will be sent out 11/21/2025.** Students applying early can also receive an early acceptance for course planning purposes. The first class will be Tuesday, January 6th, 8:30-11:30am and is required for all enrolled students. [Interested students can apply here.](#)

PREREQUISITES

None.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

No non-Booth Students

MATERIALS

Cases, course-assigned readings, client-assigned readings.

GRADES

Grading Criterion:

- 65% team output, including graded midterm (25%) and graded final project deliverables (40%)
- 35% individual contribution, including class participation (20%) and effective facilitation (15%)
- Teams must submit a team contract, mid-point contract revision, and a final team performance reflection
- No pass/fail grades. No auditors.

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 12 2025

GLOBAL SOCIAL ENTREPRENEURSHIP LAB (42711) - **HANNA, ANDREW LEON>>**

CONTENT

The **Global Social Entrepreneurship Lab (GSEL)** is an experiential course in which students ideate, research, validate, and test new concepts for impactful social ventures. Each week we have guest speakers ("Founder-Mentors") who are founders of award-winning for-profit and non-profit social ventures around the world – including edtech for refugees in Lebanon, climate tech supporting farmers in Kenya, youth empowerment programs in El Salvador, innovative mental health interventions in the U.S., and microbanks for widows in India, Egypt, and across the globe. Students come into the class without an idea or with an early idea and – after becoming more proximate to a social or environmental problem, developing and validating potential solution ideas, and testing those ideas – leave with a pressure-tested social venture that they can take forward.

The most pressing human rights, social, and environmental issues in society – the refugee crisis, homelessness, inadequate and inequitable access to education and health care, racial injustice, threats to environmental sustainability, and so on – are solvable only by innovative leadership. GSEL provides an opportunity to build the early foundations of a potentially world-changing social venture. At our course meetings, we will learn from the founders of leading social ventures – an incredibly diverse group of guest speakers – about how they designed, refined, launched, and funded their ventures. Students will go from more deeply understanding the issue that most makes them "come alive" to designing and rapidly testing their own social ventures – many of which our students go on to launch after concluding the course, often as part of SNVC.

Students apply individually and can work in groups of one to three. If you already have potential team members in mind, there is a place to note this on your application. This course is for anyone who has an interest in social entrepreneurship and wants to spend their quarter crafting their own social

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 42711-01
TH 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C07
In-Person Only

venture. It is designed to have a global feel and to feature placement partners and guest speakers representing a wide range of backgrounds. Note that this year, unlike in the previous two years, this year's course will focus fully on designing your own social venture ideas; there will not be an additional project component with partner social ventures.

[Applications are now open here](#) and are due by Friday, November 7th at 11:59pm CT.

PREREQUISITES

[Apply here](#) by 11/7 at 11:59pm CT.

We expect all students enrolled in the course to commit significant time each week outside of class on developing and testing their venture ideas. You will not be able to drop after the first class session. No undergraduate students.

RESTRICTIONS

Application-based course

MATERIALS

None.

GRADES

There are five key components of the course grade:

1. Venture Writeups – 16%
2. Interviews Memo – 12%
3. MVP Testing Memo – 12%
4. Deck & Presentation – 36%
5. Participation – 24%

You can read much more about each of these elements in the Syllabus.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors No pass/fail grades Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 03 2025

STRATEGY SIMULATION: CREATING VALUE IN COMPLEX AND AMBIGUOUS SETTINGS (42715) - FITZGERALD, KATHLEEN>>

CONTENT

Strategy Simulation: Creating Value in Complex and Ambiguous Settings is designed around an advanced simulation developed by Booth in which participants focus on managing a business. Students compete in teams to grow a struggling start-up into a valuable company poised for IPO, merger, LBO, MBO, or some other strategy determined by the team. Students come away with a C-suite perspective on the core functions of a business at various stages of development, as well as an intensely salient experience that they can draw upon in their careers.

This course gives students the opportunity to integrate and apply knowledge from several disciplines simultaneously, providing insight into the complexity of real-world business situations and hands-on experience that is hard to come by in more theoretical courses. Not everything can be boiled down to a simple equation. A great strategy can be undermined by an ineffective team, and the organizational chart for a start-up must adapt as it grows. Negotiated agreements may not stand the test of time, and plans can go awry in the face of competition.

To succeed, students draw upon material learned in microeconomics, operations, competitive strategy, financial accounting, managerial accounting, corporate finance, negotiations, marketing, governance, managerial decision-making, and other subjects in the Booth curriculum. The outcome of the simulation depends entirely on the interaction between the strategies that the separate businesses employ, and on their ability to effectively execute these strategies. Success relies on a team's ability to work together, make effective decisions, and compete or collaborate with other teams.

For a brief overview of some of the aspects of the game and class, please go here: [Strategy Simulation Introduction](#)

Course Format and Methodology

In Winter 2025, Strategy Simulation will be taught in person over 9 weeks. The format is largely a mix of lectures and game play. Much of the learning is hands-on, self-driven, and takes place in the context of the simulation. Lectures serve as an overview and a reminder of concepts. Students are provided with frameworks, tools, and guidance; the challenge of integrating the underlying material and finding their own answers is a central part of the learning experience. Approximately 4 hours per week are spent outside of class on analysis, planning, and game play in the simulation. Almost all of the work is done in teams, and thus the ability to work well with others is crucial to success in the course.

Please take the following into account when deciding whether to take the course:

- This course applies many of the concepts learned in other Booth courses. It is not necessary to have taken all of the classes, but we recommend building teams whose combined members have taken many of the classes.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 42715-01
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
C03
In-Person Only

Winter 2026
Section: 42715-81
T 6:00 PM-9:00 PM
Gleacher Center
406
In-Person Only

- Students are given guidance but encouraged to think through problems and find their own answers.
- The simulation is designed to reflect a complex business environment. To run the business effectively students should expect to invest time and effort to (1) learn the interface, (2) analyze the business and its environment, (3) plan strategy and tactics, and (4) work with others to execute those plans in the face of competition.

PREREQUISITES

First quarter MBA students may not enroll. Attendance is mandatory. Students who do not attend week 1 will be dropped. Students who are on the waitlist should attend if they intend to add the class should a spot become available.

Recommended: We recommend you have taken some (the more the better) of the classes listed below and that you form teams whose combined members have taken all of them. We will review some concepts from those courses, but you will be expected to fill in any gaps in your knowledge if you haven't taken the classes.

- Operations
- Corporation Finance
- Financial Accounting
- Managerial Accounting
- Microeconomics
- Statistics
- Competitive Strategy
- Marketing

MATERIALS

All necessary materials will be posted on Canvas.

Please note that the syllabus attached here is for Section 01. Section 85 will have different due dates.

GRADES

No auditors. No pass/fail grades.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors No pass/fail grades Mandatory attendance week 1

SYLLABUS>>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: October 28 2025

STORYTELLING (42813, 50 UNIT COURSE) - ROLNIK, GUY>>

CONTENT

Taking its cue from writers, social scientists, politicians, innovators and powerful business people, "Storytelling and Narratives in Business" argues that whether leading an organization, working with politicians and the media, or looking for business partners, all successful managers, entrepreneurs, and companies share a few potent skills: they appreciate the importance of stories, they develop and maintain strategic narratives, and they know how to tell stories that people remember.

Guided by Clinical Professor of Strategic Management Guy Rolnik, "Storytelling" develops these crucial tools for strategic management in two key ways. First, students learn to critically account for how stories shape our perception of the world in general and our sense of business, economics and politics in particular. This work is undergirded by exciting case studies that explore how companies and CEOs succeed and fail to control their narratives. Second, students learn to identify, refine, and share their own stories every class. This requirement, one of the course's most unique and intensive features, affords students an unparalleled means of shaping their own future narratives. Today's chaotic and fast-paced economic, political, cultural, and technological developments make honing these skills more important than ever before.

Upon completion of the course students should be able to:

- Grasp the ways in which our reality is made of ever-competing narratives.
- Understand the role that stories and narratives play within organizations and outside of them.
- Establish a critical perspective on narratives as tools for strategic management in the arenas of business, economics, and politics.
- Learn the characteristics and techniques of successful narratives and storytellers.
- Acquire the tools for constructing and telling powerful stories that will enable them to become more effective leaders inside their organizations, vis-à-vis their superiors, peers, and employees.
- Acquire tools for constructing and telling powerful stories outside of their organizations, vis-à-vis consumers, regulators, politicians, competitors, and the media.

PREREQUISITES

Prereq: Cannot enroll if 42123 taken previously. Admission to the Executive MBA program

MATERIALS

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 42813-87
08/03, 08/04, 08/05, 08/07, 08/08
EMBA1 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

Summer 2026
Section: 42813-88
08/10, 08/11, 08/12, 08/14, 08/15
EMBA2 9:00 AM-12:00 PM
Gleacher Center
304
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

GRADING BREAKDOWN

This course demands a number of unique requirements – including a high level of open, active participation that entails sharing your story and emotions – that some students may find challenging. While taking this class is an opportunity to overcome those challenges, students unwilling to tell their story in class, sharing it in group meetings during the week and to receive open feedback from day one should feel free to drop out of the course. If you are unsure about whether this course is right for you, please reach out to Nadia Belkind at nadiabelkind@uchicago.edu

Mandatory pre-class assignment

- First story draft (~ 500 words) and 5 minutes recording of the same story.
- Short Pre-class Survey.

Due - Monday, July 27, 2026 at midnight.

Class Participation – 30%

- Attendance during all five sessions.
- Participation will be tracked in each class based on the quality of the response.
- Telling your story in class.
- Responding to cold calling.
- Reading all required reading materials thoroughly before each class.
- Submitting memo on Warren Buffett's Case Study
- Participating in two peer feedback meetings in groups of 4 students.
- Submitting one Progress Report after a peer feedback meeting

Final Project submitted individually – 70%

- Final written version of your personal business story ~ 500-700 words.
- 5-minute video recording of your story, including the version of your story charted across the "Arc Canvas" template provided by Prof. Rolnik

Due - Friday, September 11, 2026 at midnight.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 29 2026

STRATEGY AND DISRUPTION (42830, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [KNEZ, MARC>>](#)

CONTENT

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026

This EMBA elective focuses on the ingredients to developing new venture strategies that have the potential for disrupting industry incumbents. Generally speaking, industry incumbents get disrupted because existing positional advantages that have protected them against new entrants are neutralized. There are two fundamental ingredients to disruptive new venture strategies. First is the innovative application of new technology. For example, Netflix entered and disrupted Blockbuster in the movie rental industry by taking advantage of the weight and durability of DVDs relative to VHS tapes. Salesforce.com took advantage of the emergence of cloud computing to enter and disrupt the enterprise CRM software industry. Of course, while new technology is often a critical ingredient, it must be incorporated into a new innovative business model (often referred to as *business model innovation*) – the second ingredient. For example, Netflix leveraged the DVD to create an innovative DVD home delivery service business model. Also, while Uber's founders cleverly used smartphone technology to automate the traditional taxi dispatch function, just as important was their innovative 2-sided platform-based business model.

These above two critical ingredients to developing disruptive new venture strategies are the basis for successful disruptive new venture strategies along two critical dimensions. First, they create distinctive value for customers in an existing industry. Second, as these new ventures scale their innovative business models, incumbents are faced with the challenge of making fundamental changes to their existing, soon to be obsolete, business models. If incumbents are too slow in making the requisite changes, they lose significant market share, and ultimately, may get completely disrupted.

Finally, from an incumbent's perspective, avoiding disruption requires getting out in front of the disruptive threat. If they confine their strategy to incremental improvements within their existing business model, they are setting themselves up for disruption. By implication, an incumbent's strategy development process needs to incorporate the content from this class. They need to understand the future of their industry through the lens of disruptive new ventures, not just their positionally advantaged incumbent lens. Hence, the content in this class applies to both new ventures and incumbents. It's not just a new venture strategy class.

The academic content will be a combination of concepts and frameworks from competitive strategy, new venture strategy, technology strategy (e.g., Clayton Christensen's *Innovator's Dilemma*), and platform strategy, along with both classic and recent disruption examples/cases (e.g., Netflix, Apple-iPod, Salesforce.com, Uber, Canva, Figma, Resy, Anduril, and more). Finally, given the current "AI revolution", AI as a technology ingredient to new disruptive entrants will be one of the topics covered.

Section: 42830-88
08/10, 08/11, 08/13, 08/14,
08/15
EMBA2 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if 34102, 34882, 39101 or 42820 taken previously.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 07 2026

AI ESSENTIALS (43100) - XIU, DACHENG>>

CONTENT

This course is designed to introduce students to the cutting-edge field of Artificial Intelligence (AI). Across detailed lectures, participants will gain insights into the core principles of AI and machine learning, explore the intricacies of natural language processing, discover the potential of vision recognition and image generation technologies, delve into reinforcement learning for sequential decision-making, and learn about the design of recommender systems that power personalized user experiences. The course also examines the burgeoning field of generative AI and the AI-generated content industry, while emphasizing the crucial importance of bias assessment and the principles of responsible AI.

This course is designed for those who are interested in the inner workings of state-of-the-art AI technologies. Specifically, it places emphases on the philosophy and intuition behind these technologies, as well as their promises and perils, but not on the technical details.

[View welcome/overview video.](#)

PREREQUISITES

There are no formal prerequisites for this course. However, the material covered draws on a range of background knowledge in economics, statistics, and finance. While MBA core courses are recommended, they are not required. Cannot enroll in 43100 if 32200 or 43800 taken previously: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

Canvas site. There is no required text for this course, as the provided lecture notes and cases are self-contained.

GRADES

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 43100-01
M 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only

Grades will be determined as follows: six homework assignments (30%), participation and professionalism (20%), and an individual final exam (50%). For the homework assignments, you are encouraged to work in groups of up to four students, with each group submitting a single, well-organized and professionally presented write-up. Homework is due at the start of each class. The final exam will be a take-home assignment, similar in style to the homework, but must be completed individually.

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

No auditors

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 15 2026

BUILDING AN AI COMPANY (43120) - [GANOZA, CARLOS>>](#)

CONTENT

AI is transforming industries at an unprecedented pace, creating new opportunities for startups and established businesses alike. It represents a fundamental shift in how businesses operate. Yet, while AI's potential is widely discussed, far less attention is given to how to actually build and scale AI products and companies. AI products have different dynamics from traditional software -from the cold start problem and to ethical risks and usability constraints. Successfully navigating these challenges requires a different strategic approach and operational playbook. This course fills that gap.

Designed for future founders, executives and investors, the course aims to provide students with a deep and practical understanding of what it takes to create and grow an AI-driven business. Students will learn about key principles and tradeoffs when developing effective product strategies, the ethical and technical considerations that have to go into AI business decisions, and lessons from early failures and successes of companies that have scaled.

The course is built around two core themes: achieving product-market fit in AI, and the challenges AI companies face when trying to build, scale and sustain competitive advantage.

It follows a structured approach that blends relevant research, real-world case studies, and hands-on application. We will review foundational insights from economics, behavioral science, and computer science that are shaping the frameworks AI practitioners use when making practical decisions. We will have case discussions, analyzing how AI companies navigate critical decisions and trade-offs. Finally, students will apply these concepts and techniques through practical assignments, progressively designing an AI product by the end of the course.

SCHEDULE

Autumn 2025
Section: 43120-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C10
In-Person Only
New Course

Winter 2026
Section: 43120-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C05
In-Person Only

The first half of the course will be primarily focused on understanding the relevant frameworks to make decisions on AI products and illustrate them through case discussions, while the second half will be more focused on the practical aspects of building an AI product through hands-on application in class.

This is not a course on machine learning or generative AI—it's a course on building AI products and businesses, not models or systems.

However, AI products are highly technical, so students are expected to have at least a basic understanding of how AI works under the hood. The course will not cover fundamentals like how to train models and measure their performance, students are expected to be at least familiar with these topics. If terms like AUC, recall, or embeddings sound completely foreign, students should be aware that the workload to be successful in the course will be much higher. While recommended readings and resources will be provided for those who need to catch up, these concepts will not be explained in class.

You should NOT take this class if:

- Your main interest is to learn how to build AI models and systems. There are other technical classes you can take, not this one.
- You want a lab class that will teach you to use different AI tools for product managers and founders. You don't need a full term class to learn those tools, they are easy to learn on your own. While this class may provide a good opportunity to use some of those tools as part of your group project, we will not spend time teaching them.
- You are not interested in frameworks and cases, you just want to build something. There are other pure lab courses you can take for that. This course takes the view that you can't build great AI products without a rigorous decision-making framework, so a good part of the course is dedicated to teaching it.

PREREQUISITES

No formal prerequisites are required, but students without prior coursework in AI, statistics, or competitive strategy should expect a significantly heavier workload, as core concepts in these areas will not be covered during class.

MATERIALS

A mixture of readings and cases that can be found in the Canvas course site.

GRADES

Class participation: 40%

Final group project: 60%

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

No auditors

AI FOR GOOD (43130) - GANOZA, CARLOS>>**CONTENT**

strict: At least one of: BUSN 30135, BUSN 32210, BUSN 35137, BUSN 41204, BUSN 43100 or BUSN 43120

AI is transforming industries, societies, and daily life—offering immense opportunities for innovation but also posing significant challenges. How can business and product leaders ensure AI is designed and deployed in ways that maximize positive impact on users and society?

This course provides practical training and frameworks to build AI products that are responsible and maximize human wellbeing. Through guest speakers, discussions of relevant research, and hands-on exercises and lab work, students will learn how to evaluate when and how AI products can drive social good and mitigate unintended harms.

Students will apply these concepts by working on an AI product—either an existing one to be redesigned for greater positive impact or a new project of their own— throughout the course using the principles learned.

The course will cover both AI products designed explicitly to tackle societal problems (such as access to healthcare, climate change, financial inclusion, etc.), and commercial AI products that while profit driven can be designed in ways that enhance user well-being in relevant dimensions.

PREREQUISITES

At least one of: BUSN 30135, BUSN 32210, BUSN 35137, BUSN 41204, BUSN 43100 or BUSN 43120 (strict)

RESTRICTIONS

Strict Prerequisite

MATERIALS

The reading list can be found in the Canvas course site.

GRADES

Class participation, assignments and a final project/presentation.

RESTRICTIONS**SCHEDULE**

Spring 2026
Section: 43130-01
T 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C01
In-Person Only
New Course

No auditors

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: March 02 2026

ANALYTICS WITH AI (43800, 50 UNIT COURSE) - [MISRA, SANJOG>>](#)

CONTENT

Artificial intelligence is reshaping the practice of analytics. In many organizations, AI now sits alongside dashboards, spreadsheets, statistical models, and business intelligence tools as a practical means of asking questions, interrogating data, summarizing evidence, generating code, and communicating insights.

This course provides an applied introduction to Analytics with AI for executives. The emphasis is not on becoming programmers or machine learning specialists. Instead, the course focuses on how AI changes the analytic process itself: how it can improve the productivity of analysts, expand the types of data that can be analyzed, support new forms of evaluation and measurement, and help teams build lightweight analytic products and workflows.

Across five sessions, the course will combine a general framework component with a practicum component. Sessions will remain intentionally broad enough to adapt to participant interests, while still giving a clear view of the main ideas, tools, and organizational implications of AI-enabled analytics.

PREREQUISITES

Cannot enroll if 32210 or 43100 taken previously: strict.

RESTRICTIONS

No non-Booth Students

Strict Prerequisite

GRADES

RESTRICTIONS

No pass/fail grades

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: April 15 2026

SCHEDULE

Summer 2026
Section: 43800-88
08/03, 08/04, 08/06, 08/07,
08/08
EMBA1 2:00 PM-5:00 PM
Gleacher Center
308
50 Unit Course
In-Person Only

RESEARCH TOPICS IN GENERATIVE AI (43950) - MISRA, SANJOG>>

CONTENT

This course provides a research-focused introduction to modern Generative AI, with an emphasis on how the underlying ideas translate into applied work in economics, marketing, finance, accounting, and the broader social sciences. Rather than emphasizing implementation details, the course focuses on conceptual frameworks, intellectual foundations, and emerging methodological directions. The aim is to help students understand the structure of contemporary AI models and identify how these tools and ideas can inform their own research agendas.

PREREQUISITES

Non-Booth students require instructor permission to enroll: strict.

GRADES

Evaluation will be based on:

1. Weekly Reflections & Mini HW (30%) Short written responses on assigned readings and some smallish HW to help establish ideas.
2. Paper Presentation (30%) Students will present (up to 2) research papers and lead discussions.
3. Final Project (40%) A 10-page research paper developing an idea inspired

SYLLABUS>>

Description and/or course criteria last updated: December 12 2025

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 43950-50
W 1:30 PM-4:30 PM
Harper Center
3SW - Seminar Room
In-Person Only

VOICE OF A LEADER: SPEAKING WITH EXECUTIVE PRESENCE (44101) - WEITZMAN, HAL>>

CONTENT

Speaking like a leader doesn't require you to have formal authority. Organizations are full of people who are not in senior positions but use effective communication to lead initiatives, motivate teams, and unite diverse individuals in pursuit of a shared mission. This course develops your ability to speak like a leader in your organization or sector, whether you're in the boardroom, at an industry conference, or hosting an internal strategy session.

The course is about you, so we'll start by identifying, practicing and refining a "leadership communication avatar" that captures how you want to come across and conveys your vision in a way that's authentic. We'll review and analyze examples of leadership communication and hear from guest speakers.

SCHEDULE

Winter 2026
Section: 44101-01
W 8:30 AM-11:30 AM
Harper Center
C09
In-Person Only
New Course

Summer 2026
Section: 44101-81
W 6:00 PM-9:00 PM

Leadership communication is fundamentally different from operational and managerial communication. It is less about transmitting information and more about shaping interpretation. You will be challenged to move beyond the safety of describing what is, and to stake a claim about what could be. That shift from analyst to author, from manager to visionary, is rhetorical and intellectual. It requires a willingness to risk being wrong in order to lead.

You will learn and practice articulating a vision, framing opportunities, and speaking persuasively about the future. Emphasis is placed on clarity, tone, narrative control, and intellectual authority. You will learn how to develop strategic foresight, use rhetorical devices to frame a vision, and how to project that vision in public.

Throughout the course, we will analyze real-world examples of leadership speech, from quarterly earnings calls to public keynote addresses, and assess what makes them credible, memorable, and effective. You will be expected to produce work that combines expertise and insight with passion and conviction. The aim is not to create stylized performances, but to discover and articulate your own authentic leadership language.

Gleacher Center
208
In-Person Only

PREREQUISITES

None

MATERIALS

None

GRADES

GRADES

Allow Provisional Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

Early Final Grades (For joint degree and non-Booth students only)

RESTRICTIONS

Mandatory attendance week 1

[SYLLABUS>>](#)

Description and/or course criteria last updated: November 13 2025

[Refine Search](#)[New Search](#)[Back to Search Results](#)[Print](#)[See Course Schedule \(Spreadsheet\)](#)

Disclaimer: Course Search provides an overview of each faculty member's course. Specific details regarding class format, assessment, attendance, etc. can be found in faculty members' syllabi. Please review syllabi, and address any questions or concerns directly with faculty and/or TAs.